Data Wrangling with R

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Preface



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Structure of the book

Chapters @import-data-in-r-basics and @import-data-in-r-advanced focus on reading data from flat/delimited files and spreadsheets. Chapters @dplyr-basics, @joining-tables-in-r-dplyr and @dplyr-helper-functions focus on wrangling data using the **dplyr** package, chaining verbs with the base R pipe `|>` (see the primer below). Chapter @r-pipe-magrittr covers the pipe mechanic in detail, including the `_` placeholder, anonymous functions with `\(x)`, and reading older magrittr code. Chapter @tibbles-in-r explores `tibble()`, an alternative for `data.frame()`. Chapter @tidying-data-with-tidyr reshapes data with the **tidyr** package (pivots, splitting/combining columns, missing-value helpers). Chapters @strings-in-r, @date-and-time-in-r and @categorical-data-in-r explore ways to handle text, date/time and categorical data.

The pipe |> in 30 seconds

Every example from @dplyr-basics onward chains verbs with the base R pipe `|>`, available in R 4.1 and later with no extra package:

- `|>` forwards the value on its left into the **first argument** of the function on its right, so `ecom |> filter(purchase)` means `filter(ecom, purchase)`.
- Every **dplyr** verb takes a data frame (or tibble) first and returns one, so a chain like `ecom |> filter(purchase) |> summarise(...)` reads top to bottom as "take `ecom`, keep purchasers, then summarise".

> **Tip**
>
> If you inherit code using the older magrittr pipe `%>%`, read it the same way: for first-argument forwarding it behaves identically to `|>`. The differences (`_` placeholder, `\(x)` functions, exposition/assignment variants) are covered in @r-pipe-magrittr.

Software information

This book requires R >= 4.1 (for the native pipe `|>`) and dplyr >= 1.1.0 (for `.by`, `slice_*()` and `join_by()`); package versions are pinned in `renv.lock`. The R session information when compiling this book is shown below:

```
sessionInfo()
```

```
R version 4.5.3 (2026-03-11)
Platform: x86_64-pc-linux-gnu
Running under: Ubuntu 24.04.5 LTS
```

```
Matrix products: default
BLAS:   /usr/lib/x86_64-linux-gnu/openblas-pthread/libblas.so.3
LAPACK: /usr/lib/x86_64-linux-gnu/openblas-pthread/libopenblasp-r0.3.26.so;  LAPACK versio

locale:
 [1] LC_CTYPE=C.UTF-8       LC_NUMERIC=C           LC_TIME=C.UTF-8
 [4] LC_COLLATE=C.UTF-8     LC_MONETARY=C.UTF-8    LC_MESSAGES=C.UTF-8
 [7] LC_PAPER=C.UTF-8       LC_NAME=C              LC_ADDRESS=C
[10] LC_TELEPHONE=C         LC_MEASUREMENT=C.UTF-8 LC_IDENTIFICATION=C

time zone: UTC
tzcode source: system (glibc)

attached base packages:
[1] stats     graphics  grDevices datasets  utils     methods   base

loaded via a namespace (and not attached):
 [1] compiler_4.5.3  fastmap_1.2.0   cli_3.6.6       htmltools_0.5.9
 [5] tools_4.5.3     otel_0.2.0      yaml_2.3.12     rmarkdown_2.32
 [9] knitr_1.52      jsonlite_2.0.0  xfun_0.62       digest_0.6.39
[13] rlang_1.3.0     renv_1.2.4      evaluate_1.0.5
```

We do not add prompts (`>` and `+`) to R source code in this book, and we comment out the text output with two hashes `##` by default, as you can see from the R session information above. This is for your convenience when you want to copy and run the code (the text output will be ignored since it is commented out). Package names are in bold text (e.g., **rmarkdown**), and function names are followed by parentheses (e.g., `bookdown::render_book()`). The double-colon operator `::` means accessing an object from a package.

About the Author

Aravind Hebbali is the founder of Rsquared Academy. He earned his Masters in Economics from Madras School of Economics. As an active R user, he has authored several R packages such as

- olsrr
- rfm
- descriptr
- blorr
- xplorerr

In 2015, he founded Rsquared Academy, a free and open source education initiative with focus on data science and analytics. Apart from self paced online courses, Rsquared Academy offers customized learning modules for corporates and universities.

You can find him on GitHub.

1 Import Data - Basics

1.1 Introduction

In this chapter, we will learn to:

- read data from flat or delimited files
- handle column names/header
- skip text/info present before data
- specify column/variable types
- read specific columns/variables

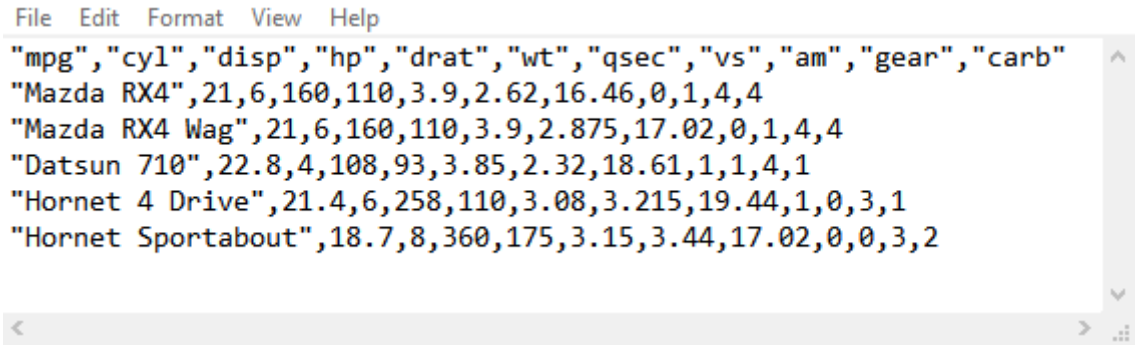
We will use the following R packages:

```
library(readr)
```

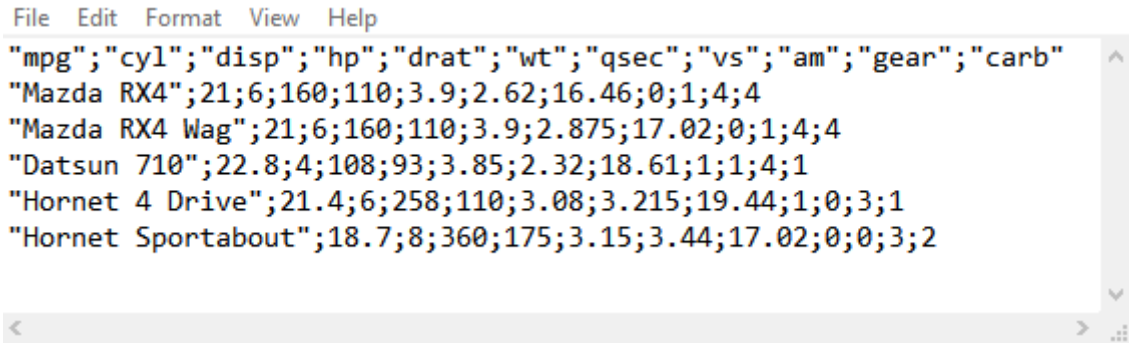
1.2 Delimiters

Before we start reading data from files, let us take a quick look at the different types of delimiters we have to deal with while reading or importing data. In general, it is a good practice to take a quick look at as you will clearly know the delimiter used in the file.

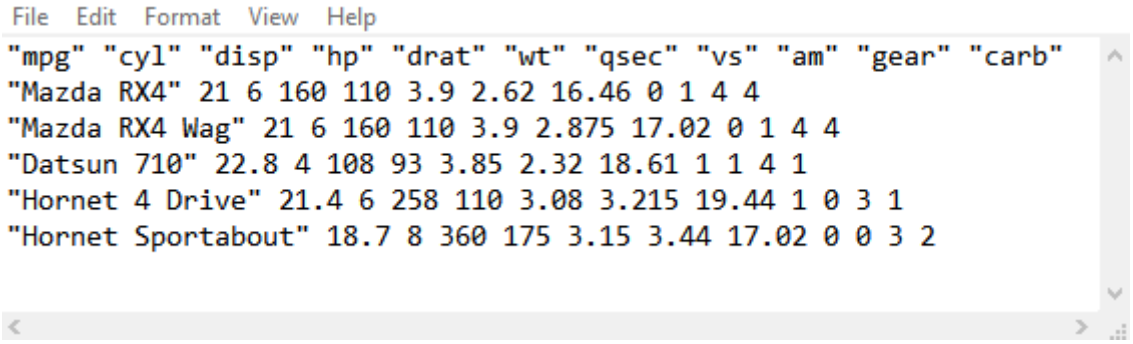
1.2.1 Comma Separated Values



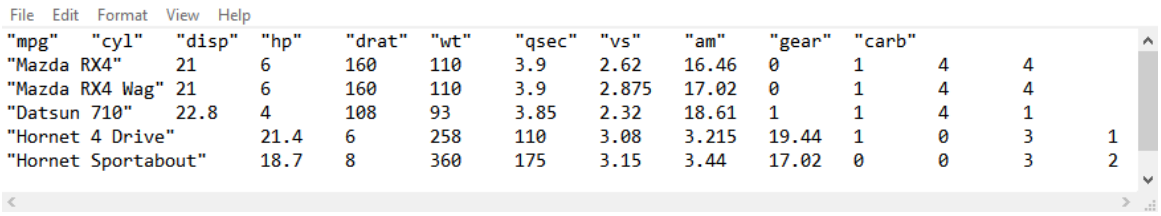
1.2.2 Semi Colon Separated Values



1.2.3 Space Separated Values



1.2.4 Tab Separated Values



1.3 Read Data

Let us begin by reading data from a `csv` file using `read_csv()`.

```
read_csv('hsb2.csv')
```

```
# A tibble: 200 x 11
      id female  race   ses schtyp  prog  read write  math science socst
   <dbl>  <dbl> <dbl> <dbl>  <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl>   <dbl> <dbl>
 1    70      0     4     1      1     1    57    52    41      47    57
 2   121      1     4     2      1     3    68    59    53      63    61
 3    86      0     4     3      1     1    44    33    54      58    31
 4   141      0     4     3      1     3    63    44    47      53    56
 5   172      0     4     2      1     2    47    52    57      53    61
 6   113      0     4     2      1     2    44    52    51      63    61
 7    50      0     3     2      1     1    50    59    42      53    61
 8    11      0     1     2      1     2    34    46    45      39    36
 9    84      0     4     2      1     1    63    57    54      58    51
10    48      0     3     2      1     2    57    55    52      50    51
# i 190 more rows
```

Great! If you see the above output, you have successfully read data into R. If you see an error message (which most of us see when we are trying to read data for the first time), follow the below instructions:

- check the separator in the file and ensure it is a `comma`
- check the file name
- check the file path i.e. location of the file
- ensure that the file name or path is enclosed in single or double quotes

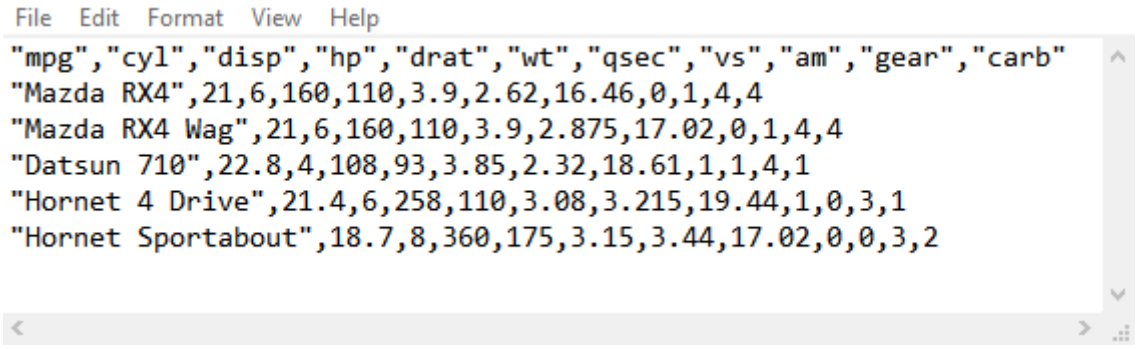
When you read data using `readr`, it will display the data type detected for each column/variable in the data set. If you want to check the data types before reading the data, use `spec_csv()`. We will learn to specify the column types in the next section.

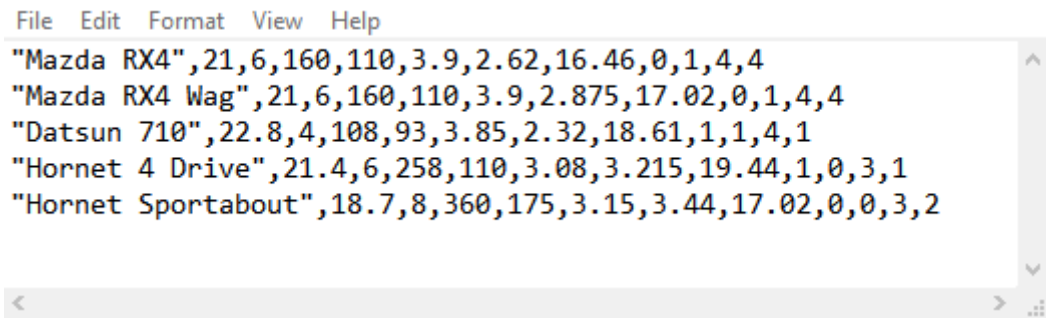
```
spec_csv('hsb2.csv')
```

```
cols(
  id = col_double(),
  female = col_double(),
  race = col_double(),
  ses = col_double(),
  schtyp = col_double(),
  prog = col_double(),
  read = col_double(),
  write = col_double(),
  math = col_double(),
  science = col_double(),
  socst = col_double()
)
```

1.4 Column Names

In some cases, files do not include column names or headers. If we do not indicate the absence of column names, `readr` will treat the first row from the data as the column name. Like we said before, it is a good practice to take a quick look at the data to check for the presence/absence of column names.





We will first read the data set without indicating the presence or absence of column names.

```
read_csv('hsb3.csv')
```

```
# A tibble: 199 x 11
    `70`   `0`   `4` `1...4` `1...5` `1...6` `57...7`  `52`  `41`  `47`
   <dbl> <dbl> <dbl>   <dbl>   <dbl>   <dbl>    <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl>
 1   121     1     4       2       1       3       68    59    53    63
 2    86     0     4       3       1       1       44    33    54    58
 3   141     0     4       3       1       3       63    44    47    53
 4   172     0     4       2       1       2       47    52    57    53
 5   113     0     4       2       1       2       44    52    51    63
 6    50     0     3       2       1       1       50    59    42    53
 7    11     0     1       2       1       2       34    46    45    39
 8    84     0     4       2       1       1       63    57    54    58
 9    48     0     3       2       1       2       57    55    52    50
```

```
10    75     0     4       2       1       3       60    46    51    53
# i 189 more rows
# i 1 more variable: `57...11` <dbl>
```

As you can see, in the absence of column names, `readr` has converted the first row of the data into the column names. As a result, the data is not read properly and there are lots of missing values and warnings. If the column names are absent (i.e. the column names are provided in a separate file), use the `col_names` argument and set it to `FALSE`. Now `readr` will not convert the first row of data into column name and instead it will generate new column names.

```
read_csv('hsb3.csv', col_names = FALSE)
```

```
# A tibble: 200 x 11
      X1    X2    X3    X4    X5    X6    X7    X8    X9   X10   X11
   <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl>
 1    70     0     4     1     1     1    57    52    41    47    57
 2   121     1     4     2     1     3    68    59    53    63    61
 3    86     0     4     3     1     1    44    33    54    58    31
 4   141     0     4     3     1     3    63    44    47    53    56
 5   172     0     4     2     1     2    47    52    57    53    61
 6   113     0     4     2     1     2    44    52    51    63    61
 7    50     0     3     2     1     1    50    59    42    53    61
 8    11     0     1     2     1     2    34    46    45    39    36
 9    84     0     4     2     1     1    63    57    54    58    51
10    48     0     3     2     1     2    57    55    52    50    51
# i 190 more rows
```

We may not always want to use the column names generated by `readr` and instead specify new column names. In such cases, we can use `col_names` to supply column names as shown in the below example. Let us reread `hsb3` and specify column names.

```
cnames <- c("id", "gender", "race", "socio_economic_status", "school_type", "program", "re
read_csv('hsb3.csv', col_names = cnames)
```

```
# A tibble: 200 x 11
      id gender  race socio_economic_status school_type program  read write
   <dbl>  <dbl> <dbl>                 <dbl>       <dbl>   <dbl> <dbl> <dbl>
 1    70      0     4                     1           1       1    57    52
 2   121      1     4                     2           1       3    68    59
 3    86      0     4                     3           1       1    44    33
 4   141      0     4                     3           1       3    63    44
 5   172      0     4                     2           1       2    47    52
 6   113      0     4                     2           1       2    44    52
```

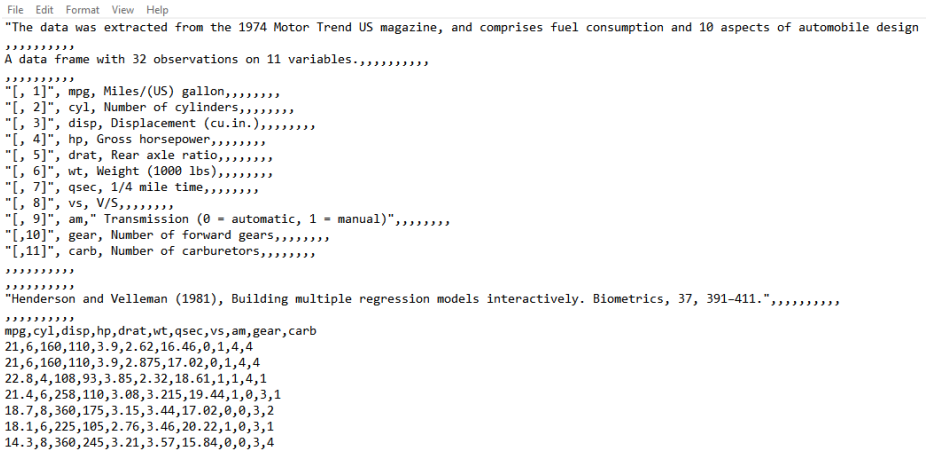
```
 7    50       0      3                      2            1        1     50     59
 8    11       0      1                      2            1        2     34     46
 9    84       0      4                      2            1        1     63     57
10    48       0      3                      2            1        2     57     55
# i 190 more rows
# i 3 more variables: math <dbl>, science <dbl>, socst <dbl>
```

1.5 Skip Lines

In certain files, you will find information related to the data such as:

- the data source
- column names
- column description
- copyright etc.

The data will appear after/below such text/information. While reading data from such files, we need to skip all the rows where the text is present. If we do not skip them, `readr` will consider them as part of the data.



```
File  Edit  Format  View  Help
"The data was extracted from the 1974 Motor Trend US magazine, and comprises fuel consumption and 10 aspects of automobile design
,,,,,,,,,,
A data frame with 32 observations on 11 variables.,,,,,,,,,,
,,,,,,,,,,
"[, 1]", mpg, Miles/(US) gallon,,,,,,,,
"[, 2]", cyl, Number of cylinders,,,,,,,,
"[, 3]", disp, Displacement (cu.in.),,,,,,,,
"[, 4]", hp, Gross horsepower,,,,,,,,
"[, 5]", drat, Rear axle ratio,,,,,,,,
"[, 6]", wt, Weight (1000 lbs),,,,,,,,
"[, 7]", qsec, 1/4 mile time,,,,,,,,
"[, 8]", vs, V/S,,,,,,,,
"[, 9]", am," Transmission (0 = automatic, 1 = manual)",,,,,,,
"[,10]", gear, Number of forward gears,,,,,,,,
"[,11]", carb, Number of carburetors,,,,,,,,
,,,,,,,,,,
,,,,,,,,,,
"Henderson and Velleman (1981), Building multiple regression models interactively. Biometrics, 37, 391-411.",,,,,,,,,,
,,,,,,,,,,
mpg,cyl,disp,hp,drat,wt,qsec,vs,am,gear,carb
21,6,160,110,3.9,2.62,16.46,0,1,4,4
21,6,160,110,3.9,2.875,17.02,0,1,4,4
22.8,4,108,93,3.85,2.32,18.61,1,1,4,1
21.4,6,258,110,3.08,3.215,19.44,1,0,3,1
18.7,8,360,175,3.15,3.44,17.02,0,0,3,2
18.1,6,225,105,2.76,3.46,20.22,1,0,3,1
14.3,8,360,245,3.21,3.57,15.84,0,0,3,4
```

Let us read the data without skipping any lines/rows and observe the result.

```
read_csv('hsb4.csv')
```

```
# A tibble: 203 x 1
   `# A dataset containing demographic information and standardized`
   <chr>
 1 # test scores of high school students.
 2 # http://www.ats.ucla.edu/stat/spss/whatstat/whatstat.htm
 3 id,female,race,ses,schtyp,prog,read,write,math,science,socst
```

```
 4 70,0,4,1,1,1,57,52,41,47,57
 5 121,1,4,2,1,3,68,59,53,63,61
 6 86,0,4,3,1,1,44,33,54,58,31
 7 141,0,4,3,1,3,63,44,47,53,56
 8 172,0,4,2,1,2,47,52,57,53,61
 9 113,0,4,2,1,2,44,52,51,63,61
10 50,0,3,2,1,1,50,59,42,53,61
# i 193 more rows
```

Use `skip` argument to indicate the number of lines/rows to be skipped while reading data from a file. For example, if the file has contents other than data in the first few lines, we need to skip them before reading the data. In the below example, we will skip the first 3 lines as they contain information about the data set which we do not need.

```
read_csv('hsb4.csv', skip = 3)
```

```
# A tibble: 200 x 11
      id female  race   ses schtyp  prog  read write  math science socst
   <dbl>  <dbl> <dbl> <dbl>  <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl>   <dbl> <dbl>
 1    70      0     4     1      1     1    57    52    41      47    57
 2   121      1     4     2      1     3    68    59    53      63    61
 3    86      0     4     3      1     1    44    33    54      58    31
 4   141      0     4     3      1     3    63    44    47      53    56
 5   172      0     4     2      1     2    47    52    57      53    61
 6   113      0     4     2      1     2    44    52    51      63    61
 7    50      0     3     2      1     1    50    59    42      53    61
 8    11      0     1     2      1     2    34    46    45      39    36
 9    84      0     4     2      1     1    63    57    54      58    51
10    48      0     3     2      1     2    57    55    52      50    51
# i 190 more rows
```

1.6 Maximum Lines

Suppose the data file contains several thousands of rows of data and we do not want to read all of it. What can we do in such cases? `readr` allows us to specify the maximum number of rows to be read using the `n_max` argument. Suppose we want to read only 100 rows of data from a file, we can set `n_max` equal to 100. In the next example, we will read the first 120 rows from the `hsb2` file. If you observe the last row in the output, it says `# ... with 110 more rows`, indicating that only 120 rows of data has been read from the file.

```
read_csv('hsb2.csv', n_max = 120)
```

```
# A tibble: 120 x 11
      id female  race   ses schtyp  prog  read write  math science socst
   <dbl>  <dbl> <dbl> <dbl>  <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl>   <dbl> <dbl>
 1    70      0     4     1      1     1    57    52    41      47    57
 2   121      1     4     2      1     3    68    59    53      63    61
 3    86      0     4     3      1     1    44    33    54      58    31
 4   141      0     4     3      1     3    63    44    47      53    56
 5   172      0     4     2      1     2    47    52    57      53    61
 6   113      0     4     2      1     2    44    52    51      63    61
 7    50      0     3     2      1     1    50    59    42      53    61
 8    11      0     1     2      1     2    34    46    45      39    36
 9    84      0     4     2      1     1    63    57    54      58    51
10    48      0     3     2      1     2    57    55    52      50    51
# i 110 more rows
```

1.7 Column Types

If you have observed carefully, when you read data using `readr`, it displays the column names and column types followed by the first 10 rows of data. `readr` determines the data type for each column based on the first 1000 rows of data. The data can be of the following types:

- integer
- double (decimal point)
- logical (TRUE/FALSE)
- character (text/string)
- factor (categorical/qualitative)
- date/time

Data Type	Function
Integer	`col_integer()`
Double	col_double()
Logical	col_logical()
Categorical	col_factor()
Character	col_character()
Date/Time	col_datetime(), col_date(), col_time()
Skip	col_skip()

Before you read data from a file, use `spec_csv()` to see the data types as determined by `readr`. If it determines the data types correctly, you can go ahead and read the data else we will have to specify the data types and we will have to do that for all the columns we want to read and not just for those columns whose data type was wrongly determined by `readr`.

To specify the data types, we will use the `col_types` argument and supply it a list of data types. The data types can be specified using:

- `col_integer()`
- `col_double()`
- `col_factor()`
- `col_logical()`
- `col_character()`
- `col_date()`
- `col_time()`
- `col_datetime()`

While specifying the data types we also need to specify the categories of the categorical/qualitative variable. To do that, we use the `levels` argument within `col_factor()`. Let us read data from the `hsb2.csv` file to understand data type specification.

```
read_csv('hsb2.csv', col_types = list(
  col_integer(), col_factor(levels = c("0", "1")),
  col_factor(levels = c("1", "2", "3", "4")), col_factor(levels = c("1", "2", "3")),
  col_factor(levels = c("1", "2")), col_factor(levels = c("1", "2", "3")),
```

```
  col_integer(), col_integer(), col_integer(), col_integer(),
  col_integer())
)
```

```
# A tibble: 200 x 11
      id female race  ses   schtyp prog   read write  math science socst
   <int> <fct>  <fct> <fct> <fct>  <fct> <int> <int> <int>   <int> <int>
 1    70 0      4     1     1      1        57    52    41      47    57
 2   121 1      4     2     1      3        68    59    53      63    61
 3    86 0      4     3     1      1        44    33    54      58    31
 4   141 0      4     3     1      3        63    44    47      53    56
 5   172 0      4     2     1      2        47    52    57      53    61
 6   113 0      4     2     1      2        44    52    51      63    61
 7    50 0      3     2     1      1        50    59    42      53    61
 8    11 0      1     2     1      2        34    46    45      39    36
 9    84 0      4     2     1      1        63    57    54      58    51
10    48 0      3     2     1      2        57    55    52      50    51
# i 190 more rows
```

If we do not specify the data type for all columns, `readr` will return an error which leads to the following questions:

1. What if I want to skip a few columns?
2. What if I want to read certain columns only?

1.8 Select Columns

Objective	Function
Specify column data types	`col_types()`
Skip column	col_skip()
Read spcecific columns	cols_only()

For the first scenario, we can use `col_skip()` i.e. instead of specifying the data type, we indicate to `readr` to skip that particular column while reading the data.

In case of the second scenario, we will use `cols_only()` to specify the columns to be read i.e. instead of using `list()` to supply the data types, we will use `cols_only()` and provide the following details:

- column name
- column type using `col_types` argument

```
read_csv('hsb2.csv', col_types = cols_only(id = col_integer(),
  prog = col_factor(levels = c("1", "2", "3")), read = col_integer())
)
```

```
# A tibble: 200 x 3
      id prog   read
   <int> <fct> <int>
 1    70 1        57
 2   121 3        68
 3    86 1        44
 4   141 3        63
 5   172 2        47
 6   113 2        44
 7    50 1        50
 8    11 2        34
 9    84 1        63
10    48 2        57
# i 190 more rows
```

If you have a data set with 10 columns and plan to skip only a couple of columns, use `col_skip()` instead if you plan to read only a couple of columns, use `cols_only()`.

1.9 Beyond CSV: parquet and quiet reads

Two habits scale beyond this chapter. First, `read_csv()` announces its guessed column types on every read; once you trust the spec, silence it with `show_col_types = FALSE`. Second, remote files re-download on every knit — cache them locally with `download.file()` once and read from disk afterwards. And when a CSV grows past comfortable memory (the 35 MB `analytics_raw.csv` in later chapters is the first warning sign), switch the format, not the workflow: `arrow::read_parquet()` returns the same tibble the dplyr verbs expect. See @arrow-duckdb for the full quickstart.

1.10 Summary

Type	readr	Base R
comma	`read_csv()`	`read.csv()`
semicolon	read_csv2()	read.csv2()
tab	read_tsv()	read.delim() / read.table()
space	read_table()	read.table()
multiple spaces	read_table2()	read.table()
any delimiter	read_delim()	read.delim()

2 Import Data - Advanced

2.1 Introduction

In this chapter, we will:

- list sheets in an excel file
- read data from an excel sheet
- read specific cells from an excel sheet
- read specific rows
- read specific columns
- read data from - SAS - SPSS - STATA

We will use the following R packages:

```
library(readxl)
library(haven)
```

2.2 List Sheets

An excel file may contain several sheets. Let us see how many sheets are present in `sample.xls` file and their respective names using `excel_sheets()`.

```
excel_sheets('sample.xls')
```

```
[1] "ecom"
```

2.3 Read Sheet

Now that we know the number of sheets and their names, let us read data from the `ecom` sheet of the `sample.xls` file using `read_excel()`. We will specify the file name, and the sheet name or sheet number.

2.3.1 Case 1: Specify the sheet number

```
read_excel('sample.xls', sheet = 1)
```

```
# A tibble: 7 x 5
  channel        users new_users sessions bounce_rate
  <chr>          <dbl>     <dbl>    <dbl> <chr>
1 Organic Search 43296     40238    50810 48.72%
2 Direct         12916     12311    16419 49.27%
3 Referral       10983      7636    18105 22.26%
4 Social         10346     10029    11101 61.92%
5 Display         5564      4790     7220 83.30%
6 Paid Search     2687      2205     3438 38.02%
7 Affiliates      1773      1585     2167 55.75%
```

2.3.2 Case 2: Specify the sheet name

```
read_excel('sample.xls', sheet = 'ecom')
```

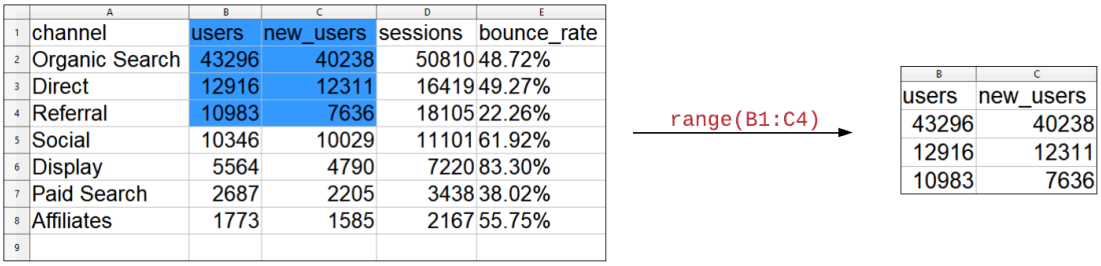
```
# A tibble: 7 x 5
  channel        users new_users sessions bounce_rate
  <chr>          <dbl>     <dbl>    <dbl> <chr>
1 Organic Search 43296     40238    50810 48.72%
2 Direct         12916     12311    16419 49.27%
3 Referral       10983      7636    18105 22.26%
4 Social         10346     10029    11101 61.92%
5 Display         5564      4790     7220 83.30%
6 Paid Search     2687      2205     3438 38.02%
7 Affiliates      1773      1585     2167 55.75%
```

Notice when you use the sheet name, the name should be enclosed in single/double quotes.

2.4 Read Specific Cells

You may not always want to read all the columns or rows from the excel sheet. In such cases, you can specify the cells from which the data must be read which can be achieved using the `range` argument. So how do we specify the cells from which to read data? There are different ways of specifying the cell range and we will look at them one by one:

2.4.1 Method 1



	A	B	C	D	E
1	channel	users	new_users	sessions	bounce_rate
2	Organic Search	43296	40238	50810	48.72%
3	Direct	12916	12311	16419	49.27%
4	Referral	10983	7636	18105	22.26%
5	Social	10346	10029	11101	61.92%
6	Display	5564	4790	7220	83.30%
7	Paid Search	2687	2205	3438	38.02%
8	Affiliates	1773	1585	2167	55.75%
9					

B	C
users	new_users
43296	40238
12916	12311
10983	7636

The first method uses the cell names along with `:` to specify the cell range. For example, to read data from first 4 rows of columns **B** and **C**, we will specify the range as `"B1:C4"`.

```
read_excel('sample.xls', sheet = 1, range = "B1:C4")
```

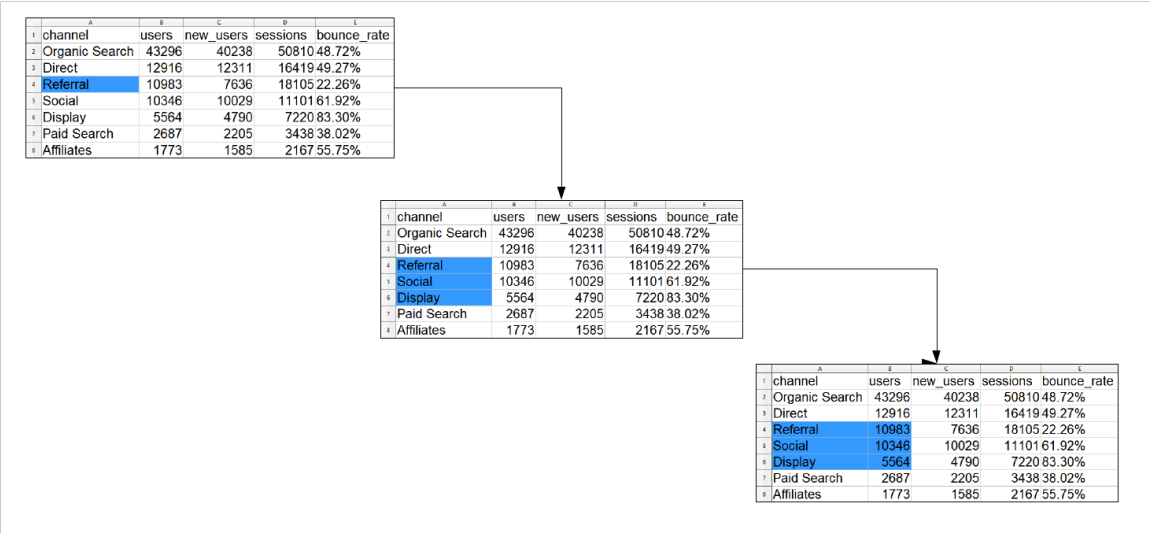
```
# A tibble: 3 x 2
  users new_users
  <dbl>     <dbl>
1 43296     40238
2 12916     12311
3 10983      7636
```

To read data from first 5 rows of columns **A**, **B** and **C**, we will specify the range as `"A1:C5"`.

```
read_excel('sample.xls', sheet = 1, range = "A1:C5")
```

```
# A tibble: 4 x 3
  channel        users new_users
  <chr>          <dbl>     <dbl>
1 Organic Search 43296     40238
2 Direct         12916     12311
3 Referral       10983      7636
4 Social         10346     10029
```

2.4.2 Method 2



channel	users	new_users	sessions	bounce_rate
Organic Search	43296	40238	50810	48.72%
Direct	12916	12311	16419	49.27%
Referral	10983	7636	18105	22.26%
Social	10346	10029	11101	61.92%
Display	5564	4790	7220	83.30%
Paid Search	2687	2205	3438	38.02%
Affiliates	1773	1585	2167	55.75%

In the second method, we start from a particular cell and specify the number of rows and columns to be covered keeping the initial cell as anchorage. In the below example, we want to read 3 rows and 2 columns starting from the cell `A4`.

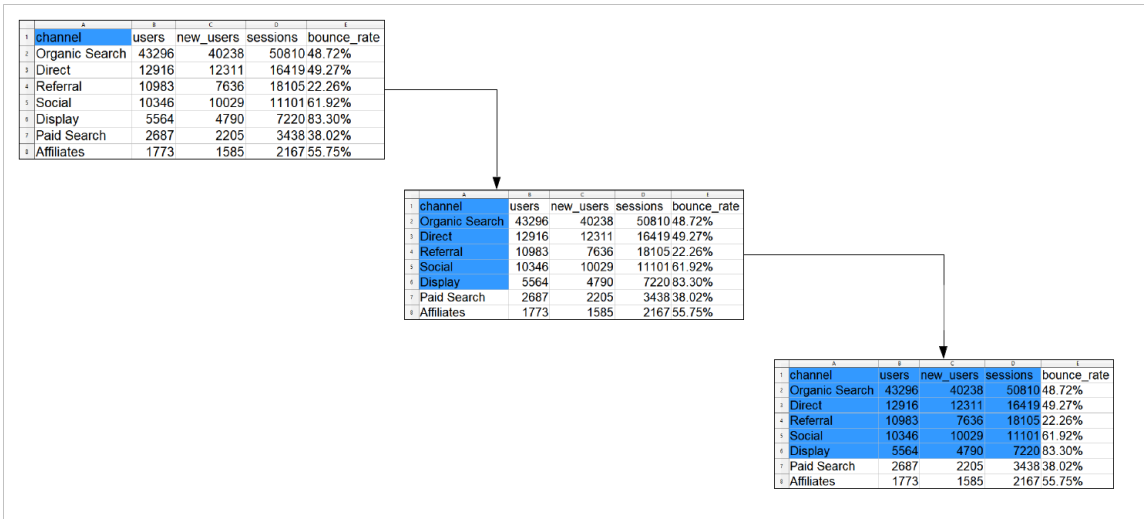
```
read_excel('sample.xls', sheet = 1, col_names = FALSE,
  range = anchored("A4", dim = c(3, 2)))
```

```
# A tibble: 3 x 2
  ...1       ...2
  <chr>     <dbl>
1 Referral 10983
2 Social   10346
3 Display   5564
```

2.4.3 Method 3

In this method, we use the `cell_limit()` and specify the location of two ends of a rectangle covering the cells we want to read. For example, to read data from the first 6 rows and 4 columns, we will specify the range as following:

- start from the first row of the first column
- cover all cells upto the 6th row of the 4th column



channel	users	new_users	sessions	bounce_rate
Organic Search	43296	40238	50810	48.72%
Direct	12916	12311	16419	49.27%
Referral	10983	7636	18105	22.26%
Social	10346	10029	11101	61.92%
Display	5564	4790	7220	83.30%
Paid Search	2687	2205	3438	38.02%
Affiliates	1773	1585	2167	55.75%

```
read_excel('sample.xls', sheet = 1,
  range = cell_limits(c(1, 1), c(6, 4)))
```

```
# A tibble: 5 x 4
  channel         users new_users sessions
  <chr>           <dbl>     <dbl>    <dbl>
1 Organic Search 43296      40238    50810
2 Direct          12916      12311    16419
3 Referral        10983       7636    18105
4 Social          10346      10029    11101
5 Display          5564       4790     7220
```

You can use `NA` to indicate the first and last row/column. For example, to read data from all the rows from the second column onwards:

```
read_excel('sample.xls', sheet = 1,
  range = cell_limits(c(1, 2), c(NA, NA)))
```

```
# A tibble: 7 x 4
  users new_users sessions bounce_rate
  <dbl>     <dbl>    <dbl> <chr>
1 43296     40238    50810 48.72%
2 12916     12311    16419 49.27%
3 10983      7636    18105 22.26%
4 10346     10029    11101 61.92%
5  5564      4790     7220 83.30%
6  2687      2205     3438 38.02%
7  1773      1585     2167 55.75%
```

Let us quickly look at how we will specify range of cells using the above 3 methods when we want to read data from the first 4 rows of columns `B` and `C`:

2.4.4 Method 1

```
read_excel('sample.xls', sheet = 1,
  range = "B1:C4")
```

```
# A tibble: 3 x 2
  users new_users
  <dbl>     <dbl>
1 43296     40238
2 12916     12311
3 10983      7636
```

2.4.5 Method 2

```
read_excel('sample.xls', sheet = 1,
  range = anchored("B1", dim = c(4, 2)))
```

```
# A tibble: 3 x 2
  users new_users
  <dbl>     <dbl>
1 43296     40238
2 12916     12311
3 10983      7636
```

2.4.6 Method 3

```
read_excel('sample.xls', sheet = 1,
  range = cell_limits(c(1, 2), c(4, 3)))
```

```
# A tibble: 3 x 2
  users new_users
  <dbl>     <dbl>
1 43296     40238
2 12916     12311
3 10983      7636
```

2.5 Read Specific Rows

When you want to read a subset of rows from the data, use `cell_rows()` and specify the row numbers or the range. In the below example, we want to read the first 4 rows of data from the file.

```
read_excel('sample.xls', sheet = 1, range = cell_rows(1:4))
```

```
# A tibble: 3 x 5
  channel        users new_users sessions bounce_rate
  <chr>          <dbl>     <dbl>    <dbl> <chr>
1 Organic Search 43296     40238    50810 48.72%
2 Direct         12916     12311    16419 49.27%
3 Referral       10983      7636    18105 22.26%
```

2.6 Read Single Column

If you want to read a single column from the data, use `cell_cols()` and specify the column number. In the below example, we read the second column from the `sample.xls` file.

```
read_excel('sample.xls', sheet = 1, range = cell_cols(2))
```

```
# A tibble: 7 x 1
  users
  <dbl>
1 43296
2 12916
3 10983
4 10346
5  5564
6  2687
7  1773
```

2.7 Read Multiple Columns

In case of multiple columns, we need to specify the column numbers or the column range. In the below example, we want to read the 2nd, 4th and 6th column from the `sample.xls` file.

```
read_excel('sample.xls', sheet = 1, range = cell_cols(c(2, 4, 6)))
```

```
# A tibble: 7 x 5
  users new_users sessions bounce_rate ...5
  <dbl>     <dbl>    <dbl> <chr>       <lgl>
1 43296     40238    50810 48.72%      NA
2 12916     12311    16419 49.27%      NA
3 10983      7636    18105 22.26%      NA
4 10346     10029    11101 61.92%      NA
5  5564      4790     7220 83.30%      NA
6  2687      2205     3438 38.02%      NA
7  1773      1585     2167 55.75%      NA
```

In the next example, we want to read data from the 2nd column upto and including the 6th column.

```
read_excel('sample.xls', sheet = 1, range = cell_cols(c(2:6)))
```

```
# A tibble: 7 x 5
  users new_users sessions bounce_rate ...5
  <dbl>     <dbl>    <dbl> <chr>       <lgl>
1 43296     40238    50810 48.72%      NA
2 12916     12311    16419 49.27%      NA
3 10983      7636    18105 22.26%      NA
4 10346     10029    11101 61.92%      NA
5  5564      4790     7220 83.30%      NA
6  2687      2205     3438 38.02%      NA
7  1773      1585     2167 55.75%      NA
```

2.7.1 Summary

Function	Description
anchored()	Range of cells
cell_limits()	Range of cells
cell_cols()	Columns
cell_rows()	Rows

2.8 Statistical Softwares

We will use the haven package to read data from files of other statistical softwares such as:

- SAS
- SPSS
- STATA

2.8.1 STATA

```
read_stata('airline.dta')
```

```
# A tibble: 32 x 6
    year     y     w     r     l     k
   <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl>
 1  1948  1.21 0.243 0.145  1.41 0.612
 2  1949  1.35 0.260 0.218  1.38 0.559
 3  1950  1.57 0.278 0.316  1.39 0.573
```

```
 4  1951  1.95 0.297 0.394  1.55 0.564
 5  1952  2.27 0.310 0.356  1.80 0.574
 6  1953  2.73 0.322 0.359  1.93 0.711
 7  1954  3.03 0.335 0.403  1.96 0.776
 8  1955  3.56 0.350 0.396  2.12 0.827
 9  1956  3.98 0.361 0.382  2.43 0.800
10  1957  4.42 0.379 0.305  2.71 0.921
# i 22 more rows
```

2.8.2 SPSS

```
read_spss('employee.sav')
```

```
# A tibble: 474 x 9
      id gender     educ       jobcat  salary salbegin jobtime prevexp   minority
   <dbl> <chr+lbl>  <dbl+lbl> <dbl+l> <dbl+> <dbl+lb> <dbl+l> <dbl+lbl> <dbl+lb>
 1     1 m [Male]   15 [15]    3 [Man~ 57000  27000    98       144       0 [No]
 2     2 m [Male]   16 [16]    1 [Cle~ 40200  18750    98        36       0 [No]
 3     3 f [Female] 12 [12]    1 [Cle~ 21450  12000    98       381       0 [No]
 4     4 f [Female]  8 [8]     1 [Cle~ 21900  13200    98       190       0 [No]
 5     5 m [Male]   15 [15]    1 [Cle~ 45000  21000    98       138       0 [No]
 6     6 m [Male]   15 [15]    1 [Cle~ 32100  13500    98        67       0 [No]
 7     7 m [Male]   15 [15]    1 [Cle~ 36000  18750    98       114       0 [No]
 8     8 f [Female] 12 [12]    1 [Cle~ 21900   9750    98         0 [mis~ 0 [No]
 9     9 f [Female] 15 [15]    1 [Cle~ 27900  12750    98       115       0 [No]
10    10 f [Female] 12 [12]    1 [Cle~ 24000  13500    98       244       0 [No]
# i 464 more rows
```

2.8.3 SAS

```
read_sas('airline.sas7bdat')
```

```
# A tibble: 32 x 6
    YEAR     Y     W     R     L     K
   <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl>
 1  1948  1.21 0.243 0.145  1.41 0.612
 2  1949  1.35 0.260 0.218  1.38 0.559
 3  1950  1.57 0.278 0.316  1.39 0.573
 4  1951  1.95 0.297 0.394  1.55 0.564
 5  1952  2.27 0.310 0.356  1.80 0.574
 6  1953  2.73 0.322 0.359  1.93 0.711
```

```
 7  1954  3.03 0.335 0.403  1.96 0.776
 8  1955  3.56 0.350 0.396  2.12 0.827
 9  1956  3.98 0.361 0.382  2.43 0.800
10  1957  4.42 0.379 0.305  2.71 0.921
# i 22 more rows
```

2.9 Summary

File Type	readr	foreign/sas7bdat
excel	`read_excel()`	
sas	read_sas()	read.sas7bdat()
spss	read_sav() / read_spss()	read.spss()
stata	read_dta() / read_stata()	read.dta()

3 Pipe Operator

3.1 Introduction

R code contain a lot of parentheses in case of a sequence of multiple operations. When you are dealing with complex code, it results in nested function calls which are hard to read and maintain. The magrittr package by Stefan Milton Bache provides pipes enabling us to write R code that is readable.

Pipes allow us to clearly express a sequence of multiple operations by:

- structuring operations from left to right
- avoiding
  - nested function calls
  - intermediate steps
  - overwriting of original data
- minimizing creation of local variables

3.2 Pipes

The examples in this chapter use the base R pipe `|>`, available in R 4.1 and later with no extra package. It forwards the value on its left into the first argument of the function on its right, letting us read a sequence of operations from left to right (or top to bottom).

> **Legacy note**
>
> Older code — including the first edition of this chapter — used the magrittr pipe `%>%` and its companions documented in `?magrittr::operators`. Those operators are kept only for reading inherited code; every example below uses `|>` together with `pull()`/`pluck()` and base assignment instead (see the data-extraction section).

3.2.1 `|>` vs `%>%` at a glance

Topic	Base pipe `|>` (this book)	magrittr `%>%` (inherited code)
Package	None — syntax in R >= 4.1	`magrittr` (loaded with the tidyverse)
How it works	Implemented in the R parser; no runtime pipe object	A regular function call, with a small overhead per step
Default	Forwards into the **first** argument	Forwards into the first argument
Other argument	Placeholder `_`: `mtcars |> lm(mpg ~ disp, data = _)`	Dot `.`: `mtcars %>% lm(mpg ~ disp, data = .)`
Inline function	`\(x): 1:5 |> (\(x) x^2)() |> sum()`	`.` shorthand: `1:5 %>% (function(x) x^2) %>% sum()`

For first-argument chains — every example in this book — the two pipes read identically, so inherited `%>%` code can be read as `|>`:

```
# placeholder: pipe into a non-first argument
mtcars |>
  lm(mpg ~ disp, data = _) |>
  coef()
```

```
(Intercept)        disp
29.59985476 -0.04121512
```

```
# shorthand function of one argument, then continue the chain
1:5 |>
  (\(x) x^2)() |>
  sum()
```

```
[1] 55
```

We will use the following R packages:

```
library(magrittr)
library(readr)
library(dplyr)
library(stringr)
library(purrr)
```

3.3 Data

```
ecom <-
  read_csv('https://raw.githubusercontent.com/rsquaredacademy/datasets/master/web.csv',
    col_types = cols_only(
      referrer = col_factor(levels = c("bing", "direct", "social", "yahoo", "google")),
      n_pages = col_double(), duration = col_double(), purchase = col_logical()
    )
  )

ecom
```

```
# A tibble: 1,000 x 4
   referrer n_pages duration purchase
   <fct>      <dbl>    <dbl> <lgl>
 1 google         1      693 FALSE
 2 yahoo          1      459 FALSE
 3 direct         1      996 FALSE
 4 bing          18      468 TRUE
 5 yahoo          1      955 FALSE
 6 yahoo          5      135 FALSE
 7 yahoo          1       75 FALSE
 8 direct         1      908 FALSE
 9 bing          19      209 FALSE
10 google         1      208 FALSE
# i 990 more rows
```

We will create a smaller data set from the above data to be used in some examples:

```
ecom_mini <- slice_sample(ecom, n = 10)
ecom_mini
```

```
# A tibble: 10 x 4
   referrer n_pages duration purchase
   <fct>      <dbl>    <dbl> <lgl>
 1 google        20      220 FALSE
 2 google         4       76 FALSE
 3 yahoo         20      200 FALSE
 4 yahoo         18      198 FALSE
 5 google        18      468 FALSE
 6 social         1      809 FALSE
 7 bing           1      550 FALSE
 8 yahoo         11      176 FALSE
 9 yahoo          8      136 FALSE
10 yahoo          7      140 FALSE
```

3.3.1 Data Dictionary

- referrer: referrer website/search engine
- n_pages: number of pages visited
- duration: time spent on the website (in seconds)
- purchase: whether visitor purchased

3.4 head()

Let us start with a simple example. You must be aware of `head()`. If not, do not worry. It returns the first few observations/rows of data. We can specify the number of observations it should return as well. Let us use it to view the first 10 rows of our data set.

```
head(ecom, 10)
```

```
# A tibble: 10 x 4
   referrer n_pages duration purchase
   <fct>      <dbl>    <dbl> <lgl>
 1 google         1      693 FALSE
 2 yahoo          1      459 FALSE
 3 direct         1      996 FALSE
 4 bing          18      468 TRUE
 5 yahoo          1      955 FALSE
 6 yahoo          5      135 FALSE
 7 yahoo          1       75 FALSE
 8 direct         1      908 FALSE
 9 bing          19      209 FALSE
10 google         1      208 FALSE
```

3.4.1 Using Pipe

Now let us do the same but with `|>`.

```
ecom |> head(10)
```

```
# A tibble: 10 x 4
   referrer n_pages duration purchase
   <fct>      <dbl>    <dbl> <lgl>
 1 google         1      693 FALSE
 2 yahoo          1      459 FALSE
 3 direct         1      996 FALSE
 4 bing          18      468 TRUE
```

```
 5 yahoo           1      955 FALSE
 6 yahoo           5      135 FALSE
 7 yahoo           1       75 FALSE
 8 direct          1      908 FALSE
 9 bing           19      209 FALSE
10 google          1      208 FALSE
```

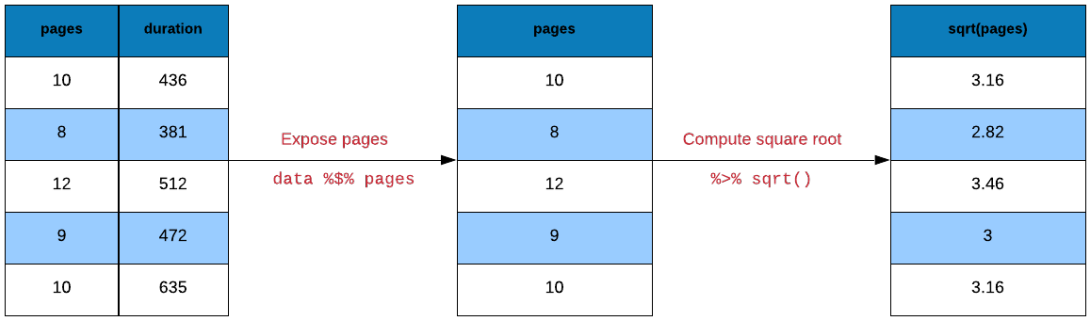
3.5 Square Root

Time to try a slightly more challenging example. We want the square root of `n_pages` column from the data set.

```
y <- sqrt(ecom_mini$n_pages)
```

Let us break down the above computation into small steps:

- select/expose the `n_pages` column from `ecom` data
- compute the square root
- assign the first few observations to `y`



Let us reproduce `y` using pipes.

```
# extract the n_pages column and assign it to y
y <-
  ecom_mini |>
  pull(n_pages)

# compute the square root of y and assign it back to y
y <- sqrt(y)
```

Another way to compute the square root of y is shown below.

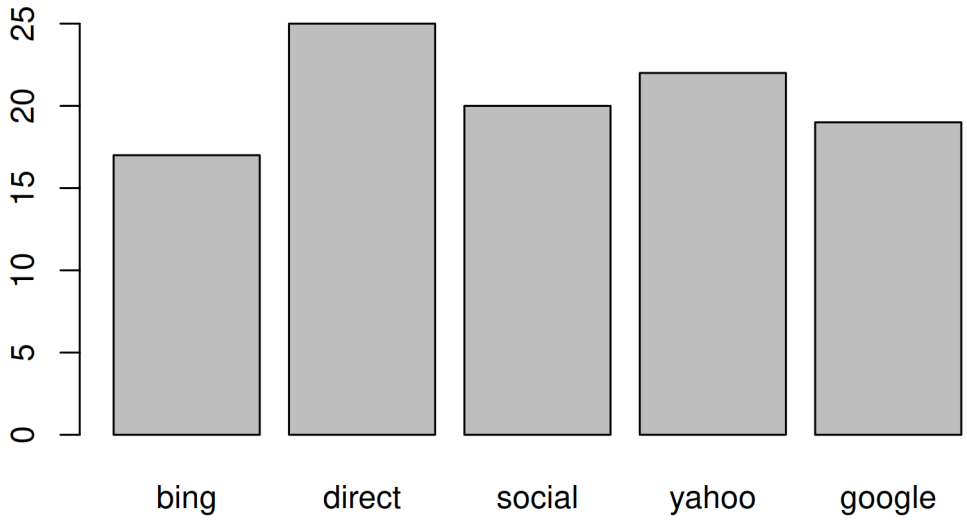
```r
y <-
  ecom_mini |>
  pull(n_pages) |>
  sqrt()
```

3.6 Visualization

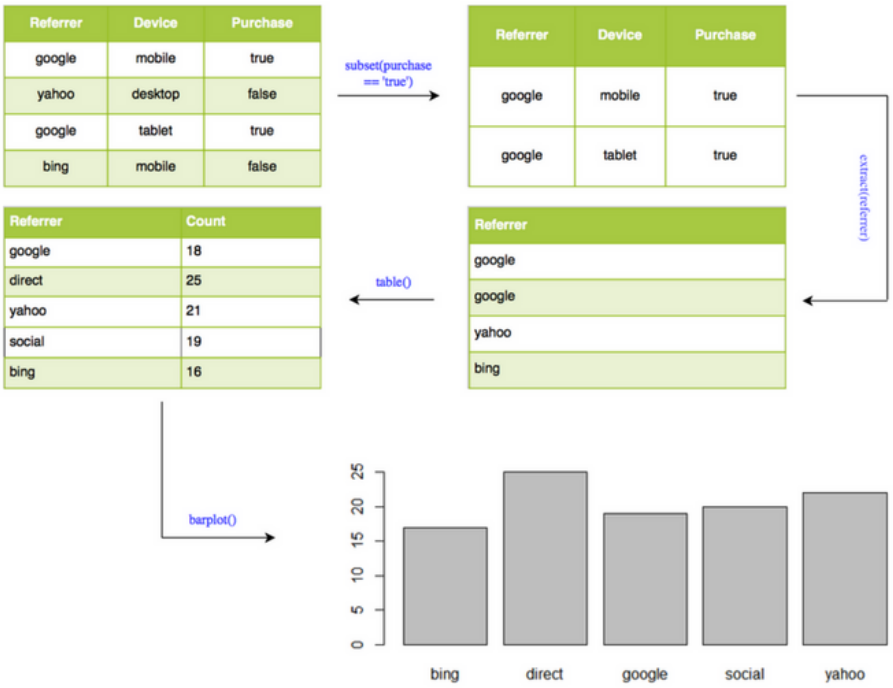
Let us look at a data visualization example. We will create a bar plot to visualize the frequency of different referrer types that drove purchasers to the website. Let us look at the steps involved in creating the bar plot:

- extract rows where purchase is TRUE
- select/expose `referrer` column
- tabulate referrer data using `table()`
- use the tabulated data to create bar plot using `barplot()`

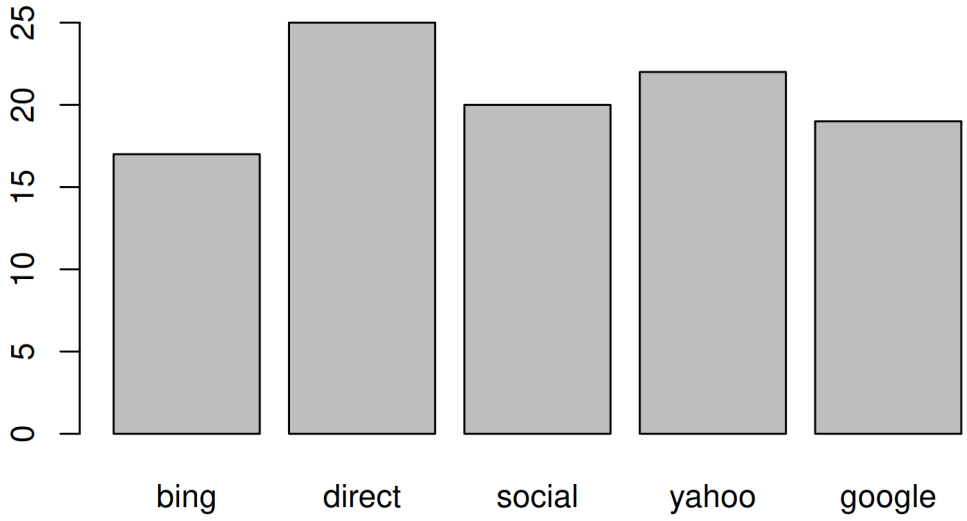
```r
barplot(table(subset(ecom, purchase)$referrer))
```



3.6.1 Using pipe



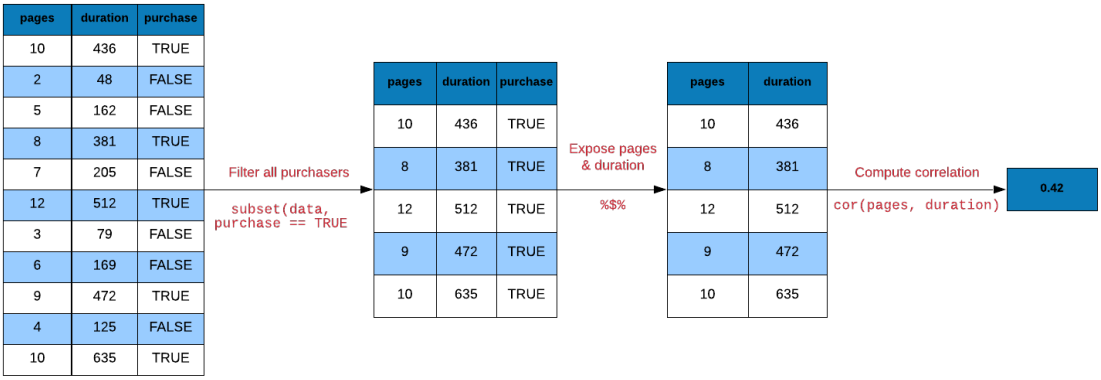

```
ecom |>
  subset(purchase) |>
  pull('referrer') |>
  table() |>
  barplot()
```



3.7 Correlation

Correlation is a statistical measure that indicates the extent to which two or more variables fluctuate together. In R, correlation is computed using `cor()`. Let us look at the correlation between the number of pages browsed and time spent on the site for visitors who purchased some product. Below are the steps for computing correlation:

- extract rows where purchase is TRUE
- select/expose `n_pages` and `duration` columns
- use `cor()` to compute the correlation




```
# without pipe
ecom1 <- subset(ecom, purchase)
cor(ecom1$n_pages, ecom1$duration)
```

```
[1] 0.4290905
```

```
# with pipe
ecom |>
  filter(purchase) |>
  summarise(cor = cor(n_pages, duration))
```

```
# A tibble: 1 x 1
    cor
  <dbl>
1 0.429
```

3.8 Regression

Let us look at a regression example. We regress time spent on the site on number of pages visited. Below are the steps involved in running the regression:

- use `duration` and `n_pages` columns from ecom data
- pass the above data to `lm()`
- pass the output from `lm()` to `summary()`

```
summary(lm(duration ~ n_pages, data = ecom))
```

```
Call:
lm(formula = duration ~ n_pages, data = ecom)

Residuals:
    Min      1Q  Median      3Q     Max
-386.45 -213.03  -38.93  179.31  602.55

Coefficients:
            Estimate Std. Error t value Pr(>|t|)
(Intercept)  404.803     11.323  35.750  < 2e-16 ***
n_pages       -8.355      1.296  -6.449 1.76e-10 ***
---
Signif. codes:  0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1

Residual standard error: 263.3 on 998 degrees of freedom
Multiple R-squared:   0.04, Adjusted R-squared:  0.03904
F-statistic: 41.58 on 1 and 998 DF,  p-value: 1.756e-10
```

3.8.1 Using pipe

```
ecom |>
  with(lm(duration ~ n_pages)) |>
  summary()
```

```
Call:
lm(formula = duration ~ n_pages)

Residuals:
    Min      1Q  Median      3Q     Max
-386.45 -213.03  -38.93  179.31  602.55

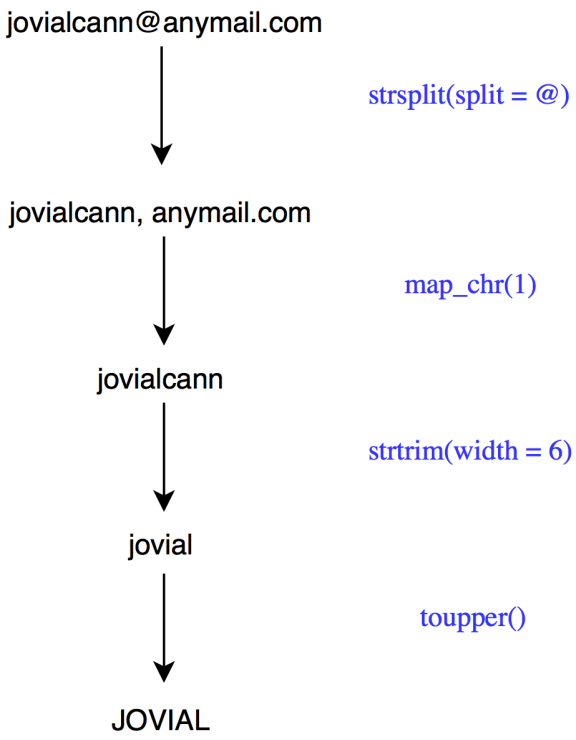
Coefficients:
            Estimate Std. Error t value Pr(>|t|)
(Intercept)  404.803     11.323  35.750  < 2e-16 ***
n_pages       -8.355      1.296  -6.449 1.76e-10 ***
---
Signif. codes:  0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1

Residual standard error: 263.3 on 998 degrees of freedom
Multiple R-squared:   0.04, Adjusted R-squared:  0.03904
F-statistic: 41.58 on 1 and 998 DF,  p-value: 1.756e-10
```

3.9 String Manipulation

We want to extract the first name (jovial) from the below email id and convert it to upper case. Below are the steps to achieve this:

- split the email id using the pattern `@` using `str_split()`
- extract the first element of the resulting list and the first element of the character vector using `pluck()`
- extract the first six characters using `str_sub()`
- convert to upper case using `str_to_upper()`




```
email <- 'jovialcann@anymail.com'

# without pipe
str_to_upper(str_sub(str_split(email, '@')[[1]][1], start = 1, end = 6))
```

```
[1] "JOVIAL"
```

```
# with pipe
email |>
  str_split(pattern = '@') |>
  pluck(1, 1) |>
```

```
  str_sub(start = 1, end = 6) |>
  str_to_upper()
```

```
[1] "JOVIAL"
```

Another method that uses `map_chr()` from the purrr package.

```
email |>
  str_split(pattern = '@') |>
  map_chr(1) |>
  str_sub(start = 1, end = 6) |>
  str_to_upper()
```

```
[1] "JOVIAL"
```

3.10 Data Extraction

Let us turn our attention towards data extraction. dplyr and purrr provide `pull()` and `pluck()` as readable alternatives to `$`, `[` and `[[`:

- `pull()` extracts a column as a vector (like `$`)
- `pluck()` extracts an element from a list or vector (like `[[`)

3.10.1 Extract Column

To extract a specific column using the column name, we mention the name of the column in single/double quotes within `[` or `[[`. In case of `$`, we do not use quotes.

```
# base
ecom_mini['n_pages']
```

```
# A tibble: 10 x 1
   n_pages
     <dbl>
 1      20
 2       4
 3      20
 4      18
 5      18
 6       1
 7       1
```

```
 8      11
 9       8
10       7
```

```
# tidyverse
select(ecom_mini, n_pages)
```

```
# A tibble: 10 x 1
   n_pages
     <dbl>
 1      20
 2       4
 3      20
 4      18
 5      18
 6       1
 7       1
 8      11
 9       8
10       7
```

We can extract columns using their index position. Keep in mind that index position starts from **1** in R. In the below example, we show how to extract `n_pages` column but instead of using the column name, we use the column position.

```
# base
ecom_mini[2]
```

```
# A tibble: 10 x 1
   n_pages
     <dbl>
 1      20
 2       4
 3      20
 4      18
 5      18
 6       1
 7       1
 8      11
 9       8
10       7
```

```
# tidyverse
select(ecom_mini, 2)
```

```
# A tibble: 10 x 1
   n_pages
     <dbl>
 1      20
 2       4
 3      20
 4      18
 5      18
 6       1
 7       1
 8      11
 9       8
10       7
```

One important differentiator between `[` and `[[` is that `[[` will return an atomic vector and not a `data.frame`. `$` will also return an atomic vector. In the tidyverse, we use `pull()` in place of `$`.

```
# base
ecom_mini$n_pages
```

```
 [1] 20  4 20 18 18  1  1 11  8  7
```

```
# tidyverse
pull(ecom_mini, n_pages)
```

```
 [1] 20  4 20 18 18  1  1 11  8  7
```

3.10.2 Extract List Element

Let us convert `ecom_mini` into a list using as.list() as shown below:

```
ecom_list <- as.list(ecom_mini)
```

To extract elements of a list, we use `pluck()`. It is the tidyverse alternative for `[[`.

```
# base
ecom_list[['n_pages']]
```

```
 [1] 20  4 20 18 18  1  1 11  8  7
```

```
# tidyverse
pluck(ecom_list, 'n_pages')
```

```
 [1] 20  4 20 18 18  1  1 11  8  7
```

```
# base
ecom_list[[1]]
```

```
 [1] google google yahoo  yahoo  google social bing   yahoo  yahoo  yahoo
Levels: bing direct social yahoo google
```

```
# tidyverse
pluck(ecom_list, 1)
```

```
 [1] google google yahoo  yahoo  google social bing   yahoo  yahoo  yahoo
Levels: bing direct social yahoo google
```

We can extract the elements of a list by name using `pluck()` as well.

```
# base
ecom_list$n_pages
```

```
 [1] 20  4 20 18 18  1  1 11  8  7
```

```
# tidyverse
pluck(ecom_list, "n_pages")
```

```
 [1] 20  4 20 18 18  1  1 11  8  7
```

3.11 Arithmetic Operations

magrittr offer alternatives for arithemtic operations as well. We will look at a few examples below.

- `add()`
- `subtract()`
- `multiply_by()`
- `multiply_by_matrix()`
- `divide_by()`
- `divide_by_int()`
- `mod()`
- `raise_to_power()`

3.11.1 Addition

```
1:10 + 1
```

```
 [1]  2  3  4  5  6  7  8  9 10 11
```

```
add(1:10, 1)
```

```
 [1]  2  3  4  5  6  7  8  9 10 11
```

```
`+`(1:10, 1)
```

```
 [1]  2  3  4  5  6  7  8  9 10 11
```

3.11.2 Multiplication

```
1:10 * 3
```

```
 [1]  3  6  9 12 15 18 21 24 27 30
```

```
multiply_by(1:10, 3)
```

```
 [1]  3  6  9 12 15 18 21 24 27 30
```

```
`*`(1:10, 3)
```

```
 [1]  3  6  9 12 15 18 21 24 27 30
```

3.11.3 Division

```
1:10 / 2
```

```
 [1] 0.5 1.0 1.5 2.0 2.5 3.0 3.5 4.0 4.5 5.0
```

```
divide_by(1:10, 2)
```

```
 [1] 0.5 1.0 1.5 2.0 2.5 3.0 3.5 4.0 4.5 5.0
```

```
`/`(1:10, 2)
```

```
 [1] 0.5 1.0 1.5 2.0 2.5 3.0 3.5 4.0 4.5 5.0
```

3.11.4 Power

```
1:10 ^ 2
```

```
  [1]   1   2   3   4   5   6   7   8   9  10  11  12  13  14  15  16  17  18
 [19]  19  20  21  22  23  24  25  26  27  28  29  30  31  32  33  34  35  36
 [37]  37  38  39  40  41  42  43  44  45  46  47  48  49  50  51  52  53  54
 [55]  55  56  57  58  59  60  61  62  63  64  65  66  67  68  69  70  71  72
 [73]  73  74  75  76  77  78  79  80  81  82  83  84  85  86  87  88  89  90
 [91]  91  92  93  94  95  96  97  98  99 100
```

```
raise_to_power(1:10, 2)
```

```
 [1]   1   4   9  16  25  36  49  64  81 100
```

```
`^`(1:10, 2)
```

```
 [1]   1   4   9  16  25  36  49  64  81 100
```

3.12 Logical Operators

There are alternatives for logical operators as well. We will look at a few examples below.

- `and()`
- `or()`
- `equals()`
- `not()`
- `is_greater_than()`
- `is_weakly_greater_than()`
- `is_less_than()`
- `is_weakly_less_than()`

3.12.1 Greater Than

```
1:10 > 5
```

```
 [1] FALSE FALSE FALSE FALSE FALSE  TRUE  TRUE  TRUE  TRUE  TRUE
```

```
is_greater_than(1:10, 5)
```

```
 [1] FALSE FALSE FALSE FALSE FALSE  TRUE  TRUE  TRUE  TRUE  TRUE
```

```
`>`(1:10, 5)
```

```
 [1] FALSE FALSE FALSE FALSE FALSE  TRUE  TRUE  TRUE  TRUE  TRUE
```

3.12.2 Weakly Greater Than

```
1:10 >= 5
```

```
 [1] FALSE FALSE FALSE FALSE  TRUE  TRUE  TRUE  TRUE  TRUE  TRUE
```

```
is_weakly_greater_than(1:10, 5)
```

```
 [1] FALSE FALSE FALSE FALSE  TRUE  TRUE  TRUE  TRUE  TRUE  TRUE
```

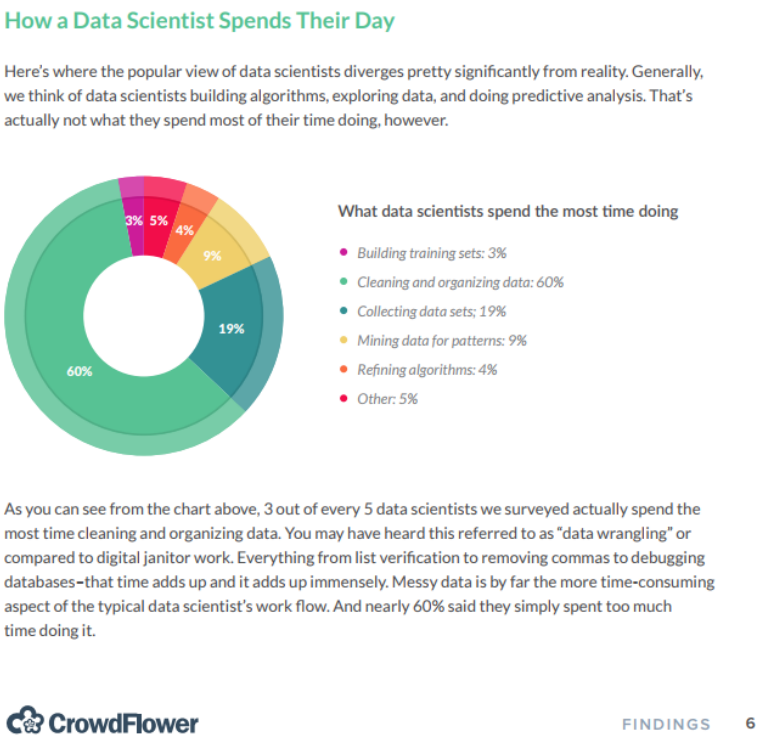
```
`>=`(1:10, 5)
```

```
 [1] FALSE FALSE FALSE FALSE  TRUE  TRUE  TRUE  TRUE  TRUE  TRUE
```

4 dplyr Basics

4.1 Introduction

According to a survey by CrowdFlower, data scientists spend most of their time cleaning and manipulating data rather than mining or modeling them for insights. As such, it becomes important to have tools that make data manipulation faster and easier. In today's chapter, we introduce you to dplyr, a grammar of data manipulation.



How a Data Scientist Spends Their Day

Here's where the popular view of data scientists diverges pretty significantly from reality. Generally, we think of data scientists building algorithms, exploring data, and doing predictive analysis. That's actually not what they spend most of their time doing, however.

As you can see from the chart above, 3 out of every 5 data scientists we surveyed actually spend the most time cleaning and organizing data. You may have heard this referred to as "data wrangling" or compared to digital janitor work. Everything from list verification to removing commas to debugging databases–that time adds up and it adds up immensely. Messy data is by far the more time-consuming aspect of the typical data scientist's work flow. And nearly 60% said they simply spent too much time doing it.

CrowdFlower FINDINGS 6

We will use the following R packages:

```
library(dplyr)
library(readr)
```

4.2 dplyr Verbs

dplyr provides a set of verbs that help us solve the most common data manipulation challenges while working with tabular data (dataframes, tibbles):

- select
- filter
- arrange
- mutate
- summarise

4.3 Data

```
ecom <-
  read_csv('https://raw.githubusercontent.com/rsquaredacademy/datasets/master/web.csv',
    col_types = cols_only(device = col_factor(levels = c("laptop", "tablet", "mobile")),
      referrer = col_factor(levels = c("bing", "direct", "social", "yahoo", "google")),
      purchase = col_logical(), n_pages = col_double(), n_visit = col_double(),
      duration = col_double(), order_value = col_double(), order_items = col_double()
    )
  )

ecom
```

```
# A tibble: 1,000 x 8
   referrer device n_visit n_pages duration purchase order_items order_value
   <fct>    <fct>    <dbl>   <dbl>    <dbl> <lgl>          <dbl>       <dbl>
 1 google   laptop      10       1      693 FALSE              0           0
 2 yahoo    tablet       9       1      459 FALSE              0           0
 3 direct   laptop       0       1      996 FALSE              0           0
 4 bing     tablet       3      18      468 TRUE               6         434
 5 yahoo    mobile       9       1      955 FALSE              0           0
 6 yahoo    laptop       5       5      135 FALSE              0           0
 7 yahoo    mobile      10       1       75 FALSE              0           0
 8 direct   mobile      10       1      908 FALSE              0           0
 9 bing     mobile       3      19      209 FALSE              0           0
10 google   mobile       6       1      208 FALSE              0           0
# i 990 more rows
```

4.3.1 Data Dictionary

Below is the description of the data set:

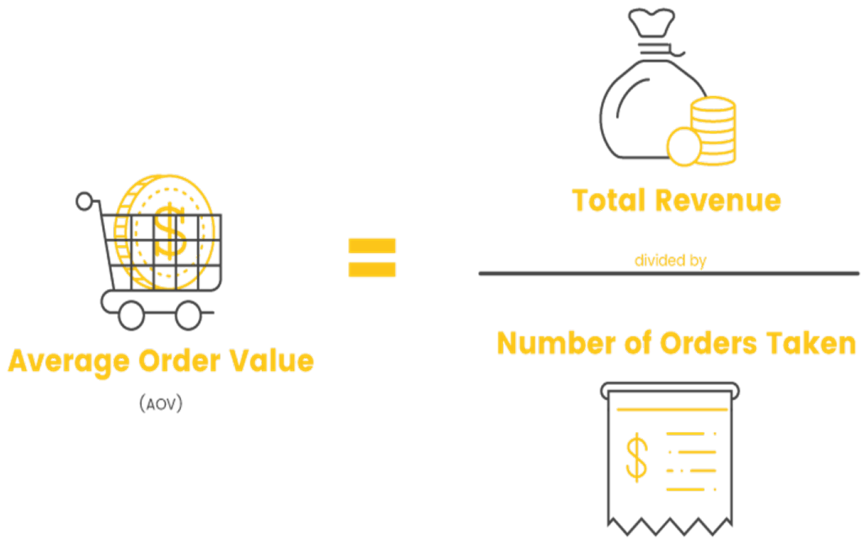
- referrer: referrer website/search engine
- device: device used to visit the website
- n_pages: number of pages visited
- duration: time spent on the website (in seconds)
- purchase: whether visitor purchased
- order_value: order value of visitor (in dollars)
- n_visit: number of visits

4.4 Case Study

We will use dplyr to answer the following:

- what is the average order value by device types?
- what is the average number of pages visited by purchasers and non-purchasers?
- what is the average time on site for purchasers vs non-purchasers?
- what is the average number of pages visited by purchasers and non-purchasers using mobile?

4.5 Average Order Value



4.6 AOV by Devices

> **Reading pipes**
>
> `|>` forwards the tibble on its left into the first argument of the verb on its right (see the Preface primer). Every verb below returns a tibble, so the chain reads as one sentence: keep purchasers, summarise revenue and orders by device, add AOV, keep two columns, sort.

```
ecom |>
  filter(purchase) |>
  summarise(revenue = sum(order_value), orders = n(), .by = device) |>
  mutate(
    aov = revenue / orders
  ) |>
  select(device, aov) |>
  arrange(aov)
```

```
# A tibble: 3 x 2
  device   aov
  <fct>  <dbl>
1 tablet 1426.
2 mobile 1431.
3 laptop 1824.
```

4.7 Syntax

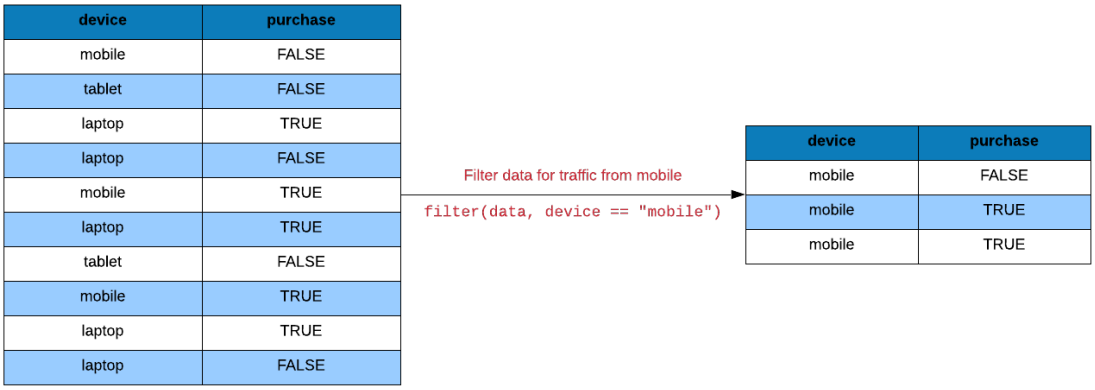
Before we start exploring the dplyr verbs, let us look at their syntax:

- the first argument is always a `data.frame` or `tibble`
- the subsequent arguments provide the information required for the verbs to take action
- the name of columns in the data need not be surrounded by quotes

4.8 Filter Rows

In order to compute the AOV, we must first separate the purchasers from non-purchasers. We will do this by filtering the data related to purchasers using the `filter()` function. It allows us to filter rows that meet a specific criteria/condition. The first argument is the name of the data frame and the rest of the arguments are expressions for filtering the data. Let us look at a few examples:

The first example we will look at filters all visits from device **mobile**. As we had learnt in the previous section, the first argument is our data set `ecom` and the next argument is the condition for filtering rows.

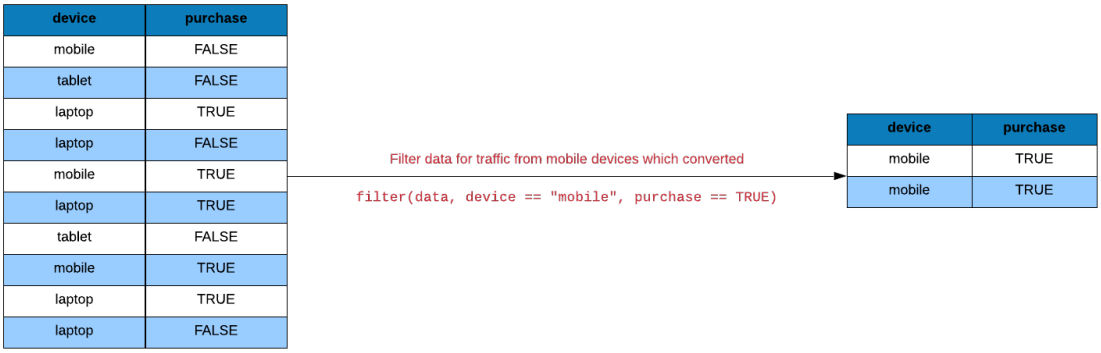



```
filter(ecom, device == "mobile")
```

```
# A tibble: 344 x 8
   referrer device n_visit n_pages duration purchase order_items order_value
   <fct>    <fct>    <dbl>   <dbl>    <dbl> <lgl>          <dbl>       <dbl>
 1 yahoo    mobile       9       1      955 FALSE              0           0
 2 yahoo    mobile      10       1       75 FALSE              0           0
 3 direct   mobile      10       1      908 FALSE              0           0
 4 bing     mobile       3      19      209 FALSE              0           0
 5 google   mobile       6       1      208 FALSE              0           0
 6 direct   mobile       9      14      406 TRUE               3         651
 7 yahoo    mobile       7       1       19 FALSE              7        2423
 8 google   mobile       5       1      147 FALSE              0           0
 9 bing     mobile       0       7      196 FALSE              4         237
10 google   mobile      10       1      338 FALSE              0           0
# i 334 more rows
```

We can specify multiple filtering conditions as well. In the below example, we specify two filter conditions:

- visit from device **mobile**
- resulted in a purchase or conversion




```
filter(ecom, device == "mobile", purchase)
```

```
# A tibble: 36 x 8
   referrer device n_visit n_pages duration purchase order_items order_value
   <fct>    <fct>    <dbl>   <dbl>    <dbl> <lgl>          <dbl>       <dbl>
 1 direct   mobile       9      14      406 TRUE               3         651
 2 bing     mobile       4      20      440 TRUE               3         184
 3 bing     mobile       3      18      288 TRUE               6         764
 4 social   mobile      10      11      242 TRUE               4         287
 5 yahoo    mobile       6      14      322 TRUE               3        1443
 6 google   mobile       1      18      252 TRUE               3        2449
 7 social   mobile       7      16      352 TRUE              10        2824
 8 direct   mobile       4      18      324 TRUE               3        1670
 9 social   mobile       1      20      520 TRUE               5        1021
10 yahoo    mobile       0      13      351 TRUE              10         288
# i 26 more rows
```

Here is another example where we specify multiple conditions:

- visit from device **tablet**
- made a purchase
- browsed less than 15 pages

```
filter(ecom, device == "tablet", purchase, n_pages < 15)
```

```
# A tibble: 12 x 8
   referrer device n_visit n_pages duration purchase order_items order_value
   <fct>    <fct>    <dbl>   <dbl>    <dbl> <lgl>          <dbl>       <dbl>
 1 social   tablet       7      10      290 TRUE               9        1304
 2 yahoo    tablet       2      14      364 TRUE               6        1667
 3 google   tablet       7      12      324 TRUE               2        1358
 4 direct   tablet       3      12      324 TRUE              10        1257
```

```
 5 yahoo    tablet       0      13      390 TRUE              5        1748
 6 social   tablet       2      12      300 TRUE              2        2754
 7 direct   tablet       6      13      338 TRUE              5         683
 8 yahoo    tablet       2      10      280 TRUE              4         293
 9 social   tablet      10      10      290 TRUE              9          37
10 direct   tablet       3      10      260 TRUE              7         980
11 google   tablet       9      14      308 TRUE              7        2436
12 social   tablet      10      11      330 TRUE              1        2171
```

4.8.1 Case Study

Let us apply what we have learnt to the case study. We want to filter all visits that resulted in a purchase.

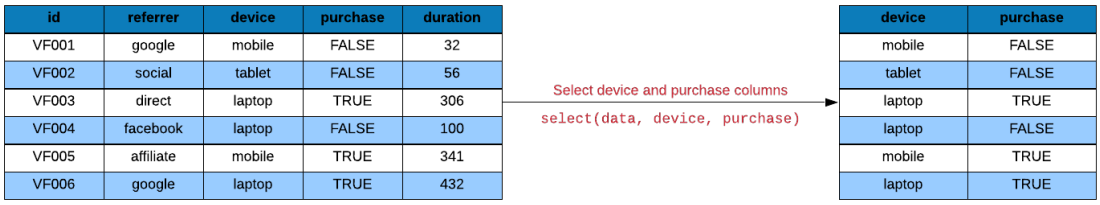
```
filter(ecom, purchase)
```

```
# A tibble: 103 x 8
   referrer device n_visit n_pages duration purchase order_items order_value
   <fct>    <fct>    <dbl>   <dbl>    <dbl> <lgl>          <dbl>       <dbl>
 1 bing     tablet       3      18      468 TRUE               6         434
 2 direct   mobile       9      14      406 TRUE               3         651
 3 bing     tablet       5      16      368 TRUE               6        1049
 4 social   tablet       7      10      290 TRUE               9        1304
 5 direct   tablet       2      19      342 TRUE               5         622
 6 social   tablet       9      20      420 TRUE               7        1613
 7 bing     mobile       4      20      440 TRUE               3         184
 8 yahoo    tablet       2      16      480 TRUE               9         286
 9 bing     mobile       3      18      288 TRUE               6         764
10 yahoo    tablet       2      14      364 TRUE               6        1667
# i 93 more rows
```

4.9 Select Columns

After filtering the data, we need to select relevent variables to compute the AOV. Remember, we do not need all the columns in the data to compute a required metric (in our case, AOV). The `select()` function allows us to select a subset of columns. The first argument is the name of the data frame and the subsequent arguments specify the columns by name or position.

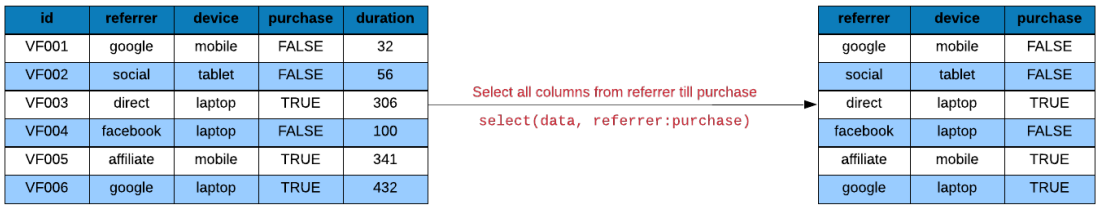
To select the `device` and `duration` columns, we specify the data set i.e. `ecom` followed by the name of the columns.




```
select(ecom, device, duration)
```

```
# A tibble: 1,000 x 2
   device duration
   <fct>     <dbl>
 1 laptop      693
 2 tablet      459
 3 laptop      996
 4 tablet      468
 5 mobile      955
 6 laptop      135
 7 mobile       75
 8 mobile      908
 9 mobile      209
10 mobile      208
# i 990 more rows
```

We can select a set of columns using `:`. In the below example, we select all the columns starting from `referrer` up to `order_items`. Remember that we can use `:` only when the columns are adjacent to each other in the data set.

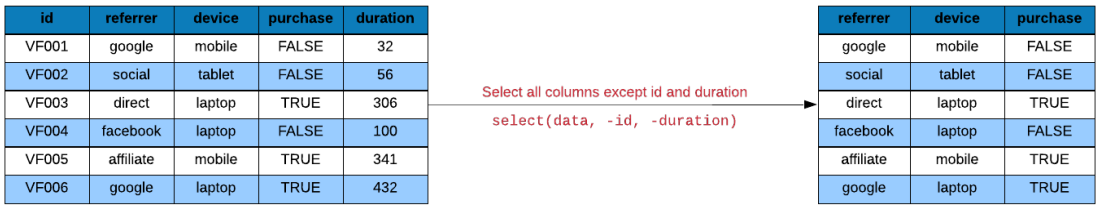



```
select(ecom, referrer:order_items)
```

```
# A tibble: 1,000 x 7
   referrer device n_visit n_pages duration purchase order_items
   <fct>    <fct>    <dbl>   <dbl>    <dbl> <lgl>          <dbl>
```

```
 1 google   laptop      10       1      693 FALSE              0
 2 yahoo    tablet       9       1      459 FALSE              0
 3 direct   laptop       0       1      996 FALSE              0
 4 bing     tablet       3      18      468 TRUE               6
 5 yahoo    mobile       9       1      955 FALSE              0
 6 yahoo    laptop       5       5      135 FALSE              0
 7 yahoo    mobile      10       1       75 FALSE              0
 8 direct   mobile      10       1      908 FALSE              0
 9 bing     mobile       3      19      209 FALSE              0
10 google   mobile       6       1      208 FALSE              0
# i 990 more rows
```

What if you want to select all columns except a few? Typing the name of many columns can be cumbersome and may also result in spelling errors. We may use `:` only if the columns are adjacent to each other but that may not always be the case. dplyr allows us to specify columns that need not be selected using `-`. In the below example, we select all columns except `n_pages` and `duration`. Notice the `-` before both of them.




```
select(ecom, -n_pages, -duration)
```

```
# A tibble: 1,000 x 6
   referrer device n_visit purchase order_items order_value
   <fct>    <fct>    <dbl> <lgl>          <dbl>       <dbl>
 1 google   laptop      10 FALSE              0           0
 2 yahoo    tablet       9 FALSE              0           0
 3 direct   laptop       0 FALSE              0           0
 4 bing     tablet       3 TRUE               6         434
 5 yahoo    mobile       9 FALSE              0           0
 6 yahoo    laptop       5 FALSE              0           0
 7 yahoo    mobile      10 FALSE              0           0
 8 direct   mobile      10 FALSE              0           0
 9 bing     mobile       3 FALSE              0           0
10 google   mobile       6 FALSE              0           0
# i 990 more rows
```

4.9.1 Case Study

For our case study, we need to select the column `order_value` to calculate the AOV. We also need to select the `device` column as we are computing the AOV for each device type.

```
select(ecom, device, order_value)
```

```
# A tibble: 1,000 x 2
   device order_value
   <fct>        <dbl>
 1 laptop           0
 2 tablet           0
 3 laptop           0
 4 tablet         434
 5 mobile           0
 6 laptop           0
 7 mobile           0
 8 mobile           0
 9 mobile           0
10 mobile           0
# i 990 more rows
```

But we want the above data only for purchasers. Let us combine `filter()` and `select()` functions to extract `order_value` and `order_items` only for those visis that resulted in a purchase.

```
# filter all visits that resulted in a purchase
ecom1 <- filter(ecom, purchase)

# select the relevant columns
ecom2 <- select(ecom1, device, order_value)

# view data
ecom2
```

```
# A tibble: 103 x 2
   device order_value
   <fct>        <dbl>
 1 tablet         434
 2 mobile         651
 3 tablet        1049
 4 tablet        1304
 5 tablet         622
 6 tablet        1613
```

```
 7 mobile         184
 8 tablet         286
 9 mobile         764
10 tablet        1667
# i 93 more rows
```

4.10 Grouping Data

We need to compute the total order value and total order items for each device in order to compute their AOV. To achieve this, we need to group the selected `order_value` and `order_items` by device type. `group_by()` allows us to group or split data based on particular (discrete) variable. The first argument is the name of the data set and the second argument is the name of the column based on which the data will be split.

To split the data by referrer type, we use `group_by` and specify the data set i.e. `ecom` and the column based on which to split the data i.e. `referrer`.

```
group_by(ecom, referrer)
```

```
# A tibble: 1,000 x 8
# Groups:   referrer [5]
   referrer device n_visit n_pages duration purchase order_items order_value
   <fct>    <fct>    <dbl>   <dbl>    <dbl> <lgl>          <dbl>       <dbl>
 1 google   laptop      10       1      693 FALSE              0           0
 2 yahoo    tablet       9       1      459 FALSE              0           0
 3 direct   laptop       0       1      996 FALSE              0           0
 4 bing     tablet       3      18      468 TRUE               6         434
 5 yahoo    mobile       9       1      955 FALSE              0           0
 6 yahoo    laptop       5       5      135 FALSE              0           0
 7 yahoo    mobile      10       1       75 FALSE              0           0
 8 direct   mobile      10       1      908 FALSE              0           0
 9 bing     mobile       3      19      209 FALSE              0           0
10 google   mobile       6       1      208 FALSE              0           0
# i 990 more rows
```

4.10.1 Case Study

In the second line in the previous output, you can observe `Groups: referrer [5]` . The data is split into 5 groups as the referrer variable has 5 distinct values. For our case study, we need to group the data by `device` type.

```
# split ecom2 by device type
ecom3 <- group_by(ecom2, device)
ecom3
```

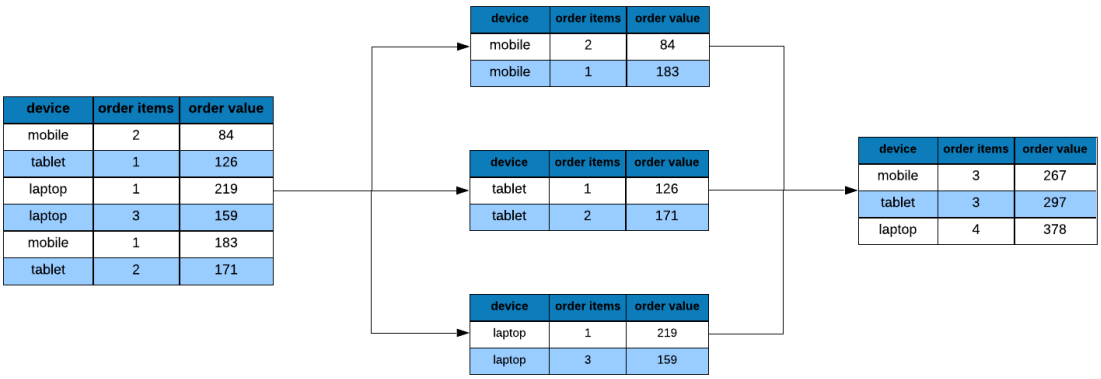
```
# A tibble: 103 x 2
# Groups:   device [3]
   device order_value
   <fct>        <dbl>
 1 tablet         434
 2 mobile         651
 3 tablet        1049
 4 tablet        1304
 5 tablet         622
 6 tablet        1613
 7 mobile         184
 8 tablet         286
 9 mobile         764
10 tablet        1667
# i 93 more rows
```

4.11 Summarise Data

The next step is to compute the total order value and total order items for each device. i.e. we need to reduce the order value and order items data to a single summary. We can achieve this using `summarise()`. As usual, the first argument is the name of a data set and the subsequent arguments are functions that can summarise data. For example, we can use `min`, `max`, `sum`, `mean` etc.

Let us compute the average number of pages browsed by referrer type:

- split data by `referrer` type
- compute the average number of pages using `mean`



```
# split data by referrer type
step_1 <- group_by(ecom, referrer)

# compute average number of pages
step_2 <- summarise(step_1, mean(n_pages))
step_2
```

```
# A tibble: 5 x 2
  referrer `mean(n_pages)`
  <fct>              <dbl>
1 bing                6.13
2 direct              6.38
3 social              5.42
4 yahoo               5.99
5 google              5.73
```

Now let us compute both the `mean` and the `median`.

```
# split data by referrer type
step_1 <- group_by(ecom, referrer)

# compute average number of pages
step_2 <- summarise(step_1, mean(n_pages), median(n_pages))
step_2
```

```
# A tibble: 5 x 3
  referrer `mean(n_pages)` `median(n_pages)`
  <fct>              <dbl>             <dbl>
1 bing                6.13                 1
2 direct              6.38                 1
3 social              5.42                 1
4 yahoo               5.99                 2
5 google              5.73                 1
```

The two steps above — split with `group_by()`, then `summarise()` — can also be written in one step with the `.by` argument, which groups only for that verb and leaves the data ungrouped afterwards:

```
# compute average number of pages by referrer without group_by()
step_2 <- summarise(ecom, mean(n_pages), median(n_pages), .by = referrer)
step_2
```

```
# A tibble: 5 x 3
  referrer `mean(n_pages)` `median(n_pages)`
  <fct>              <dbl>             <dbl>
1 google              5.73                 1
2 yahoo               5.99                 2
3 direct              6.38                 1
4 bing                6.13                 1
5 social              5.42                 1
```

One difference to know: `group_by()` sorts the result by group, while `.by` keeps the rows in order of first appearance. Use `arrange()` afterwards when the order matters.

Another way to achieve the above result is to use `across()` inside `summarise()`. It applies the specified summary function to all the columns in the data set except for the grouping column. So we need to ensure that the data does not have any irrelevant columns.

- split data by `referrer` type
- select `order_value` and `order_items`
- compute the average number of pages by applying the `mean` function to all the columns

```
# select relevant columns
step_1 <- select(ecom, referrer, order_value)

# split data by referrer type
step_2 <- group_by(step_1, referrer)

# compute average number of pages
step_3 <- summarise(step_2, across(everything(), mean))
step_3
```

```
# A tibble: 5 x 2
  referrer order_value
  <fct>          <dbl>
1 bing            316.
2 direct          441.
3 social          380.
4 yahoo           470.
5 google          328.
```

Let us compute `mean` and `median` number of pages for each referre type using `summarise()` with `across()`.

```
# select relevant columns
step_1 <- select(ecom, referrer, order_value)

# split data by referrer type
step_2 <- group_by(step_1, referrer)

# compute mean and median number of pages
step_3 <- summarise(step_2, across(everything(), list(mean = mean, median = median)))
step_3
```

```
# A tibble: 5 x 3
  referrer order_value_mean order_value_median
  <fct>               <dbl>              <dbl>
1 bing                 316.                  0
2 direct               441.                  0
3 social               380.                  0
4 yahoo                470.                  0
5 google               328.                  0
```

4.11.1 Case Study

So far, we have split the data based on the `device` type and we have selected 2 columns, `order_value` and `order_items`. We need the sum of order value and order items. What function can we use to obtain them? The `sum()` function will generate the sum of the values and hence we will use it inside the `summarise()` function. Remember, we need to provide a name to the summary being generated.

```
ecom4 <- summarise(ecom3, revenue = sum(order_value),
          orders = n())
ecom4
```

```
# A tibble: 3 x 3
  device revenue orders
  <fct>    <dbl>  <int>
1 laptop   56531     31
2 tablet   51321     36
3 mobile   51504     36
```

There you go, we have the total order value and total order items for each device type. The same grouped summary can be written more directly with the `.by` argument, which avoids keeping the data grouped with `group_by()`/`ungroup()`:

```
ecom4 <- summarise(ecom2, revenue = sum(order_value), orders = n(), .by = device)
ecom4
```

```
# A tibble: 3 x 3
  device revenue orders
  <fct>    <dbl>  <int>
1 tablet   51321     36
2 mobile   51504     36
3 laptop   56531     31
```

4.12 Create Columns

To create a new column, we will use `mutate()`. The first argument is the name of the data set and the subsequent arguments are expressions for creating new columns based out of existing columns.

Let us add a new column `avg_page_time` i.e. time on site divided by number of pages visited.

```
# select duration and n_pages from ecom
mutate_1 <- select(ecom, n_pages, duration)
mutate(mutate_1, avg_page_time = duration / n_pages)
```

```
# A tibble: 1,000 x 3
   n_pages duration avg_page_time
     <dbl>    <dbl>         <dbl>
 1       1      693           693
 2       1      459           459
 3       1      996           996
 4      18      468            26
 5       1      955           955
 6       5      135            27
 7       1       75            75
 8       1      908           908
 9      19      209            11
10       1      208           208
# i 990 more rows
```

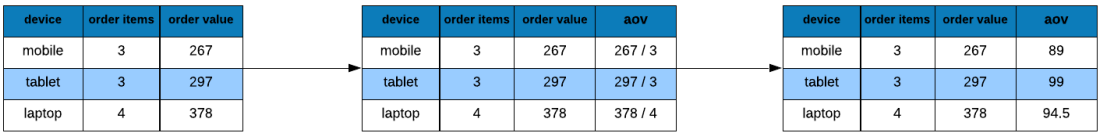
We can create new columns based on other columns created using `mutate`. Let us create another column `sqrt_avg_page_time` i.e. square root of the average time on page using `avg_page_time`.

```
mutate(mutate_1,
       avg_page_time = duration / n_pages,
       sqrt_avg_page_time = sqrt(avg_page_time))
```

```
# A tibble: 1,000 x 4
   n_pages duration avg_page_time sqrt_avg_page_time
     <dbl>    <dbl>         <dbl>               <dbl>
 1       1      693           693                26.3
 2       1      459           459                21.4
 3       1      996           996                31.6
 4      18      468            26                 5.10
 5       1      955           955                30.9
 6       5      135            27                 5.20
 7       1       75            75                 8.66
 8       1      908           908                30.1
 9      19      209            11                 3.32
10       1      208           208                14.4
# i 990 more rows
```

4.12.1 Case Study

Back to our case study, from the last step we have the total order value and total order items for each device category and can compute the AOV. We will create a new column to store AOV.



device	order items	order value
mobile	3	267
tablet	3	297
laptop	4	378

device	order items	order value	aov
mobile	3	267	267 / 3
tablet	3	297	297 / 3
laptop	4	378	378 / 4

device	order items	order value	aov
mobile	3	267	89
tablet	3	297	99
laptop	4	378	94.5

```
ecom5 <- mutate(ecom4, aov = revenue / orders)
ecom5
```

```
# A tibble: 3 x 4
  device revenue orders   aov
  <fct>    <dbl>  <int> <dbl>
1 tablet   51321     36 1426.
2 mobile   51504     36 1431.
3 laptop   56531     31 1824.
```

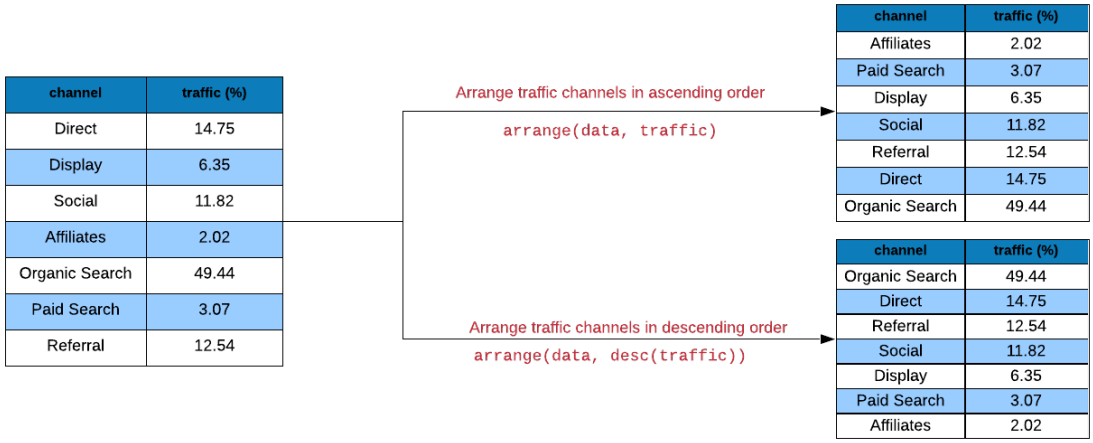
The last step is to select the relevant columns. We will select the device type and the corresponding aov while getting rid of other columns. Use `select()` to extract the relevant columns.

```
ecom6 <- select(ecom5, device, aov)
ecom6
```

```
# A tibble: 3 x 2
  device   aov
  <fct>  <dbl>
1 tablet 1426.
2 mobile 1431.
3 laptop 1824.
```

4.13 Arrange Data

Arranging data in ascending or descending order is one of the most common tasks in data manipulation. We can use `arrange` to arrange data by different columns. Let us say we want to arrange data by the number of pages browsed.




```
arrange(ecom, n_pages)
```

```
# A tibble: 1,000 x 8
   referrer device n_visit n_pages duration purchase order_items order_value
   <fct>    <fct>    <dbl>   <dbl>    <dbl> <lgl>          <dbl>       <dbl>
 1 google   laptop      10       1      693 FALSE              0           0
```

```
 2 yahoo    tablet       9       1      459 FALSE              0           0
 3 direct   laptop       0       1      996 FALSE              0           0
 4 yahoo    mobile       9       1      955 FALSE              0           0
 5 yahoo    mobile      10       1       75 FALSE              0           0
 6 direct   mobile      10       1      908 FALSE              0           0
 7 google   mobile       6       1      208 FALSE              0           0
 8 direct   laptop       9       1      738 FALSE              0           0
 9 yahoo    mobile       7       1       19 FALSE              7        2423
10 bing     laptop       1       1      995 FALSE              0           0
# i 990 more rows
```

If we want to arrange the data in descending order, we can use `desc()`. Let us arrange the data in descending order.

```
arrange(ecom , desc(n_pages))
```

```
# A tibble: 1,000 x 8
   referrer device n_visit n_pages duration purchase order_items order_value
   <fct>    <fct>    <dbl>   <dbl>    <dbl> <lgl>          <dbl>       <dbl>
 1 social   tablet       9      20      420 TRUE               7        1613
 2 bing     mobile       4      20      440 TRUE               3         184
 3 yahoo    tablet       0      20      200 FALSE              0           0
 4 direct   tablet       6      20      580 TRUE               5        1155
 5 social   mobile       1      20      520 TRUE               5        1021
 6 google   mobile       8      20      300 TRUE               7        2091
 7 social   laptop       4      20      200 FALSE              0           0
 8 yahoo    mobile       3      20      480 FALSE              0           0
 9 social   laptop      10      20      280 TRUE               1        2011
10 yahoo    mobile       2      20      240 FALSE              0           0
# i 990 more rows
```

Data can be arranged by multiple variables as well. Let us arrange data first by number of visits and then by number of pages in a descending order.

```
arrange(ecom, n_visit, desc(n_pages))
```

```
# A tibble: 1,000 x 8
   referrer device n_visit n_pages duration purchase order_items order_value
   <fct>    <fct>    <dbl>   <dbl>    <dbl> <lgl>          <dbl>       <dbl>
 1 yahoo    tablet       0      20      200 FALSE              0           0
 2 google   laptop       0      19      418 TRUE               2         996
 3 bing     laptop       0      18      180 FALSE              0           0
 4 yahoo    laptop       0      18      522 TRUE               8        1523
 5 direct   tablet       0      18      252 FALSE              0           0
```

```
 6 social   laptop       0      17      204 FALSE              0           0
 7 bing     laptop       0      17      272 TRUE               9        1384
 8 bing     mobile       0      16      272 FALSE              0           0
 9 yahoo    mobile       0      15      255 FALSE              0           0
10 direct   laptop       0      15      255 FALSE              0           0
# i 990 more rows
```

4.13.1 Case Study

If you observe `ecom6`, the `aov` column is arranged in descending order.

```
arrange(ecom6, aov)
```

```
# A tibble: 3 x 2
  device   aov
  <fct>  <dbl>
1 tablet 1426.
2 mobile 1431.
3 laptop 1824.
```

4.14 AOV by Devices

Let us combine all the code from the above steps:

```
ecom1 <- filter(ecom, purchase)
ecom2 <- select(ecom1, device, order_value)
ecom3 <- group_by(ecom2, device)
ecom4 <- summarise(ecom3, revenue = sum(order_value), orders = n())
ecom5 <- mutate(ecom4, aov = revenue / orders)
ecom6 <- select(ecom5, device, aov)
ecom7 <- arrange(ecom6, aov)
ecom7
```

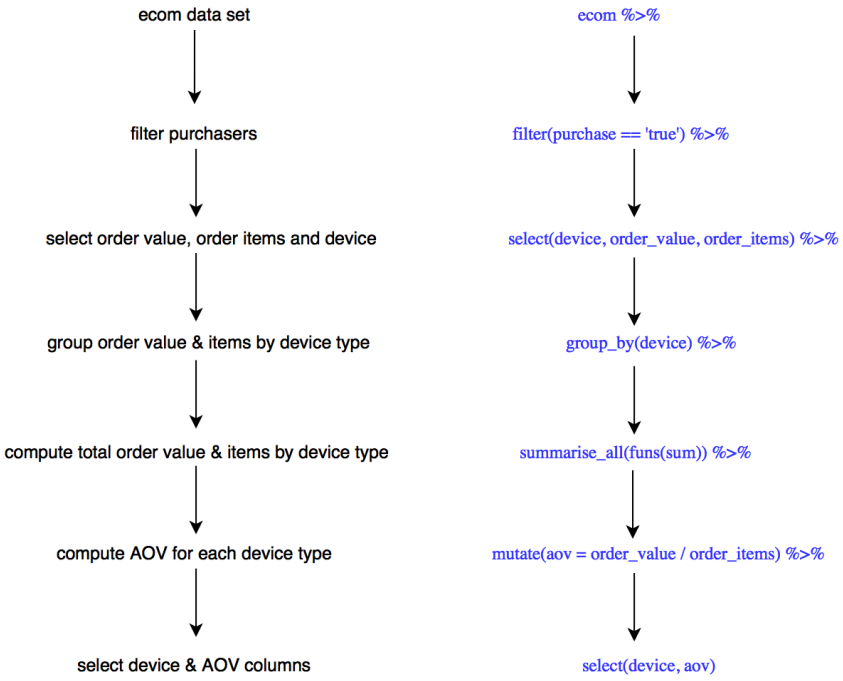
```
# A tibble: 3 x 2
  device   aov
  <fct>  <dbl>
1 tablet 1426.
2 mobile 1431.
3 laptop 1824.
```

If you observe, at each step we create a new variable(data frame) and then use it as an input in the next step i.e. the output from one step becomes the input for the next. Can we achieve the final outcome i.e. `ecom7` without creating the intermediate data (ecom1 - ecom6)? Yes, we can. We will use the `|>` operator to chain the steps and get rid of the intermediate data.

```
ecom |>
  filter(purchase) |>
  summarise(revenue = sum(order_value), orders = n(), .by = device) |>
  mutate(
    aov = revenue / orders
  ) |>
  select(device, aov) |>
  arrange(aov)
```

```
# A tibble: 3 x 2
  device   aov
  <fct>  <dbl>
1 tablet 1426.
2 mobile 1431.
3 laptop 1824.
```

Below we map the description of each step to dplyr verbs.



4.15 Your Turn

- what is the average number of pages visited by purchasers and non-purchasers?
- what is the average time on site for purchasers vs non-purchasers?
- what is the average number of pages visited by purchasers and non-purchasers using mobile?

Try it live

Try it in your browser

Edit the code below and press **Run**. It executes entirely in your browser via WebR — no R installation needed. The runtime downloads once, on this page only.

```
library(dplyr)
library(readr)
if (!file.exists("ecom_sample.csv")) {
  download.file(
    "https://wrangle-r.rsquaredacademy.com/data-webr/ecom_sample.csv",
    "ecom_sample.csv"
  )
}
ecom <- read_csv("ecom_sample.csv", show_col_types = FALSE)
ecom |>
  filter(purchase) |>
  summarise(revenue = sum(order_value), orders = n(), .by = device) |>
  mutate(aov = revenue / orders) |>
  arrange(desc(aov))
```

5 Joining Tables using dplyr

5.1 Introduction

In this chapter, we will learn to combine tables using different `*_join` functions provided in dplyr.

We will use the following R packages:

```
library(dplyr)
library(readr)
options(tibble.width = Inf)
```

5.2 Case Study

For our case study, we will use two data sets. The first one, `order`, contains details of orders placed by different customers. The second data set, `customer` contains details of each customer. The below table displays the details stored in each data set.

Order
order_id
order_date
order_number
customer_id
amount

Customer
customer_id
first_name
last_name
city
phone number

Let us import both the data sets using `read_csv`.

5.2.1 Data: Orders

```
order <- read_delim('https://raw.githubusercontent.com/rsquaredacademy/datasets/master/ord
order
```

```
# A tibble: 300 x 3
      id order_date amount
   <dbl> <chr>       <dbl>
 1   368 7/2/2016     365.
 2   286 11/2/2016   2064.
 3    28 2/22/2017    432.
 4   309 3/5/2017     480.
 5     2 12/28/2016   235.
 6    31 12/30/2016  2745.
 7   179 12/21/2016  2358.
 8   484 11/24/2016  1031.
 9   115 9/9/2016    1218.
10   340 5/6/2017    1184.
# i 290 more rows
```

5.2.2 Data: Customers

```
customer <- read_delim('https://raw.githubusercontent.com/rsquaredacademy/datasets/master/
customer
```

```
# A tibble: 91 x 3
      id first_name city
   <dbl> <chr>      <chr>
 1     1 Elbertine  California
 2     2 Marcella   Colorado
 3     3 Daria      Florida
 4     4 Sherilyn   Distric...
 5     5 Ketty      Texas
 6     6 Jethro     California
 7     7 Jeremiah   California
 8     8 Constancia Texas
 9     9 Muire      Idaho
10    10 Abigail    Texas
# i 81 more rows
```

We will explore the following in the case study:

- details of customers who have placed orders and their order details
- details of customers and their orders irrespective of whether a customer has placed orders or not
- customer details for each order
- details of customers who have placed orders
- details of customers who have not placed orders
- details of all customers and all orders

5.3 Example Data

We will use another data set to illustrate how the different joins work. You can view the example data sets below.

Age

Name	Age
John	26
Jenny	24
Jacob	28

Height

Name	Height
John	170
Jenny	174
Janet	166

5.4 Specifying keys with `join_by()`

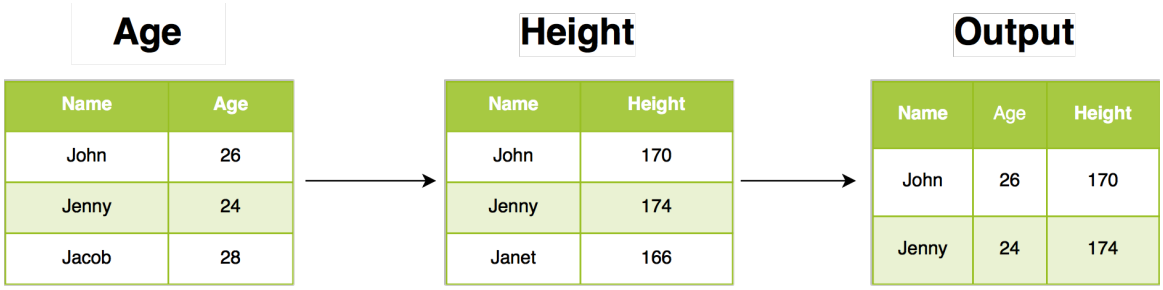
Every join below matches rows on the `id` column present in both tables, written as `by = join_by(id)`. Use `join_by()` (dplyr >= 1.1) instead of a plain string whenever keys need attention:

- same name in both tables: `by = join_by(id)`
- different names: `by = join_by(customer_id == id)`
- multiple keys: `by = join_by(id, region)`

> Audit habit
>
> Before trusting any join, run `anti_join()` in both directions (see Anti Join). Rows on either side with no match are data-quality findings, not join errors — investigate them first.

5.5 Inner Join

Inner join return all rows from `Age` where there are matching values in `Height`, and all columns from `Age` and `Height`. If there are multiple matches between `Age` and `Height`, all combination of the matches are returned.



5.5.1 Case Study: Details of customers who have placed orders and their order details

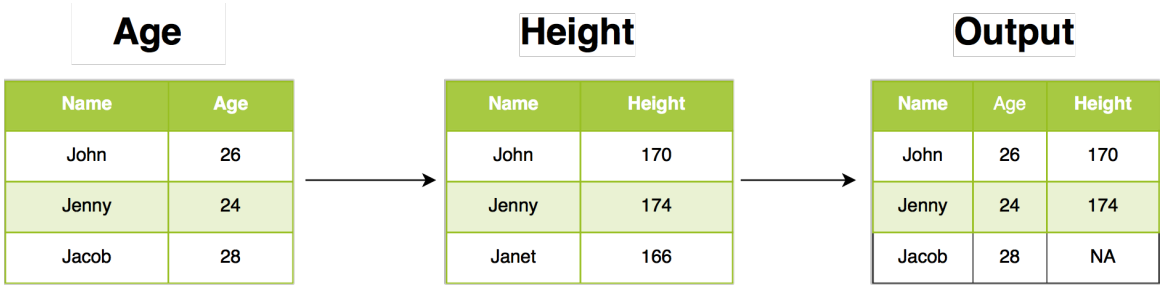
To get data for all those customers who have placed orders in the past let us join the `order` data with the `customer` data using `inner_join`.

```
inner_join(customer, order, by = join_by(id))
```

```
# A tibble: 55 x 5
      id first_name city       order_date amount
   <dbl> <chr>      <chr>      <chr>       <dbl>
 1     2 Marcella   Colorado   12/28/2016   235.
 2     2 Marcella   Colorado   8/31/2016   1150.
 3     5 Ketty      Texas      1/17/2017    346.
 4     6 Jethro     California 1/27/2017   2317.
 5     7 Jeremiah   California 6/21/2016    136.
 6     7 Jeremiah   California 2/13/2017   1407.
 7     7 Jeremiah   California 7/8/2016    1914.
 8     8 Constancia Texas      11/5/2016   2461.
 9     8 Constancia Texas      5/19/2017   2714.
10     9 Muire      Idaho      12/28/2016   187.
# i 45 more rows
```

5.6 Left Join

Left join return all rows from `Age`, and all columns from `Age` and `Height`. Rows in `Age` with no match in `Height` will have NA values in the new columns. If there are multiple matches between `Age` and `Height`, all combinations of the matches are returned.



5.7 Case Study: Details of customers and their orders irrespective of whether a customer has

placed orders or not.

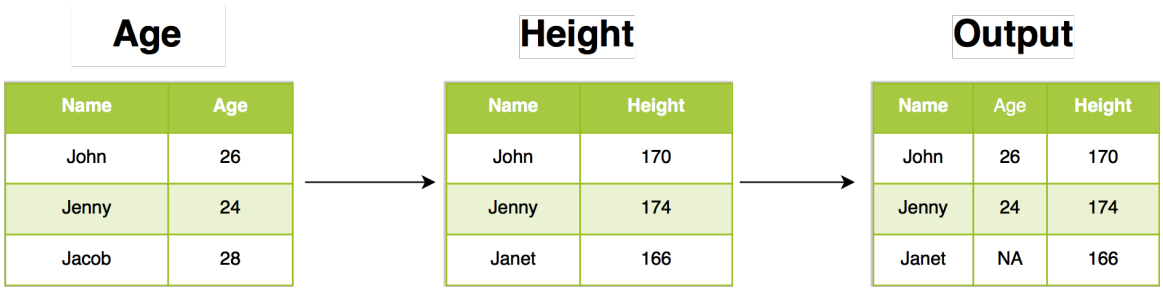
To get data for all those customers and their orders irrespective of whether a customer has placed orders or not let us join the `order` data with the `customer` data using `left_join`.

```
left_join(customer, order, by = join_by(id))
```

```
# A tibble: 104 x 5
      id first_name city       order_date amount
   <dbl> <chr>      <chr>      <chr>       <dbl>
 1     1 Elbertine  California <NA>          NA
 2     2 Marcella   Colorado   12/28/2016   235.
 3     2 Marcella   Colorado   8/31/2016   1150.
 4     3 Daria      Florida    <NA>          NA
 5     4 Sherilyn   Distric... <NA>          NA
 6     5 Ketty      Texas      1/17/2017    346.
 7     6 Jethro     California 1/27/2017   2317.
 8     7 Jeremiah   California 6/21/2016    136.
 9     7 Jeremiah   California 2/13/2017   1407.
10     7 Jeremiah   California 7/8/2016    1914.
# i 94 more rows
```

5.8 Right Join

Right join return all rows from `Height`, and all columns from `Age` and `Height`. Rows in `Height` with no match in `Age` will have NA values in the new columns. If there are multiple matches between `Age` and `Height`, all combinations of the matches are returned.



5.8.1 Case Study: Customer details for each order

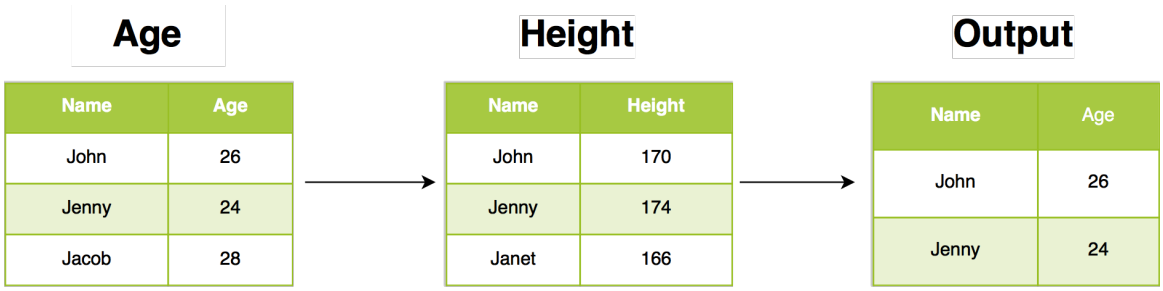
To get customer data for all orders, let us join the `order` data with the `customer` data using `right_join`.

```
right_join(customer, order, by = join_by(id))
```

```
# A tibble: 300 x 5
      id first_name city       order_date amount
   <dbl> <chr>      <chr>      <chr>       <dbl>
 1     2 Marcella   Colorado   12/28/2016   235.
 2     2 Marcella   Colorado   8/31/2016   1150.
 3     5 Ketty      Texas      1/17/2017    346.
 4     6 Jethro     California 1/27/2017   2317.
 5     7 Jeremiah   California 6/21/2016    136.
 6     7 Jeremiah   California 2/13/2017   1407.
 7     7 Jeremiah   California 7/8/2016    1914.
 8     8 Constancia Texas      11/5/2016   2461.
 9     8 Constancia Texas      5/19/2017   2714.
10     9 Muire      Idaho      12/28/2016   187.
# i 290 more rows
```

5.9 Semi Join

Semi join return all rows from `Age` where there are matching values in `Height`, keeping just columns from `Age`. A semi join differs from an inner join because an inner join will return one row of `Age` for each matching row of `Height`, where a semi join will never duplicate rows of `Age`.



5.9.1 Case Study: Details of customers who have placed orders

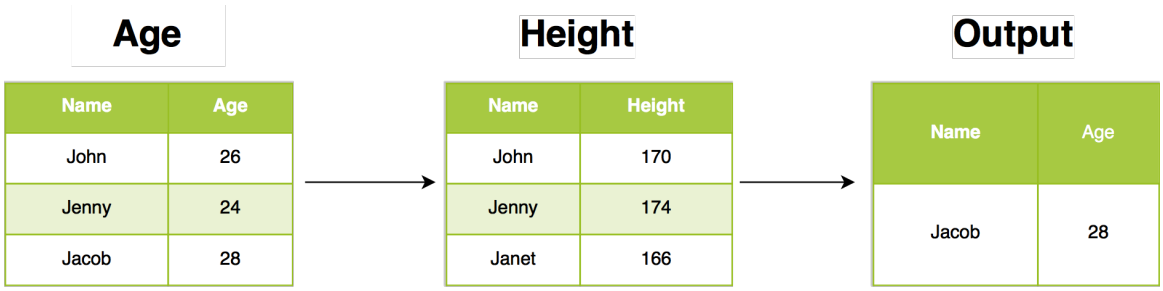
To get customer data for all orders where customer data exists, let us join the `order` data with the `customer` data using `semi_join`. You can observe that data is returned only for those cases where customer data is present.

```
semi_join(customer, order, by = join_by(id))
```

```
# A tibble: 42 x 3
      id first_name city
   <dbl> <chr>      <chr>
 1     2 Marcella   Colorado
 2     5 Ketty      Texas
 3     6 Jethro     California
 4     7 Jeremiah   California
 5     8 Constancia Texas
 6     9 Muire      Idaho
 7    15 Valentijn  California
 8    16 Monique    Missouri
 9    20 Colette    Texas
10    28 Avrit      Texas
# i 32 more rows
```

5.10 Anti Join

Anti join return all rows from `Age` where there are not matching values in `Height`, keeping just columns from `Age`.



5.10.1 Case Study: Details of customers who have not placed orders

To get details of customers who have not placed orders, let us join the `order` data with the `customer` data using `anti_join`.

```
anti_join(customer, order, by = join_by(id))
```

```
# A tibble: 49 x 3
      id first_name city
   <dbl> <chr>      <chr>
 1     1 Elbertine  California
 2     3 Daria      Florida
 3     4 Sherilyn   Distric...
 4    10 Abigail    Texas
 5    11 Wynne      Georgia
 6    12 Pietra     Minnesota
 7    13 Bram       Iowa
 8    14 Rees       New York
 9    17 Orazio     Louisiana
10    18 Mason      Texas
# i 39 more rows
```

5.10.2 Audit pattern: check mismatches in both directions

A single `anti_join()` shows only one side. Before trusting a join, check both:

```
# customers with no orders
anti_join(customer, order, by = join_by(id))
```

```
# A tibble: 49 x 3
      id first_name city
   <dbl> <chr>      <chr>
 1     1 Elbertine  California
 2     3 Daria      Florida
```

```
 3     4 Sherilyn   Distric...
 4    10 Abigail    Texas
 5    11 Wynne      Georgia
 6    12 Pietra     Minnesota
 7    13 Bram       Iowa
 8    14 Rees       New York
 9    17 Orazio     Louisiana
10    18 Mason      Texas
# i 39 more rows
```

```
# orders with no matching customer record
anti_join(order, customer, by = join_by(id))
```

```
# A tibble: 245 x 3
      id order_date amount
   <dbl> <chr>       <dbl>
 1   368 7/2/2016     365.
 2   286 11/2/2016   2064.
 3   309 3/5/2017     480.
 4   179 12/21/2016  2358.
 5   484 11/24/2016  1031.
 6   115 9/9/2016    1218.
 7   340 5/6/2017    1184.
 8   493 7/11/2016   1558.
 9   340 2/15/2017   2330.
10   235 2/27/2017    149.
# i 235 more rows
```

In this data, 49 customers placed no orders — and 245 orders have no matching customer record. Those 245 rows are a data-quality finding (missing or mismatched customer data upstream), not a join mistake: an `inner_join()` will silently drop them, and a `left_join()`/`right_join()` will carry them with `NA`s. Decide deliberately which behavior the analysis needs.

5.11 semi_join vs anti_join: which filter join to use?

`semi_join()` and `anti_join()` are *filter* joins: they filter rows of `x` by match status in `y` and never add columns from `y`.

Question	Filter join
Which customers placed orders? (keep matches)	`semi_join(customer, order, by = join_by(id))`

Question	Filter join
Which customers placed no orders? (keep misses)	`anti_join(customer, order, by = join_by(id))`
Which orders have no customer record? (audit the other side)	`anti_join(order, customer, by = join_by(id))`

5.11.1 When to use semi_join instead of inner_join

Use `semi_join()` when you want the *customers* (or *orders*) themselves, not the combined rows. An `inner_join()` duplicates the left row once per match — here 42 customers with orders explode to 55 joined rows — while `semi_join()` returns each matching customer exactly once (42 rows, customer columns only):

```
# one row per customer with orders - no duplication, no order columns
semi_join(customer, order, by = join_by(id))
```

```
# A tibble: 42 x 3
      id first_name city
   <dbl> <chr>      <chr>
 1     2 Marcella   Colorado
 2     5 Ketty      Texas
 3     6 Jethro     California
 4     7 Jeremiah   California
 5     8 Constancia Texas
 6     9 Muire      Idaho
 7    15 Valentijn  California
 8    16 Monique    Missouri
 9    20 Colette    Texas
10    28 Avrit      Texas
# i 32 more rows
```

```
# one row per order - customers repeat, order columns attached
inner_join(customer, order, by = join_by(id))
```

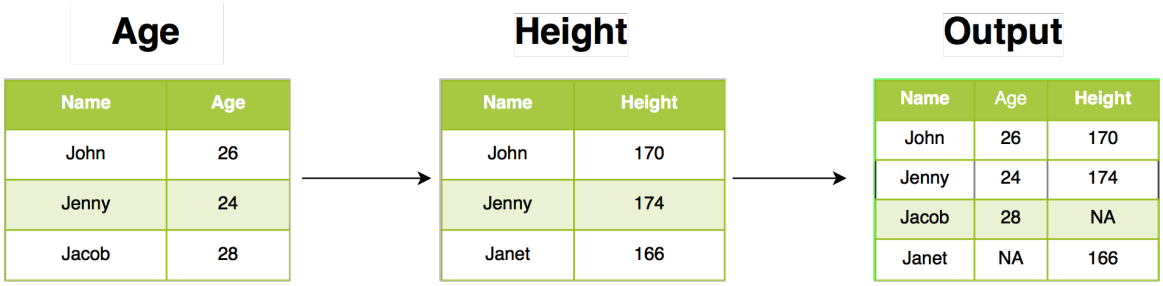
```
# A tibble: 55 x 5
      id first_name city       order_date amount
   <dbl> <chr>      <chr>      <chr>       <dbl>
 1     2 Marcella   Colorado   12/28/2016   235.
 2     2 Marcella   Colorado   8/31/2016   1150.
 3     5 Ketty      Texas      1/17/2017    346.
 4     6 Jethro     California 1/27/2017   2317.
 5     7 Jeremiah   California 6/21/2016    136.
```

```
 6     7 Jeremiah   California 2/13/2017   1407.
 7     7 Jeremiah   California 7/8/2016    1914.
 8     8 Constancia Texas      11/5/2016   2461.
 9     8 Constancia Texas      5/19/2017   2714.
10     9 Muire      Idaho      12/28/2016   187.
# i 45 more rows
```

Rule of thumb: filtering rows → `semi_join()` / `anti_join()`; combining columns → `inner_join()` / `left_join()` / `full_join()`; diagnosing coverage → `anti_join()` in both directions.

5.12 Full Join

Full join return all rows and all columns from both `Age` and `Height`. Where there are not matching values, returns NA for the one missing.



5.12.1 Case Study: Details of all customers and all orders

To get details of all customers and all orders, let us join the `order` data with the `customer` data using `full_join`.

```
full_join(customer, order, by = join_by(id))
```

```
# A tibble: 349 x 5
      id first_name city       order_date amount
   <dbl> <chr>      <chr>      <chr>       <dbl>
 1     1 Elbertine  California <NA>          NA
 2     2 Marcella   Colorado   12/28/2016   235.
 3     2 Marcella   Colorado   8/31/2016   1150.
 4     3 Daria      Florida    <NA>          NA
 5     4 Sherilyn   Distric... <NA>          NA
 6     5 Ketty      Texas      1/17/2017    346.
 7     6 Jethro     California 1/27/2017   2317.
```

```
 8     7 Jeremiah   California 6/21/2016    136.
 9     7 Jeremiah   California 2/13/2017   1407.
10     7 Jeremiah   California 7/8/2016    1914.
# i 339 more rows
```

5.13 Cross Join

`cross_join()` returns every combination of rows from both tables (a Cartesian product), so it takes no key. Use it for grids — e.g. all size × color combinations — never for large tables, since the result has `nrow(x) * nrow(y)` rows.

```
cross_join(tibble(size = c("S", "M")), tibble(color = c("red", "blue")))
```

```
# A tibble: 4 x 2
  size  color
  <chr> <chr>
1 S     red
2 S     blue
3 M     red
4 M     blue
```

Try it live

> **Try it in your browser**
>
> Edit the code below and press **Run**. It executes entirely in your browser via WebR — no R installation needed. The runtime downloads once, on this page only.

```
library(dplyr)
library(readr)
order <- read_delim("https://raw.githubusercontent.com/rsquaredacademy/datasets/master/ord
customer <- read_delim("https://raw.githubusercontent.com/rsquaredacademy/datasets/master/
left_join(customer, order, by = join_by(id))
```

6 dplyr Helpers

6.1 Introduction

In this chapter, we will explore a set of helper functions in order to:

- extract unique rows
- rename columns
- sample data
- extract columns
- slice rows
- arrange rows
- compare tables
- extract/mutate data using predicate functions
- count observations for different levels of a variable

We will use the following R packages:

```
library(dplyr)
library(readr)
```

6.2 Case Study

Let us look at a case study (e-commerce data) and see how we can use dplyr helper functions to answer questions we have about and to modify/transform the underlying data set.

6.2.1 Data

```
ecom <-
  read_csv('https://raw.githubusercontent.com/rsquaredacademy/datasets/master/web.csv',
    col_types = cols_only(device = col_factor(levels = c("laptop", "tablet", "mobile")),
      referrer = col_factor(levels = c("bing", "direct", "social", "yahoo", "google")),
      purchase = col_logical(), bouncers = col_logical(), duration = col_double(),
      n_visit = col_double(), n_pages = col_double()
    )
  )
```

```
ecom
```

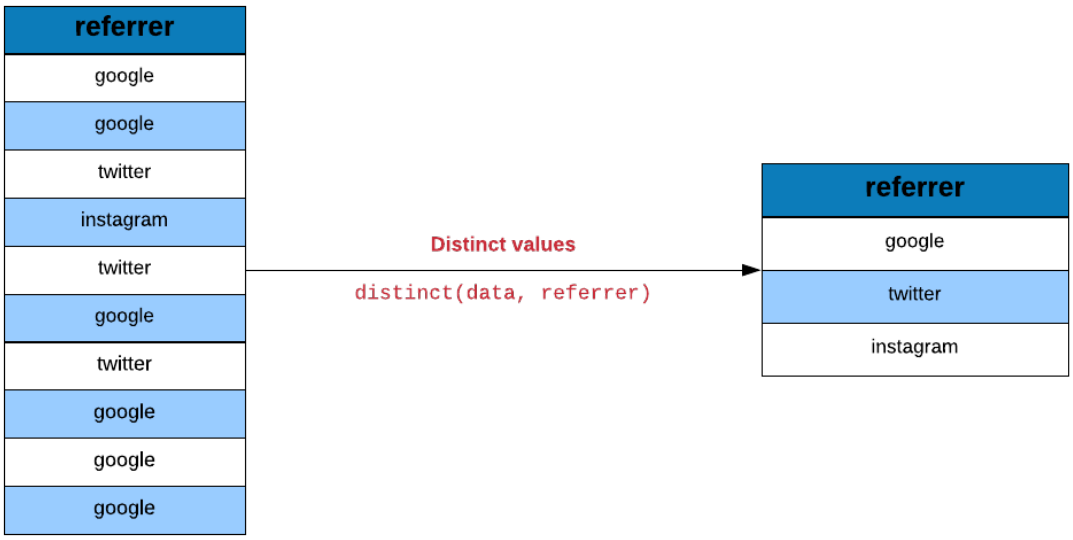
```
# A tibble: 1,000 x 7
   referrer device bouncers n_visit n_pages duration purchase
   <fct>    <fct>  <lgl>      <dbl>   <dbl>    <dbl> <lgl>
 1 google   laptop TRUE          10       1      693 FALSE
 2 yahoo    tablet TRUE           9       1      459 FALSE
 3 direct   laptop TRUE           0       1      996 FALSE
 4 bing     tablet FALSE          3      18      468 TRUE
 5 yahoo    mobile TRUE           9       1      955 FALSE
 6 yahoo    laptop FALSE          5       5      135 FALSE
 7 yahoo    mobile TRUE          10       1       75 FALSE
 8 direct   mobile TRUE          10       1      908 FALSE
 9 bing     mobile FALSE          3      19      209 FALSE
10 google   mobile TRUE           6       1      208 FALSE
# i 990 more rows
```

6.2.2 Data Dictionary

- referrer: referrer website/search engine
- device: device used to visit the website
- bouncers: whether a visit bounced (exited from landing page)
- duration: time spent on the website (in seconds)
- purchase: whether visitor purchased
- n_visit: number of visits
- n_pages: number of pages visited/browsed

6.3 Data Sanitization

Let us ensure that the data is sanitized by checking the sources of traffic and devices used to visit the site. We will use `distinct` to examine the values in the `referrer` column




```
distinct(ecom, referrer)
```

```
# A tibble: 5 x 1
  referrer
  <fct>
1 google
2 yahoo
3 direct
4 bing
5 social
```

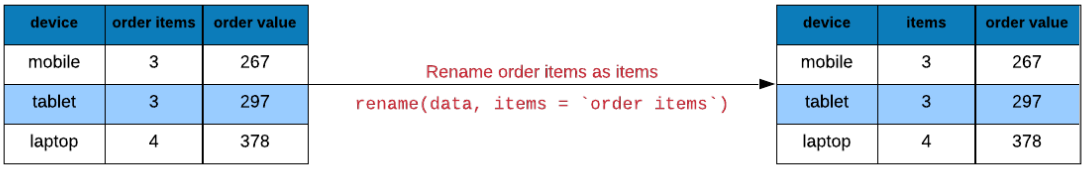
and the `device` column as well.

```
distinct(ecom, device)
```

```
# A tibble: 3 x 1
  device
  <fct>
1 laptop
2 tablet
3 mobile
```

6.4 Rename Columns

Columns can be renamed using `rename()`.

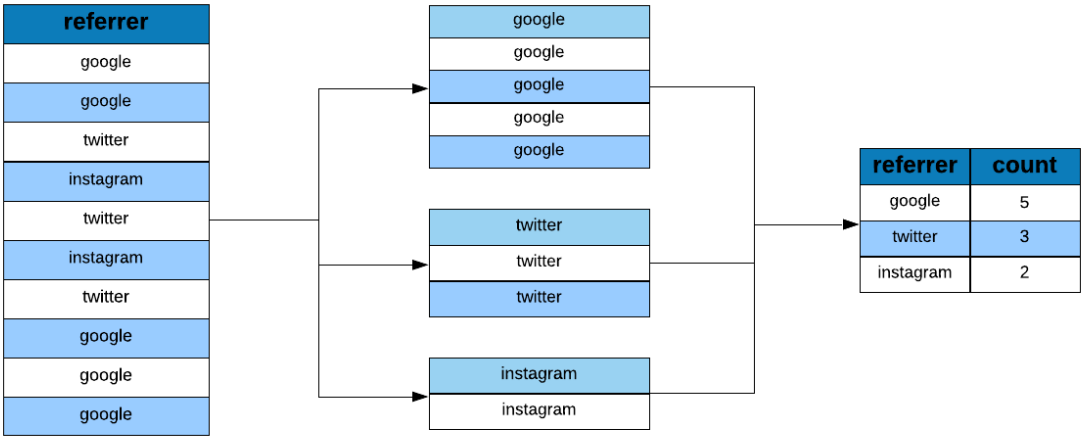



```
rename(ecom, time_on_site = duration)
```

```
# A tibble: 1,000 x 7
   referrer device bouncers n_visit n_pages time_on_site purchase
   <fct>    <fct>  <lgl>      <dbl>   <dbl>        <dbl> <lgl>
 1 google   laptop TRUE          10       1          693 FALSE
 2 yahoo    tablet TRUE           9       1          459 FALSE
 3 direct   laptop TRUE           0       1          996 FALSE
 4 bing     tablet FALSE          3      18          468 TRUE
 5 yahoo    mobile TRUE           9       1          955 FALSE
 6 yahoo    laptop FALSE          5       5          135 FALSE
 7 yahoo    mobile TRUE          10       1           75 FALSE
 8 direct   mobile TRUE          10       1          908 FALSE
 9 bing     mobile FALSE          3      19          209 FALSE
10 google   mobile TRUE           6       1          208 FALSE
# i 990 more rows
```

6.5 Data Tabulation

Let us now look at the proportion or share of visits driven by different sources of traffic.



```
ecom |>
  group_by(referrer) |>
  tally()
```

```
# A tibble: 5 x 2
  referrer     n
  <fct>    <int>
1 bing       194
2 direct     191
3 social     200
4 yahoo      207
5 google     208
```

We would also like to know the number of bouncers driven by the different sources of traffic.

```
ecom |>
  group_by(referrer, bouncers) |>
  tally()
```

```
# A tibble: 10 x 3
# Groups:   referrer [5]
   referrer bouncers     n
   <fct>    <lgl>    <int>
 1 bing     FALSE      104
 2 bing     TRUE        90
 3 direct   FALSE       98
 4 direct   TRUE        93
 5 social   FALSE       93
 6 social   TRUE       107
 7 yahoo    FALSE      110
 8 yahoo    TRUE        97
 9 google   FALSE      101
10 google   TRUE       107
```

Let us look at how many conversions happen across different devices.

```
ecom |>
  group_by(device, purchase) |>
  tally() |>
  filter(purchase)
```

```
# A tibble: 3 x 3
# Groups:   device [3]
```

```
  device purchase     n
  <fct>  <lgl>    <int>
1 laptop TRUE        31
2 tablet TRUE        36
3 mobile TRUE        36
```

Another way to extract the above information is by using `count`

```
ecom |>
  count(referrer, purchase) |>
  filter(purchase)
```

```
# A tibble: 5 x 3
  referrer purchase     n
  <fct>    <lgl>    <int>
1 bing     TRUE        17
2 direct   TRUE        25
3 social   TRUE        20
4 yahoo    TRUE        22
5 google   TRUE        19
```

The `group_by()` + `tally()` pairs above can also be written with the `.by` argument, which groups only for that verb and leaves the data ungrouped afterwards:

```
ecom |>
  summarise(n = n(), .by = referrer)
```

```
# A tibble: 5 x 2
  referrer     n
  <fct>    <int>
1 google     208
2 yahoo      207
3 direct     191
4 bing       194
5 social     200
```

Two more helpers round out grouped work. `summarise()` must return a single row per group; when a summary needs several rows, use `reframe()` instead:

```
ecom |>
  reframe(quartile = quantile(n_pages, c(0.25, 0.75)), .by = purchase)
```

```
# A tibble: 4 x 2
  purchase quartile
  <lgl>       <dbl>
1 FALSE           1
2 FALSE           8
3 TRUE           13
4 TRUE           18
```

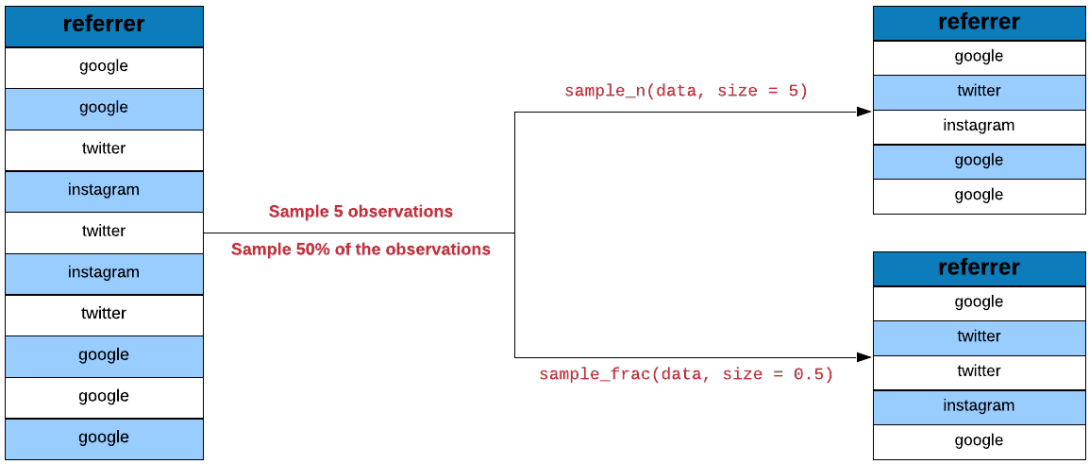
And `pick()` bundles columns into a data frame inside a verb, so a computation needing several columns at once does not repeat the data name:

```
ecom |>
  summarise(cor = with(pick(n_pages, duration), cor(n_pages, duration)), .by = purchase)
```

```
# A tibble: 2 x 2
  purchase    cor
  <lgl>     <dbl>
1 FALSE    -0.251
2 TRUE      0.429
```

6.6 Sampling Data

dplyr offers a sampling function which allows us to specify either the number or percentage of observations. `slice_sample()` allows sampling a specific number of observations.



```
slice_sample(ecom, n = 700)
```

```
# A tibble: 700 x 7
   referrer device bouncers n_visit n_pages duration purchase
   <fct>    <fct>  <lgl>      <dbl>   <dbl>    <dbl> <lgl>
 1 google   laptop FALSE          1       7      126 FALSE
 2 social   tablet TRUE           2       1      576 FALSE
 3 direct   mobile FALSE          8      16      464 FALSE
 4 bing     tablet TRUE           5       1      999 FALSE
 5 direct   laptop FALSE          1      19      399 TRUE
 6 google   tablet TRUE           3       1      652 FALSE
 7 yahoo    laptop TRUE           2       1      731 FALSE
 8 yahoo    laptop FALSE          3       1       23 FALSE
 9 social   tablet FALSE          4       8       80 FALSE
10 bing     laptop FALSE         10      16      304 FALSE
# i 690 more rows
```

We can combine the sampling function with grouping as shown below where we sample observations after grouping them according to the source of traffic.

```
slice_sample(ecom, n = 100, by = referrer)
```

```
# A tibble: 500 x 7
   referrer device bouncers n_visit n_pages duration purchase
   <fct>    <fct>  <lgl>      <dbl>   <dbl>    <dbl> <lgl>
 1 google   tablet TRUE           0       1      866 FALSE
 2 google   tablet FALSE         10       8      200 FALSE
 3 google   mobile FALSE          5       3       66 FALSE
 4 google   laptop TRUE           4       1      164 FALSE
 5 google   mobile FALSE          9      17      221 FALSE
 6 google   tablet TRUE           6       1      250 FALSE
 7 google   mobile TRUE           5       1      147 FALSE
 8 google   tablet TRUE           4       1      565 FALSE
 9 google   laptop FALSE         10       4       60 FALSE
10 google   mobile FALSE          7      12      288 TRUE
# i 490 more rows
```

`slice_sample()` with the `prop` argument allows sampling a specific percentage of observations.

```
slice_sample(ecom, prop = 0.7)
```

```
# A tibble: 700 x 7
   referrer device bouncers n_visit n_pages duration purchase
   <fct>    <fct>  <lgl>      <dbl>   <dbl>    <dbl> <lgl>
 1 google   tablet TRUE           7       1      406 FALSE
 2 google   mobile TRUE          10       1      351 FALSE
 3 google   laptop TRUE           5       1      751 FALSE
 4 social   laptop FALSE          5      16      176 FALSE
 5 google   mobile TRUE           0       1      134 FALSE
 6 yahoo    mobile FALSE          5       3       30 FALSE
 7 google   laptop FALSE          2       6      174 FALSE
 8 google   laptop TRUE           6       1      369 FALSE
 9 google   tablet TRUE           8       1      249 FALSE
10 google   laptop TRUE           3       1      369 FALSE
# i 690 more rows
```

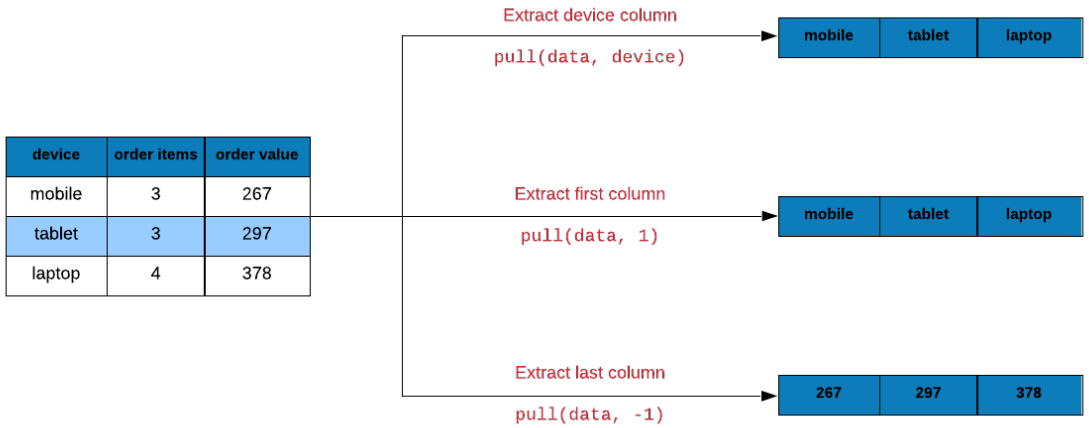
6.7 Data Extraction

In the first chapter, we had observed that dplyr verbs always returned a tibble. What if you want to extract a specific column or a bunch of rows but not as a tibble?

Use `pull` to extract columns either by name or position. It will return a vector. In the below example, we extract the `device` column as a vector. I am using `head` in addition to limit the output printed.

6.7.1 Sample Data

```
ecom_mini <- slice_sample(ecom, n = 10)
```



```
pull(ecom_mini, device)
```

```
 [1] tablet tablet tablet tablet laptop mobile tablet mobile mobile mobile
Levels: laptop tablet mobile
```

Let us extract the first column from `ecom` using column position instead of name.

```
pull(ecom_mini, 1)
```

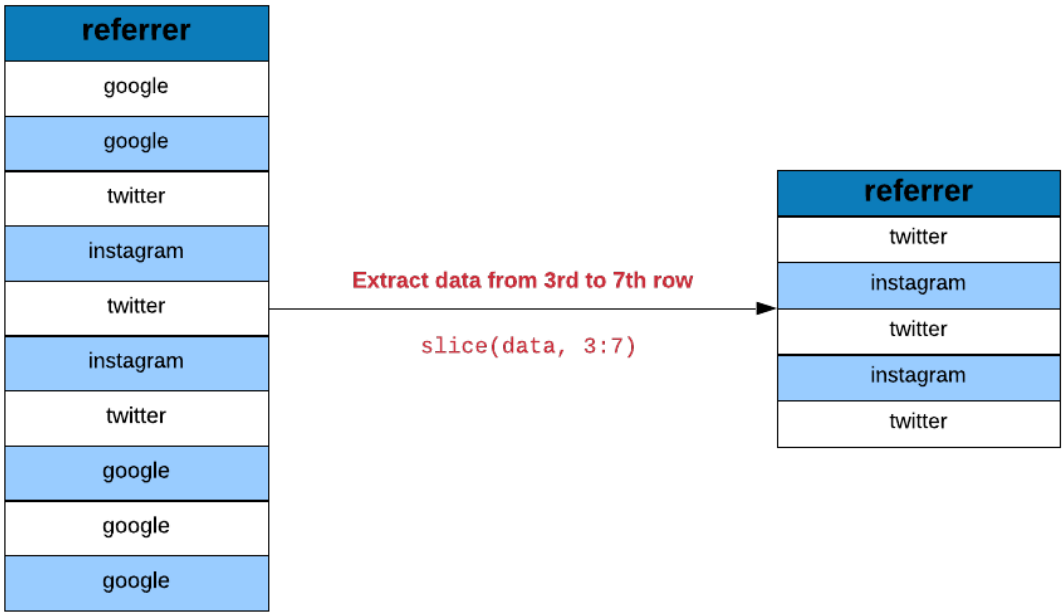
```
 [1] google direct bing   direct google yahoo  social social bing   yahoo
Levels: bing direct social yahoo google
```

You can use `-` before the column position to indicate the position in reverse. The below example extracts data from the last column.

```
pull(ecom_mini, -1)
```

```
 [1] FALSE  TRUE FALSE FALSE FALSE FALSE FALSE FALSE FALSE FALSE
```

Let us now look at extracting rows using `slice()`. In the below example, we extract data starting from the 5th row and upto the 15th row.



```
slice(ecom, 5:15)
```

```
# A tibble: 11 x 7
   referrer device bouncers n_visit n_pages duration purchase
   <fct>    <fct>  <lgl>      <dbl>   <dbl>    <dbl> <lgl>
 1 yahoo    mobile TRUE           9       1      955 FALSE
 2 yahoo    laptop FALSE          5       5      135 FALSE
 3 yahoo    mobile TRUE          10       1       75 FALSE
 4 direct   mobile TRUE          10       1      908 FALSE
 5 bing     mobile FALSE          3      19      209 FALSE
 6 google   mobile TRUE           6       1      208 FALSE
 7 direct   laptop TRUE           9       1      738 FALSE
 8 direct   tablet FALSE          6      12      132 FALSE
 9 direct   mobile FALSE          9      14      406 TRUE
10 yahoo    tablet FALSE          5       8       80 FALSE
11 yahoo    mobile FALSE          7       1       19 FALSE
```

Use `n()` inside `slice()` to extract the last row.

```
slice(ecom, n())
```

```
# A tibble: 1 x 7
  referrer device bouncers n_visit n_pages duration purchase
  <fct>    <fct>  <lgl>      <dbl>   <dbl>    <dbl> <lgl>
1 google   mobile TRUE           9       1      269 FALSE
```

6.8 Between

`between()` allows us to test if the values in a column lie between two specific values. In the below example, we check how many visits browsed pages between 5 and 15.

```
ecom_sample <- slice_sample(ecom, n = 30)

ecom_sample |>
  pull(n_pages) |>
  between(5, 15)
```

```
 [1] FALSE FALSE  TRUE FALSE FALSE FALSE FALSE  TRUE FALSE FALSE FALSE  TRUE
[13]  TRUE FALSE  TRUE FALSE FALSE  TRUE  TRUE  TRUE  TRUE FALSE FALSE FALSE
[25]  TRUE  TRUE FALSE FALSE  TRUE FALSE
```

6.9 Case When

`case_when()` is an alternative to `if else`. It allows us to lay down the conditions clearly and makes the code more readable. In the below example, we create a new column `repeat_visit` from `n_visit` (the number of previous visits).

```
ecom |>
  mutate(
    repeat_visit = case_when(
      n_visit > 0 ~ TRUE,
      TRUE ~ FALSE
    )
  ) |>
  select(n_visit, repeat_visit)
```

```
# A tibble: 1,000 x 2
   n_visit repeat_visit
     <dbl> <lgl>
 1      10 TRUE
 2       9 TRUE
 3       0 FALSE
 4       3 TRUE
 5       9 TRUE
 6       5 TRUE
 7      10 TRUE
 8      10 TRUE
 9       3 TRUE
10       6 TRUE
# i 990 more rows
```

Try it live

> **Try it in your browser**
>
> Edit the code below and press **Run**. It executes entirely in your browser via WebR — no R installation needed. The runtime downloads once, on this page only.

```
library(dplyr)
library(readr)
if (!file.exists("ecom_sample.csv")) {
  download.file(
    "https://wrangle-r.rsquaredacademy.com/data-webr/ecom_sample.csv",
```

```
    "ecom_sample.csv"
  )
}
ecom <- read_csv("ecom_sample.csv", show_col_types = FALSE)
slice_sample(ecom, n = 10)
```

7 tibbles

7.1 Introduction

A **tibble**, or `tbl_df`, is a modern reimagining of the data.frame, keeping what time has proven to be effective, and throwing out what is not. Tibbles are data.frames that are lazy and surly: they do less (i.e. they don't change variable names or types, and don't do partial matching) and complain more (e.g. when a variable does not exist). This forces you to confront problems earlier, typically leading to cleaner, more expressive code. Tibbles also have an enhanced `print method()` which makes them easier to use with large datasets containing complex objects.

Source: https://tibble.tidyverse.org/

In this chapter, we will explore tibbles. To be more precise, we will learn:

- how tibbles are different from data frames?
- how to create tibbles?
- how to manipulate tibbles?

We will use the following R packages:

```
library(tibble)
library(dplyr)
```

7.2 Creating tibbles

tibble can be created using any of the following:

- `tibble()`
- `as_tibble()`
- `tribble()`

Let us start with `tibble()`.

```
tibble(x = letters,
       y = 1:26,
       z = sample(100, 26))
```

```
# A tibble: 26 x 3
   x         y     z
   <chr> <int> <int>
 1 a         1    92
 2 b         2    75
 3 c         3    81
 4 d         4    17
 5 e         5    15
 6 f         6    57
 7 g         7    89
 8 h         8     1
 9 i         9    30
10 j        10    48
# i 16 more rows
```

We mentioned the column names followed by the data. If you do not specify the column names, `tibble()` will supply them. Ensure that the length of each column is same.

7.3 tibble features

7.3.1 never changes input's types

`tibble()` will never alter the input's type. For example, if you supply a character vector it will not be converted to factor unlike data.frame where you need to set `stringsAsFactors` to `FALSE`.

```
tibble(x = letters,
       y = 1:26,
       z = sample(100, 26))
```

```
# A tibble: 26 x 3
   x         y     z
   <chr> <int> <int>
 1 a         1    85
 2 b         2    47
 3 c         3    59
 4 d         4    34
 5 e         5    44
 6 f         6    25
 7 g         7    62
 8 h         8    89
 9 i         9    24
10 j        10    38
# i 16 more rows
```

7.3.2 never adjusts variable names

`tibble()` will never modify the column names. In the below example, you can observe that while `data.frame` adds a `.`, `tibble()` retains the column names as is.

```
names(data.frame(`order value` = 10))
```

```
[1] "order.value"
```

```
names(tibble(`order value` = 10))
```

```
[1] "order value"
```

7.3.3 never prints all rows

`tibble()` will never print all the rows and clutter your console. It will only print the first 10 rows and only as many columns that fit the width of the console.

```
x <- 1:100
y <- letters[1]
z <- sample(c(TRUE, FALSE), 100, replace = TRUE)
tibble(x, y, z)
```

```
# A tibble: 100 x 3
       x y     z
   <int> <chr> <lgl>
 1     1 a     TRUE
 2     2 a     TRUE
 3     3 a     TRUE
 4     4 a     TRUE
 5     5 a     FALSE
 6     6 a     FALSE
 7     7 a     TRUE
 8     8 a     TRUE
 9     9 a     TRUE
10    10 a     FALSE
# i 90 more rows
```

7.3.4 never recycles vector of length greater than 1

Recycling vectors of length greater than 1 often leads to errors and as such `tibble()` will only recycle vectors of length 1.

```
x <- 1:100
y <- letters
z <- sample(c(TRUE, FALSE), 100, replace = TRUE)
tibble(x, y, z)
Error in overscope_eval_next(overscope, expr) : object 'y' not found
```

7.4 Membership Testing

We can test if an object is a tibble using `is_tibble()`.

```
is_tibble(mtcars)
```

```
[1] FALSE
```

```
is_tibble(as_tibble(mtcars))
```

```
[1] TRUE
```

7.5 Tribble

Another way to create tibbles is using `tribble()`:

- it is short for transposed tibbles
- it is customized for data entry in code
- column names start with `~`
- and values are separated by commas

```
tribble(
  ~x, ~y, ~z,
  #--|--|----
  1, TRUE, 'a',
  2, FALSE, 'b'
)
```

```
# A tibble: 2 x 3
      x y     z
  <dbl> <lgl> <chr>
1     1 TRUE  a
2     2 FALSE b
```

7.6 Column Names

Names of the columns in tibbles need not be valid R variable names. They can contain unusual characters like a space or a smiley but must be enclosed in ticks.

```
tibble(
  ` ` = 'space',
  `2` = 'integer',
  `:)` = 'smiley'
)
```

```
# A tibble: 1 x 3
  ` `   `2`     `:)`
  <chr> <chr>   <chr>
1 space integer smiley
```

7.7 Add Rows

Let us add data related to **Safari** browser to the web traffic data using `add_row()`.

```
browsers <- enframe(c(chrome = 40, firefox = 20, edge = 30))
browsers
```

```
# A tibble: 3 x 2
  name    value
  <chr>   <dbl>
1 chrome     40
2 firefox    20
3 edge       30
```

```
add_row(browsers, name = 'safari', value = 10)
```

```
# A tibble: 4 x 2
  name    value
  <chr>   <dbl>
1 chrome     40
2 firefox    20
3 edge       30
4 safari     10
```

If we want to add the data at a particular row, we can specify the row number using the `.before` argument. Let us add the data related to **Safari** browser in the second row instead of the last row.

```
add_row(browsers, name = 'safari', value = 10, .before = 2)
```

```
# A tibble: 4 x 2
  name    value
  <chr>   <dbl>
1 chrome     40
2 safari     10
3 firefox    20
4 edge       30
```

7.8 Add Columns

`add_column()` adds a new column to tibbles.

```
browsers <- enframe(c(chrome = 40, firefox = 20, edge = 30, safari = 10))
add_column(browsers, visits = c(4000, 2000, 3000, 1000))
```

```
# A tibble: 4 x 3
  name    value visits
  <chr>   <dbl>  <dbl>
1 chrome     40   4000
2 firefox    20   2000
3 edge       30   3000
4 safari     10   1000
```

7.9 Rownames

The tibble package provides a set of functions to deal with rownames. Remember, `tibble` does not have `rownames` unlike `data.frame`. To check whether a data set has rownames, use `has_rownames()`.

```
has_rownames(mtcars)
```

```
[1] TRUE
```

7.9.1 Remove Rownames

```
remove_rownames(mtcars)
```

```
    mpg cyl  disp  hp drat    wt  qsec vs am gear carb
1  21.0   6 160.0 110 3.90 2.620 16.46  0  1    4    4
2  21.0   6 160.0 110 3.90 2.875 17.02  0  1    4    4
3  22.8   4 108.0  93 3.85 2.320 18.61  1  1    4    1
4  21.4   6 258.0 110 3.08 3.215 19.44  1  0    3    1
5  18.7   8 360.0 175 3.15 3.440 17.02  0  0    3    2
6  18.1   6 225.0 105 2.76 3.460 20.22  1  0    3    1
7  14.3   8 360.0 245 3.21 3.570 15.84  0  0    3    4
8  24.4   4 146.7  62 3.69 3.190 20.00  1  0    4    2
9  22.8   4 140.8  95 3.92 3.150 22.90  1  0    4    2
10 19.2   6 167.6 123 3.92 3.440 18.30  1  0    4    4
11 17.8   6 167.6 123 3.92 3.440 18.90  1  0    4    4
12 16.4   8 275.8 180 3.07 4.070 17.40  0  0    3    3
13 17.3   8 275.8 180 3.07 3.730 17.60  0  0    3    3
14 15.2   8 275.8 180 3.07 3.780 18.00  0  0    3    3
15 10.4   8 472.0 205 2.93 5.250 17.98  0  0    3    4
16 10.4   8 460.0 215 3.00 5.424 17.82  0  0    3    4
17 14.7   8 440.0 230 3.23 5.345 17.42  0  0    3    4
18 32.4   4  78.7  66 4.08 2.200 19.47  1  1    4    1
19 30.4   4  75.7  52 4.93 1.615 18.52  1  1    4    2
20 33.9   4  71.1  65 4.22 1.835 19.90  1  1    4    1
21 21.5   4 120.1  97 3.70 2.465 20.01  1  0    3    1
22 15.5   8 318.0 150 2.76 3.520 16.87  0  0    3    2
23 15.2   8 304.0 150 3.15 3.435 17.30  0  0    3    2
24 13.3   8 350.0 245 3.73 3.840 15.41  0  0    3    4
25 19.2   8 400.0 175 3.08 3.845 17.05  0  0    3    2
26 27.3   4  79.0  66 4.08 1.935 18.90  1  1    4    1
27 26.0   4 120.3  91 4.43 2.140 16.70  0  1    5    2
28 30.4   4  95.1 113 3.77 1.513 16.90  1  1    5    2
29 15.8   8 351.0 264 4.22 3.170 14.50  0  1    5    4
30 19.7   6 145.0 175 3.62 2.770 15.50  0  1    5    6
31 15.0   8 301.0 335 3.54 3.570 14.60  0  1    5    8
32 21.4   4 121.0 109 4.11 2.780 18.60  1  1    4    2
```

7.9.2 Rownames to Column

```
head(rownames_to_column(mtcars))
```

```
            rowname  mpg cyl disp  hp drat    wt  qsec vs am gear carb
1         Mazda RX4 21.0   6  160 110 3.90 2.620 16.46  0  1    4    4
2     Mazda RX4 Wag 21.0   6  160 110 3.90 2.875 17.02  0  1    4    4
3        Datsun 710 22.8   4  108  93 3.85 2.320 18.61  1  1    4    1
4    Hornet 4 Drive 21.4   6  258 110 3.08 3.215 19.44  1  0    3    1
5 Hornet Sportabout 18.7   8  360 175 3.15 3.440 17.02  0  0    3    2
6           Valiant 18.1   6  225 105 2.76 3.460 20.22  1  0    3    1
```

7.9.3 Column to Rownames

To convert the first column in the data set to rownames, use `column_to_rownames()`:

```
mtcars_tbl <- rownames_to_column(mtcars)
column_to_rownames(mtcars_tbl)
```

```
                   mpg cyl  disp  hp drat    wt  qsec vs am gear carb
Mazda RX4         21.0   6 160.0 110 3.90 2.620 16.46  0  1    4    4
Mazda RX4 Wag     21.0   6 160.0 110 3.90 2.875 17.02  0  1    4    4
Datsun 710        22.8   4 108.0  93 3.85 2.320 18.61  1  1    4    1
Hornet 4 Drive    21.4   6 258.0 110 3.08 3.215 19.44  1  0    3    1
Hornet Sportabout 18.7   8 360.0 175 3.15 3.440 17.02  0  0    3    2
Valiant           18.1   6 225.0 105 2.76 3.460 20.22  1  0    3    1
Duster 360        14.3   8 360.0 245 3.21 3.570 15.84  0  0    3    4
Merc 240D         24.4   4 146.7  62 3.69 3.190 20.00  1  0    4    2
Merc 230          22.8   4 140.8  95 3.92 3.150 22.90  1  0    4    2
Merc 280          19.2   6 167.6 123 3.92 3.440 18.30  1  0    4    4
Merc 280C         17.8   6 167.6 123 3.92 3.440 18.90  1  0    4    4
Merc 450SE        16.4   8 275.8 180 3.07 4.070 17.40  0  0    3    3
Merc 450SL        17.3   8 275.8 180 3.07 3.730 17.60  0  0    3    3
Merc 450SLC       15.2   8 275.8 180 3.07 3.780 18.00  0  0    3    3
Cadillac Fleetwood  10.4   8 472.0 205 2.93 5.250 17.98  0  0    3    4
Lincoln Continental 10.4   8 460.0 215 3.00 5.424 17.82  0  0    3    4
Chrysler Imperial   14.7   8 440.0 230 3.23 5.345 17.42  0  0    3    4
Fiat 128          32.4   4  78.7  66 4.08 2.200 19.47  1  1    4    1
Honda Civic       30.4   4  75.7  52 4.93 1.615 18.52  1  1    4    2
Toyota Corolla    33.9   4  71.1  65 4.22 1.835 19.90  1  1    4    1
Toyota Corona     21.5   4 120.1  97 3.70 2.465 20.01  1  0    3    1
Dodge Challenger  15.5   8 318.0 150 2.76 3.520 16.87  0  0    3    2
AMC Javelin       15.2   8 304.0 150 3.15 3.435 17.30  0  0    3    2
Camaro Z28        13.3   8 350.0 245 3.73 3.840 15.41  0  0    3    4
Pontiac Firebird  19.2   8 400.0 175 3.08 3.845 17.05  0  0    3    2
Fiat X1-9         27.3   4  79.0  66 4.08 1.935 18.90  1  1    4    1
Porsche 914-2     26.0   4 120.3  91 4.43 2.140 16.70  0  1    5    2
Lotus Europa      30.4   4  95.1 113 3.77 1.513 16.90  1  1    5    2
```

```
Ford Pantera L      15.8   8 351.0 264 4.22 3.170 14.50  0  1    5    4
Ferrari Dino        19.7   6 145.0 175 3.62 2.770 15.50  0  1    5    6
Maserati Bora       15.0   8 301.0 335 3.54 3.570 14.60  0  1    5    8
Volvo 142E          21.4   4 121.0 109 4.11 2.780 18.60  1  1    4    2
```

7.10 Glimpse

Use `glimpse()` to get an overview of the data.

```
glimpse(mtcars)
```

```
Rows: 32
Columns: 11
$ mpg  <dbl> 21.0, 21.0, 22.8, 21.4, 18.7, 18.1, 14.3, 24.4, 22.8, 19.2, 17.8,~
$ cyl  <dbl> 6, 6, 4, 6, 8, 6, 8, 4, 4, 6, 6, 8, 8, 8, 8, 8, 8, 4, 4, 4, 4, 8,~
$ disp <dbl> 160.0, 160.0, 108.0, 258.0, 360.0, 225.0, 360.0, 146.7, 140.8, 16~
$ hp   <dbl> 110, 110, 93, 110, 175, 105, 245, 62, 95, 123, 123, 180, 180, 180~
$ drat <dbl> 3.90, 3.90, 3.85, 3.08, 3.15, 2.76, 3.21, 3.69, 3.92, 3.92, 3.92,~
$ wt   <dbl> 2.620, 2.875, 2.320, 3.215, 3.440, 3.460, 3.570, 3.190, 3.150, 3.~
$ qsec <dbl> 16.46, 17.02, 18.61, 19.44, 17.02, 20.22, 15.84, 20.00, 22.90, 18~
$ vs   <dbl> 0, 0, 1, 1, 0, 1, 0, 1, 1, 1, 1, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 1, 1, 1, 1, 0,~
$ am   <dbl> 1, 1, 1, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 1, 1, 1, 0, 0,~
$ gear <dbl> 4, 4, 4, 3, 3, 3, 3, 4, 4, 4, 4, 3, 3, 3, 3, 3, 3, 4, 4, 4, 3, 3,~
$ carb <dbl> 4, 4, 1, 1, 2, 1, 4, 2, 2, 4, 4, 3, 3, 3, 4, 4, 4, 1, 2, 1, 1, 2,~
```

7.11 Check Column

`has_name()` can be used to check if a tibble has a specific column.

```
has_name(mtcars, 'cyl')
```

```
[1] TRUE
```

```
has_name(mtcars, 'gears')
```

```
[1] FALSE
```

7.12 Summary

7.12.1 Creating tibbles

- use `tibble()` to create tibbles
- use `as_tibble()` to coerce other objects to tibble
- use `enframe()` to coerce vector to tibble
- use `tribble()` to create tibble using data entry

7.12.2 Modifying tibbles

- use `add_row()` to add a new row
- use `add_column()` to add a new column
- use `remove_rownames()` to remove rownames from data
- use `rownames_to_colum()` to coerce rowname to first column
- use `column_to_rownames()` to coerce first column to rownames

7.12.3 Testing tibbles

- use `is_tibble()` to test if an object is a tibble
- use `has_rownames()` to check whether a data set has rownames
- use `has_name()` to check if tibble has a specific column
- use `glimpse()` to get an overview of data

Try it live

Try it in your browser

Edit the code below and press **Run**. It executes entirely in your browser via WebR — no R installation needed. The runtime downloads once, on this page only.

```
library(tibble)
library(readr)
if (!file.exists("ecom_sample.csv")) {
  download.file(
    "https://wrangle-r.rsquaredacademy.com/data-webr/ecom_sample.csv",
    "ecom_sample.csv"
  )
}
ecom <- read_csv("ecom_sample.csv", show_col_types = FALSE)
as_tibble(ecom) |> glimpse()
```

8 Tidying Data with tidyr

8.1 Introduction

Tidy data has one row per observation and one column per variable. Real data rarely arrives that way: metrics sprawl across columns, several values share one column, and combinations go missing. In this chapter we reshape data with **tidyr**:

- `pivot_longer()` / `pivot_wider()` — move between long and wide layouts
- `separate_wider_delim()` / `unite()` — split one column into several and back
- `drop_na()` / `complete()` / `fill()` — handle missing values and combinations

We will use the following R packages:

```
library(dplyr)
library(tidyr)
library(readr)
library(lubridate)
```

8.2 Data

We reuse the ecommerce data from @dplyr-basics, so no new data to learn. The URL and date examples borrow the `mock_strings` and `transact` data sets already used in @strings-in-r and @date-and-time-in-r.

```
ecom <-
  read_csv('https://raw.githubusercontent.com/rsquaredacademy/datasets/master/web.csv',
    col_types = cols_only(device = col_factor(levels = c("laptop", "tablet", "mobile")),
      referrer = col_factor(levels = c("bing", "direct", "social", "yahoo", "google")),
      purchase = col_logical(), n_pages = col_double(), n_visit = col_double(),
      duration = col_double(), order_value = col_double(), order_items = col_double()
    )
  )

ecom
```

```
# A tibble: 1,000 x 8
   referrer device n_visit n_pages duration purchase order_items order_value
   <fct>    <fct>    <dbl>   <dbl>    <dbl> <lgl>          <dbl>       <dbl>
 1 google   laptop      10       1      693 FALSE              0           0
 2 yahoo    tablet       9       1      459 FALSE              0           0
 3 direct   laptop       0       1      996 FALSE              0           0
 4 bing     tablet       3      18      468 TRUE               6         434
 5 yahoo    mobile       9       1      955 FALSE              0           0
 6 yahoo    laptop       5       5      135 FALSE              0           0
 7 yahoo    mobile      10       1       75 FALSE              0           0
 8 direct   mobile      10       1      908 FALSE              0           0
 9 bing     mobile       3      19      209 FALSE              0           0
10 google   mobile       6       1      208 FALSE              0           0
# i 990 more rows
```

8.3 Long format with `pivot_longer()`

Suppose we average three metrics by device. The result is *wide*: one column per metric, which is awkward to plot or rank.

```
wide <- ecom |>
  summarise(across(c(n_pages, duration, order_value), \(x) mean(x, na.rm = TRUE)), .by = d
wide
```

```
# A tibble: 3 x 4
  device n_pages duration order_value
  <fct>    <dbl>    <dbl>       <dbl>
1 laptop    5.36     376.        441.
2 tablet    6.23     354.        352.
3 mobile    6.17     337.        370.
```

`pivot_longer()` stacks the metric columns into `metric`/`mean_value` pairs — one row per device-metric observation:

```
long <- wide |>
  pivot_longer(-device, names_to = "metric", values_to = "mean_value")
long
```

```
# A tibble: 9 x 3
  device metric      mean_value
  <fct>  <chr>            <dbl>
1 laptop n_pages           5.36
2 laptop duration        376.
```

```
3 laptop order_value     441.
4 tablet n_pages           6.23
5 tablet duration        354.
6 tablet order_value     352.
7 mobile n_pages           6.17
8 mobile duration        337.
9 mobile order_value     370.
```

8.4 Wide format with `pivot_wider()`

The reverse trip is just as common. Counts by device and purchase come out long (one row per combination):

```
counts <- ecom |>
  count(device, purchase)
counts
```

```
# A tibble: 6 x 3
  device purchase     n
  <fct>  <lgl>    <int>
1 laptop FALSE      294
2 laptop TRUE        31
3 tablet FALSE      295
4 tablet TRUE        36
5 mobile FALSE      308
6 mobile TRUE        36
```

`pivot_wider()` spreads `purchase` into columns so each device occupies a single row — the layout managers usually want in a report:

```
counts |>
  pivot_wider(names_from = purchase, values_from = n, names_prefix = "purchase_")
```

```
# A tibble: 3 x 3
  device purchase_FALSE purchase_TRUE
  <fct>           <int>         <int>
1 laptop            294            31
2 tablet            295            36
3 mobile            308            36
```

8.5 pivot_longer vs pivot_wider: which direction?

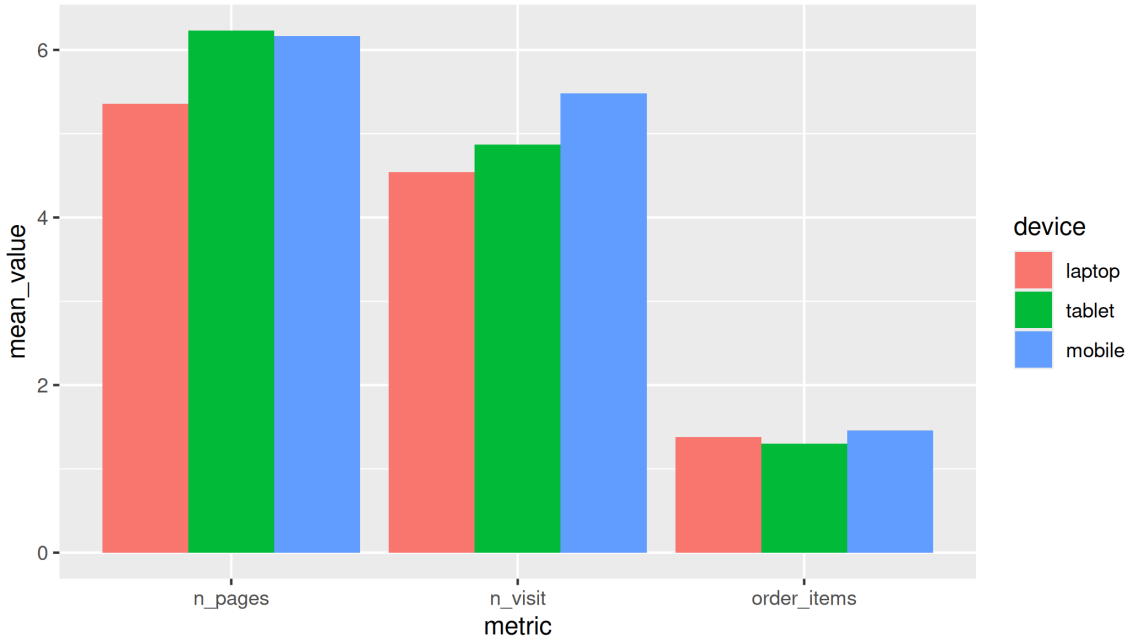
Reshaping has two directions — pick by what the next step needs:

Next step	Direction
Plot or rank several metrics (facets, dodged bars)	`pivot_longer()`: metrics become rows
Report-style table (one row per group)	`pivot_wider()`: groups become rows
Model matrix / spreadsheet handoff	`pivot_wider()`

The payoff for going long: `ggplot2` maps variables to aesthetics, so one long table draws every metric in a single call — no per-metric layers:

```
library(ggplot2)
long_metrics <- ecom |>
  summarise(across(c(n_pages, n_visit, order_items),
    \(x) mean(x, na.rm = TRUE)), .by = device) |>
  pivot_longer(-device, names_to = "metric", values_to = "mean_value")

ggplot(long_metrics, aes(x = metric, y = mean_value, fill = device)) +
  geom_bar(stat = "identity", position = "dodge")
```



And the trip reverses cleanly — `pivot_wider()` on the long table restores the wide summary exactly, so reshaping is safe to do mid-pipeline.

8.6 Split columns with `separate_wider_delim()`

The `url` column of `mock_strings` packs the protocol and the address into one string, separated by `://`. `separate_wider_delim()` splits it into two columns:

```
mockstring <-
  read_csv('https://raw.githubusercontent.com/rsquaredacademy/datasets/master/mock_strings

tibble(url = head(mockstring$url, 3)) |>
  separate_wider_delim(url, delim = "://", names = c("protocol", "rest")) |>
  select(protocol)
```

```
# A tibble: 3 x 1
  protocol
  <chr>
1 https
2 http
3 https
```

The same verb splits calendar dates. The `Due` column of `transact` is `YYYY-MM-DD`; splitting on `"-"` recovers the components:

```
transact <-
  read_csv('https://raw.githubusercontent.com/rsquaredacademy/datasets/master/transact.csv

tibble(due_iso = as.character(head(transact$Due, 5))) |>
  separate_wider_delim(due_iso, delim = "-", names = c("due_year", "due_month", "due_day")
```

```
# A tibble: 5 x 3
  due_year due_month due_day
  <chr>    <chr>     <chr>
1 2013     02        01
2 2013     02        25
3 2013     08        02
4 2013     03        12
5 2012     11        24
```

8.7 Combine columns with `unite()`

`unite()` is the inverse: it pastes several columns back into one. Splitting the ISO date and reuniting it returns the input exactly — a useful check that a separate/unite round-trip loses nothing:

```r
tibble(due_iso = as.character(head(transact$Due, 5))) |>
  separate_wider_delim(due_iso, delim = "-", names = c("due_year", "due_month", "due_day")) |>
  unite("due_rebuilt", due_year, due_month, due_day, sep = "-")
```

```
# A tibble: 5 x 1
  due_rebuilt
  <chr>
1 2013-02-01
2 2013-02-25
3 2013-08-02
4 2013-03-12
5 2012-11-24
```

8.8 Drop missing values with `drop_na()`

`ecom` itself has no missing values, but joins create them: the full join of `customer` and `order` from @joining-tables-in-r-dplyr carries `NA`s for every unmatched row. `drop_na()` keeps only complete rows:

```r
order <- read_delim('https://raw.githubusercontent.com/rsquaredacademy/datasets/master/ord
customer <- read_delim('https://raw.githubusercontent.com/rsquaredacademy/datasets/master/

joined <- full_join(customer, order, by = join_by(id))
nrow(joined)
```

```
[1] 349
```

```r
nrow(drop_na(joined))
```

```
[1] 55
```

Only the 55 fully matched rows survive — the same rows `inner_join()` returns. Use `drop_na()` when a downstream step needs complete cases, and prefer it over filtering each column by hand.

8.9 Complete combinations with `complete()`

Counts over a filtered subset can silently omit combinations. Purchasers only span `purchase == TRUE`, so the `FALSE` rows are missing rather than zero:

```
purchasers <- ecom |>
  filter(purchase) |>
  count(device, purchase)
purchasers
```

```
# A tibble: 3 x 3
  device purchase     n
  <fct>  <lgl>    <int>
1 laptop TRUE        31
2 tablet TRUE        36
3 mobile TRUE        36
```

`complete()` adds the missing combinations and fills the count with 0, so plots and tables show every device × purchase cell:

```
purchasers |>
  complete(device, purchase = c(TRUE, FALSE), fill = list(n = 0L))
```

```
# A tibble: 6 x 3
  device purchase     n
  <fct>  <lgl>    <int>
1 laptop FALSE        0
2 laptop TRUE        31
3 tablet FALSE        0
4 tablet TRUE        36
5 mobile FALSE        0
6 mobile TRUE        36
```

8.10 Fill down labels with `fill()`

Spreadsheet exports often write a group label once and leave the rest blank. `fill()` carries the last non-missing value down (or up with `.direction = "up"`):

```
report <- tibble(device = c("laptop", NA, "tablet", NA),
                 metric = c("aov", "orders", "aov", "orders"))
report |>
  fill(device)
```

```
# A tibble: 4 x 2
  device metric
  <chr>  <chr>
1 laptop aov
```

```
2 laptop orders
3 tablet aov
4 tablet orders
```

8.11 Your Turn

- reshape the mean of `n_visit` and `order_items` by `referrer` from wide to long
- split the `email` column of `mockstring` at `"@"` and reunite it — does the round-trip hold?
- run the `complete()` example without `fill`: what does the missing count become, and why?

Try it live

> **Try it in your browser**
>
> Edit the code below and press **Run**. It executes entirely in your browser via WebR — no R installation needed. The runtime downloads once, on this page only.

```
library(dplyr)
library(tidyr)
library(readr)
if (!file.exists("ecom_sample.csv")) {
  download.file(
    "https://wrangle-r.rsquaredacademy.com/data-webr/ecom_sample.csv",
    "ecom_sample.csv"
  )
}
ecom <- read_csv("ecom_sample.csv", show_col_types = FALSE)
ecom |>
  summarise(across(c(n_pages, duration, order_value), \(x) mean(x, na.rm = TRUE)), .by = d
  pivot_longer(-device, names_to = "metric", values_to = "mean_value")
```

9 Hacking Strings

9.1 Introduction

In this chapter, we will learn to work with string data in R using stringr. As we did in the other chapters, we will use a case study to explore the various features of the stringr package. We will use the following R packages:

```
library(stringr)
library(tibble)
library(magrittr)
library(purrr)
library(dplyr)
library(readr)
```

9.2 Case Study

- extract domain name from random email ids
- extract image type from url
- extract image dimension from url
- extract extension from domain name
- extract http protocol from url
- extract file type from url

9.2.1 Data

```
mockstring <- read_csv('https://raw.githubusercontent.com/rsquaredacademy/datasets/master/
mockstring
```

```
# A tibble: 1,000 x 12
      id image_url  domain imageurl email filename phone address url   full_name
   <dbl> <chr>      <chr>  <chr>    <chr> <chr>    <chr> <chr>   <chr> <chr>
 1     1 https://r~ addto~ http://~ mnew~ PedeMal~ 66-(~ 8 Anha~ http~ Mufi Ruit
 2     2 https://r~ gmpg.~ http://~ mdan~ Loborti~ 351-~ 697 Ea~ http~ Leese Fu~
 3     3 https://r~ samsu~ http://~ hgir~ CongueD~ 33-(~ 89 Dot~ http~ Blakelee~
```

```
 4     4 https://r~ spoti~ http://~ pmcm~ Eleifen~ 86-(~ 98135 ~ http~ Terencio~
 5     5 https://r~ wunde~ http://~ dris~ PurusPh~ 223-~ 7814 P~ http~ Debee Mc~
 6     6 https://r~ alexa~ http://~ cphl~ Element~ 420-~ 4897 L~ http~ Fran Pai~
 7     7 https://r~ googl~ http://~ kdod~ Mattis.~ 1-(7~ 53541 ~ http~ Frasco B~
 8     8 https://r~ ed.gov http://~ vhou~ PurusEu~ 62-(~ 4819 H~ http~ Car Pont~
 9     9 https://r~ jigsy~ http://~ rdik~ JustoEt~ 1-(6~ 68096 ~ http~ Tades Ch~
10    10 https://r~ jugem~ http://~ tdud~ Ante.ti~ 30-(~ 9595 S~ http~ Wilton K~
# i 990 more rows
# i 2 more variables: currency <chr>, passwords <chr>
```

9.2.2 Data Dictionary

- domain: dummy website domain
- imageurl: url of an image
- email: dummy email id
- filename: dummy file name with different extensions
- phone: dummy phone number
- address: dummy address with door and street names
- url: randomyly generated urls
- full_name: dummy first and last names
- currency: different currencies
- passwords: dummy passwords

9.3 Overview

Before we start with the case study, let us take a quick tour of **stringr** and introduce ourselves to some of the functions we will be using later in the case study. One of the columns in the case study data is `email`. It contains random email ids. We want to ensure that the email ids adher to a particular format .i.e

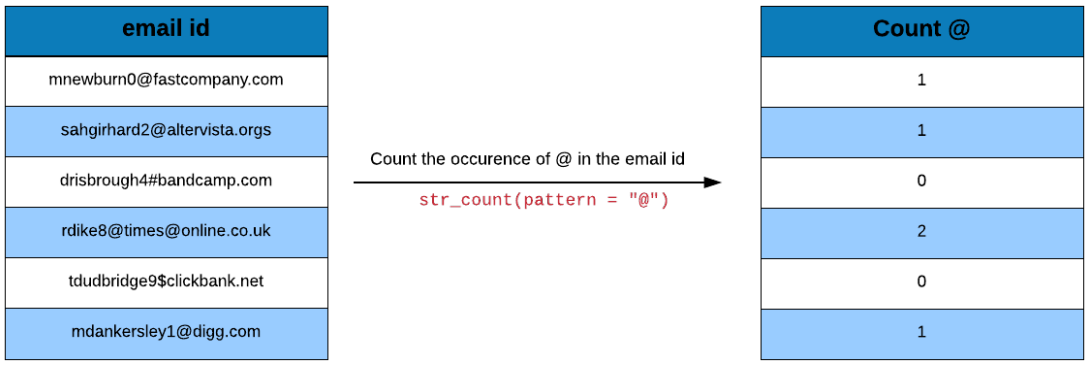
- they contain `@`
- they contain only one `@`

Let us first detect if the email ids contain `@`. Since the data set has 1000 rows, we will use a smaller sample in the examples.

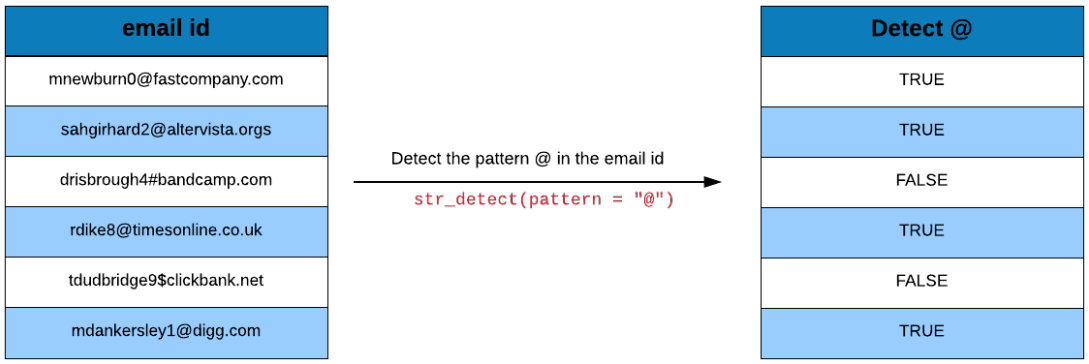
```
mockdata <- slice(mockstring, 1:10)
mockdata
```

```
# A tibble: 10 x 12
      id image_url  domain imageurl email filename phone address url   full_name
   <dbl> <chr>      <chr>  <chr>    <chr> <chr>    <chr> <chr>   <chr> <chr>
 1     1 https://r~ addto~ http://~ mnew~ PedeMal~ 66-(~ 8 Anha~ http~ Mufi Ruit
 2     2 https://r~ gmpg.~ http://~ mdan~ Loborti~ 351-~ 697 Ea~ http~ Leese Fu~
```

```
 3     3 https://r~ samsu~ http://~ hgir~ CongueD~ 33-(~ 89 Dot~ http~ Blakelee~
 4     4 https://r~ spoti~ http://~ pmcm~ Eleifen~ 86-(~ 98135 ~ http~ Terencio~
 5     5 https://r~ wunde~ http://~ dris~ PurusPh~ 223-~ 7814 P~ http~ Debee Mc~
 6     6 https://r~ alexa~ http://~ cphl~ Element~ 420-~ 4897 L~ http~ Fran Pai~
 7     7 https://r~ googl~ http://~ kdod~ Mattis.~ 1-(7~ 53541 ~ http~ Frasco B~
 8     8 https://r~ ed.gov http://~ vhou~ PurusEu~ 62-(~ 4819 H~ http~ Car Pont~
 9     9 https://r~ jigsy~ http://~ rdik~ JustoEt~ 1-(6~ 68096 ~ http~ Tades Ch~
10    10 https://r~ jugem~ http://~ tdud~ Ante.ti~ 30-(~ 9595 S~ http~ Wilton K~
# i 2 more variables: currency <chr>, passwords <chr>
```



Use `str_detect()` to detect `@` and `str_count()` to count the number of times `@` appears in the email ids.



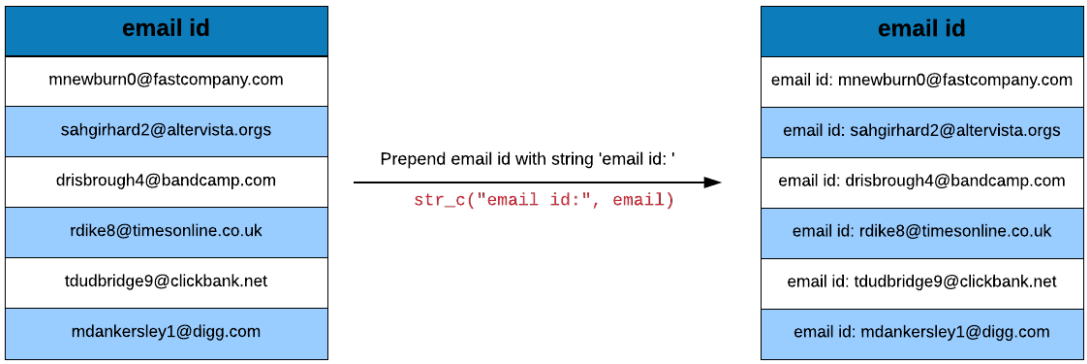

```
# detect @
str_detect(mockdata$email, pattern = "@")
```

```
 [1] TRUE TRUE TRUE TRUE TRUE TRUE TRUE TRUE TRUE TRUE
```

```
# count @
str_count(mockdata$email, pattern = "@")
```

```
 [1] 1 1 1 1 1 1 1 1 1 1
```

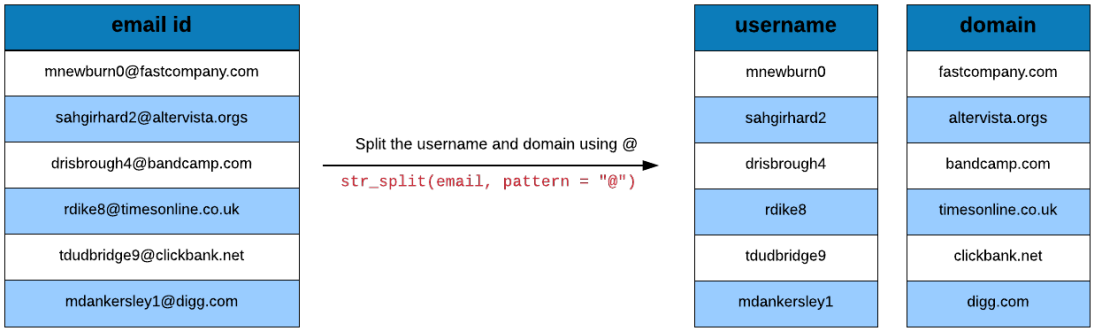
We can use `str_c()` to concatenate strings. Let us add the string `email id:` before each email id in the data set.




```
str_c("email id:", mockdata$email)
```

```
 [1] "email id:mnewburn0@fastcompany.com"
 [2] "email id:mdankersley1@digg.com"
 [3] "email id:hgirhard2@altervista.org"
 [4] "email id:pmcmenamy3@sciencedirect.com"
 [5] "email id:drisbrough4@bandcamp.com"
 [6] "email id:cphlippi5@surveymonkey.com"
 [7] "email id:kdodswell6@un.org"
 [8] "email id:vhourihane7@ovh.net"
 [9] "email id:rdike8@timesonline.co.uk"
[10] "email id:tdudbridge9@clickbank.net"
```

If we want to split a string into two parts using a particular pattern, we use `str_split()`. Let us split the domain name and extension from the domain column in the data. The domain name and extension are separated by `.` and we will use it to split the domain column. Since `.` is a special character, we will use two slashes to escape the special character.




```
str_split(mockdata$domain, pattern = "\\.")
```

```
[[1]]
[1] "addtoany" "com"

[[2]]
[1] "gmpg" "org"

[[3]]
[1] "samsung" "com"

[[4]]
[1] "spotify" "com"

[[5]]
[1] "wunderground" "com"

[[6]]
[1] "alexa" "com"

[[7]]
[1] "google" "it"

[[8]]
[1] "ed"  "gov"

[[9]]
[1] "jigsy" "com"

[[10]]
[1] "jugem" "jp"
```

We can truncate a string using `str_trunc()`. The default truncation happens at the

beggining of the string but we can truncate the central part or the end of the string as well.

```
str_trunc(mockdata$email, width = 10)
```

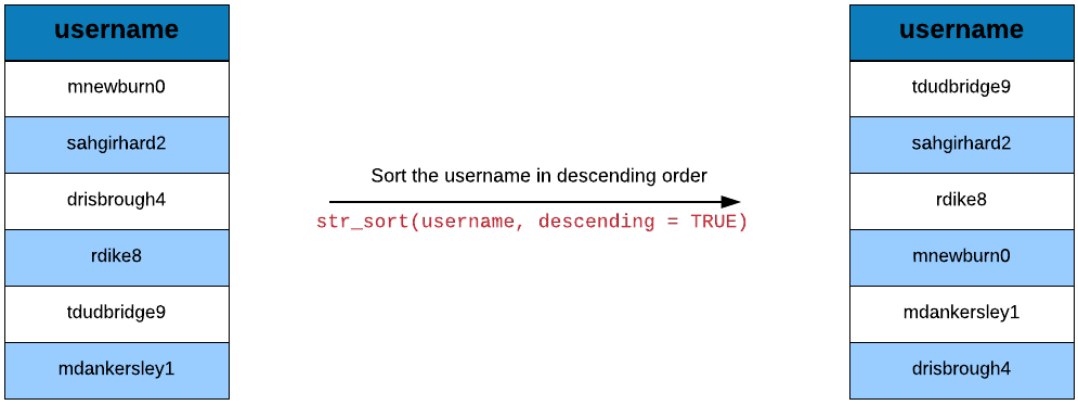
```
 [1] "mnewbur..." "mdanker..." "hgirhar..." "pmcmena..." "drisbro..."
 [6] "cphlipp..." "kdodswe..." "vhourih..." "rdike8@..." "tdudbri..."
```

```
str_trunc(mockdata$email, width = 10, side = "left")
```

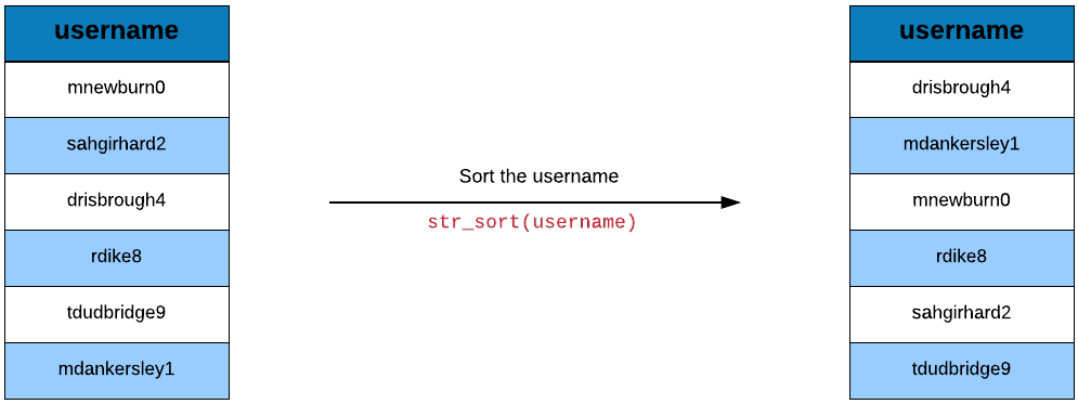
```
 [1] "...any.com" "...igg.com" "...sta.org" "...ect.com" "...amp.com"
 [6] "...key.com" "...@un.org" "...ovh.net" "...e.co.uk" "...ank.net"
```

```
str_trunc(mockdata$email, width = 10, side = "center")
```

```
 [1] "mnew...com" "mdan...com" "hgir...org" "pmcm...com" "dris...com"
 [6] "cphl...com" "kdod...org" "vhou...net" "rdik....uk" "tdud...net"
```



Strings can be sorted using `str_sort()`. Let us quickly sort the emails in both ascending and descending orders.



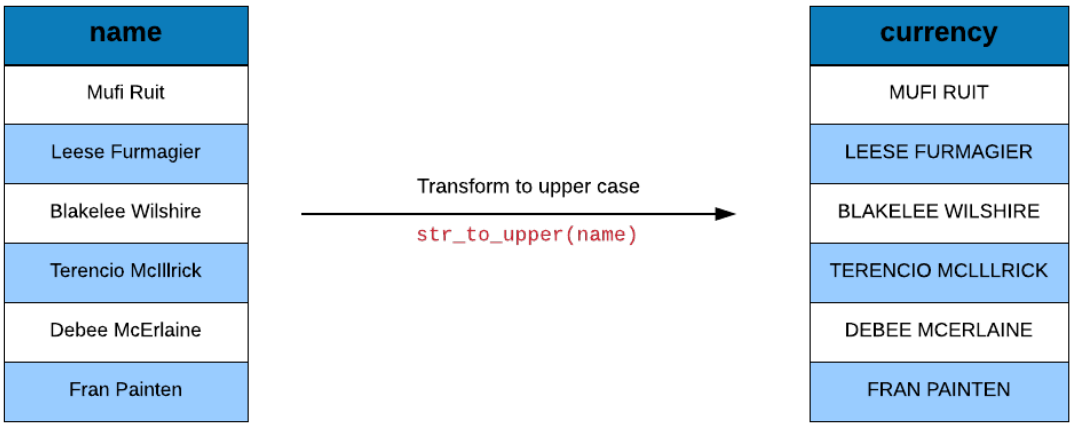

```
str_sort(mockdata$email)
```

```
 [1] "cphlippi5@surveymonkey.com"    "drisbrough4@bandcamp.com"
 [3] "hgirhard2@altervista.org"      "kdodswell6@un.org"
 [5] "mdankersley1@digg.com"         "mnewburn0@fastcompany.com"
 [7] "pmcmenamy3@sciencedirect.com" "rdike8@timesonline.co.uk"
 [9] "tdudbridge9@clickbank.net"     "vhourihane7@ovh.net"
```

```
str_sort(mockdata$email, decreasing = TRUE)
```

```
 [1] "vhourihane7@ovh.net"           "tdudbridge9@clickbank.net"
 [3] "rdike8@timesonline.co.uk"      "pmcmenamy3@sciencedirect.com"
 [5] "mnewburn0@fastcompany.com"     "mdankersley1@digg.com"
 [7] "kdodswell6@un.org"             "hgirhard2@altervista.org"
 [9] "drisbrough4@bandcamp.com"      "cphlippi5@surveymonkey.com"
```

The case of a string can be changed to upper, lower or title case as shown below.




```
str_to_upper(mockdata$full_name)
```

```
 [1] "MUFI RUIT"          "LEESE FURMAGIER"    "BLAKELEE WILSHIRE"
 [4] "TERENCIO MCILLRICK" "DEBEE MCERLAINE"    "FRAN PAINTEN"
 [7] "FRASCO BOWICH"      "CAR PONTEN"         "TADES CHECCUCCI"
[10] "WILTON KEMMEY"
```

```
str_to_lower(mockdata$full_name)
```

```
 [1] "mufi ruit"          "leese furmagier"    "blakelee wilshire"
 [4] "terencio mcillrick" "debee mcerlaine"    "fran painten"
 [7] "frasco bowich"      "car ponten"         "tades checcucci"
[10] "wilton kemmey"
```

Parts of a string can be replaced using `str_replace()`. In the `address` column of the data set, let us replace:

- Street with ST
- Road with RD



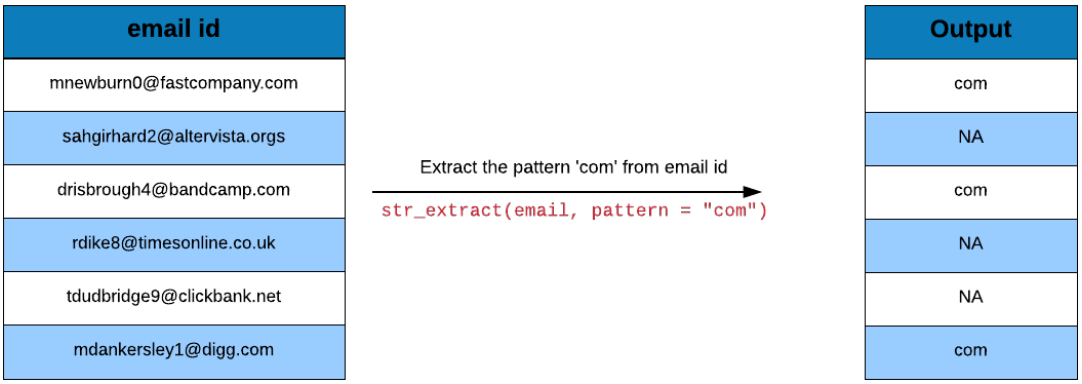

```
str_replace(mockdata$address, "Street", "ST")
```

```
 [1] "8 Anhalt Crossing"          "697 East Avenue"
 [3] "89 Dottie Circle"           "98135 Blue Bill Park Drive"
 [5] "7814 Pennsylvania ST"       "4897 Little Fleur Drive"
 [7] "53541 Morrow Center"        "4819 Hermina Parkway"
 [9] "68096 Monument Park"        "9595 Spaight Avenue"
```

```
str_replace(mockdata$address, "Road", "RD")
```

```
 [1] "8 Anhalt Crossing"          "697 East Avenue"
 [3] "89 Dottie Circle"           "98135 Blue Bill Park Drive"
 [5] "7814 Pennsylvania Street"   "4897 Little Fleur Drive"
 [7] "53541 Morrow Center"        "4819 Hermina Parkway"
 [9] "68096 Monument Park"        "9595 Spaight Avenue"
```

We can extract parts of the string that match a particular pattern using `str_extract()`.



```
str_extract(mockdata$email, pattern = "org")
```

```
 [1] NA    NA    "org" NA    NA    NA    "org" NA    NA    NA
```

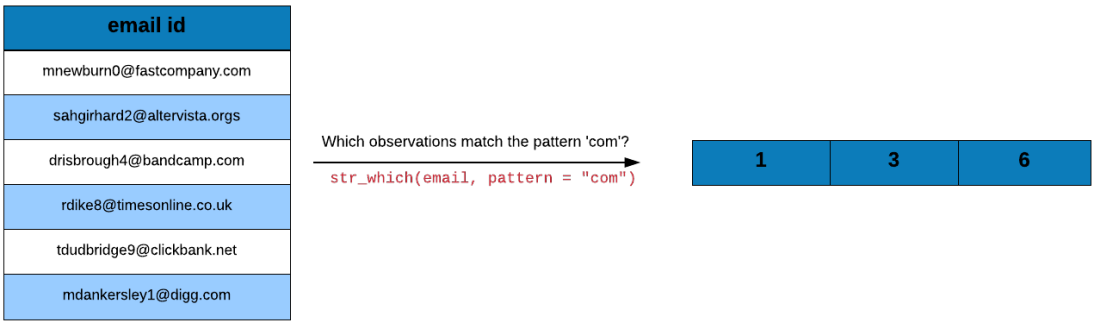
Before we extract, we need to know whether the string contains text that match our pattern. Use `str_match()` to see if the pattern is present in the string.




```
str_match(mockdata$email, pattern = "org")
```

```
      [,1]
 [1,] NA
 [2,] NA
 [3,] "org"
 [4,] NA
 [5,] NA
 [6,] NA
 [7,] "org"
 [8,] NA
 [9,] NA
[10,] NA
```

If we are dealing with a character vector and know that the pattern we are looking at is present in the vector, we might want to know the index of the strings in which it is present. Use `str_which()` to identify the index of the strings that match our pattern.




```
str_which(mockdata$email, pattern = "org")
```

```
[1] 3 7
```

Another objective might be to locate the position of the pattern we are looking for in the string. For example, if we want to know the position of `@` in the email ids, we can use `str_locate()`.

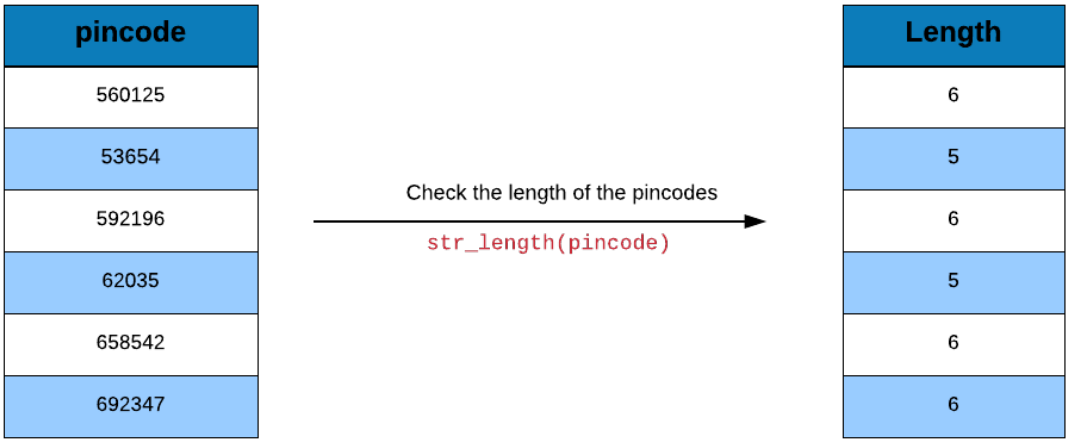



```
str_locate(mockdata$email, pattern = "@")
```

```
     start end
[1,]    10  10
[2,]    13  13
[3,]    10  10
[4,]    11  11
[5,]    12  12
[6,]    10  10
[7,]    11  11
[8,]    12  12
```

```
 [9,]     7   7
[10,]    12  12
```

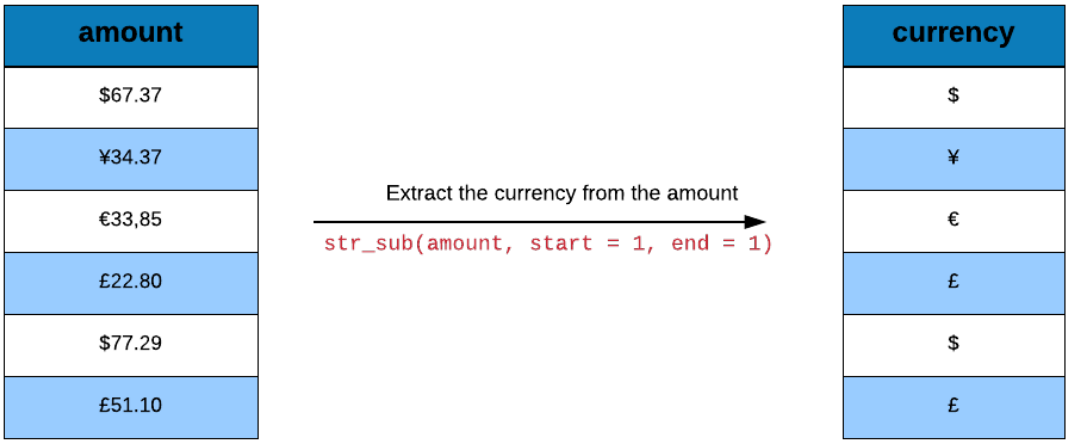
The length of the string can be computed using `str_length()`. Let us ensure that the length of the strings in the `password` column is 16.




```
str_length(mockdata$passwords)
```

```
 [1] 16 16 16 16 16 16 16 16 16 16
```

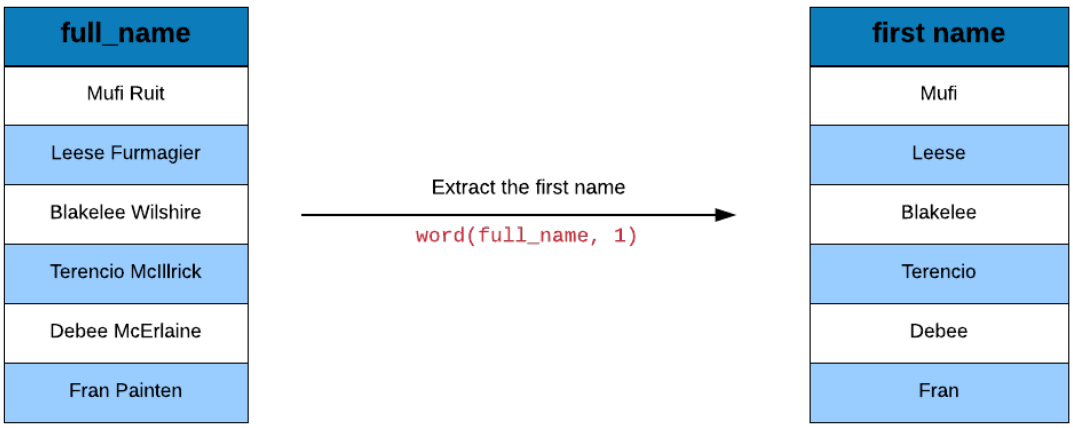
We can extract parts of a string by specifying the starting and ending position using `str_sub()`. Let us extract the currency type from the `currency` column.



```
str_sub(mockdata$currency, start = 1, end = 1)
```

```
 [1] "¥" "$" "€" "€" "€" "¥" "$" "¥" "€" "€"
```

One final function that we will look at before the case study is `word()`. It extracts word(s) from sentences. We do not have any sentences in the data set, but let us use it to extract the first and last name from the `full_name` column.




```
word(mockdata$full_name, 1)
```

```
 [1] "Mufi"     "Leese"    "Blakelee" "Terencio" "Debee"    "Fran"
 [7] "Frasco"   "Car"      "Tades"    "Wilton"
```

```
word(mockdata$full_name, 2)
```

```
 [1] "Ruit"      "Furmagier" "Wilshire"  "McIllrick" "McErlaine" "Painten"
 [7] "Bowich"    "Ponten"    "Checcucci" "Kemmey"
```

Alright, now let us apply what we have learned so far to our case study.

9.4 Extract domain name from email ids

9.4.1 Steps

- split email using pattern `@`

- extract the second element from the resulting list
- split the above using pattern \\.
- extract the first element from the resulting list

Let us take a look at the emails before we extract the domain names.

```
emails <-
  mockstring |>
  pull(email) |>
  head()

emails
```

```
[1] "mnewburn0@fastcompany.com"    "mdankersley1@digg.com"
[3] "hgirhard2@altervista.org"     "pmcmenamy3@sciencedirect.com"
[5] "drisbrough4@bandcamp.com"     "cphlippi5@surveymonkey.com"
```

9.4.1.1 Step 1: Split email using pattern `@`.

We will split the email using `str_split`. It will split a string using the pattern supplied. In our case the pattern is `@`.

```
 str_split(emails, pattern = '@')
```

```
[[1]]
[1] "mnewburn0"       "fastcompany.com"

[[2]]
[1] "mdankersley1" "digg.com"

[[3]]
[1] "hgirhard2"      "altervista.org"

[[4]]
[1] "pmcmenamy3"        "sciencedirect.com"

[[5]]
[1] "drisbrough4"  "bandcamp.com"

[[6]]
[1] "cphlippi5"        "surveymonkey.com"
```

9.4.1.2 Step 2: Extract the second element from the resulting list.

Step 1 returned a list. Each element of the list has two values. The first one is the username and the second is the domain name. Since we are extracting the domain name, we want the second value from each element of the list.

We will use `map_chr()` from purrr to extract the domain names. It will return the second value from each element in the list. Since the domain name is a string, `map_chr()` will return a character vector.

```
emails |>
  str_split(pattern = '@') |>
  map_chr(2)
```

```
[1] "fastcompany.com"   "digg.com"          "altervista.org"
[4] "sciencedirect.com" "bandcamp.com"      "surveymonkey.com"
```

9.4.1.3 Step 3: Split the above using pattern `\\.`

We want the domain name and not the extension. Step 2 returned a character vector and we need to split the domain name and the domain extension. They are separated by `.`. Since `.` is a special character, we will use `\\` before `.` to escape it. Let us split the domain name and domain extension using `str_split` and `\\.` as the pattern.

```
emails |>
  str_split(pattern = '@') |>
  map_chr(2) |>
  str_split(pattern = '\\.')
```

```
[[1]]
[1] "fastcompany" "com"

[[2]]
[1] "digg" "com"

[[3]]
[1] "altervista" "org"

[[4]]
[1] "sciencedirect" "com"

[[5]]
[1] "bandcamp" "com"
```

```
[[6]]
[1] "surveymonkey" "com"
```

9.4.1.4 Step 4: Extract the first element from the resulting list.

Now that we have separated the domain name from its extension, let us extract the first value from each element in the list returned in step 3. We will again use `map_chr` to achieve this.

```
emails |>
  str_split(pattern = '@') |>
  map_chr(2) |>
  str_split(pattern = '\\.') |>
  map_chr(1)
```

```
[1] "fastcompany"   "digg"          "altervista"    "sciencedirect"
[5] "bandcamp"      "surveymonkey"
```

9.5 Extract Domain Extension

The below code extracts the domain extension instead of the domain name.

```
emails |>
  str_split(pattern = '@') |>
  map_chr(2) |>
  str_split(pattern = '\\.', simplify = TRUE) |>
  (\(m) m[, 2])()
```

```
[1] "com" "com" "org" "com" "com" "com"
```

9.6 Extract email domains with str_extract() in one step

The four-step split above teaches the mechanics, but in practice a single `str_extract()` with a lookbehind does the same job — verified identical on all 1001 addresses:

```
# domain name only (fastcompany, digg, altervista, ...)
mockstring |>
  pull(email) |>
  str_extract("(?<=@)[^.]+") |>
  head()
```

```
[1] "fastcompany"   "digg"          "altervista"    "sciencedirect"
[5] "bandcamp"      "surveymonkey"
```

```
# full domain (fastcompany.com, altervista.org, ...)
mockstring |>
  pull(email) |>
  str_extract("(?<=@).+") |>
  head()
```

```
[1] "fastcompany.com"   "digg.com"          "altervista.org"
[4] "sciencedirect.com" "bandcamp.com"      "surveymonkey.com"
```

```
# extension only (com, org, ...)
mockstring |>
  pull(email) |>
  str_extract("[^.]+$") |>
  head()
```

```
[1] "com" "com" "org" "com" "com" "com"
```

`(?<=@)` matches the position right after `@` without consuming it, and `[^.]+` takes everything up to the first dot. Reach for the one-step regex when the pattern is regular; keep the split-then-pick pipeline for messier strings where each step deserves inspection.

9.7 Extract image type from URL

9.7.1 Steps

- split imageurl using pattern \\.
- extract the third value from each element of the resulting list
- subset the string using the index position

Let us take a look at the URL of the image.

```
img <-
  mockstring |>
  pull(imageurl) |>
  head()

img
```

```
[1] "http://dummyimage.com/130x183.jpg/dddddd/000000"
[2] "http://dummyimage.com/106x217.bmp/dddddd/000000"
[3] "http://dummyimage.com/146x127.bmp/cc0000/ffffff"
[4] "http://dummyimage.com/181x194.png/5fa2dd/ffffff"
[5] "http://dummyimage.com/220x123.jpg/ff4444/ffffff"
[6] "http://dummyimage.com/118x176.bmp/dddddd/000000"
```

9.7.1.1 Step 1: Split imageurl using pattern \\.

Let us split imageurl using `str_split` and the pattern `\\.`.

```
str_split(img, pattern = '\\.')
```

```
[[1]]
[1] "http://dummyimage" "com/130x183"       "jpg/dddddd/000000"

[[2]]
[1] "http://dummyimage" "com/106x217"       "bmp/dddddd/000000"

[[3]]
[1] "http://dummyimage" "com/146x127"       "bmp/cc0000/ffffff"

[[4]]
[1] "http://dummyimage" "com/181x194"       "png/5fa2dd/ffffff"

[[5]]
[1] "http://dummyimage" "com/220x123"       "jpg/ff4444/ffffff"

[[6]]
[1] "http://dummyimage" "com/118x176"       "bmp/dddddd/000000"
```

9.7.1.2 Step 2: Extract the third value from each element of the resulting list

Step 1 returned a list the elements of which have 3 values each. If you observe the list, the image type is in the 3rd value. We will now extract the third value from each element of the list using `map_chr`.

```
img |>
  str_split(pattern = '\\.') |>
  map_chr(3)
```

```
[1] "jpg/dddddd/000000" "bmp/dddddd/000000" "bmp/cc0000/ffffff"
[4] "png/5fa2dd/ffffff" "jpg/ff4444/ffffff" "bmp/dddddd/000000"
```

9.7.1.3 Step 3: Subset the string using the index position

We can now extract the image type in two ways:

- subset the first 3 characters of the string
- split the string using pattern `/` and extract the first value from the elements of the resulting list

Below is the first method. We know that the image type is 3 characters. So we use `str_sub` to subset the first 3 characters. The index positions are mentioned using `start` and `stop`.

```
img |>
  str_split(pattern = '\\.') |>
  map_chr(3) |>
  str_sub(start = 1, end = 3)
```

```
[1] "jpg" "bmp" "bmp" "png" "jpg" "bmp"
```

In case you are not sure about the length of the image type. In such cases, we will split the string using pattern `/` and then use `map_chr` to extract the first value of each element of the resulting list.

```
img |>
  str_split(pattern = '\\.') |>
  map_chr(3) |>
  str_split(pattern = '/') |>
  map_chr(1)
```

```
[1] "jpg" "bmp" "bmp" "png" "jpg" "bmp"
```

9.8 Extract Image Dimesion from URL

9.8.1 Steps

- locate numbers between 0 and 9
- extract part of url starting with image dimension
- split the string using the pattern `\\.`
- extract the first element

9.8.1.1 Step 1: Locate numbers between 0 and 9.

Let us inspect the image url. The dimension of the image appears after the domain extension and there are no numbers in the url before. We will locate the position or index of the first number in the url using `str_locate()` and using the pattern `[0-9]` which instructs to look for any number between and including 0 and 9.

```
str_locate(img, pattern = "[0-9]")
```

```
     start end
[1,]    23  23
[2,]    23  23
[3,]    23  23
[4,]    23  23
[5,]    23  23
[6,]    23  23
```

9.8.1.2 Step 2: Extract url

We know where the dimension is located in the url. Let us extract the part of the url that contains the image dimension using `str_sub()`.

```
str_sub(img, start = 23)
```

```
[1] "130x183.jpg/dddddd/000000" "106x217.bmp/dddddd/000000"
[3] "146x127.bmp/cc0000/ffffff" "181x194.png/5fa2dd/ffffff"
[5] "220x123.jpg/ff4444/ffffff" "118x176.bmp/dddddd/000000"
```

9.8.1.3 Step 3: Split the string using the pattern `\\.`

From the previous step, we have the part of the url that contains the image dimension. To extract the dimension, we will split it from the rest of the url using `str_split()` and using the pattern `\\.` as it separates the dimension and the image extension.

```
img |>
  str_sub(start = 23) |>
  str_split(pattern = '\\.')
```

```
[[1]]
[1] "130x183"           "jpg/dddddd/000000"

[[2]]
```

```
[1] "106x217"           "bmp/dddddd/000000"

[[3]]
[1] "146x127"           "bmp/cc0000/ffffff"

[[4]]
[1] "181x194"           "png/5fa2dd/ffffff"

[[5]]
[1] "220x123"           "jpg/ff4444/ffffff"

[[6]]
[1] "118x176"           "bmp/dddddd/000000"
```

9.8.1.4 Step 4: Extract the first element.

The above step resulted in a list which contains the image dimension and the rest of the url. Each element of the list is a character vector. We want to extract the first value in the character vector. Let us use `map_chr()` to extract the first value from each element of the list.

```
img |>
  str_sub(start = 23) |>
  str_split(pattern = '\\.') |>
  map_chr(1)
```

```
[1] "130x183" "106x217" "146x127" "181x194" "220x123" "118x176"
```

9.9 Extract HTTP Protocol from URL

```
url1 <-
  mockstring |>
  pull(url) |>
  first()

url1
```

```
[1] "https://engadget.com/nascetur/ridiculus/mus/vivamus/vestibulum.jsp?eu=est&tincidunt=r
```

9.9.1 Steps

- split the url using the pattern `://`
- extract the first element

9.9.1.1 Step 1: Split the url using the pattern `://`.

The HTTP protocol is the first part of the url and is separated from the rest of the url by `:`. Let us split the url using `str_split()` and using the pattern `:`. Since `:` is a special character, we will escape it using `\\`.

```
str_split(url1, pattern = '://')
```

```
[[1]]
[1] "https"
[2] "engadget.com/nascetur/ridiculus/mus/vivamus/vestibulum.jsp?eu=est&tincidunt=risus&in=
```

9.9.1.2 Step 2: Extract the first element.

The HTTP protocol is the first value in each element of the list. As we did in the previous example, we will extract it using `map_chr()` with the element position.

```
url1 |>
  str_split(pattern = '://') |>
  map_chr(1)
```

```
[1] "https"
```

9.10 Extract file type

```
urls <-
  mockstring |>
  pull(url) |>
  head(3)
```

9.10.1 Steps

- check if there are only 2 dots in the URL
- check if there is only 1 question mark in the URL
- detect the staritng position of file type
- tetect the ending position of file type
- use the locations to specify the index position for extracting file type

9.10.1.1 Step 1: Check if there are only 2 dots in the URL

Let us locate all the dots in the url using `str_locate_all()` and see if any of them contain more than 2 dots.

```
urls |>
  str_locate_all(pattern = '\\.') |>
  map_int(nrow) |>
  is_greater_than(2) |>
  sum()
```

```
[1] 0
```

9.10.1.2 Step 2: Check if there is only 1 question mark in the URL

The next step is to check if there is only one `?` (question mark) in the url.

```
urls |>
  str_locate_all(pattern = "[?]") |>
  map_int(nrow) |>
  is_greater_than(1) |>
  sum()
```

```
[1] 0
```

9.10.1.3 Step 3: Detect the staritng position of file type

Since the file type is located between the second dot and the first quesiton mark in the url, let us extract the location of the second dot and add 1 as the file type starts after the dot.

```
d <-
  urls |>
  str_locate_all(pattern = '\\.') |>
  map_int(2) |>
  add(1)

d
```

```
[1] 64 47 48
```

9.10.1.4 Step 4: Detect the ending position of file type

In step 2, we confirmed that the url has only one question mark. Let us locate the question mark in the url and subtract 1 (as the file type ends before the question mark) so that we get the ending chapterion of the file type. .

```
q <-
  urls |>
  str_locate_all(pattern = "[?]") |>
  map_int(1) |>
  subtract(1)

q
```

```
[1] 66 50 51
```

9.10.1.5 Step 5: Specify the index position for extracting file type

From steps 3 and 4, we have the location of the second dot and the first question mark in the url. Let us use them with `str_sub()` to extract the file type.

```
str_sub(urls, start = d, end = q)
```

```
[1] "jsp"  "json" "json"
```

Try it live

> Try it in your browser
>
> Edit the code below and press **Run**. It executes entirely in your browser via WebR — no R installation needed. The runtime downloads once, on this page only.

```
library(stringr)
library(readr)
if (!file.exists("mockstrings_sample.csv")) {
  download.file(
    "https://wrangle-r.rsquaredacademy.com/data-webr/mockstrings_sample.csv",
    "mockstrings_sample.csv"
  )
}
mock <- read_csv("mockstrings_sample.csv", show_col_types = FALSE)
str_detect(mock$email, pattern = "@")
```

10 Date & Time: Parsing and Components

> **Continued in part B**
>
> This chapter was split for readability. Arithmetic, intervals, time zones and rounding continue in @date-arithmetic-time-zones.

This chapter is the first of two on dates and times. Here we parse character data into dates and extract components (year, month, weekday, quarter). @date-arithmetic-time-zones continues with arithmetic, intervals, time zones, rounding and rollback.

10.1 Introduction

Let us begin by looking at the current date and time.

10.1.1 Date

`Sys.Date()` and `today()` will return the current date.

```
Sys.Date()
```

```
[1] "2026-11-01"
```

```
lubridate::today()
```

```
[1] "2026-11-01"
```

10.1.2 Time

`Sys.time()` and `now()` return the date, time and the timezone. In `now()`, we can specify the timezone using the `tzone` argument.

```
Sys.time()
```

```
[1] "2026-11-01 11:35:20 UTC"
```

```
lubridate::now()
```

```
[1] "2026-11-01 11:35:20 UTC"
```

```
lubridate::now(tzone = "UTC")
```

```
[1] "2026-11-01 11:35:20 UTC"
```

10.1.3 AM or PM?

`am()` and `pm()` allow us to check whether date/time occur in the am or pm? They return a logical value i.e. `TRUE` or `FALSE`

```
lubridate::am(now())
```

```
[1] TRUE
```

```
lubridate::pm(now())
```

```
[1] FALSE
```

10.1.4 Leap Year

We can also check if the current year is a leap year using `leap_year()`.

```
lubridate::leap_year(Sys.Date())
```

```
[1] FALSE
```

10.1.5 Summary

Function	Description
‘Sys.Date()‘	Current Date
‘lubridate::today()‘	Current Date
‘Sys.time()‘	Current Time
‘lubridate::now()‘	Current Time
‘lubridate::am()‘	Whether time occurs in am?
‘lubridate::pm()‘	Whether time occurs in pm?

‘lubridate::leap_year()‘	Check if the year is a leap year?

10.1.6 Your Turn

- get current date
- get current time
- check whether the time occurs in am or pm?
- check whether the following years were leap years
  - 2018
  - 2016

10.2 Case Study

Throughout the tutorial, we will work on a case study related to transactions of a imaginary company. The data set includes information about invoice and payment dates.

10.2.1 Data

```
transact <- readr::read_csv('https://raw.githubusercontent.com/rsquaredacademy/datasets/ma
```

```
# A tibble: 2,466 x 3
   Invoice    Due        Payment
   <date>     <date>     <date>
 1 2013-01-02 2013-02-01 2013-01-15
 2 2013-01-26 2013-02-25 2013-03-03
 3 2013-07-03 2013-08-02 2013-07-08
 4 2013-02-10 2013-03-12 2013-03-17
 5 2012-10-25 2012-11-24 2012-11-28
 6 2012-01-27 2012-02-26 2012-02-22
 7 2013-08-13 2013-09-12 2013-09-09
 8 2012-12-16 2013-01-15 2013-01-12
 9 2012-05-14 2012-06-13 2012-07-01
10 2013-07-01 2013-07-31 2013-07-26
# i 2,456 more rows
```

10.2.2 Data Dictionary

The data set has 3 columns. All the dates are in the format (yyyy-mm-dd).

Column	Description
Invoice	Invoice Date
Due	Due Date
Payment	Payment Date

In the case study, we will try to answer a few questions we have about the `transact` data.

- extract date, month and year from Due
- compute the number of days to settle invoice
- compute days over due
- check if due year is a leap year
- check when due day in february is 29, whether it is a leap year
- how many invoices were settled within due date
- how many invoices are due in each quarter

10.3 Date & Time Classes

10.3.1 Introduction

In this section, we will look at two things. First, how to create date/time data in R, and second, how to convert other data types to date/time. Let us begin by creating the latest R release date manually.

```
release_date <- 2019-12-12
release_date
```

```
[1] 1995
```

Okay! Why do we see `1995` when we call the date? What is happening here? Let us quickly check the data type of `release_date`.

```
class(release_date)
```

```
[1] "numeric"
```

The data type is `numeric` i.e. R has subtracted `12` twice from `2019` to return `1995`. Clearly, the above method is not the right way to store date/time. Let us see if we can get some hints from the builtin R functions we used in the previous section. If you observe the output, all of them returned date/time wrapped in quotes. Hmmm… let us wrap our date in quotes and see what happens.

```
release_date <- "2019-12-12"
release_date
```

```
[1] "2019-12-12"
```

Alright, now R does not do any arithmetic and returns the date as we specified. Great! Is this the right format to store date/time? No. Why? What is the problem if date/time is saved as character/string? The problem is the nature or type of operations done on date or time is different when compared to string/character, number or logical values.

- how do we add/subtract dates?
- how do we extract components such as year, month, day etc.

To answer the above questions, we will first check the data type of `Sys.Date()` and `now()`.

```
class(Sys.Date())
```

```
[1] "Date"
```

```
class(lubridate::now())
```

```
[1] "POSIXct" "POSIXt"
```

```
class(release_date)
```

```
[1] "character"
```

As you can see from the above output, there are 3 different classes for storing date/time in R

- `Date`
- `POSIXct`
- `POSIXlt`

Let us explore each of the above classes one by one.

10.3.2 Date

10.3.2.1 Introduction

The `Date` class represents calendar dates. Let us go back to `Sys.Date()`. If you check the class of `Sys.Date()`, it is `Date`. Internally, this date is a number i.e. an integer. The `unclass()` function will show dates are stored internally.

```
unclass(Sys.Date())
```

```
[1] 20758
```

What does this integer represent? Why has R stored the date as an integer? Before we answer this question, we need to know something else. In R, dates are represented as the number of days since `1970-01-01`. All the dates in R are internally stored in this way. Before we explore this concept further, let us learn to create `Date` objects in R. We will continue to use the latest R release date, `2019-12-12`.

Until now, we have stored the above date as character/string but now we will use `as.Date()` to save it as a `Date` object. `as.Date()` is the easiest and simplest way to create dates in R.

```
release_date <- as.Date("2019-12-12")
release_date
```

```
[1] "2019-12-12"
```

The `as_date()` function from the lubridate package is similar to `as.Date()`.

```
release_date <- lubridate::as_date("2019-12-12")
release_date
```

```
[1] "2019-12-12"
```

If you look at the difference between `release_date` and `1970-01-01`, it will be the same as `unclass(release_date)`.

```
release_date - as.Date("1970-01-01")
```

```
Time difference of 18242 days
```

```
unclass(release_date)
```

```
[1] 18242
```

Let us come back to `1970-01-01` i.e. the origin for dates in R.

```
lubridate::origin
```

```
[1] "1970-01-01 UTC"
```

From the previous examples, we know that dates are internally stored as number of days since `1970-01-01`. How about dates older than the origin? How are they stored? Let us look at that briefly.

```
unclass(as.Date("1963-08-28"))
```

```
[1] -2318
```

Dates older than the origin are stored as negative integers. For those who are not aware, Martin Luther King, Jr. delivered his famous **I Have a Dream** speech on `1963-08-28`. Let us move on and learn how to convert numbers into dates.

10.3.2.2 Convert Numeric

The `as.Date()` function can be used to convert any of the following to a `Date` object

- character/string
- number
- factor (categorical/qualitative)

We have explored how to convert strings to date. How about converting numbers to date? Sure, we can create date from numbers by specifying the origin and number of days since it.

```
as.Date(18242, origin = "1970-01-01")
```

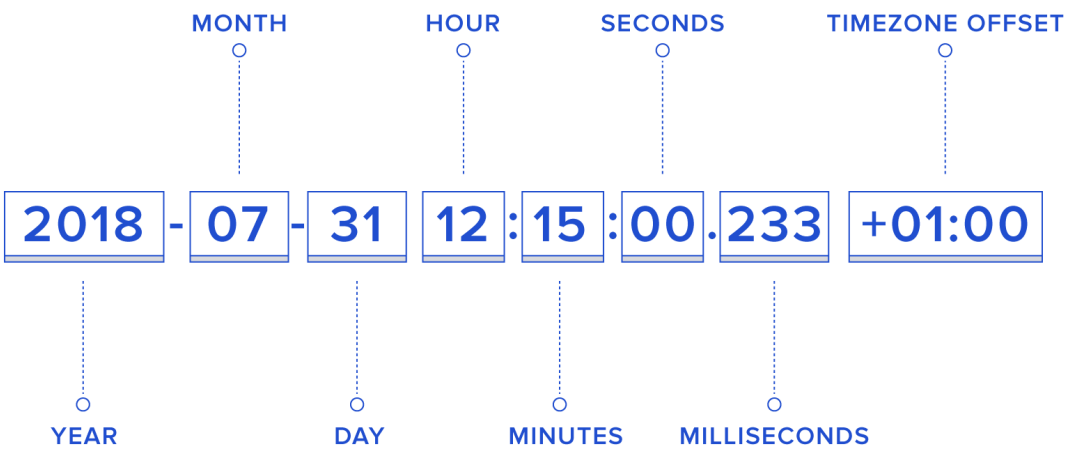
```
[1] "2019-12-12"
```

The origin can be changed to another date (while changing the number as well.)

```
as.Date(7285, origin = "2000-01-01")
```

```
[1] "2019-12-12"
```

10.3.3 ISO 8601



If you have carefully observed, the format in which we have been specifying the dates as well as of those returned by functions such as `Sys.Date()` or `Sys.time()` is the same i.e. `YYYY-MM-DD`. It includes

- the year including the century
- the month
- the date

The month and date separated by `-`. This default format used in R is the ISO 8601 standard for date/time. ISO 8601 is the internationally accepted way to represent dates and times and uses the 24 hour clock system. Let us create the release date using another function `ISOdate()`.

```
ISOdate(year  = 2019,
        month = 12,
        day   = 12,
        hour  = 8,
        min   = 5,
        sec   = 3,
        tz    = "UTC")
```

```
[1] "2019-12-12 08:05:03 UTC"
```

We will look at all the different weird ways in which date/time are specified in the real world in the Date & Time Formats section. For the time being, let us continue exploring date/time classes in R. The next class we are going to look at is `POSIXct/POSIXlt`.

10.3.4 POSIX

You might be wondering what is this POSIX thing? POSIX stands for **P**ortable **O**perating **S**ystem **I**nterface. It is a family of standards specified f or maintaining compatibility between different operating systems. Before we learn to create POSIX objects, let us look at `now()` from lubridate.

```
class(lubridate::now())
```

```
[1] "POSIXct" "POSIXt"
```

`now()` returns current date/time as a POSIXct object. Let us look at its internal representation using `unclass()`

```
unclass(lubridate::now())
```

```
[1] 1793532921
attr(,"tzone")
[1] ""
```

The output you see is the number of seconds since January 1, 1970.

10.3.4.1 POSIXct

`POSIXct` represents the number of seconds since the beginning of 1970 (UTC) and `ct` stands for calendar time. To store date/time as `POSIXct` objects, use `as.POSIXct()`. Let us now store the latest R release date as `POSIXct` as shown below

```
release_date <- as.POSIXct("2019-12-12 08:05:03")
class(release_date)
```

```
[1] "POSIXct" "POSIXt"
```

```
unclass(release_date)
```

```
[1] 1576137903
attr(,"tzone")
[1] ""
```

10.3.4.2 POSIXlt

`POSIXlt` represents the following information in a list

- seconds
- minutes
- hour
- day of the month
- month
- year
- day of week
- day of year
- daylight saving time flag
- time zone
- offset in seconds from GMT

The `lt` in `POSIXlt` stands for local time. Use `as.POSIXlt()` to store date/time as `POSIXlt` objects. Let us store the release date as a `POSIXlt` object as shown below

```
release_date <- as.POSIXlt("2019-12-12 08:05:03")
release_date
```

```
[1] "2019-12-12 08:05:03 UTC"
```

As we said earlier, `POSIXlt` stores date/time components in a list and these can be extracted. Let us look at the date/time components returned by `POSIXlt` using `unclass()`.

```
release_date <- as.POSIXlt("2019-12-12 08:05:03")
unclass(release_date)
```

```
$sec
[1] 3

$min
[1] 5

$hour
[1] 8

$mday
[1] 12

$mon
[1] 11
```

```
$year
[1] 119

$wday
[1] 4

$yday
[1] 345

$isdst
[1] 0

$zone
[1] "UTC"

$gmtoff
[1] 0

attr(,"tzone")
[1] "UTC"
attr(,"balanced")
[1] TRUE
```

Use `unlist()` if you want the components returned as a `vector`.

```
release_date <- as.POSIXlt("2019-12-12 08:05:03")
unlist(release_date)
```

```
   sec    min   hour   mday    mon   year   wday   yday  isdst   zone gmtoff
   "3"    "5"    "8"   "12"   "11"  "119"    "4"  "345"    "0"  "UTC"    "0"
```

To extract specific components, use `$`.

```
release_date <- as.POSIXlt("2019-12-12 08:05:03")
release_date$hour
```

```
[1] 8
```

```
release_date$mon
```

```
[1] 11
```

```
release_date$zone
```

```
[1] "UTC"
```

Now, let us look at the components returned by `POSIXlt`. Some of them are intuitive

Component	Description
‘sec‘	Second
‘min‘	Minute
‘hour‘	Hour of the day
‘mon‘	Month of the year (0-11
‘zone‘	Timezone
‘wday‘	Day of week
‘mday‘	Day of month
‘year‘	Years since 1900
‘yday‘	Day of year
‘isdst‘	Daylight saving flag
‘gmtoff‘	Offset is seconds from GMT

Great! We will end this section with a few tips/suggestions on when to use `Date` or `POSIXct/POSIXlt`.

- use `Date` when there is no time component
- use `POSIX` when dealing with time and timezones
- use `POSIXlt` when you want to access/extract the different components

10.3.5 Your Turn

R 1.0.0 was released on `2000-02-29 08:55:23 UTC`. Save it as

- `Date` using character
- `Date` using origin and number
- `POSIXct`
- `POSIXlt` and extract
  - month day
  - day of year
  - month
  - zone
- ISODate

10.4 Date & Time Formats

10.4.1 Introduction

After the timezones and daylight savings detour, let us get back on path and explore another important aspect, date & time formats. Although it is a good practice to adher to ISO 8601 format, not all date/time data will comply with it. In real world, date/time data may come in all types of weird formats. Below is a sample

Format
December 12, 2019
12th Dec, 2019
Dec 12th, 19
12-Dec-19
2019 December
12.12.19

When the data is not in the default ISO 8601 format, we need to explicitly specify the format in R. We do this using conversion specifications. A conversion specification is introduced by %, usually followed by a single letter or O or E and then a single letter.

10.4.2 Conversion Specifications

Specification	Description	Example
'%d'	Day of the month (decimal number)	12
'%m'	Month (decimal number)	12
'%b'	Month (abbreviated)	Dec
'%B'	Month (full name)	December
'%y'	Year (2 digit)	19
'%Y'	Year (4 digit)	2019
%H	Hour	8
%M	Minute	5
%S	Second	3

Time to work through a few examples. Let us say you are dealing with dates in the format `19/12/12`. In this format, the year comes first followed by month and the date; each separated by a backslash (`/`). The year consists of only 2 digits i.e. it does not include the century. Let us now map each component of the date to the format table shown at the beginning.

Date	Specification
19	‘%y‘
12	‘%m‘
12	‘%d‘

Using the format argument, we will specify the date format as a character vector i.e. enclosed in quotes.

```
as.Date("19/12/12", format = "%y/%m/%d")
```

```
[1] "2019-12-12"
```

Another way in which the release data can be written is `2019-Dec-12`. We still have the year followed by the month and the date but there are a few changes here:

- the components are separated by a `-` instead of `/`
- year has 4 digits i.e. includes the century
- the month is specified using abbreviation instead of digits

Let us map the components to the format table:

Date	Specification
2019	‘%Y‘
Dec	‘%b‘
12	‘%d‘

Let us specify the format for the date using the above mapping.

```
as.Date("2019-Dec-12", format = "%Y-%b-%d")
```

```
[1] "2019-12-12"
```

In both the above examples, we have not dealt with time components. Let us include the time of the latest R release in the next one i.e. `19/12/12 08:05:03`.

Date	Specification
19	‘%y‘
12	‘%m‘
12	‘%d‘
08	‘%H‘
05	‘%M‘

03	‘%S‘

Since we are dealing with time, we will use `as.POSIXct()` instead of `as.Date()`.

```
as.POSIXct("19/12/12 08:05:03", tz = "UTC", format = "%y/%m/%d %H:%M:%S")
```

```
[1] "2019-12-12 08:05:03 UTC"
```

In the below table, we look at some of the most widely used conversion specifications. You can learn more about these specifications by running `?strptime` or `help(strptime)`.

Specification	Description
‘%a‘	Abbreviated weekday
‘%A‘	Full weekday
‘%C‘	Century (00-99)
‘%D‘	Same as ‘%m/%d/%y‘
‘%e‘	Day of month [1 - 31]
‘%F‘	Same as ‘%Y-%m-%d‘
‘%h‘	Same as ‘%b‘
‘%I‘	Hours as decimal [01 - 12]
‘%j‘	Day of year [001 - 366]
‘%R‘	Same as ‘%H:%M‘
‘%t‘	Tab
‘%T‘	Same as ‘%H:%M:%S‘
‘%u‘	Weekday [1 - 7](Monday is 1)
‘%U‘	Week of year [00 - 53]
‘%V‘	Week of year [01 - 53]
‘%w‘	Weekday [0 - 6](sunday is 0)
‘%W‘	Week of year [00 - 53]

We have included a lot of practice questions for you to explore the different date/time formats. The solutions are available in the Learning Management system as well as in our GitHub repo. Try them and let us know if you have any doubts.

10.4.3 Guess Format

`guess_formats()` from lubridate is a very useful function. It will guess the date/time format if you specify the order in which year, month, date, hour, minute and second appear.

```r
release_date_formats <- c("December 12th 2019",
                          "Dec 12th 19",
                          "dec 12 2019")

guess_formats(release_date_formats,
              orders = "mdy",
              print_matches = TRUE)
```

```
                          Omdy          mdy
[1,] "December 12th 2019" "%Om %dth %Y" "%B %dth %Y"
[2,] "Dec 12th 19"        "%Om %dth %y" "%b %dth %y"
[3,] "dec 12 2019"        "%Om %d %Y"   "%b %d %Y"
```

```
         Omdy           Omdy           Omdy            mdy            mdy
"%Om %dth %Y" "%Om %dth %y"   "%Om %d %Y"  "%B %dth %Y"  "%b %dth %y"
          mdy
   "%b %d %Y"
```

10.4.4 Your Turn

Below, we have specified `July 5th, 2019` in different ways. Create the date using `as.Date()` while specifying the correct format for each of them.

- `July-05-19`
- `JUL-05-19`
- `05.07.19`
- `5-July 2019`
- `July 5th, 2019`
- `July 05, 2019`
- `2019-July- 05`
- `05/07/2019`
- `07/05/2019`
- `7/5/2019`
- `07/5/19`
- `2019-07-05`

10.5 Parse Date & Time

While creating date-time objects, we specified different formats using the conversion specification but most often you will not create date/time and instead deal with data thay comes your way from a system or colleague/collaborator. In such cases, we need to be able to parse date/time from the data provided to us. In this section, we will focus on parsing date/time

from character data. Both base R and the lubridate package offer functions to parse date and time and we will explore a few of them in this section. We will initially use functions from base R and later on explore those from lubridate which will give us an opportunity to compare and contrast. It will also allow us to choose the functions based on the data we are dealing with.

`strptime()` will convert character data to `POSIXlt`. You will use this when converting from character data to date/time. On the other hand, if you want to convert date/time to character data, use any of the following:

- `strftime()`
- `format()`
- `as.character()`

The above functions will convert `POSIXct/POSIXlt` to character. Let us start with a simple example. The data we have been supplied has date/time as character data and in the format `YYYYMMDD` i.e. nothing separates the year, month and date from each other. We will use `strptime()` to convert this to an object of class `POSIXlt`.

```
rel_date <- strptime("20191212", format = "%Y%m%d")
class(rel_date)
```

```
[1] "POSIXlt" "POSIXt"
```

If you have a basic knowledge of conversion specifications, you can use `strptime()` to convert character data to `POSIXlt`. Let us quickly explore the functions to convert date/time to character data before moving on to the functions from lubridate.

```
rel_date_strf <- strftime(rel_date)
class(rel_date_strf)
```

```
[1] "character"
```

```
rel_date_format <- format(rel_date)
class(rel_date_format)
```

```
[1] "character"
```

```
rel_date_char <- as.character(rel_date)
class(rel_date_char)
```

```
[1] "character"
```

As you can see, all the 3 functions converted date/time to character. Time to move on and explore the lubridate package. We will start with an example in which the release date is formatted in 3 different ways but they have one thing in common i.e. the order in which the components appear. In all the 3 formats, the year is followed by the month and then the date.

To parse the release date, we will use `parse_date_time()` from lubridate which parses the input into `POSIXct` objects.

```
release_date <- c("19-12-12", "20191212", "19-12 12")
parse_date_time(release_date, "ymd")
```

```
[1] "2019-12-12 UTC" "2019-12-12 UTC" "2019-12-12 UTC"
```

```
parse_date_time(release_date, "y m d")
```

```
[1] "2019-12-12 UTC" "2019-12-12 UTC" "2019-12-12 UTC"
```

```
parse_date_time(release_date, "%y%m%d")
```

```
[1] "2019-12-12 UTC" "2019-12-12 UTC" "2019-12-12 UTC"
```

Try to use `strptime()` in the above example and see what happens. Now, let us look at another data set.

```
release_date <- c("19-07-05", "2019-07-05", "05-07-2019", "07-05-2019")
```

What happens in the below case? The same date appears in multiple formats. How do we parse them? `parse_date_time()` allows us to specify mutiple date-time formats. Let us first map the dates to their formats.

Date	Specification
19-07-05	‘ymd‘
2019-07-05	‘ymd‘
05-07-2019	‘dmy‘
07-05-2019	‘mdy‘

The above specifications can be supplied as a character vector.

```
parse_date_time(release_date, c("ymd", "ymd", "dmy", "mdy"))
```

```
[1] "2019-07-05 UTC" "2019-07-05 UTC" "2019-07-05 UTC" "2019-05-07 UTC"
```

Great! We have used both `strptime()` and `parse_date_time()` now. Can you tell what differentiates `parse_date_time()` when compared to `strptime()`? We summarize it in the points below:

- no need to include `%` prefix or separator
- specify several date/time formats

There are other helper functions that can be used to

- parse dates with year, month, day components
- parse dates with year, month, day, hour, minute, seconds components
- parse period with hour, minute, second components

and are explored in the below examples.

```
# year/month/date
ymd("2019-12-12")
```

```
[1] "2019-12-12"
```

```
# year/month/date
ymd("19/12/12")
```

```
[1] "2019-12-12"
```

```
# date/month/year
dmy(121219)
```

```
[1] "2019-12-12"
```

```
# year/month/date/hour/minute/second
ymd_hms(191212080503)
```

```
[1] "2019-12-12 08:05:03 UTC"
```

```
# hour/minute/second
hms("8, 5, 3")
```

```
[1] "8H 5M 3S"
```

```
# hour/minute/second
hms("08:05:03")
```

```
[1] "8H 5M 3S"
```

```
# minute/second
ms("5,3")
```

```
[1] "5M 3S"
```

```
# hour/minute
hm("8, 5")
```

```
[1] "8H 5M 0S"
```

Note, in a couple of cases where the components are not separated by `/`, `-` or space, we have not enclosed the values in quotes.

10.5.1 Your Turn

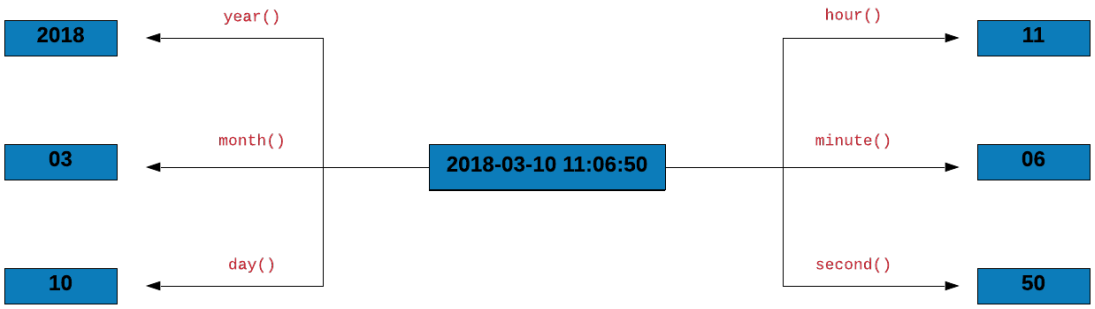
Below, we have specified `July 5th, 2019` in different ways. Parse the dates using `strptime()` or `parse_date_time()` or any other helper function.

- `July-05-19`
- `JUL-05-19`
- `05.07.19`
- `5-July 2019`
- `July 5th, 2019`
- `July 05, 2019`
- `2019-July- 05`
- `05/07/2019`
- `07/05/2019`
- `7/5/2019`
- `07/5/19`
- `2019-07-05`

10.6 Date & Time Components

In the second section, we discussed the downside of saving date/time as character/string in R. One of the points we discussed was that we can't extract components such as year, month, day etc. In this section, we will learn to extract date/time components such as

- year
- month
- date
- week
- day
- quarter
- semester
- hour
- minute
- second
- timezone



The below table outlines the functions we will explore in the first part of this section.

Function	Description
'year()'	Get year
'month()'	Get month (number)
'month(label = TRUE)'	Get month (abbreviated name)
'month(abbr = FALSE)'	Get month (full name)
'months()'	Get month
'week()'	Get week

10.6.1 Year

```
release_date <- ymd_hms("2019-12-12 08:05:03")
year(release_date)
```

```
[1] 2019
```

10.6.2 Month

`month()` will return the month as a number i.e. `07` for July.

```
month(release_date)
```

```
[1] 12
```

If you want the name of the month instead, use the `label` argument and set it to `TRUE`. Now it returns `Jul` instead of `07`.

```
month(release_date, label = TRUE)
```

```
[1] Dec
12 Levels: Jan < Feb < Mar < Apr < May < Jun < Jul < Aug < Sep < ... < Dec
```

But this is the abbreviated name and not the full name. How do we get the full name of the month? Set the `abbr` argument to `FALSE`.

```
month(release_date, label = TRUE, abbr  = FALSE)
```

```
[1] December
12 Levels: January < February < March < April < May < June < ... < December
```

Ah! now we can see the full name of the month. `months()` from base R will return the full name of the month by default. If you want the abbreviated name, use the `abbreviate` argument and set it to `TRUE`.

```
months(release_date)
```

```
[1] "December"
```

10.6.3 Week

`week()` returns the number of complete 7 day periods between the date and 1st January plus one.

```
week(release_date)
```

```
[1] 50
```

10.6.4 Day

Use `day()` to extract the date component. There are other variations such as

Function	Description
‘day‘	Get day
‘mday()‘	Day of the month
‘wday()‘	Day of the week
‘qday()‘	Day of quarter
‘yday()‘	Day of year
‘weekdays()‘	Day of week
‘days_in_month()‘	Days in the month

```
day(release_date)
```

```
[1] 12
```

```
mday(release_date)
```

```
[1] 12
```

```
qday(release_date)
```

```
[1] 73
```

```
yday(release_date)
```

```
[1] 346
```

`wday` can return

- a number
- abbreviation of the weekday
- full name of the weekday

```
wday(release_date)
```

```
[1] 5
```

```
wday(release_date, label = TRUE)
```

```
[1] Thu
Levels: Sun < Mon < Tue < Wed < Thu < Fri < Sat
```

```
wday(release_date, label = TRUE, abbr  = FALSE)
```

```
[1] Thursday
7 Levels: Sunday < Monday < Tuesday < Wednesday < Thursday < ... < Saturday
```

`weekdays()` from base R also returns the day of the week (the name and not the number). If you want the abbreviated name, use the `abbreviate` argument.

```
weekdays(release_date)
```

```
[1] "Thursday"
```

```
weekdays(release_date, abbreviate = TRUE)
```

```
[1] "Thu"
```

10.6.5 Days in Month

If you want to know the number of days in the month, use `days_in_month()`. In our example, the month is December and it has 31 days.

```
days_in_month(release_date)
```

```
Dec
 31
```

10.6.6 Hour, Minute & Seconds

Function	Description
‘hour()‘	Get hour
‘minute()‘	Get minute
‘second()‘	Get second
‘seconds()‘	Number of seconds since ‘1970-01-01‘

So far we have been looking at date components. Now, let us look at time components.

```
hour(release_date)
```

```
[1] 8
```

```
minute(release_date)
```

```
[1] 5
```

```
second(release_date)
```

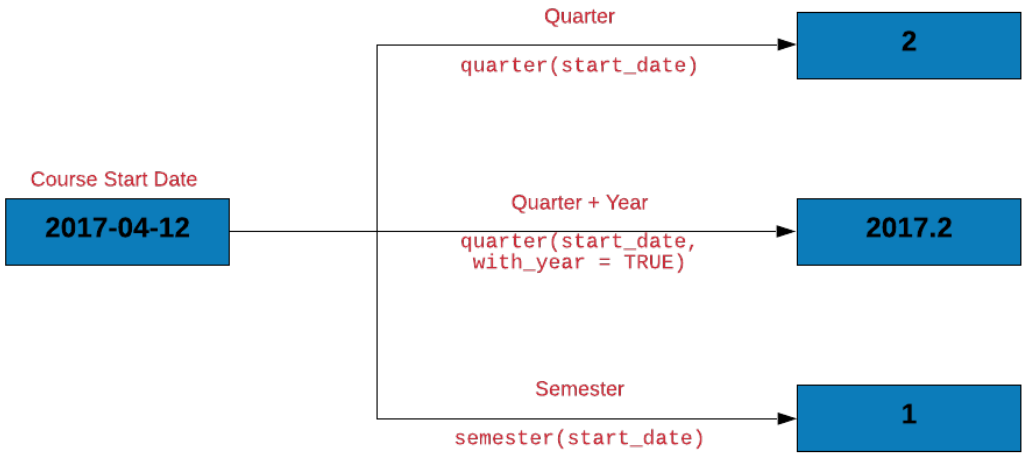
```
[1] 3
```

`seconds()` returns the number of seconds since `1970-01-01`.

```
seconds(release_date)
```

```
[1] "1576137903S"
```

10.6.7 Quarter & Semester



`quarter()` will return the quarter from the date. December is in the 4th quarter and hence it returns 4.

```
quarter(release_date)
```

```
[1] 4
```

If you want the year along with the quarter, set the `with_year` argument to `TRUE`.

```
quarter(release_date, with_year = TRUE)
```

```
[1] 2019.4
```

In India, the fiscal starts in April and December falls in the 3rd quarter. How can we accommodate this change? The `fiscal_start` argument allows us to set the month in which the fiscal begins. We will set it to 4 for April. Now it returns 3 instead of 4.

```
quarter(release_date, fiscal_start = 4)
```

```
[1] 3
```

`quarters()` from base R also returns the quarter.

```
quarters(release_date)
```

```
[1] "Q4"
```

Function	Description
‘quarter()‘	Get quarter
‘quarter(with_year = TRUE)‘	Quarter with year
‘quarter(fiscal_start = 4)‘	Fiscal starts in April
‘quarters()‘	Get quarter
‘semester()‘	Get semester

10.6.8 Case Study

10.6.8.1 Extract Date, Month & Year from Due Date

Let us now extract the date, month and year from the `Due` column.

```
transact |>
  mutate(
    due_day   = day(Due),
    due_month = month(Due),
    due_year  = year(Due)
  )
```

```
# A tibble: 2,466 x 6
   Invoice    Due        Payment    due_day due_month due_year
   <date>     <date>     <date>       <int>     <dbl>    <dbl>
 1 2013-01-02 2013-02-01 2013-01-15       1         2     2013
 2 2013-01-26 2013-02-25 2013-03-03      25         2     2013
 3 2013-07-03 2013-08-02 2013-07-08       2         8     2013
 4 2013-02-10 2013-03-12 2013-03-17      12         3     2013
 5 2012-10-25 2012-11-24 2012-11-28      24        11     2012
 6 2012-01-27 2012-02-26 2012-02-22      26         2     2012
 7 2013-08-13 2013-09-12 2013-09-09      12         9     2013
 8 2012-12-16 2013-01-15 2013-01-12      15         1     2013
 9 2012-05-14 2012-06-13 2012-07-01      13         6     2012
10 2013-07-01 2013-07-31 2013-07-26      31         7     2013
# i 2,456 more rows
```

10.6.8.2 Data Sanitization

Let us do some data sanitization. If the due day happens to be February 29, let us ensure that the due year is a leap year. Below are the steps to check if the due year is a leap year:

- we will extract the following from the due date:
  - day
  - month
  - year
- we will then create a new column `is_leap` which will have be set to `TRUE` if the year is a leap year else it will be set to `FALSE`
- filter all the payments due on 29th Feb
- select the following columns:
  - `Due`
  - `is_leap`

```
transact |>
  mutate(
    due_day   = day(Due),
    due_month = month(Due),
    due_year  = year(Due),
    is_leap   = leap_year(due_year)
  ) |>
  filter(due_month == 2 & due_day == 29) |>
  select(Due, is_leap)
```

```
# A tibble: 4 x 2
  Due        is_leap
  <date>     <lgl>
1 2012-02-29 TRUE
2 2012-02-29 TRUE
3 2012-02-29 TRUE
4 2012-02-29 TRUE
```

10.6.8.3 Invoices Distribution by Quarter

Let us count the invoices due for each quarter.

```
transact |>
  mutate(
    quarter_due = quarter(Due)
  ) |>
  count(quarter_due)
```

```
# A tibble: 4 x 2
  quarter_due     n
        <int> <int>
1           1   521
2           2   661
3           3   618
4           4   666
```

10.6.9 Your Turn

Using the `transact` data, tabulate the following from the `Due` column:

- year
- month with label
- weekday with label
- hour
- and quarter

10.7 Create, Update & Verify

In the second section, we learnt to create date-time objects using `as.Date()`, `as.POSIXct()` etc. In this section, we will explore a few other functions that will allow us to do the same

- `make_date()`
- `make_datetime()`

10.7.1 Create

To create date without time components, use `make_date()` and specify the following:

- year
- month
- date

We need to specify all the components in numbers i.e. we cannot use `Jul` or `July` for the month. It has to be `7`.

```
make_date(year  = 2019,
          month = 12,
          day   = 12)
```

```
[1] "2019-12-12"
```

When you need to include time components, use `make_datetime()`.

```
make_datetime(year  = 2019,
              month = 12,
              day   = 12,
              hour  = 08,
              min   = 05,
              sec   = 03,
              tz    = "UTC")
```

```
[1] "2019-12-12 08:05:03 UTC"
```

10.7.2 Update

Let us look at another scenario. You have a date-time object and want to change one of its components i.e. any of the following

- year
- month
- date

Instead of creating another date-time object, you can change any of the components using `update()`. In the below example, we will start with the date of release of R version 3.6.1 and using `update()`, we will change it to `2019-12-12`.

```
prev_release <- ymd("2019-07-05")
prev_release |>
  update(year  = 2019,
         month = 12,
         mday  = 12)
```

```
[1] "2019-12-12"
```

10.7.3 Date Sequence

So far we have created a single date-time instance. How about creating a sequence of dates? We can do that using `seq.Date()`. We need to specify the from date as the bare minimum input. If the end date is not specified, it will create the sequence uptil the current date.

The interval of the sequence can be specified in any of the following units:

- day
- week
- month

- quarter
- year

We can add the following to the interval units

- integer
- `+` / `-` (increment or decrement)

Using the integer, we can specify multiples of the units mentioned and using the sign, we can specify whether to increment or decrement.

The below table displays the main arguments used in `seq.Date()`:

Function	Description
'from'	Starting date of the sequence
'by'	End date of the sequence
'to'	Date increment of the sequence
'length.out'	Length of the sequence
'along.with'	Use length of this value as length of sequence

In the first example, we will create a sequence of dates from `2010-01-01` to `2019-12-31`. The unit of increment should be a year i.e. the difference between the dates in the sequence should be 1 year, specified using the `by` argument.

```
seq.Date(from = as.Date("2010-01-01"), to = as.Date("2019-12-31"), by = "year")
```

```
 [1] "2010-01-01" "2011-01-01" "2012-01-01" "2013-01-01" "2014-01-01"
 [6] "2015-01-01" "2016-01-01" "2017-01-01" "2018-01-01" "2019-01-01"
```

In the next example, we change the unit of increment to a quarter i.e. the difference between the dates in the sequence should be a quarter or 3 months.

```
seq.Date(from = as.Date("2009-12-12"), to = as.Date("2019-12-12"), by = "quarter")
```

```
 [1] "2009-12-12" "2010-03-12" "2010-06-12" "2010-09-12" "2010-12-12"
 [6] "2011-03-12" "2011-06-12" "2011-09-12" "2011-12-12" "2012-03-12"
[11] "2012-06-12" "2012-09-12" "2012-12-12" "2013-03-12" "2013-06-12"
[16] "2013-09-12" "2013-12-12" "2014-03-12" "2014-06-12" "2014-09-12"
[21] "2014-12-12" "2015-03-12" "2015-06-12" "2015-09-12" "2015-12-12"
[26] "2016-03-12" "2016-06-12" "2016-09-12" "2016-12-12" "2017-03-12"
[31] "2017-06-12" "2017-09-12" "2017-12-12" "2018-03-12" "2018-06-12"
[36] "2018-09-12" "2018-12-12" "2019-03-12" "2019-06-12" "2019-09-12"
[41] "2019-12-12"
```

We will now create a sequence of dates but instead of specifying the unit of increment, we specify the number of dates in the sequence i.e. the length of the sequence. We do this using the `length.out` argument which specifies the desired length of the sequence. We want the sequence to have 10 dates including the start and end date, and hence we supply the value `10` for the `length.out` argument.

```
seq.Date(from = as.Date("2010-01-01"), to = as.Date("2019-12-31"), length.out = 10)
```

```
 [1] "2010-01-01" "2011-02-10" "2012-03-22" "2013-05-02" "2014-06-11"
 [6] "2015-07-22" "2016-08-31" "2017-10-10" "2018-11-20" "2019-12-31"
```

In all of the previous examples, we have specified both the start and the end date. Let us look at a few examples where we create a sequence of dates where we only specify the start date. In the below example, we want to create a sequence of dates starting from `2010-01-01`. The unit of increment should be 1 year i.e. the difference between the dates in the sequence should be 1 year and the length of the sequence should be `10` i.e. the number of dates including the start date should be `10`.

```
seq.Date(from = as.Date("2010-01-01"), by = "year", length.out = 10)
```

```
 [1] "2010-01-01" "2011-01-01" "2012-01-01" "2013-01-01" "2014-01-01"
 [6] "2015-01-01" "2016-01-01" "2017-01-01" "2018-01-01" "2019-01-01"
```

The unit of increment can include multiples and `+/-` sign i.e. it can be an unit of increment or decrement. In the next example, we can increment the dates in the sequence by `2` i.e. the difference between the dates should be `2` instead of `1`. This is achieved by specifying the unit of increment (multiple) first followed by a space and then the unit. In our example, it is `2 year`. As you can see, the sequence now goes all the way till `2028` and the gap between the dates is 2 years.

```
seq.Date(from = as.Date("2010-01-01"), by = "2 year", length.out = 10)
```

```
 [1] "2010-01-01" "2012-01-01" "2014-01-01" "2016-01-01" "2018-01-01"
 [6] "2020-01-01" "2022-01-01" "2024-01-01" "2026-01-01" "2028-01-01"
```

Let us say instead of increment we want to decrement the dates i.e. the sequence of dates will go backwards as shown in the next example. We achieve this by using the `-` sign along with the unit of decrement. The sequence of dates in next example starts from `2010` and goes back upto `1992` and the difference between the dates in 2 years.

```
seq.Date(from = as.Date("2010-01-01"), by = "-2 year", length.out = 10)
```

```
 [1] "2010-01-01" "2008-01-01" "2006-01-01" "2004-01-01" "2002-01-01"
 [6] "2000-01-01" "1998-01-01" "1996-01-01" "1994-01-01" "1992-01-01"
```

In the last example, we will explore the `along.with` argument. Here we have supplied a vector which is a sequence of numbers from 1 to 10. The length of this vector is 10 and the same length is used as the length of the sequence i.e. the length of value supplied to `along.with` is also the length of the sequence.

```
seq.Date(from = as.Date("2010-01-01"), by = "-2 year", along.with = 1:10)
```

```
 [1] "2010-01-01" "2008-01-01" "2006-01-01" "2004-01-01" "2002-01-01"
 [6] "2000-01-01" "1998-01-01" "1996-01-01" "1994-01-01" "1992-01-01"
```

10.7.4 Verify Type

How do you check if the data is a date-time object? You can do that using any of the following from the lubridate package.

- `is.Date()`
- `is.POSIXct()`
- `is.POSIXlt()`

```
is.Date(release_date)
```

```
[1] FALSE
```

```
is.POSIXct(release_date)
```

```
[1] TRUE
```

```
is.POSIXlt(release_date)
```

```
[1] FALSE
```

10.7.5 Your Turn

- R 2.0.0 was released on `2004-10-04 14:24:38`. Create this date using both `make_date()` and `make_datetime()`
- R 3.0.0 was released on `2013-04-03 07:12:36`. Update the date created in the previous step to the above using `update()`

Try it live

Try it in your browser

Edit the code below and press **Run**. It executes entirely in your browser via WebR — no R installation needed. The runtime downloads once, on this page only.

```
library(dplyr)
library(lubridate)
library(readr)
if (!file.exists("transact_sample.csv")) {
  download.file(
    "https://wrangle-r.rsquaredacademy.com/data-webr/transact_sample.csv",
    "transact_sample.csv"
  )
}
transact <- read_csv("transact_sample.csv", show_col_types = FALSE)
transact |>
  mutate(due_year = year(Due), due_month = month(Due, label = TRUE)) |>
  head()
```

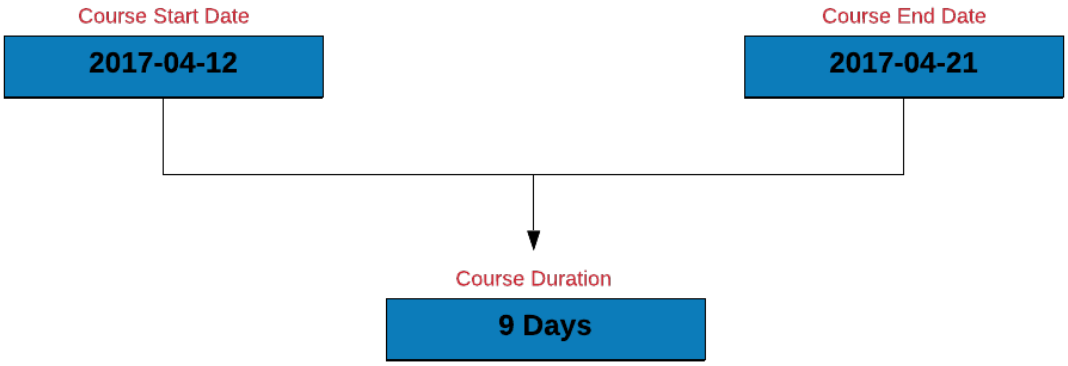
11 Date & Time: Arithmetic and Time Zones

This chapter continues @date-and-time-in-r. We do arithmetic with dates, compare durations, periods and intervals, handle time zones and DST, and round and roll back dates — including the receivables overdue case study.

11.1 Date Arithmetic

11.1.1 Introduction

Time to do some arithmetic with the dates. Let us calculate the length of a course you have enrolled for (Become a Rock Star Data Scientist in 10 Days) by subtracting the course start date from the course end date.

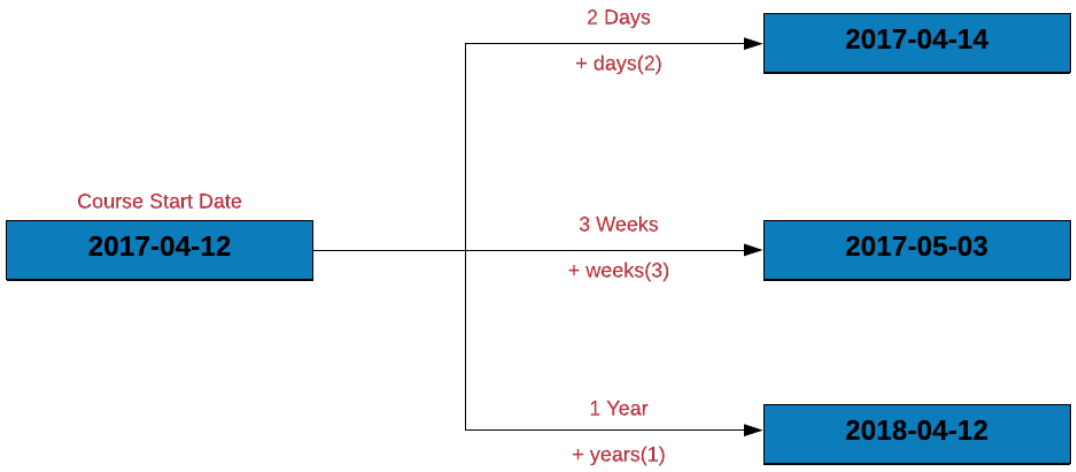



```
course_start    <- as_date('2017-04-12')
course_end      <- as_date('2017-04-21')
course_duration <- course_end - course_start
course_duration
## Time difference of 9 days
```

11.1.2 Shift Date

Time to shift the course dates. We can shift a date by days, weeks or months. Let us shift the course start date by:

- 2 days
- 3 weeks
- 1 year




```
course_start + days(2)
## [1] "2017-04-14"
course_start + weeks(3)
## [1] "2017-05-03"
course_start + years(1)
## [1] "2018-04-12"
```

11.1.3 Case Study

11.1.3.1 Compute days to settle invoice

Let us estimate the number of days to settle the invoice by subtracting the date of invoice from the date of payment.

```
transact |>
  mutate(
    days_to_pay = Payment - Invoice
  )
```

```
# A tibble: 2,466 x 4
   Invoice    Due        Payment    days_to_pay
   <date>     <date>     <date>     <drtn>
 1 2013-01-02 2013-02-01 2013-01-15 13 days
 2 2013-01-26 2013-02-25 2013-03-03 36 days
 3 2013-07-03 2013-08-02 2013-07-08  5 days
 4 2013-02-10 2013-03-12 2013-03-17 35 days
 5 2012-10-25 2012-11-24 2012-11-28 34 days
 6 2012-01-27 2012-02-26 2012-02-22 26 days
 7 2013-08-13 2013-09-12 2013-09-09 27 days
 8 2012-12-16 2013-01-15 2013-01-12 27 days
 9 2012-05-14 2012-06-13 2012-07-01 48 days
10 2013-07-01 2013-07-31 2013-07-26 25 days
# i 2,456 more rows
```

11.1.3.2 Compute days over due

How many of the invoices were settled post the due date? We can find this by:

- subtracting the due date from the payment date
- counting the number of rows where delay < 0

```
transact |>
  mutate(
    delay = Due - Payment
  ) |>
  filter(delay < 0) |>
  mutate(
    delay = delay * -1
  ) |>
  count(delay)
```

```
# A tibble: 36 x 2
   delay       n
   <drtn>  <int>
 1  1 days    61
 2  2 days    65
 3  3 days    51
 4  4 days    62
 5  5 days    69
 6  6 days    56
 7  7 days    55
 8  8 days    49
 9  9 days    38
10 10 days    33
```

```
# i 26 more rows
```

11.1.4 Your Turn

- compute the length of a vacation which begins on `2020-04-19` and ends on `2020-04-25`
- recompute the length of the vacation after shifting the vacation start and end date by `10` days and `2` weeks
- compute the days to settle invoice and days overdue from the `receivables.csv` data set
- compute the length of employment (only for those employees who have been terminated) from the `hr-data.csv` data set (use date of hire and termination)

11.2 Time Zones

11.2.1 Introduction



In the previous section, `POSIXlt` stored date/time components as a list. Among the different components it returned were

- `gmtoff`
- `zone`

`gmtoff` is offset in seconds from GMT i.e. difference in hours and minutes from UTC. Wait.. What do UTC and GMT stand for?

- Coordinated Universal Time (UTC)
- Greenwich Meridian Time (GMT)

Since we are talking about UTC, GMT etc., let us spend a little time on understanding the basics of time zones and daylight savings.

11.2.2 Time Zones

Timezones exist because different parts of the Earth receive sun light at different times. If there was a single timezone, noon or morning would mean different things in different parts of the world. The timezones are based on Earth's rotation. The Earth moves ~15 degrees every 60 minutes i.e. 360 degrees in 24 hours. The planet is divided into 24 timezones each 15 degrees of longitude width.

Now, you have heard of Greenwich Meridian Time (GMT) right? We just saw GMT off set in `POSIXlt` and you would have come across it in other time formats as well. For example, India timezone is given as GMT +5:30. Let us explore GMT in a little more detail. Greenwich is a suburb of London and the time at Greenwich is **G**reenwich **M**ean **T**ime. As you move West from Greenwich, every 15 degree section is one hour earlier than GMT and every 15 degree section to the East is an hour later.

Alright! What is **UTC** then? **C**oordinated **U**niversal **T**ime (UTC) , on the other hand, is the time standard commonly used across the world. Even though they share the same current time, **GMT** is a **timezone** while **UTC** is a **time standard**.

So how do we check the timezone in R? When you run `Sys.timezone()`, you should be able to see the timezone you are in.

```
Sys.timezone()
```

```
[1] "UTC"
```

If you do not see the timezone, use `Sys.getenv()` to get the value of the **TZ** environment variable.

```
Sys.getenv("TZ")
```

```
[1] "UTC"
```

If nothing is returned, it means we have to set the timezone. Use `Sys.setenv()` to set the timezone as shown below. The author resides in India and hence the timezone is set to `Asia/Calcutta`. You need to set the timezone in which you reside or work.

```
Sys.setenv(TZ = "Asia/Calcutta")
```

Another way to get the timezone is through `tz()` from the lubridate package.

```
lubridate::tz(Sys.time())
```

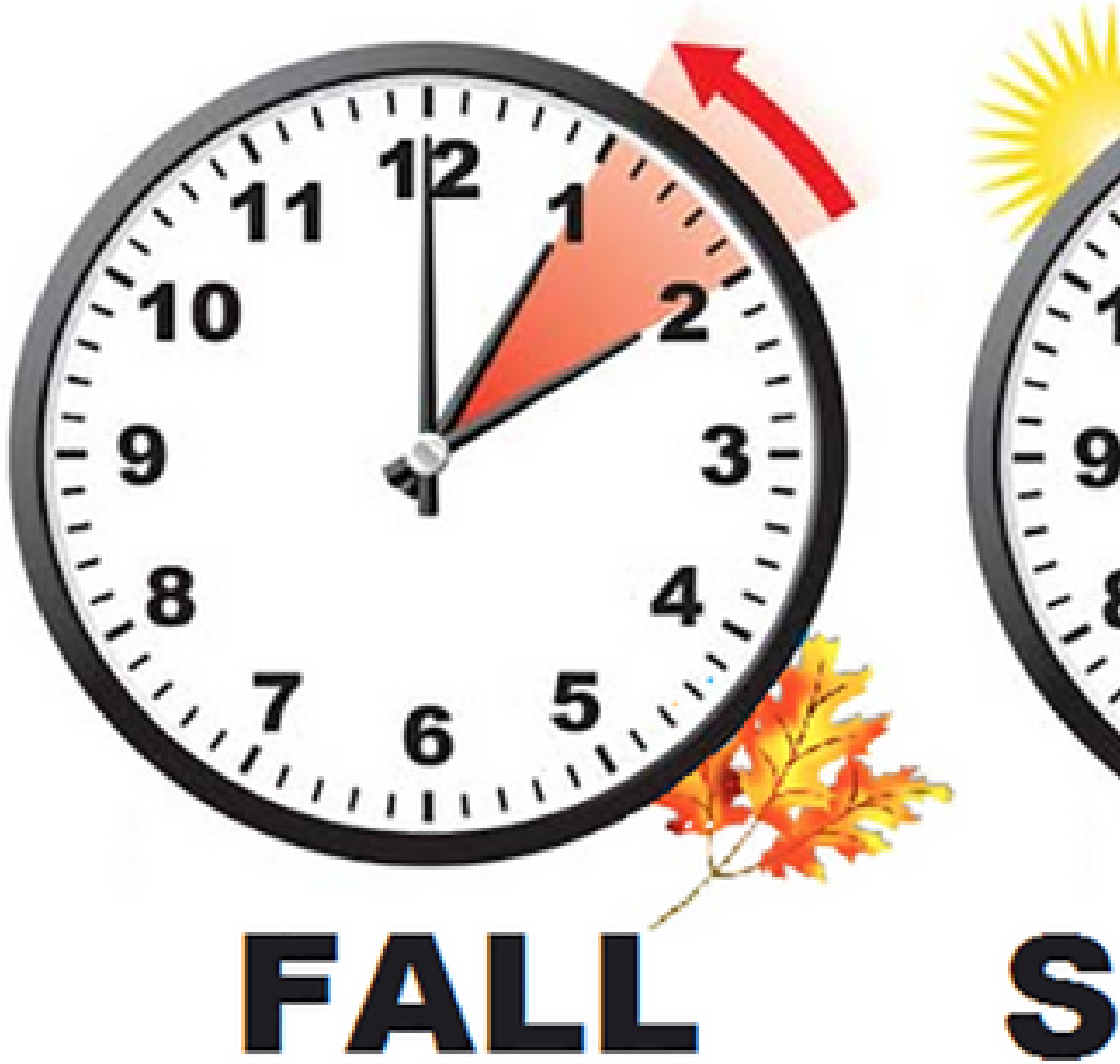
```
[1] ""
```

If you want to view the time in a different timezone, use `with_tz()`. Let us look at the current time in **UTC** instead of **Indian Standard Time**.

```
lubridate::with_tz(Sys.time(), "UTC")
```

```
[1] "2026-11-01 11:35:23 UTC"
```

11.2.3 Daylight Savings



Daylight savings also known as

- daylight saving time

- daylight savings time
- daylight time
- summer time

is the practice of advancing clocks during summer months so that darkness falls later each day according to the clock. In other words

- advance clock by one hour in spring (spring forward)
- retard clocks by one hour in autumn (fall back)

In R, the `dst()` function is an indicator for daylight savings. It returns `TRUE` if daylight saving is in force, `FALSE` if not and `NA` if unknown.

```
dst(Sys.Date())
```

```
[1] FALSE
```

11.2.4 Your Turn

- check the timezone you live in
- check if daylight savings in on
- check the current time in **UTC** or a different time zone

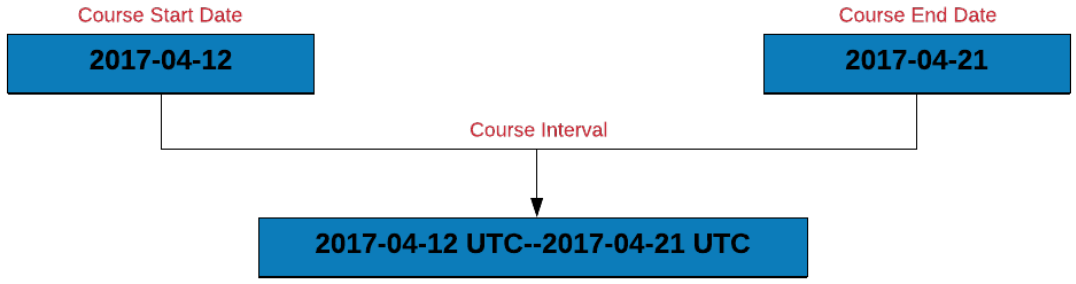
11.3 Intervals, Duration & Period

In this chapter, we will learn about

- intervals
- duration
- and period

11.3.1 Interval

An interval is a timespan defined by two date-times. Let us represent the length of the course using `interval`.




```
course_start    <- as_date('2017-04-12')
course_end      <- as_date('2017-04-21')
interval(course_start, course_end)
```

```
[1] 2017-04-12 UTC--2017-04-21 UTC
```

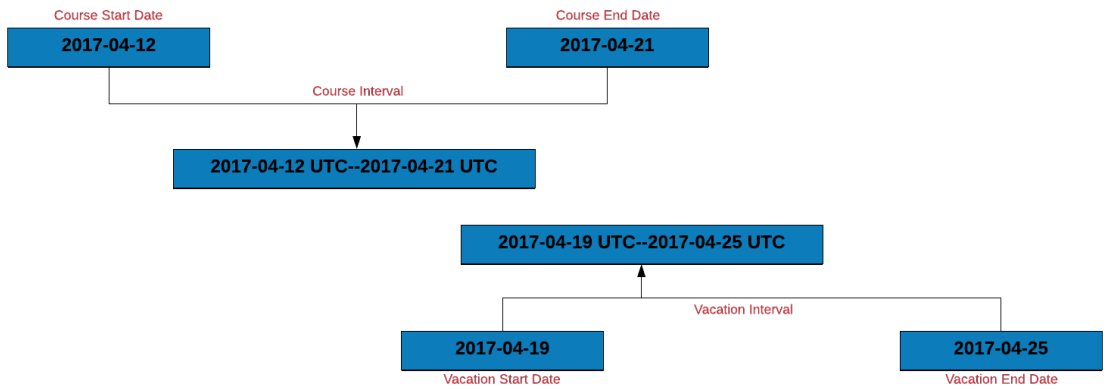
If you observe carefully, the interval is represented by the course start and end dates. We will learn how to use intervals in the case study.

11.3.1.1 Overlapping Intervals

Let us say you are planning a vacation and want to check if the vacation dates overlap with the course dates. You can do this by:

- creating vacation and course intervals
- use `int_overlaps()` to check if two intervals overlap. It returns `TRUE` if the intervals overlap else `FALSE`.

Let us use the vacation start and end dates to create `vacation_interval` and then check if it overlaps with `course_interval`.



```
vacation_start    <- as_date('2017-04-19')
vacation_end      <- as_date('2017-04-25')
course_interval   <- interval(course_start, course_end)
vacation_interval <- interval(vacation_start, vacation_end)
int_overlaps(course_interval, vacation_interval)
## [1] TRUE
```

11.3.1.2 How many invoices were settled within due date?

Let us use intervals to count the number of invoices that were settled within the due date. To do this, we will:

- create an interval for the invoice and due date
- create a new column `due_next` by incrementing the due date by 1 day
- another interval for `due_next` and the payment date
- if the intervals overlap, the payment was made within the due date

```
transact |>
  mutate(
    inv_due_interval = interval(Invoice, Due),
    due_next         = Due + days(1),
    due_pay_interval = interval(due_next, Payment),
    overlaps         = int_overlaps(inv_due_interval, due_pay_interval)
  ) |>
  select(Invoice, Due, Payment, overlaps)
```

```
# A tibble: 2,466 x 4
   Invoice    Due        Payment    overlaps
   <date>     <date>     <date>     <lgl>
 1 2013-01-02 2013-02-01 2013-01-15 TRUE
 2 2013-01-26 2013-02-25 2013-03-03 FALSE
 3 2013-07-03 2013-08-02 2013-07-08 TRUE
 4 2013-02-10 2013-03-12 2013-03-17 FALSE
 5 2012-10-25 2012-11-24 2012-11-28 FALSE
 6 2012-01-27 2012-02-26 2012-02-22 TRUE
 7 2013-08-13 2013-09-12 2013-09-09 TRUE
 8 2012-12-16 2013-01-15 2013-01-12 TRUE
 9 2012-05-14 2012-06-13 2012-07-01 FALSE
10 2013-07-01 2013-07-31 2013-07-26 TRUE
# i 2,456 more rows
```

Below we show another method to count the number of invoices paid within the due date. Instead of using `days` to change the due date, we use `int_shift` to shift it by 1 day.

```
transact |>
  mutate(
    inv_due_interval = interval(Invoice, Due),
    due_pay_interval = interval(Due, Payment),
    due_pay_next     = int_shift(due_pay_interval, by = days(1)),
    overlaps         = int_overlaps(inv_due_interval, due_pay_next)
  ) |>
  select(Invoice, Due, Payment, overlaps)
```

```
# A tibble: 2,466 x 4
   Invoice    Due        Payment    overlaps
   <date>     <date>     <date>     <lgl>
 1 2013-01-02 2013-02-01 2013-01-15 TRUE
 2 2013-01-26 2013-02-25 2013-03-03 FALSE
 3 2013-07-03 2013-08-02 2013-07-08 TRUE
 4 2013-02-10 2013-03-12 2013-03-17 FALSE
 5 2012-10-25 2012-11-24 2012-11-28 FALSE
 6 2012-01-27 2012-02-26 2012-02-22 TRUE
 7 2013-08-13 2013-09-12 2013-09-09 TRUE
 8 2012-12-16 2013-01-15 2013-01-12 TRUE
 9 2012-05-14 2012-06-13 2012-07-01 FALSE
10 2013-07-01 2013-07-31 2013-07-26 TRUE
# i 2,456 more rows
```

You might be thinking why we incremented the due date by a day before creating the interval between the due day and the payment day. If we do not increment, both the intervals will share a common date i.e. the due date and they will always overlap as shown below:

```
transact |>
  mutate(
    inv_due_interval = interval(Invoice, Due),
    due_pay_interval = interval(Due, Payment),
    overlaps         = int_overlaps(inv_due_interval, due_pay_interval)
  ) |>
  select(Invoice, Due, Payment, overlaps)
```

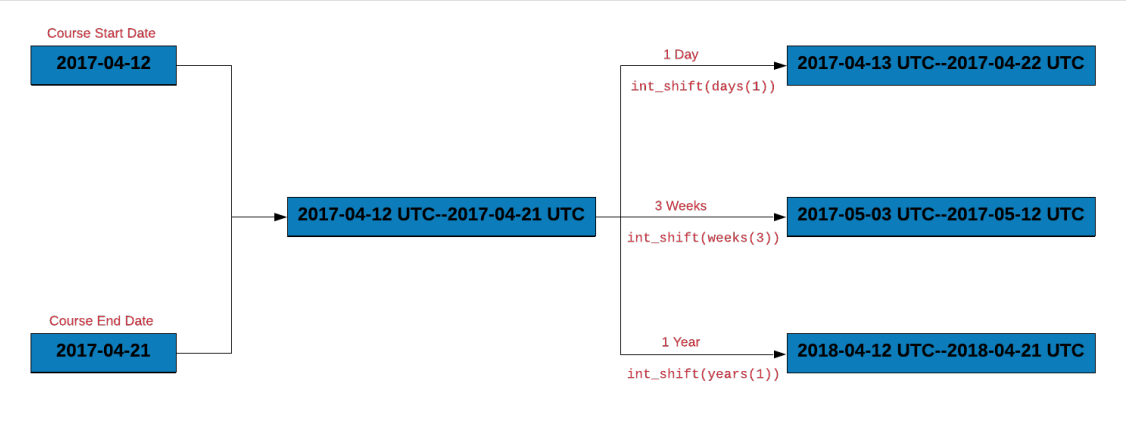
```
# A tibble: 2,466 x 4
   Invoice    Due        Payment    overlaps
   <date>     <date>     <date>     <lgl>
 1 2013-01-02 2013-02-01 2013-01-15 TRUE
 2 2013-01-26 2013-02-25 2013-03-03 TRUE
 3 2013-07-03 2013-08-02 2013-07-08 TRUE
 4 2013-02-10 2013-03-12 2013-03-17 TRUE
 5 2012-10-25 2012-11-24 2012-11-28 TRUE
```

```
 6 2012-01-27 2012-02-26 2012-02-22 TRUE
 7 2013-08-13 2013-09-12 2013-09-09 TRUE
 8 2012-12-16 2013-01-15 2013-01-12 TRUE
 9 2012-05-14 2012-06-13 2012-07-01 TRUE
10 2013-07-01 2013-07-31 2013-07-26 TRUE
# i 2,456 more rows
```

11.3.1.3 Shift Interval

Intervals can be shifted too. In the below example, we shift the course interval by:

- 1 day
- 3 weeks
- 1 year




```
course_interval <- interval(course_start, course_end)

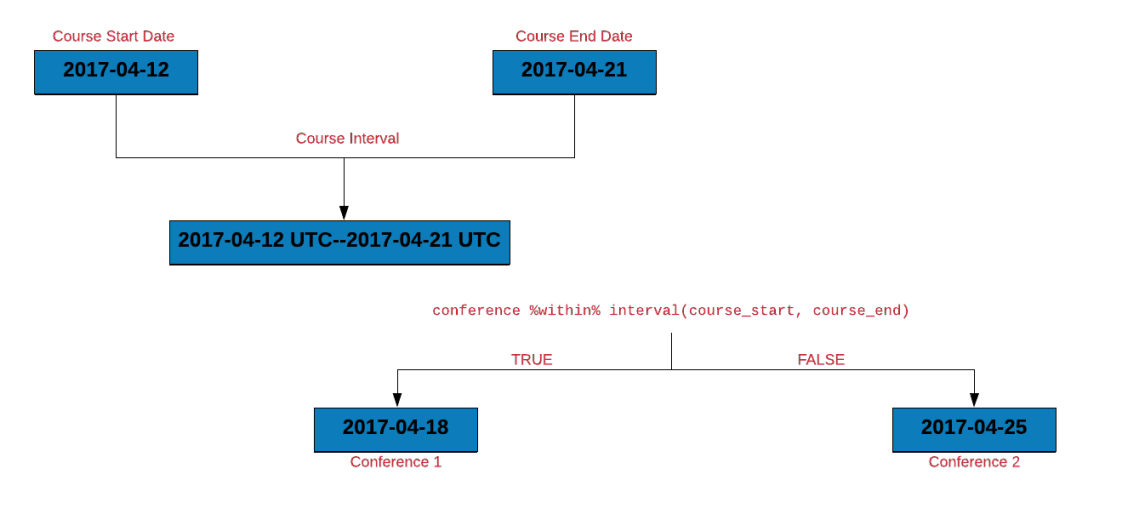
# shift course_interval by 1 day
int_shift(course_interval, by = days(1))
## [1] 2017-04-13 UTC--2017-04-22 UTC

# shift course_interval by 3 weeks
int_shift(course_interval, by = weeks(3))
## [1] 2017-05-03 UTC--2017-05-12 UTC

# shift course_interval by 1 year
int_shift(course_interval, by = years(1))
## [1] 2018-04-12 UTC--2018-04-21 UTC
```

11.3.2 Within

Let us assume that we have to attend a conference in April 2017. Does it occur during the course duration? We can answer this using `%within%` which will return `TRUE` if a date falls within an interval.




```
conference <- as_date('2017-04-15')
conference %within% course_interval
## [1] TRUE
```

11.3.2.1 How many invoices were settled within due date?

Let us use `%within%` to count the number of invoices that were settled within the due date. We will do this by:

- creating an interval for the invoice and due date
- check if the payment date falls within the above interval

```
transact |>
  mutate(
    inv_due_interval = interval(Invoice, Due),
    overlaps         = Payment %within% inv_due_interval
  ) |>
  select(Due, Payment, overlaps)
```

```
# A tibble: 2,466 x 3
   Due        Payment    overlaps
   <date>     <date>     <lgl>
```

```
 1 2013-02-01 2013-01-15 TRUE
 2 2013-02-25 2013-03-03 FALSE
 3 2013-08-02 2013-07-08 TRUE
 4 2013-03-12 2013-03-17 FALSE
 5 2012-11-24 2012-11-28 FALSE
 6 2012-02-26 2012-02-22 TRUE
 7 2013-09-12 2013-09-09 TRUE
 8 2013-01-15 2013-01-12 TRUE
 9 2012-06-13 2012-07-01 FALSE
10 2013-07-31 2013-07-26 TRUE
# i 2,456 more rows
```

11.3.3 Duration

Duration is timespan measured in seconds. To create a duration object, use `duration()`. The timespan can be anything from seconds to years but it will be represented as seconds. Let us begin by creating a duration object where the timespan is in seconds.

```
duration(50, "seconds")
```

```
[1] "50s"
```

Another way to specify the above timespan is shown below:

```
duration(second = 50)
```

```
[1] "50s"
```

As you can see, the output is same in both the cases. Let us increase the timespan to 60 seconds and see what happens.

```
duration(second = 60)
```

```
[1] "60s (~1 minutes)"
```

Although the timespan is primarily measured in seconds, it also shows `~1 minutes` in the brackets. As the length of the timespan increases i.e. the number becomes large, it is represented using larger units such as hours and days. In the below examples, as the number of seconds increases, you can observe larger units being used to represent the timespan.

```r
# minutes
duration(minute = 50)
```

```
[1] "3000s (~50 minutes)"
```

```r
duration(minute = 60)
```

```
[1] "3600s (~1 hours)"
```

```r
# hours
duration(hour = 23)
```

```
[1] "82800s (~23 hours)"
```

```r
duration(hour = 24)
```

```
[1] "86400s (~1 days)"
```

The following helper functions can be used to create duration objects as well.

```r
# default
dseconds()
```

```
[1] "1s"
```

```r
dminutes()
```

```
[1] "60s (~1 minutes)"
```

```r
# seconds
duration(second = 59)
```

```
[1] "59s"
```

```r
dseconds(59)
```

```
[1] "59s"
```

```
# minutes
duration(minute = 50)
```

```
[1] "3000s (~50 minutes)"
```

```
dminutes(50)
```

```
[1] "3000s (~50 minutes)"
```

```
# hours
duration(hour = 36)
```

```
[1] "129600s (~1.5 days)"
```

```
dhours(36)
```

```
[1] "129600s (~1.5 days)"
```

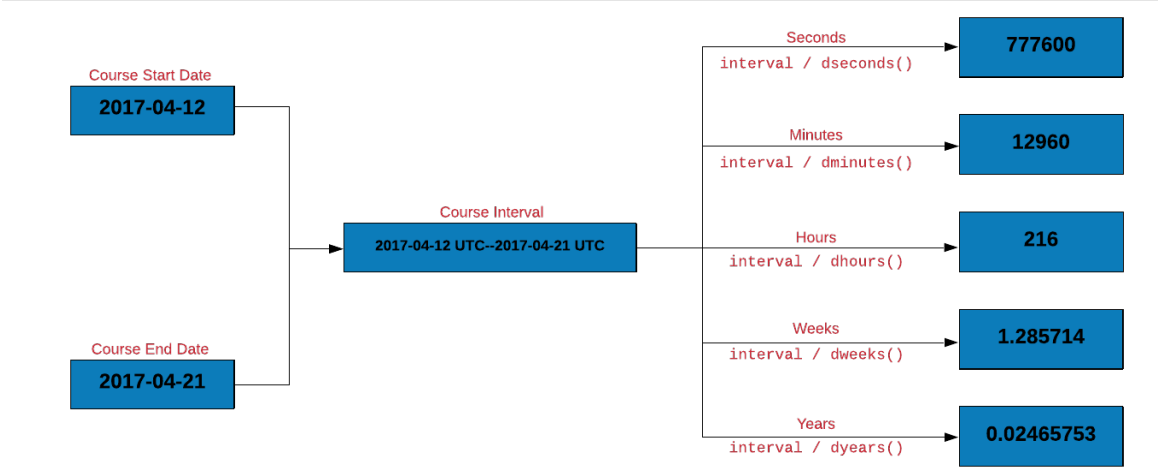
```
# weeks
duration(week = 56)
```

```
[1] "33868800s (~1.07 years)"
```

```
dweeks(56)
```

```
[1] "33868800s (~1.07 years)"
```

Let us use the above helper functions to get the course length in different units.



```r
# course length in seconds
course_interval / dseconds()
## [1] 777600

# course length in minutes
course_interval / dminutes()
## [1] 12960

# course length in hours
course_interval / dhours()
## [1] 216

# course length in weeks
course_interval / dweeks()
## [1] 1.285714

# course length in years
course_interval / dyears()
## [1] 0.02464066
```

11.3.4 Period

A `period` is a timespan defined in units such as years, months, and days. In the below examples, we use `period()` to represent timespan using different units.

```r
# second
period(5, "second")
```

```
[1] "5S"
```

```r
period(second = 5)
```

```
[1] "5S"
```

```r
# minute & second
period(c(3, 5), c("minute", "second"))
```

```
[1] "3M 5S"
```

```r
period(minute = 3, second = 5)
```

```
[1] "3M 5S"
```

```
# hour, minte & second
period(c(1, 3, 5), c("hour", "minute", "second"))
```

```
[1] "1H 3M 5S"
```

```
period(hour = 1, minute = 3, second = 5)
```

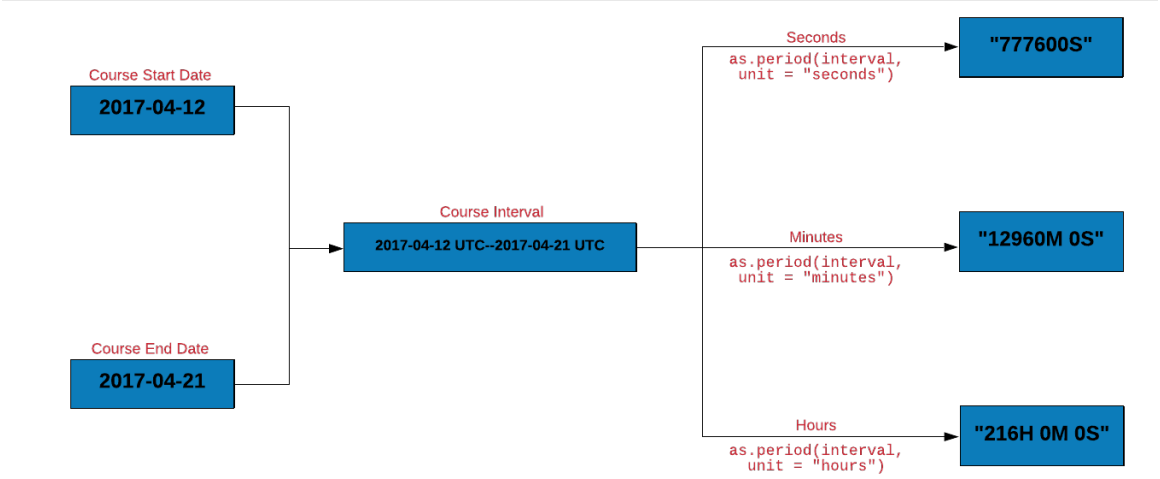
```
[1] "1H 3M 5S"
```

```
# day, hour, minute & second
period(c(3, 1, 3, 5), c("day", "hour", "minute", "second"))
```

```
[1] "3d 1H 3M 5S"
```

```
period(day = 3, hour = 1, minute = 3, second = 5)
```

```
[1] "3d 1H 3M 5S"
```



Let us get the course length in different units using `as.period()`.

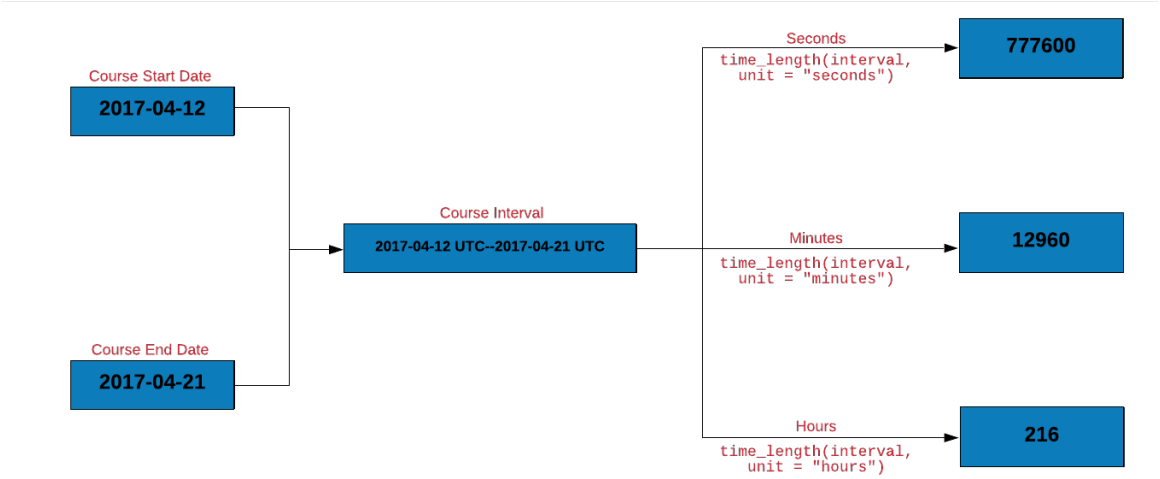
```
# course length in second
as.period(course_interval, unit = "seconds")
## [1] "777600S"

# course length in hours and minutes
```

```
as.period(course_interval, unit = "minutes")
## [1] "12960M 0S"

# course length in hours, minutes and seconds
as.period(course_interval, unit = "hours")
## [1] "216H 0M 0S"
```

`time_length()` computes the exact length of a timespan i.e. `duration`, `interval` or `period`. Let us use `time_length()` to compute the length of the course in different units.




```
# course length in seconds
time_length(course_interval, unit = "seconds")
## [1] 777600

# course length in minutes
time_length(course_interval, unit = "minutes")
## [1] 12960

# course length in hours
time_length(course_interval, unit = "hours")
## [1] 216
```

11.3.5 lubridate interval vs duration vs period

The three timespans answer different questions:

Timespan	Answers	Clock behavior
`interval` (`%--%`)	When did it start and end?	Anchored to two endpoints
`duration` (`ddays()`, `dyears()`)	How many exact seconds?	Fixed 86,400 s/day, DST-blind
`period` (`days()`, `years()`)	How does the clock read?	Calendar-aware, follows DST

The difference bites across daylight-saving boundaries. US clocks sprang forward on 2020-03-08, so that Sunday lasted 23 hours:

```
t <- ymd_hms("2020-03-07 12:00:00", tz = "America/New_York")

# period: same wall-clock time next day (noon stays noon)
t + days(1)
```

```
[1] "2020-03-08 12:00:00 EDT"
```

```
# duration: exactly 86,400 seconds later (lands at 1pm)
t + ddays(1)
```

```
[1] "2020-03-08 13:00:00 EDT"
```

Rule of thumb: scheduling and human arithmetic (invoice due in 30 days, `days_to_pay` in `transact`) → `period`; elapsed-time measurement and benchmarks → `duration`; anchoring and testing overlap (`%within%`, `int_overlaps()`) → `interval`.

11.4 Others

In this section, we will learn to round date/time to the nearest unit and roll back dates.

11.4.1 Rounding Dates

We will explore functions for rounding dates

- to the nearest value using `round_dates()`
- down using `floor_date()`
- up using `ceiling_date()`

The unit for rounding can be any of the following:

- second
- minute

- hour
- day
- week
- month
- bimonth
- quarter
- season
- halfyear
- and year

We will look at a few examples using `round_date()` and you will then practice using the other two functions.

```
# minute
round_date(release_date, unit = "minute")
```

```
[1] "2019-12-12 08:05:00 UTC"
```

```
round_date(release_date, unit = "mins")
```

```
[1] "2019-12-12 08:05:00 UTC"
```

```
round_date(release_date, unit = "5 mins")
```

```
[1] "2019-12-12 08:05:00 UTC"
```

```
# hour
round_date(release_date, unit = "hour")
```

```
[1] "2019-12-12 08:00:00 UTC"
```

```
# day
round_date(release_date, unit = "day")
```

```
[1] "2019-12-12 UTC"
```

11.4.2 Rollback

Use `rollback()` if you want to change the date to the last day of the previous month or the first day of the month.

```
rollback(release_date)
```

```
[1] "2019-11-30 08:05:03 UTC"
```

To change the date to the first day of the month, use the `roll_to_first` argument and set it to `TRUE`.

```
rollback(release_date, roll_to_first = TRUE)
```

```
[1] "2019-12-01 08:05:03 UTC"
```

11.4.3 Your Turn

- round up the `transact` due dates to weeks
- round down the `transact` due dates to days
- rollback the `transact` due dates to the beginning of the month

Try it live

> Try it in your browser
>
> Edit the code below and press **Run**. It executes entirely in your browser via WebR — no R installation needed. The runtime downloads once, on this page only.

```
library(dplyr)
library(lubridate)
library(readr)
if (!file.exists("transact_sample.csv")) {
  download.file(
    "https://wrangle-r.rsquaredacademy.com/data-webr/transact_sample.csv",
    "transact_sample.csv"
  )
}
transact <- read_csv("transact_sample.csv", show_col_types = FALSE)
transact |>
  mutate(days_to_pay = Payment - Invoice) |>
  select(Invoice, Due, Payment, days_to_pay) |>
  head()
```

12 Categorical Data Fundamentals

> **Continued in part B**
>
> This chapter was split for readability. Reordering, recoding, lumping and visualization continue in @forcats-manipulation.

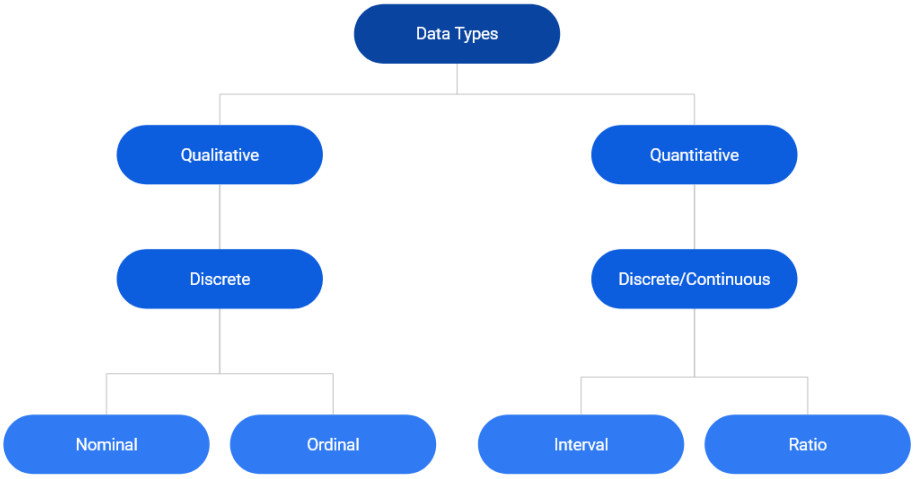
This chapter is the first of two on categorical data. Here we cover what factors are, how R stores them, frequency tabulation and base R pitfalls. @forcats-manipulation continues with reordering, recoding, lumping and ggplot2 visualization.

12.1 Introduction

Handling categorical/qualitative data is integral to data analysis. Almost every data science project involves working with categorical data and students should know how to store, summarize, visualize & manipulate such data. Working with categorical data is different from working with numbers or text. In this chapter, we will understand categorical data and explore the rich set of functions (built-in & through packages) provided by R for working with such data. The word categorical is used interchangeably with qualitative.

12.1.1 Data Types

Before we begin our deep dive on categorical data, let us get a quick overview of different data types.



In the chart above, we can see that data can be primarily classified into **qualitative** or **quantitative**. Qualitative data consists of labels or names. Quantitative data, on the other hand, consists of numbers and indicate how much or how many. This brings us to the next level of classification:

- discrete
- continuous

In the chart, we can observe that qualitative data is always **discrete** where as quantitative data may be **discrete** or **continuous**. Qualitative data is further classified into

- nominal
- ordinal

First, we will understand discrete and continuous data, and then proceed to explore nominal and ordinal data.

Discrete Data



Discrete data arises in situations where counting is involved. It can take on only a finite number of values and cannot be divided into smaller parts. For example, let us consider the number of students in a class. We can have 5 0r 10 students but not 5.5 students (we can't have half a student).

Continuous Data



Continuous data arises in situations where measuring is involved. It can take any numeric value in a specified range and can be divided into smaller parts and still have meaning. Examples include money, temperature, length, volume etc.

12.1.2 Categorical Data

Since our interest is in categorical data, we will spend more time understanding the different types of categorical data through various examples. Let us begin by formally defining categorical data:

- it is always discrete
- it may be divided into groups
- consists of names or labels
- takes on limited & fixed number of possible values
- arises in situation when counting is involved
- analysis generally involves the use of data tables

12.1.3 Dichotomous

A categorical variable that can take on exactly two values is termed as **binary** or **dichotomous** variable.



12.1.4 Polychotomous

Categorical variables with more than two possible values are called **polychotomous** variables.



12.1.5 Ordinal



In ordinal data, the categories can be ordered or ranked. Examples include

- socio-economic status
- education level
- income level
- satisfaction rating

While we can rank the categories, we cannot assign a value to them. For example, in satisfaction ranking, we cannot say that like is twice as positive as dislike i.e. we are unable to say how much they differ from each other. While the order or rank of data is meaningful, the difference between two pieces of data cannot be measured/determined or are meaningless. Ordinal data provide information about relative comparisons, but not the magnitude of the differences.

12.1.6 Nominal



Nominal data do not have an intrinsic order and cannot be ordered or measured. Examples include

- blood group
- gender
- religion
- color

Categorical data are sometimes coded with numbers, with those numbers replacing names. Although such numbers might appear to be quantitative, they are actually categorical data. When they do take numerical values, those numbers do not have any mathematical meaning. Examples include months expressed in numbers.

12.1.7 Summary

- Data can be qualitative or quantitative.
- Qualitative data is always discrete.
- Dichotomous data consists of only 2 groups/levels.
- Polychotomous data consists of more than 2 groups/levels.
- Nominal data do not have an intrinsic order.
- In ordinal data
  - categories can be ordered or ranked
  - the difference between the categories cannot be determined

12.1.8 Your Turn

1. State whether the following are quantitative or qualitative

- Age
- Gender
- Annual Sales
- Weight
- Education Level
- Vehicle Type
- Height
- Ice Cream Flavor
- Job/Work Experience
- Blood Group
- Color
- Mode of Payment

2. State whether the following are dichotomous or polychotomous

- Heads / Tails
- Blood Group

- Transportation Mode
- Rich / Poor
- Democrat / Republican
- Education Level
- Gender
- Pass / Fail
- Yes / No
- Positive / Negative

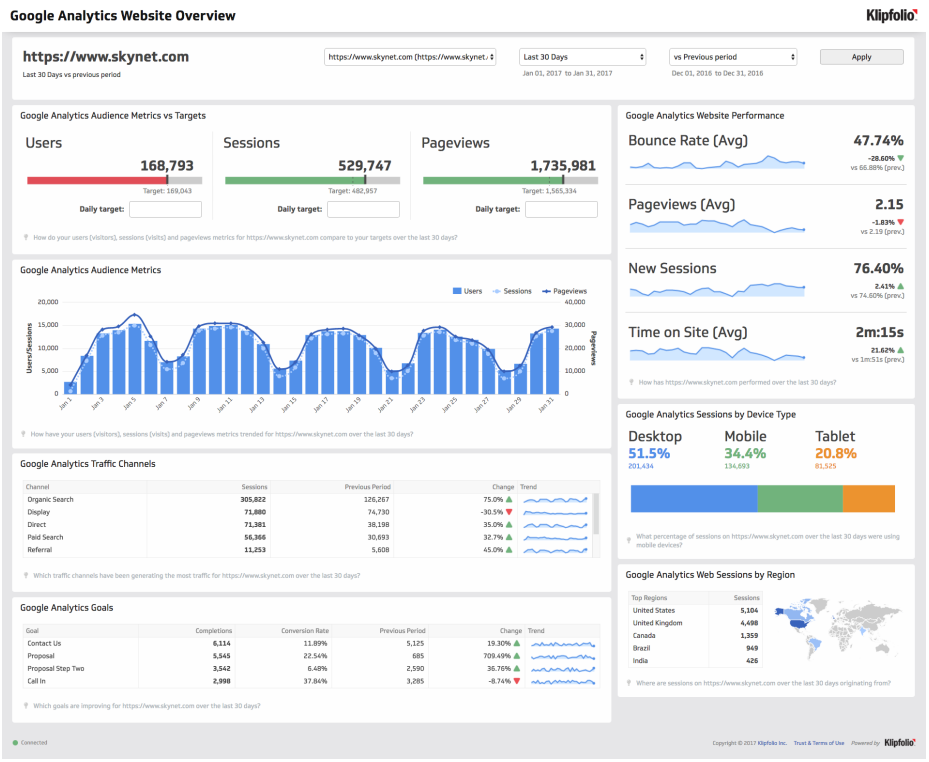
3. State whether the following are nominal or ordinal

- STD Codes
- Prepaid / Postpaid
- Hotel Ratings
- Smart Phone Brands
- Student Grades
- Cellular Operator
- ISPs (Internet Service Providers)
- Occupation
- Bank Account Number
- Class of Travel
- Military Rank

12.2 Case Study

As is the practice, throughout this chapter, we will work on a case study related to an e-commerce firm. As most of you would already be aware, a lot of data is captured when you go on the internet by the websites you browse as well as by third party cookies. Data collected is then used to display ads as well as to feed to recommendation algorithms.

The data used in the case study represents the basic information that is captured when users visit any website. It closely resembles real world data for an e-commerce store. We will try to generate insights about the visitors to be used by an imaginary marketing team for better targeting and promotion. The case study data set can be imported using the RStudio IDE or R code.



12.2.1 Data

The data set is available in both **CSV** & **RDS** formats.

CSV

If you want to specify the data types while reading the data, use the readr package. We have explored how to import data into R in a previous chapter. We will read a subset of columns from the data set (it has 20 columns) which will cover both nominal and ordinal data types. To import the data, we will use the `read_csv()` function. The first input is the name of the data set, `analytics.csv`. Ensure that the name is enclosed in single/double quotes.

```
read_csv("analytics_raw.csv",
         col_types = cols_only(device = col_factor(levels = c("Desktop", "Tablet", "Mobile
                               gender = col_factor(levels = c("female", "male", "NA")),
                               user_rating = col_factor(levels = c("1", "2", "3", "4", "5"
                                                                   ordered = TRUE)))
```

```
# A tibble: 244,398 x 3
   device  gender user_rating
   <fct>   <fct>  <ord>
 1 Desktop female 4
 2 Mobile  NA     5
```

```
 3 Desktop NA     4
 4 Desktop NA     5
 5 Desktop NA     4
 6 Mobile  NA     4
 7 Desktop NA     4
 8 Desktop NA     4
 9 Desktop female 5
10 Desktop NA     4
# i 244,388 more rows
```

Since we are specifying the column data types while importing the data, we will use the `col_types` argument to list out the data types. As we are reading in a subset of the columns and not all of them, we will use the `cols_only()` function indicating that only the columns specified must be read in and not all of them.

Categorical data and the levels/groups are specified using the `col_factor()` function. Use the `levels` argument to specify the levels/groups and the `ordered` argument to indicate if the data is ordinal. By default, it is set to `FALSE`, change this to `TRUE` if the column is ordinal.

RDS

The `.rds` file can be read using `readRDS()`.

```
data <- readRDS('analytics.rds')
head(data)
```

```
# A tibble: 6 x 19
  device  os       browser user_type channel gender frequency recency page_depth
  <fct>   <fct>    <fct>   <fct>     <fct>   <fct>      <dbl>   <dbl>      <dbl>
1 Desktop Windows  Chrome  New Visi~ Organi~ female         1       0          1
2 Mobile  iOS      Safari  Returnin~ Organi~ <NA>           3       1          1
3 Desktop Chrome ~ Chrome  New Visi~ Direct  <NA>           1       0          5
4 Desktop Macinto~ Chrome  Returnin~ Organi~ <NA>           2       0          1
5 Desktop Macinto~ Chrome  Returnin~ Referr~ <NA>           5       8          1
6 Mobile  Android  Chrome  New Visi~ Organi~ <NA>           1       0          5
# i 10 more variables: hour_of_day <chr>, age <dbl>, duration <dbl>,
#   landing_page <fct>, exit_page <fct>, country <fct>, quantity <dbl>,
#   revenue <dbl>, purchase_flag <lgl>, user_rating <dbl>
```

12.2.2 Data Dictionary

Column	Description
device	Device used to browse the website

os	Operating system of the device
browser	Browser used to visit the website
user_type	New or returning visitor
channel	Source of traffic
gender	Gender of the visitor
frequency	Count of visits to the website
recency	Number of days since last visit
page_depth	Number of website pages browsed
hour_of_day	Hour of day
age	Age of the visitor
duration	Time spent on the website (in seconds)
landing_page	Page on which visitor landed
exit_page	Page on which visitor exited
country	Country of origin
city	City of the visitor
quantity	Number of units purchased
revenue	Total revenue
purchase_flag	Whether the visitor checked out?
user_rating	Website UI rating given by visitor

12.3 Factors

In this very important section, we will learn how R

- stores categorical data
- checks if given data is categorical
- converts other data types to factor
- handles missing values in categorical data
- specifies the orders of the categories/levels
- stores ordinal data

12.3.1 Introduction

In R, categorical data is stored as `factor`. Before we explore the `factor` family of functions, let us generate the sample data we will use in this module. We will generate the `device` column from the case study data set using the `sample()` function. We provide the following inputs to generate the data:

- values from which the data must be generated
- the size of the sample
- indicate if the values must be repeated (TRUE/FALSE)

```r
device <- sample(c("Desktop", "Mobile", "Tablet"), size = 25, replace = TRUE)
device
```

```
 [1] "Desktop" "Desktop" "Tablet"  "Mobile"  "Desktop" "Tablet"  "Tablet"
 [8] "Desktop" "Mobile"  "Mobile"  "Mobile"  "Tablet"  "Mobile"  "Mobile"
[15] "Mobile"  "Mobile"  "Mobile"  "Mobile"  "Tablet"  "Tablet"  "Mobile"
[22] "Desktop" "Desktop" "Mobile"  "Mobile"
```

12.3.2 Membership Testing

Great! We have successfully generated the sample data and along the way learnt a new R function for sampling. First, let us check if the sample is a `factor` using the membership function `is.factor()`.

```r
is.factor(device)
```

```
[1] FALSE
```

Membership testing functions always have the prefix `is_` and return only logical values. If the object is a member of the specified class, they return `TRUE` else `FALSE`. Since our sample data is not stored as a factor, R has returned `FALSE`.

12.3.3 Coercion

Let us try to coerce it into `factor` using the coercion function `as.factor()`.

```r
as.factor(device)
```

```
 [1] Desktop Desktop Tablet  Mobile  Desktop Tablet  Tablet  Desktop Mobile
[10] Mobile  Mobile  Tablet  Mobile  Mobile  Mobile  Mobile  Mobile  Mobile
[19] Tablet  Tablet  Mobile  Desktop Desktop Mobile  Mobile
Levels: Desktop Mobile Tablet
```

Do you spot any difference in the output? In the last line, it displays the levels or categories of the variable. Don't worry if you didn't spot it. We are just getting started and you will pick it up by the end of this section. Another function that can be used to coerce data into factor is `as_factor()` from the forcats package.

```r
as_factor(device)
```

```
 [1] Desktop Desktop Tablet  Mobile  Desktop Tablet  Tablet  Desktop Mobile
[10] Mobile  Mobile  Tablet  Mobile  Mobile  Mobile  Mobile  Mobile  Mobile
[19] Tablet  Tablet  Mobile  Desktop Desktop Mobile  Mobile
Levels: Desktop Tablet Mobile
```

Did you notice any difference between these two functions? Focus on the last line of the output where the levels are displayed. Now observe the order of the levels. `as.factor()` displays levels in the alphabetical order whereas `as_factor()` displays them in order of appearance in the data. **Mobile**, followed by **Tablet**, and then **Desktop**. If you look at the data, they appear in the same order.

12.3.4 Factor Function

If you want finer control while creating factors, use the `factor()` function. `as.factor()` should suffice in most cases but use `factor()` when you want to:

- specify levels
- modify labels
- include `NA` as a level/category
- create ordered factors
- specify order of levels

The first input is a vector, usually a numeric or character vector with a small number of unique values. In our example, it is a character vector of length 25 (i.e. 25 values) but 3 unique values.

```
factor(device)
```

```
 [1] Desktop Desktop Tablet  Mobile  Desktop Tablet  Tablet  Desktop Mobile
[10] Mobile  Mobile  Tablet  Mobile  Mobile  Mobile  Mobile  Mobile  Mobile
[19] Tablet  Tablet  Mobile  Desktop Desktop Mobile  Mobile
Levels: Desktop Mobile Tablet
```

If you want to specify the levels or categories, use the `levels` argument.

```
factor(device, levels = c("Desktop", "Mobile", "Tablet"))
```

```
 [1] Desktop Desktop Tablet  Mobile  Desktop Tablet  Tablet  Desktop Mobile
[10] Mobile  Mobile  Tablet  Mobile  Mobile  Mobile  Mobile  Mobile  Mobile
[19] Tablet  Tablet  Mobile  Desktop Desktop Mobile  Mobile
Levels: Desktop Mobile Tablet
```

Levels not specified will be replaced by `NA`. Let us specify only **Desktop** and **Mobile** as the levels in the device column and see what happens.

```
factor(device, levels = c("Desktop", "Mobile"))
```

```
 [1] Desktop Desktop <NA>    Mobile  Desktop <NA>    <NA>    Desktop Mobile
[10] Mobile  Mobile  <NA>    Mobile  Mobile  Mobile  Mobile  Mobile  Mobile
[19] <NA>    <NA>    Mobile  Desktop Desktop Mobile  Mobile
Levels: Desktop Mobile
```

As you can see, **Tablet** has been replaced by `NA`.

12.3.5 Modify Labels

You can change the labels of the levels using the `labels` argument. The labels must be in the same order as the levels. We will modify the labels to **Desk**, **Mob** & **Tab** for **Desktop**, **Mobile** & **Tablet** respectively.

```
factor(device,
       levels = c("Desktop", "Mobile", "Tablet"),
       labels = c("Desk", "Mob", "Tab"))
```

```
 [1] Desk Desk Tab  Mob  Desk Tab  Tab  Desk Mob  Mob  Mob  Tab  Mob  Mob  Mob
[16] Mob  Mob  Mob  Tab  Tab  Mob  Desk Desk Mob  Mob
Levels: Desk Mob Tab
```

You can see that not only the values but the levels are also modified.

12.3.6 Missing Values

Let us regenerate the device column but include some missing values (`NA`) deliberately to see how `factor()` handles them.

```
# sample with missing values
device <- sample(c("Desktop", "Mobile", "Tablet", NA), size = 25, replace = TRUE)
device
```

```
 [1] NA        "Tablet"  "Desktop" NA        NA        "Tablet"  NA
 [8] NA        "Mobile"  NA        "Desktop" "Desktop" "Desktop" "Tablet"
[15] NA        "Mobile"  NA        "Tablet"  "Tablet"  NA        "Tablet"
[22] "Tablet"  "Mobile"  NA        "Mobile"
```

```
# store as categorical data
factor(device)
```

```
 [1] <NA>    Tablet  Desktop <NA>    <NA>    Tablet  <NA>    <NA>    Mobile
[10] <NA>    Desktop Desktop Desktop Tablet  <NA>    Mobile  <NA>    Tablet
[19] Tablet  <NA>    Tablet  Tablet  Mobile  <NA>    Mobile
Levels: Desktop Mobile Tablet
```

`NA` is not shown as one of the levels. Why does this happen? By default, it will ignore them. If you look at the arguments of the `factor()` function, the `exclude` argument is set to `NA` by default i.e. `NA` is excluded automatically. What should we do to ensure that `NA` is also treated as a level? In order to treat `NA` as a level, set the `exclude` argument to `NULL`.

```
factor(device, exclude = NULL)
```

```
 [1] <NA>    Tablet  Desktop <NA>    <NA>    Tablet  <NA>    <NA>    Mobile
[10] <NA>    Desktop Desktop Desktop Tablet  <NA>    Mobile  <NA>    Tablet
[19] Tablet  <NA>    Tablet  Tablet  Mobile  <NA>    Mobile
Levels: Desktop Mobile Tablet <NA>
```

As you can see, `NA` is displayed as one of the levels in the data.

12.3.7 Ordered Factors

So far, we have been looking at nominal data. Let us now explore how R handles ordered data. We will generate a new data set of satisfaction ratings to use in this section. Satisfaction ratings are widely used to measure a customer's satisfaction with an organization, service or a product.

```
rating <- sample(c("Dislike", "Neutral", "Like"), size = 25, replace = TRUE)
rating
```

```
 [1] "Dislike" "Like"    "Dislike" "Like"    "Dislike" "Dislike" "Dislike"
 [8] "Like"    "Like"    "Neutral" "Dislike" "Neutral" "Dislike" "Dislike"
[15] "Like"    "Like"    "Like"    "Dislike" "Dislike" "Neutral" "Dislike"
[22] "Neutral" "Dislike" "Dislike" "Dislike"
```

It consists of three values Dislike, Neutral & Like in that order. You can see that there is an intrinsic order here. Like is better than neutral which in turn is better than dislike. While we can order them, we can't quantify the difference between them. We can't say neutral is so many times better than dislike.

Membership Testing

As we did earlier, let us check if the data is ordered using the membership function `is.ordered()`.

```
is.ordered(rating)
```

```
[1] FALSE
```

R returns `FALSE` as the variable `rating` is not ordered. Let us use `as.ordered()` to coerce it into an ordered factor.

```
as.ordered(rating)
```

```
 [1] Dislike Like    Dislike Like    Dislike Dislike Dislike Like    Like
[10] Neutral Dislike Neutral Dislike Dislike Like    Like    Like    Dislike
[19] Dislike Neutral Dislike Neutral Dislike Dislike Dislike
Levels: Dislike < Like < Neutral
```

Look at the last line where the levels are displayed. In case of ordered factors, you will see a `<` between the labels. This is used to indicate the order of the levels. Now `rating` is both an ordered but the order of the levels is not correct. It should be `Dislike < Neutral < Like` but is displayed in order of appearance in the data. Let us use the `factor()` function since we need more control over how the levels are ranked and set the `ordered` argument to `TRUE`.

```
factor(rating, ordered = TRUE)
```

```
 [1] Dislike Like    Dislike Like    Dislike Dislike Dislike Like    Like
[10] Neutral Dislike Neutral Dislike Dislike Like    Like    Like    Dislike
[19] Dislike Neutral Dislike Neutral Dislike Dislike Dislike
Levels: Dislike < Like < Neutral
```

The ranking of the levels has not changed and is still the same. Why is this happening? If you observe carefully, the ranking follows the alphabetical order (**D**esktop, **M**obile, **T**able). The `factor()` function uses the same order for the levels.

12.3.8 Modify Order of Levels

To change the order/ranking of the levels, we need to specify it using the `levels` argument. Let us do that in the next example.

```r
factor(rating, levels = c("Dislike", "Neutral", "Like"), ordered = TRUE)
```

```
 [1] Dislike Like    Dislike Like    Dislike Dislike Dislike Like    Like
[10] Neutral Dislike Neutral Dislike Dislike Like    Like    Like    Dislike
[19] Dislike Neutral Dislike Neutral Dislike Dislike Dislike
Levels: Dislike < Neutral < Like
```

Now, you can see that the levels are ranked correctly. The `ordered()` function can also be used to create ordered factors. Let us recreate the previous example using the `ordered()` function.

```r
ordered(rating, levels = c("Dislike", "Neutral", "Like"))
```

```
 [1] Dislike Like    Dislike Like    Dislike Dislike Dislike Like    Like
[10] Neutral Dislike Neutral Dislike Dislike Like    Like    Like    Dislike
[19] Dislike Neutral Dislike Neutral Dislike Dislike Dislike
Levels: Dislike < Neutral < Like
```

You can specify levels, modify labels and handle missing values using the `ordered()` function as well.

12.3.9 Key Functions

Function	Description
`is.factor()`	Identify
`is.ordered()`	
`as.factor()`	Convert
`as_factor()`	
`as.ordered()`	
`factor()`	Create
`ordered()`	

12.3.10 Summary

- R uses **factor** to handle categorical data.
- Use `as.factor()` or `as_factor()` to coerce other data types to **factor**.
- Use `is.factor()` or `is.ordered()` to identify factor & ordered factor respectively.
- Use `factor()` to

  - specify labels
  - modify labels
  - handle missing data
  - create ordered factors
  - specify order of levels

- Use `ordered()` to create ordered factors.

12.3.11 Your Turn

Use `analytics_raw.rds` data set to answer the below questions.

1. Check whether the below variables are factor

   - `device`
   - `page_depth`
   - `landing_page`

2. Coerce the following variables to type factor

   - `device`
   - `os`
   - `browser`
   - `user_type`
   - `channel`
   - `gender`
   - `landing_page`
   - `exit_page`
   - `city`
   - `country`
   - `user_type`

3. Use only the following levels in the `gender` column:

   - `male`
   - `female`

4. Include `NA` as a level in the gender column.

5. Change label of `NA` to `missing` in the `gender` column.

6. Change the labels of the levels in `user_type` column to

   - `New`
   - `Returning`

7. Check if the `user_rating` column is ordered. If not, coerce it to type ordered factor.

12.4 Summarize

12.4.1 Introduction

Categorical data cannot be summarized in the same way as numeric data. It does not make sense to look at range, standard deviation etc. since data consists of a few distinct values only. So how do we summarize such data? We can look at

- count/frequency
- proportion
- cumulative frequency
- cross table
- contingency table etc.

In this section, we will explore the above ways of summarizing categorical data. We will also spend some time learning about tables as you will be using them extensively while working with categorical data. R has many packages for tabulating data and we list and explore all of them in the last section of this chapter.

12.4.2 Number of Categories

From our case study, we want to know the number of devices used to browse the website, the name of the devices and the proportion of traffic they drive to our website. Let us begin with the number of devices. To view the number of groups/categories in a categorical variable, use `nlevels()`.

```
nlevels(data$device)
```

```
[1] 3
```

There are 3 categories of devices used by the visitors to browse the website. This can also be used for data sanitization i.e. as an analyst you know that there are only 3 valid categories of device into which any visitor can be classified into. If you see more than 3 categories, you might want to check if there are any issues in data collection or processing. Now that we know there are 3 categories of devices, let us check if they are valid. The `levels()` function will return the labels of the groups.

12.4.3 Category Names

Knowing the number of levels is useful but not sufficient. `levels()` is one of the most useful functions when it comes to dealing with categorical data.

```
levels(data$device)
```

```
[1] "Desktop" "Mobile"  "Tablet"
```

Other functions that you can use include `unique()` and `fct_unique()`. Both these functions will return the unique names/labels along with the levels while `levels()` returns the labels of the levels.

```
unique(data$device)
```

```
[1] Desktop Mobile  Tablet
Levels: Desktop Mobile Tablet
```

```
fct_unique(data$device)
```

```
[1] Desktop Mobile  Tablet
Levels: Desktop Mobile Tablet
```

12.4.4 Names & Counts

So we have checked the number of devices and their names. Let us now examine their distribution i.e. count/frequency. `table()` and `summary()` will display the levels and their counts while `fct_count()` will return a tibble with 2 columns (level & count). It is extremely useful for further data processing or visualization (using ggplot2).

```
table(data$device)
```

```
Desktop  Mobile  Tablet
 177282   63482    3634
```

```
fct_count(data$device)
```

```
# A tibble: 3 x 2
  f            n
  <fct>    <int>
1 Desktop 177282
2 Mobile   63482
3 Tablet    3634
```

```
summary(data$device)
```

```
Desktop  Mobile  Tablet
 177282   63482    3634
```

12.4.5 Tables

In the previous section, we used the `table()` function to tabulate categorical data. We will recreate the tabulation for device and store it in a new variable tab.

```
tab <- table(data$device)
tab
```

```
Desktop  Mobile  Tablet
 177282   63482    3634
```

What does this function return? It is not a `vector`, `list`, `data.frame` or `matrix`. Let us use the `class()` function to check the class of the object returned by `table()`. It returns an object of the class **table**. This is a new type of object. Let us spend some time understanding tables as they are useful for organizing and summarizing categorical data. **table** is also the most used object when it comes to dealing with categorical data.

The `table()` function returns the counts of the categories but let us say we want to view the proportion or percentage instead of counts i.e. the proportion or percentage of traffic driven to our website by the different devices. The `proportions()` or `prop.table()` function comes in handy in such cases. It takes a table object as input (tab in our case).

```
prop.table(tab)
```

```
   Desktop     Mobile     Tablet
0.72538237 0.25974844 0.01486919
```

```
proportions(tab)
```

```
   Desktop     Mobile     Tablet
0.72538237 0.25974844 0.01486919
```

To get the percentages, multiply the output by 100. Use the `round()` function to round the decimal places according to your requirements.

```
proportions(tab) * 100
```

```
  Desktop    Mobile    Tablet
72.538237 25.974844  1.486919
```

```
round(proportions(tab) * 100, 2)
```

```
Desktop  Mobile  Tablet
  72.54   25.97    1.49
```

So far, we have used `table()` to tabulate a single categorical variable. It can be used for a lot more than just tabulating data. We can examine the relationship between two categorical variables as well as create multidimensional tables. Let us look at the relationship between **gender** and **device** in our case study. Does gender affect the type of device used? To answer this, we will create a two way or cross table. In the `table()` function, we can specify multiple variables by separating them with a comma.

```
tab2 <- table(data$gender, data$device)
tab2
```

```
        Desktop Mobile Tablet
  female   32803   7268    494
  male     46418  14503    696
  <NA>     98061  41711   2444
```

Keep in mind that the order of the variables matter. Rows represent the first variable while column represents the second.

```
table(data$device, data$gender)
```

```
         female  male  <NA>
  Desktop  32803 46418 98061
  Mobile    7268 14503 41711
  Tablet     494   696  2444
```

The `proportions()` function works with two way tables as well.

```
proportions(tab2)
```

```
            Desktop      Mobile      Tablet
  female 0.134219593 0.029738378 0.002021293
  male   0.189927904 0.059341729 0.002847814
  <NA>   0.401234871 0.170668336 0.010000082
```

```
proportions(tab2) * 100
```

```
           Desktop     Mobile     Tablet
  female 13.4219593  2.9738378  0.2021293
  male   18.9927904  5.9341729  0.2847814
  <NA>   40.1234871 17.0668336  1.0000082
```

We would like to introduce another function at this point of time, `margin.table()`. What does this function do? It computes the marginal frequencies i.e. the sum of the rows or columns. It takes a **table** object as input. The `margin` argument allows us to specify whether we want the sum of rows or columns. `1` indicates rows and `2` indicates columns.

```
margin.table(tab2, 1) # sum of rows
```

```
female   male   <NA>
 40565  61617 142216
```

```
margin.table(tab2, 2) # sum of columns
```

```
Desktop  Mobile  Tablet
 177282   63482    3634
```

If the margin argument is NULL (which it is by default), the function returns the sum of all cells of the table.

```
margin.table(tab2)
```

```
[1] 244398
```

`table()` does not display row or column labels. It does display the group labels though. Let us revisit the output from `tab2`. You can observe that while it includes the group labels, the row and column labels are missing. The output from the `dimnames()` function shows the group labels of the variables but the row & column labels are absent.

```
dimnames(tab2)
```

```
[[1]]
[1] "female" "male"   NA

[[2]]
[1] "Desktop" "Mobile"  "Tablet"
```

```
names(tab2)
```

```
NULL
```

```
names(dimnames(tab2))
```

```
[1] "" ""
```

The output from `names(dimnames(tab2))` is also empty. Let us add the variable names as the row & column labels to `tab2`.

```
names(dimnames(tab2)) <- c("Gender", "Device")
tab2
```

```
        Device
Gender   Desktop Mobile Tablet
  female   32803   7268    494
  male     46418  14503    696
  <NA>     98061  41711   2444
```

Now look at the output from `tab2` and you can observe the difference. The same is also visible when we run `dimnames(tab2)`.

```
dimnames(tab2)
```

```
$Gender
[1] "female" "male"   NA

$Device
[1] "Desktop" "Mobile"  "Tablet"
```

To add margin totals to the table, use `addmargins()`. Like `proportions()` and `margin.table()`, it also takes a `table` object as the input.

```
addmargins(tab2)
```

```
        Device
Gender   Desktop Mobile Tablet    Sum
  female   32803   7268    494  40565
  male     46418  14503    696  61617
  <NA>     98061  41711   2444 142216
  Sum     177282  63482   3634 244398
```

`rowSums()` returns the row total while `colSums()` returns the column total. They are similar to `margin.table()`.

```
rowSums(tab2)
```

```
female   male   <NA>
 40565  61617 142216
```

```
colSums(tab2)
```

```
Desktop  Mobile  Tablet
 177282   63482    3634
```

`xtabs()` is another way of creating multidimensional tables in R. In comparison to `table()`, it

- uses `formula` notation for input
- the data argument ensures variable names are referenced instead of using $ i.e. `data$variable`
- displays row & column labels by default

```
tabx <- xtabs(~gender+device, data = data)
tabx
```

```
        device
gender   Desktop Mobile Tablet
  female   32803   7268    494
  male     46418  14503    696
  <NA>     98061  41711   2444
```

The following functions work with `xtabs()` as well

- proportions()
- margin.table()
- addmargins()

```
proportions(tabx)
```

```
        device
gender       Desktop      Mobile      Tablet
  female 0.134219593 0.029738378 0.002021293
  male   0.189927904 0.059341729 0.002847814
  <NA>   0.401234871 0.170668336 0.010000082
```

```
margin.table(tabx, 1)
```

```
gender
female   male   <NA>
 40565  61617 142216
```

```
margin.table(tabx, 2)
```

```
device
Desktop  Mobile  Tablet
 177282   63482    3634
```

```
addmargins(tabx)
```

```
        device
gender   Desktop Mobile Tablet    Sum
  female   32803   7268    494  40565
  male     46418  14503    696  61617
  <NA>     98061  41711   2444 142216
  Sum     177282  63482   3634 244398
```

So far, we have been working with one or two dimensional tables. Both the `table()` and `xtabs()` functions are capable of creating multidimensional tables. Keep in mind that multidimensional tables are complex and it becomes increasingly difficult to understand or interpret them.

```
tab3 <- xtabs(~gender+device+channel, data = data)
tab3
```

```
, , channel = (Other)

        device
gender   Desktop Mobile Tablet
  female     786    258      0
  male      1063    507     19
  <NA>      2173   1186     81

, , channel = Affiliates

        device
gender   Desktop Mobile Tablet
  female    1314     60      0
  male      1714    169      0
  <NA>      3518    548     65

, , channel = Direct

        device
gender   Desktop Mobile Tablet
  female    4785    977     59
  male      7010   2381     95
  <NA>     15824   8292    430

, , channel = Display

        device
gender   Desktop Mobile Tablet
  female     123    753    104
  male       210    491     73
  <NA>       554    911    156

, , channel = Organic Search

        device
gender   Desktop Mobile Tablet
  female   17109   4480    282
  male     25016   9563    448
  <NA>     54071  27223   1476

, , channel = Paid Search

        device
gender   Desktop Mobile Tablet
  female     645    230     22
  male       887    478     26
```

```
  <NA>      1274    782     51

, , channel = Referral

        device
gender   Desktop Mobile Tablet
  female    7387     74      0
  male      9251    185      0
  <NA>     18052    615     51

, , channel = Social

        device
gender   Desktop Mobile Tablet
  female     654    436     27
  male      1267    729     35
  <NA>      2595   2154    134
```

ftable stands for flat tables and is useful for printing attractive tables. It makes it easy to read and interpret multidimensional tables. In the next example, we will use `ftable()` to print the tables we have created in the previous examples and compare the outputs.

```
ftable(tabx)
```

```
       device Desktop Mobile Tablet
gender
female          32803   7268    494
male            46418  14503    696
NA              98061  41711   2444
```

```
ftable(tab2)
```

```
       Device Desktop Mobile Tablet
Gender
female          32803   7268    494
male            46418  14503    696
NA              98061  41711   2444
```

```
ftable(tab3)
```

```
               channel (Other) Affiliates Direct Display Organic Search Paid Search Referr
gender device
female Desktop             786       1314   4785     123          17109         645     73
```

```
       Mobile   258   60   977   753   4480   230
       Tablet     0    0    59   104    282    22
male   Desktop 1063 1714  7010   210  25016   887   92
       Mobile   507  169  2381   491   9563   478    1
       Tablet    19    0    95    73    448    26
NA     Desktop 2173 3518 15824   554  54071  1274  180
       Mobile  1186  548  8292   911  27223   782    6
       Tablet    81   65   430   156   1476    51
```

By default, missing values (NAs) are excluded from tables. Let us modify the gender data from our case study a bit and see how the `table()` function deals with missing values. We won't explicitly specify `NA` as a level while recreating the gender data.

```
gen <- as.factor(as.character(data$gender))
table(gen)
```

```
gen
female   male
 40565  61617
```

As you can see, `table()` excludes missing values while tabulating the data. In order to ensure that missing values are also counted, we can use the `useNA` argument. It can take two values:

- ifany
- always

In the first case, it will show `NA` as a level and the count only if there are missing values in the data. In the second case, it will always show `NA` as a level irrespective of whether there are missing values in the data or not.

```
table(gen, useNA = "ifany")
```

```
gen
female   male   <NA>
 40565  61617 142216
```

```
table(data$device, useNA = "always")
```

```
Desktop  Mobile  Tablet    <NA>
 177282   63482    3634       0
```

In this final section on tables, we will learn how to select/access the different parts of a `table`. We will use `[` operator to select rows and columns of a table (it is similar to selecting data from a `data.frame`). Below are a few examples:

- select first row

```
tab2[1, ]
```

```
Desktop  Mobile  Tablet
  32803    7268     494
```

- select first column

```
tab2[, 1]
```

```
female   male   <NA>
 32803  46418  98061
```

- select first two rows

```
tab2[1:2, ]
```

```
        Device
Gender   Desktop Mobile Tablet
  female   32803   7268    494
  male     46418  14503    696
```

- select first two columns

```
tab2[, 1:2]
```

```
        Device
Gender   Desktop Mobile
  female   32803   7268
  male     46418  14503
  <NA>     98061  41711
```

- select nth row

```
tab2[2, ]
```

```
Desktop  Mobile  Tablet
  46418   14503     696
```

- select nth column

```
tab2[, 2]
```

```
female   male   <NA>
  7268  14503  41711
```

- select row by group label

```
tab2["female", ]
```

```
Desktop  Mobile  Tablet
  32803    7268     494
```

- select column by group label

```
tab2[, "Mobile"]
```

```
female   male   <NA>
  7268  14503  41711
```

Before we end this section, let us learn how to test if an object is of class table using `is.table()`.

```
is.table(tab2)
```

```
[1] TRUE
```

Next, we will look at different R packages for two way/contingency tables.

12.4.6 Contingency Table

For cross tables with output similar to SAS or SPSS, use any of the below:

- `CrossTable()` from the gmodels package
- `ds_cross_table()` from the descriptr package

```
gmodels::CrossTable(data$device, data$gender)
```

```
   Cell Contents
|-------------------------|
|                       N |
| Chi-square contribution |
|           N / Row Total |
|           N / Col Total |
|         N / Table Total |
|-------------------------|


Total Observations in Table:  102182


             | data$gender
 data$device |    female |      male | Row Total |
-------------|-----------|-----------|-----------|
     Desktop |     32803 |     46418 |     79221 |
             |    58.228 |    38.334 |           |
             |     0.414 |     0.586 |     0.775 |
             |     0.809 |     0.753 |           |
             |     0.321 |     0.454 |           |
-------------|-----------|-----------|-----------|
      Mobile |      7268 |     14503 |     21771 |
             |   218.694 |   143.975 |           |
             |     0.334 |     0.666 |     0.213 |
             |     0.179 |     0.235 |           |
             |     0.071 |     0.142 |           |
-------------|-----------|-----------|-----------|
      Tablet |       494 |       696 |      1190 |
             |     0.986 |     0.649 |           |
             |     0.415 |     0.585 |     0.012 |
             |     0.012 |     0.011 |           |
             |     0.005 |     0.007 |           |
-------------|-----------|-----------|-----------|
Column Total |     40565 |     61617 |    102182 |
             |     0.397 |     0.603 |           |
-------------|-----------|-----------|-----------|
```

```
descriptr::ds_cross_table(data, device, gender)
```

```
    Cell Contents
```

```
 |---------------|
 |     Frequency |
 |       Percent |
 |       Row Pct |
 |       Col Pct |
 |---------------|

 Total Observations:  244398
```

	gender			
device	female	male	NA	Row Total
Desktop	32803	46418	98061	177282
	0.134	0.19	0.401	
	0.19	0.26	0.55	0.73
	0.81	0.75	0.69	
Mobile	7268	14503	41711	63482
	0.03	0.059	0.171	
	0.11	0.23	0.66	0.26
	0.18	0.24	0.29	
Tablet	494	696	2444	3634
	0.002	0.003	0.01	
	0.14	0.19	0.67	0.01
	0.01	0.01	0.02	
Column Total	40565	61617	142216	244398
	0.166	0.252	0.582	

We list and explore different R packages for summarizing categorical data in the last section of this chapter.

12.4.7 Key Functions

Function	Description
`nlevels()`	Number of Levels
`levels()`	Levels / Groups / Categories
`unique()`	
`fct_unique()`	
`table()`	Count / Frequency
`summary()`	
`fct_count()`	
`xtabs()`	Two Way / Multi Way Tables
`ftable()`	
`gmodels::CrossTable()`	
`descriptr::ds_cross_table()`	

12.4.8 Your Turn

1. Display the number of levels in
    - `browser`
    - `channel`
    - `landing_page`
    - `exit_page`
2. Display the categories in
    - `os`
    - `channel`
    - `browser`
    - `gender`
    - `user_type`
3. Display the count/frequency of
    - `channel`
    - `user_type`
4. Examine the distribution of the following and summarize your observations:
    - `channel` by `user_type`
    - `device` by `purchase_flag`
    - `channel` by `device`
    - `channel` by `purchase_flag`
    - `user_type` by `purchase_flag`

13 Factor Manipulation with forcats

This chapter continues @categorical-data-in-r. We reorder, relevel, recode, collapse and lump factors with **forcats**, and visualize them with **ggplot2** only.

13.1 Data Manipulation

13.1.1 Introduction

In this section, our focus will be on handling the levels of a categorical variable, and exploring the forcats package for the same. We will basically look at 3 key operations or transformations we would like to do when it comes to factors which are:

- change value of levels
- add or remove levels
- change order of levels

Before we start working with the value of the levels, let us take a quick look at some of the functions we used in the previous sections. We will store the source of traffic as `channel` instead of referring to the column in the `data.frame` every time.

```
channel <- data$channel
```

Let us go back to the function we used for tabulating data, `fct_count()`. If you observe the result, it is in the same order as displayed by `levels()`.

```
fct_count(channel)
```

```
# A tibble: 8 x 2
  f                  n
  <fct>          <int>
1 (Other)         6073
2 Affiliates      7388
3 Direct         39853
4 Display         3375
5 Organic Search 139668
6 Paid Search     4395
7 Referral       35615
8 Social          8031
```

If you want to sort the results by the count i.e. most common level comes at the top, use the `sort` argument.

Channel	Count
(Other)	6073
Affiliates	7388
Direct	39853
Display	3375
Organic Search	139668
Paid Search	4395
Referral	35615
Social	8031

sort = TRUE →

Channel	Count
Organic Search	139668
Direct	39853
Referral	35615
Social	8031
Affiliates	7388
(Other)	6073
Paid Search	4395
Display	3375

```
fct_count(channel, sort = TRUE)
```

```
# A tibble: 8 x 2
  f                 n
  <fct>         <int>
1 Organic Search 139668
2 Direct          39853
3 Referral        35615
4 Social           8031
5 Affiliates       7388
6 (Other)          6073
7 Paid Search      4395
8 Display          3375
```

If you want to view the proportion along with the count, set the `prop` argument to `TRUE`.

```
fct_count(channel, prop = TRUE)
```

```
# A tibble: 8 x 3
  f                 n      p
  <fct>         <int>  <dbl>
1 (Other)          6073 0.0248
2 Affiliates       7388 0.0302
3 Direct          39853 0.163
4 Display          3375 0.0138
5 Organic Search 139668 0.571
6 Paid Search      4395 0.0180
7 Referral        35615 0.146
8 Social           8031 0.0329
```

One of the important steps in data preparation/sanitization is to check if the levels are valid i.e. only levels which should be present in the data are actually present. `fct_match()` can be used to check validity of levels. It returns a logical vector if the level is present and an error if not.

```
channel |>
  fct_match("Social") |>
  table()
```

```
 FALSE   TRUE
236367   8031
```

13.1.2 Your Turn

1. Display the count/frequency of the following variables in the descending order
    - `device`
    - `landing_page`
    - `exit_page`
2. Check if `laptop` is a level in the `device` column.

13.1.3 Change Value of Levels

In this section, we will learn how to change the value of the levels. In order to keep it interesting, we will state an objective from our case study and then map it into a function from the forcats package.

Combine both Paid & Organic Search into a single level, Search

Channel	Count
(Other)	6073
Affiliates	7388
Direct	39853
Display	3375
Organic Search	139668
Paid Search	4395
Referral	35615
Social	8031

Search = c(Paid, Organic)

Channel	Count
(Other)	6073
Affiliates	7388
Direct	39853
Display	3375
Search	144063
Referral	35615
Social	8031

In this case, we want to change the value of two levels, *Paid Search* & *Organic Search* and give them the common value *Search*. You can also look at it as collapsing two levels into one. There are two functions we can use here:

- `fct_collapse()`
- `fct_recode()`

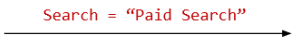
Let us look at `fct_collapse()` first. After specifying the categorical variable, we specify the new value followed by a character vector of the existing values. Remember, the new value is not enclosed in quotes (single or double) but the existing values must be a `character` vector.

```
channel |>
  fct_collapse(Search = c("Paid Search", "Organic Search")) |>
  fct_count()
```

```
# A tibble: 7 x 2
  f                n
  <fct>        <int>
1 (Other)       6073
2 Affiliates    7388
3 Direct       39853
4 Display       3375
5 Search      144063
6 Referral     35615
7 Social        8031
```

In the case of `fct_recode()`, each value being changed must be specified in a new line. Similar to `fct_collapse()`, the new value is not enclosed in quotes but the existing values must be.

Channel	Count
(Other)	6073
Affiliates	7388
Direct	39853
Display	3375
Organic Search	139668
Paid Search	4395
Referral	35615
Social	8031



Channel	Count
(Other)	6073
Affiliates	7388
Direct	39853
Display	3375
Search	144063
Referral	35615
Social	8031

```r
channel |>
  fct_recode(
    Search = "Paid Search",
    Search = "Organic Search"
  ) |>
  fct_count()
```

```
# A tibble: 7 x 2
  f                n
  <fct>        <int>
1 (Other)       6073
2 Affiliates    7388
3 Direct       39853
4 Display       3375
5 Search      144063
6 Referral     35615
7 Social        8031
```

The dplyr and car packages also have recode functions.

Retain only those channels which have driven a minimum traffic of 5000 to the website

Channel	Count
(Other)	6073
Affiliates	7388
Direct	39853
Display	3375
Organic Search	139668
Paid Search	4395
Referral	35615
Social	8031

Lump < 5000

Channel	Count
(Other)	6073
Affiliates	7388
Direct	39853
Organic Search	139668
Referral	35615
Social	8031
Other	7770

Instead of having all the channels, we desire to retain only those channels which have driven at least *5000* visits to the website. What about the rest of the channels which have driven less than *5000*? We will recategorize them as **Other**. Keep in mind that we already have a **(Other)** level in our data. `fct_lump_min()` will lump together all levels which do not have a minimum count specified. In our case study, only **Display** drives less than *5000* visits and it will be categorized into **Other**.

```
channel |>
  fct_lump_min(min = 5000) |>
  fct_count()
```

```
# A tibble: 7 x 2
  f                  n
  <fct>          <int>
1 (Other)         6073
2 Affiliates      7388
3 Direct         39853
4 Organic Search 139668
5 Referral       35615
6 Social          8031
7 Other           7770
```

Retain only top 3 referring channels and categorize rest into Other

Channel	Count
(Other)	6073
Affiliates	7388
Direct	39853
Display	3375
Organic Search	139668
Paid Search	4395
Referral	35615
Social	8031

Retain top 3 Channels →

Channel	Count
Direct	39853
Organic Search	139668
Referral	35615
Other	29262

Suppose you decide to retain only the top 3 channels in terms of the traffic driven to the website. In our case study, these are **Direct**, **Organic Search** and **Referral**. We want to retain these 3 levels and categorize the rest as **Other**. `fct_lump_n()` will retain top `n` levels by count/frequency and lump the rest into **Other**.

```
channel |>
  fct_lump_n(n = 3) |>
  fct_count()
```

```
# A tibble: 4 x 2
  f                  n
  <fct>          <int>
1 Direct         39853
```

```
2 Organic Search 139668
3 Referral        35615
4 Other           29262
```

In our case, `n` is 3 and hence the top 3 channels in terms of traffic driven are retained while the rest are lumped into **Other**.

Retain only those channels which have driven at least 2% of the overall traffic

Channel	Count
(Other)	6073
Affiliates	7388
Direct	39853
Display	3375
Organic Search	139668
Paid Search	4395
Referral	35615
Social	8031



Channel	Count
(Other)	6073
Affiliates	7388
Direct	39853
Organic Search	139668
Referral	35615
Social	8031
Other	7770

In the second scenario above, we retained channels based on minimum traffic driven by them to the website. The criteria was count of visits. If you want to specify the criteria as a percentage or proportion instead of count, use `fct_lump_prop()`. The criteria is a value between **0** and **1**. In our case study, we want to retain channels that have driven at least **2%** of the overall traffic. Hence, we have specified the criteria as `0.02`.

```
channel |>
  fct_lump_prop(prop = 0.02) |>
  fct_count()
```

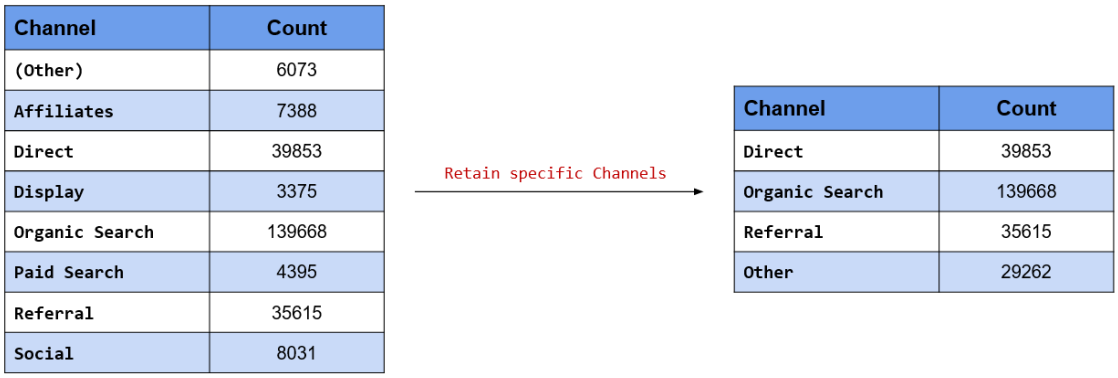
```
# A tibble: 7 x 2
  f                  n
  <fct>          <int>
1 (Other)         6073
2 Affiliates      7388
3 Direct         39853
4 Organic Search 139668
5 Referral       35615
6 Social          8031
7 Other           7770
```

As you can see, only **Display** drives less than **2%** of overall traffic and has been lumped into **Other**.

Retain the following channels and merge the rest into Other

- Organic Search
- Direct
- Referral

In the previous scenarios, we have been retaining or lumping channels based on some criteria like count or percentage of traffic driven to the website. In this scenario, we want to retain certain levels by specifying their labels and combine the rest into **Other**. While we can use `fct_collapse()` or `fct_recode()`, a more appropriate function would be `fct_other()`. We will do a comparison of the three functions in a short while.



`fct_other()` has two arguments, `keep` and `drop`. `keep` is used when we know the levels we want to retain and `drop` is used when we know the levels we want to drop. In this scenario, we know the levels we want to retain and hence we will use the `keep` argument and specify them. **Organic Search**, **Direct** and **Referral** will be retained while the rest of the channels will be lumped into **Other**.

```
# channels to be retained
retain <- c("Organic Search", "Direct", "Referral")

channel |>
  fct_other(keep = retain) |> #<<
  fct_count()
```

```
# A tibble: 4 x 2
  f                   n
  <fct>           <int>
1 Direct          39853
```

```
2 Organic Search 139668
3 Referral        35615
4 Other           29262
```

Merge the following channels into Other and retain rest of them:

- Display
- Paid Search

Channel	Count
(Other)	6073
Affiliates	7388
Direct	39853
Display	3375
Organic Search	139668
Paid Search	4395
Referral	35615
Social	8031

Drop specific channels

Channel	Count
(Other)	6073
Affiliates	7388
Direct	39853
Organic Search	139668
Referral	35615
Social	8031
Other	7770

In this scenario, we know the levels we want to drop and hence we will use the `drop` argument and specify them. **Display** and **Paid Search** will be lumped into **Other** while the rest of the channels will be retained.

```
# channels to be dropped
dropped <- c("Display", "Paid Search")

channel |>
  fct_other(drop = dropped) |>
  fct_count()
```

```
# A tibble: 7 x 2
  f                  n
  <fct>          <int>
1 (Other)         6073
2 Affiliates      7388
3 Direct         39853
4 Organic Search 139668
5 Referral       35615
6 Social          8031
7 Other           7770
```

In the previous scenario, we said we will compare `fct_other()` with `fct_collapse()` and `fct_recode()`. Let us use the other two functions as well and see the difference.

```
# collapse
channel |>
  fct_collapse(Other = c("(Other)",
                         "Affiliates",
                         "Display",
                         "Paid Search",
                         "Social")) |>
  fct_count()
```

```
# A tibble: 4 x 2
  f                  n
  <fct>          <int>
1 Other          29262
2 Direct         39853
3 Organic Search 139668
4 Referral       35615
```

```
# recode
channel |>
  fct_recode(Other = "(Other)",
             Other = "Affiliates",
             Other = "Display",
             Other = "Paid Search",
             Other = "Social") |>
  fct_count()
```

```
# A tibble: 4 x 2
  f                  n
  <fct>          <int>
1 Other          29262
2 Direct         39853
3 Organic Search 139668
4 Referral       35615
```

As you can observe, `fct_other()` requires less typing and is easier to specify.

Anonymize the data set before sharing it with your colleagues

Channel	Count
(Other)	6073
Affiliates	7388
Direct	39853
Display	3375
Organic Search	139668
Paid Search	4395
Referral	35615
Social	8031

Anonymize

Channel	Count
ch_1	7388
ch_2	139668
ch_3	8031
ch_4	4395
ch_5	35615
ch_6	3375
ch_7	39853
ch_8	6073

Anonymizing data is extremely important when you are sharing sensitive data with others. Here, we want to anonymize the channels which drive traffic to the website so that we can share it with others without divulging the names of the channels. `fct_anon()` allows us to anonymize the levels in the data. Using the `prefix` argument, we can specify the prefix to be used while anonymizing the data.

```
channel |>
  fct_anon(prefix = "ch_") |>
  fct_count()
```

```
# A tibble: 8 x 2
  f          n
  <fct>  <int>
1 ch_1   35615
2 ch_2    4395
3 ch_3    7388
4 ch_4  139668
5 ch_5    3375
6 ch_6    6073
7 ch_7   39853
8 ch_8    8031
```

13.1.4 Key Functions

Function	Description
‘fct_collapse()‘	Collapse factor levels
‘fct_recode()‘	Recode factor levels
‘fct_lump_min()‘	Lump factor levels with count lesser than specified value
‘fct_lump_n()‘	Lump all levels except the top n levels

‘fct_lump_prop()‘	Lump factor levels with count lesser than specified proportion
‘fct_lump_lowfreq()‘	Lump together least frequent levels
‘fct_other()‘	Replace levels with Other level
‘fct_anon()‘	Anonymize factor levels

13.1.5 Your Turn

3. Combine the following levels in `landing_page` into `Account`

    - `My Account`
    - `Register`
    - `Sign In`
    - `Your Info`

4. Combine levels in `landing_page` that drive less than 1000 visits.
5. Get top 10 landing and exit pages.
6. Get landing pages that drive at least 5% of the total traffic to the website.
7. Retain only the following levels in the `browser` column:

    - `Chrome`
    - `Firefox`
    - `Safari`
    - `Edge`

8. Anonymize landing and exit page levels.

13.1.6 Add / Remove Levels

In this small section, we will learn to:

- add new levels
- drop levels
- make missing values explicit

Add a new level, Blog

Channel	Count
(Other)	6073
Affiliates	7388
Direct	39853
Display	3375
Organic Search	139668
Paid Search	4395
Referral	35615
Social	8031

Add new channel

Channel	Count
(Other)	6073
Affiliates	7388
Direct	39853
Display	3375
Organic Search	139668
Paid Search	4395
Referral	35615
Social	8031
Blog	0

`fct_expand()` allows us to add new levels to the data. The label of the new level must be specified after the variable name and must be enclosed in quotes. If the level already exists, it will be ignored. Let us add a new level, `Blog`.

```
channel |>
  fct_expand("Blog") |> #<<
  levels()
```

```
[1] "(Other)"        "Affiliates"     "Direct"         "Display"
[5] "Organic Search" "Paid Search"    "Referral"       "Social"
[9] "Blog"
```

Drop existing level

Channel	Count
(Other)	6073
Affiliates	7388
Direct	39853
Display	3375
Organic Search	139668
Paid Search	4395
Referral	35615
Social	8031
Blog	0

Drop Blog Channel

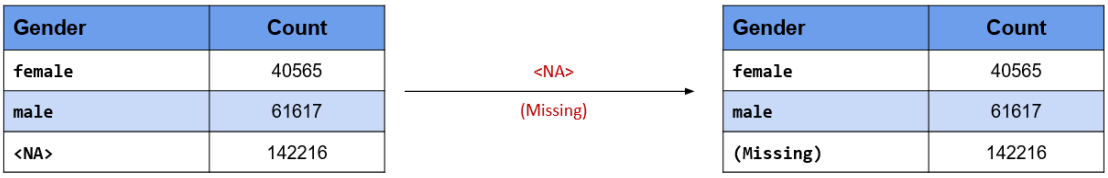
Channel	Count
(Other)	6073
Affiliates	7388
Direct	39853
Display	3375
Organic Search	139668
Paid Search	4395
Referral	35615
Social	8031

On the other hand, `fct_drop()` will drop levels which have no values i.e. unused levels. If you want to drop only specific levels, use the `only` argument and specify the name of the level in quotes. Let us drop the new level we added in the previous example.

```
channel |>
  fct_expand("Blog") |>
  fct_drop() |> #<<
  levels()
```

```
[1] "(Other)"        "Affiliates"     "Direct"         "Display"
[5] "Organic Search" "Paid Search"    "Referral"       "Social"
```

Make missing values explicit



In our data set, the gender column has many missing values, and in R, missing values are represented by `NA`. Suppose you are sharing the data or analysis with someone who is not an R user, and does not know what `NA` represents. In such a scenario, we can use the `fct_na_value_to_level()` function to make the missing values in the gender column explicit i.e. it will appear as `(Missing)` instead of `NA`. This will help non R users to understand that there are missing values in the data.

```
data |>
  pull(gender) |>
  fct_na_value_to_level(level = "(Missing)") |>  #<<
  fct_count()
```

```
# A tibble: 3 x 2
  f              n
  <fct>      <int>
1 female     40565
2 male       61617
3 (Missing) 142216
```

13.1.7 Key Functions

Function	Description
‘fct_expand()‘	Add additional levels to a factor
‘fct_drop()‘	Drop unused factor levels
‘fct_na_value_to_level()‘	Make missing values explicit

13.1.8 Change Order of Levels

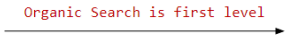
In this last part of this section, we will learn how to change the order of the levels. We will look at the following scenarios from our case study:

We want to make

- Organic Search the first level
- Referral the third level
- Display the last level

Organic Search is the first level

Channel	Count
(Other)	6073
Affiliates	7388
Direct	39853
Display	3375
Organic Search	139668
Paid Search	4395
Referral	35615
Social	8031



Channel	Count
Organic Search	139668
(Other)	6073
Affiliates	7388
Direct	39853
Display	3375
Paid Search	4395
Referral	35615
Social	8031

In this scenario, we want the levels to appear in a certain order. In the first case, we want **Organic Search** to be the first level. `fct_relevel()` allows us to manually reorder the levels. To move a level to the beginning, specify the label (it must be enclosed in quotes).

```
levels(channel)
```

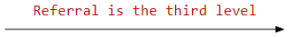
```
[1] "(Other)"        "Affiliates"     "Direct"         "Display"
[5] "Organic Search" "Paid Search"    "Referral"       "Social"
```

```
channel |>
  fct_relevel("Organic Search") |> #<<
  levels()
```

```
[1] "Organic Search" "(Other)"        "Affiliates"     "Direct"
[5] "Display"        "Paid Search"    "Referral"       "Social"
```

Referral is the third level

Channel	Count
(Other)	6073
Affiliates	7388
Direct	39853
Display	3375
Organic Search	139668
Paid Search	4395
Referral	35615
Social	8031



Channel	Count
(Other)	6073
Affiliates	7388
Referral	35615
Direct	39853
Display	3375
Organic Search	139668
Paid Search	4395
Social	8031

The `after` argument is useful when we want to move the level to the end or anywhere between the beginning and end. In the second case, we want **Referral** to be the third level. After specifying the label, use the `after` argument and specify the level after which **Referral** should appear. Since we want to move it to the third position, we will set the value of `after` to 2 i.e. **Referral** should come after the second position.

```
levels(channel)
```

```
[1] "(Other)"        "Affiliates"     "Direct"         "Display"
[5] "Organic Search" "Paid Search"    "Referral"       "Social"
```

```
channel |>
  fct_relevel("Referral", after = 2) |> #<<
  levels()
```

```
[1] "(Other)"        "Affiliates"     "Referral"       "Direct"
[5] "Display"        "Organic Search" "Paid Search"    "Social"
```

Display is the last level

Channel	Count
(Other)	6073
Affiliates	7388
Direct	39853
Display	3375
Organic Search	139668
Paid Search	4395
Referral	35615
Social	8031

Display is the last level

Channel	Count
(Other)	6073
Affiliates	7388
Direct	39853
Organic Search	139668
Paid Search	4395
Referral	35615
Social	8031
Display	3375

In this last case, we want to move **Display** to the end. If you know the number of levels, you can specify a value here. In our data, there are eight channels i.e. eight levels, so we can set the value of `after` to `7`. What happens when we do not know the number of levels or if they tend to vary? In such cases, to move a level to the end, set the value of `after` to `Inf`.

```
levels(channel)
```

```
[1] "(Other)"        "Affiliates"     "Direct"         "Display"
[5] "Organic Search" "Paid Search"    "Referral"       "Social"
```

```
channel |>
  fct_relevel("Display", after = Inf) |> #<<
  levels()
```

```
[1] "(Other)"        "Affiliates"     "Direct"         "Organic Search"
[5] "Paid Search"    "Referral"       "Social"         "Display"
```

Let us now look at a scenario where we want to order the levels by

- frequency (largest to smallest)
- order of appearance (in data)

Order levels by frequency

Channel	Count
(Other)	6073
Affiliates	7388
Direct	39853
Display	3375
Organic Search	139668
Paid Search	4395
Referral	35615
Social	8031

fct_infreq(channel) →

Channel	Count
Organic Search	139668
Direct	39853
Referral	35615
Social	8031
Affiliates	7388
(Other)	6073
Paid Search	4395
Display	3375

In the first case, the levels with the most frequency should appear at the top. `fct_infreq()` will order the levels by their frequency.

```
levels(channel)
```

```
[1] "(Other)"        "Affiliates"     "Direct"         "Display"
[5] "Organic Search" "Paid Search"    "Referral"       "Social"
```

```
# order levels by frequency
channel |>
  fct_infreq() |> #<<
  levels()
```

```
[1] "Organic Search" "Direct"         "Referral"       "Social"
[5] "Affiliates"     "(Other)"        "Paid Search"    "Display"
```

Order levels by appearance

Channel	Count
(Other)	6073
Affiliates	7388
Direct	39853
Display	3375
Organic Search	139668
Paid Search	4395
Referral	35615
Social	8031

fct_inorder(channel) →

Channel	Count
Organic Search	139668
Direct	39853
Referral	35615
Affiliates	7388
(Other)	6073
Social	8031
Display	3375
Paid Search	4395

In the second case, the order of the levels should be the same as the order of their appearance in the data. `fct_inorder()` will order the levels according to the order in which they appear in the data.

```
levels(channel)
```

```
[1] "(Other)"        "Affiliates"     "Direct"         "Display"
[5] "Organic Search" "Paid Search"    "Referral"       "Social"
```

```
# order levels in order of appearance
channel |>
  fct_inorder() |> #<<
  levels()
```

```
[1] "Organic Search" "Direct"         "Referral"       "Affiliates"
[5] "(Other)"        "Social"         "Display"        "Paid Search"
```

Reverse the order of the levels

Channel	Count
(Other)	6073
Affiliates	7388
Direct	39853
Display	3375
Organic Search	139668
Paid Search	4395
Referral	35615
Social	8031



Channel	Count
Social	8031
Referral	35615
Paid Search	4395
Organic Search	139668
Display	3375
Direct	39853
Affiliates	7388
(Other)	6073

The order of the levels can be reversed using `fct_rev()`.

```
levels(channel)
```

```
[1] "(Other)"        "Affiliates"     "Direct"         "Display"
[5] "Organic Search" "Paid Search"    "Referral"       "Social"
```

```
# reverse order of levels
channel |>
  fct_rev() |> #<<
  levels()
```

```
[1] "Social"         "Referral"       "Paid Search"    "Organic Search"
[5] "Display"        "Direct"         "Affiliates"     "(Other)"
```

Randomly shuffle the order of the levels

Channel	Count
(Other)	6073
Affiliates	7388
Direct	39853
Display	3375
Organic Search	139668
Paid Search	4395
Referral	35615
Social	8031

fct_shuffle(channel) →

Channel	Count
Direct	39853
(Other)	6073
Organic Search	139668
Social	8031
Affiliates	7388
Referral	35615
Display	3375
Paid Search	4395

The order of the levels can be randomly shuffled using `fct_shuffle()`.

```
levels(channel)
```

```
[1] "(Other)"        "Affiliates"     "Direct"         "Display"
[5] "Organic Search" "Paid Search"    "Referral"       "Social"
```

```
# randomly shuffle order of levels
channel |>
  fct_shuffle() |> #<<
  levels()
```

```
[1] "Organic Search" "Social"         "Display"        "Paid Search"
[5] "Direct"         "(Other)"        "Affiliates"     "Referral"
```

13.1.9 Key Functions

Function	Description
‘fct_relevel()‘	Reorder factor levels
‘fct_shift()‘	Shift factor levels
‘fct_infreq()‘	Reorder factor levels by frequency
‘fct_rev()‘	Reverse order of factor levels
‘fct_inorder()‘	Reorder factor levels by first appearance

‘fct_shuffle()‘	Randomly shuffle factor levels

13.1.10 Your Turn

9. Make `Home` first level in the `landing_page` column.
10. Make `Apparel` second level in the `landing_page` column.
11. Make `Specials` last level in the `landing_page` column.
12. Order the levels in the browser by frequency:
13. Order the levels in landing page by appearance:
14. Shuffle the levels in os
15. Reverse the levels in browser

13.2 Data Visualization

13.2.1 Introduction

In this section, we will learn to visualize categorical data. We will look at the following type of plots:

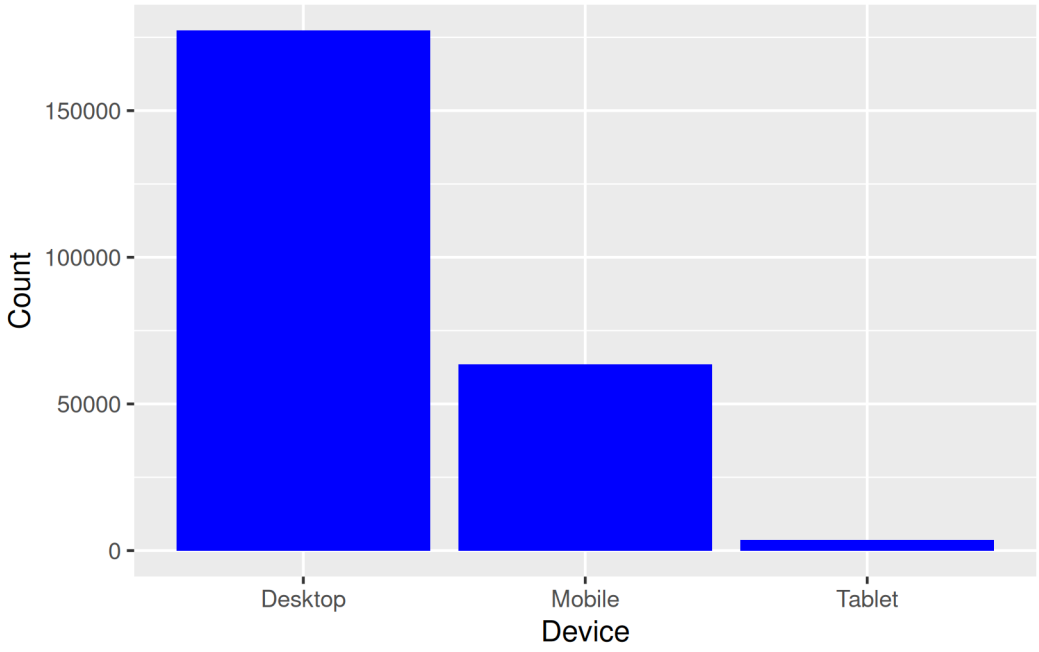
- univariate bar plot
- bivariate bar plot
  - grouped
  - stacked
  - proportional
- mosaic plot
- pie chart
- donut chart

We will be using ggplot2 in this chapter. So you should know the basics of data visualization with ggplot2. If you are new or have never used ggplot2, do not worry. We have several tutorials and an ebook on ggplot2, you can go through them first and then come back to this section.

13.2.2 Bar Plot

Bar charts provide a visual representation of categorical data. The bars can be plotted either vertically or horizontally. The categories/groups appear along the horizontal X axis and the height of the bar represents a measured value.

```
ggplot(data) +
  geom_bar(aes(x = device), fill = "blue") +
  xlab("Device") + ylab("Count")
```

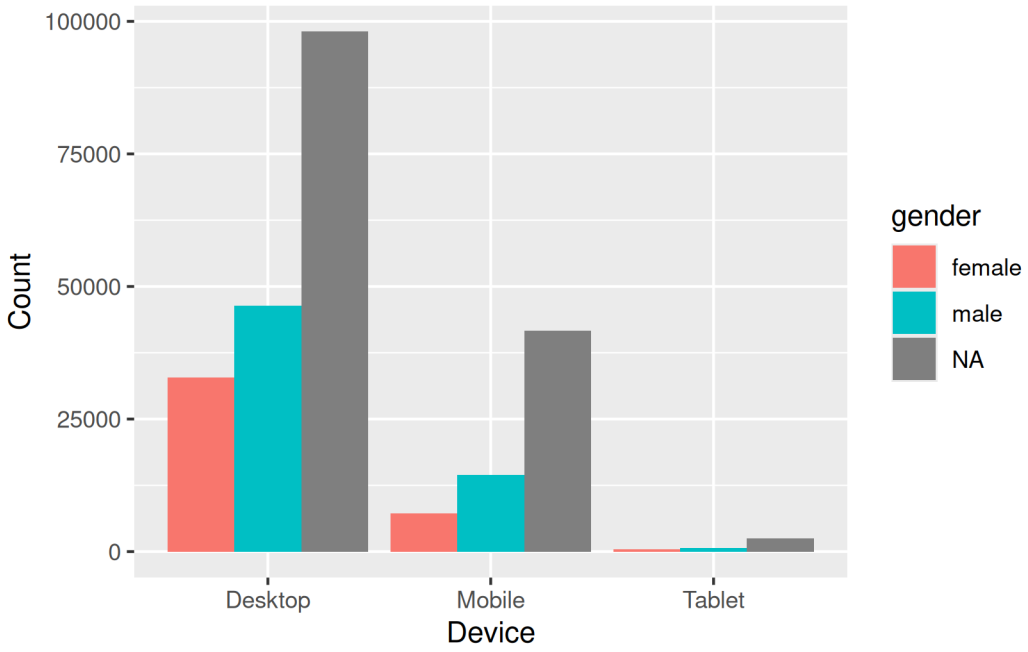


In the above example, the bars represent the count/frequency of the categories. If the bars represent continuous data, the value could be *mean* or *sum* of the variable being represented.

13.2.3 Grouped Bar Plot

A grouped bar chart plots values for two levels of a categorical variable instead of one. You should use grouped bar chart when making comparisons across different categories of data. Use it when you want to look at how the second category variable changes within each level of the first and vice versa.

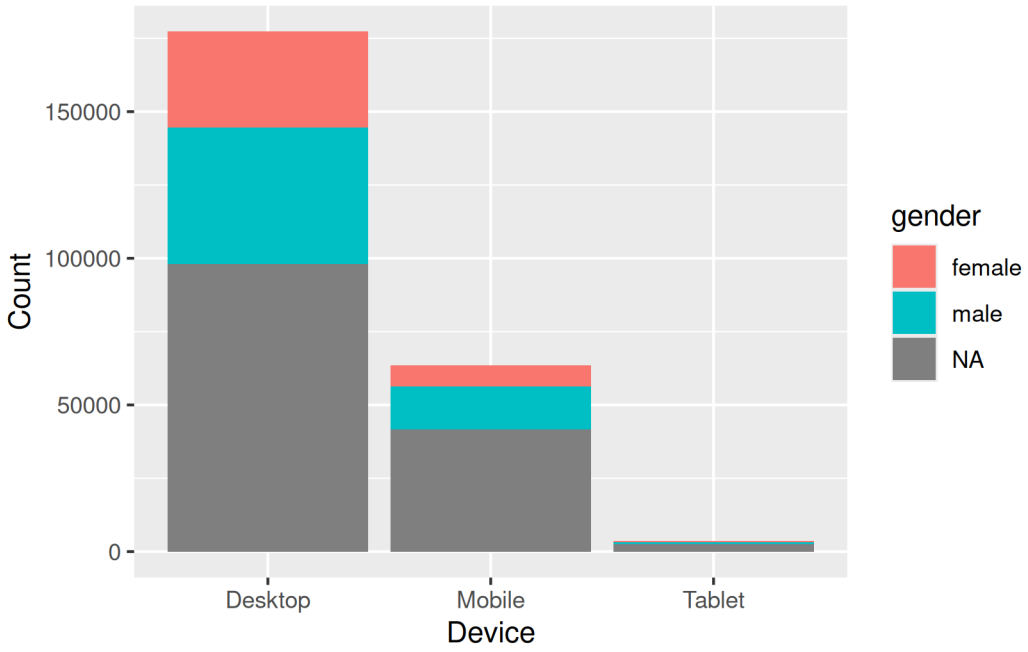
```
ggplot(data) +
  geom_bar(aes(x = device, fill = gender), position = "dodge") +
  xlab("Device") + ylab("Count")
```



13.2.4 Stacked Bar Plot

In stacked bar plots, the bars are stacked on top of each other instead of placing them next to each other. Use stacked bar plots while looking at cumulative value.

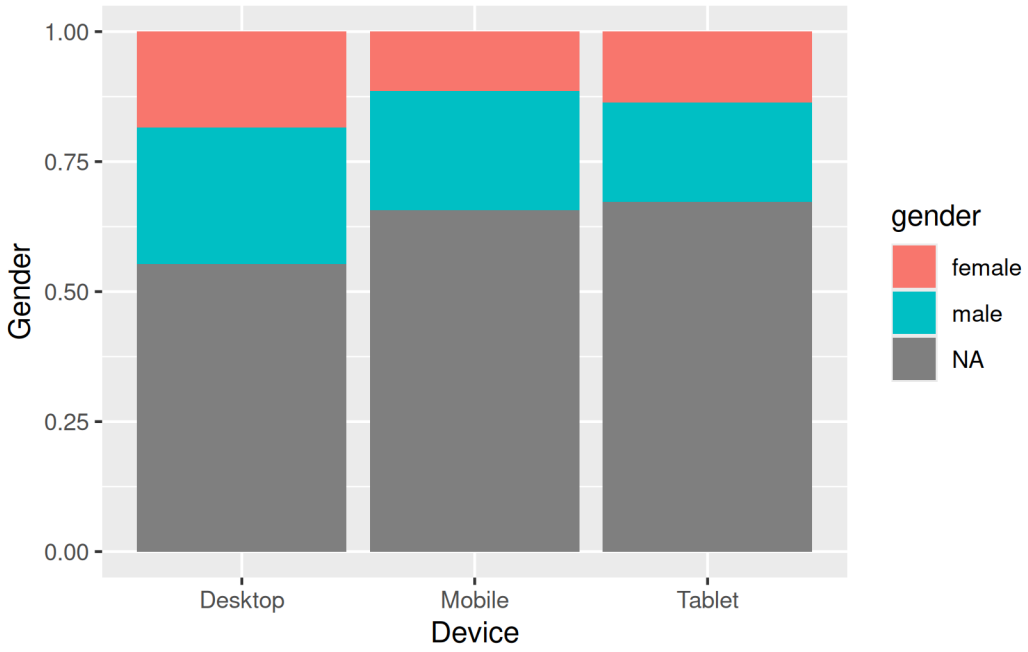
```
ggplot(data) +
  geom_bar(aes(x = device, fill = gender)) +
  xlab("Device") + ylab("Count")
```



13.2.5 Proportional Bar Plot

Also known as percent stacked plot, the height of all bars in this plot are the same. The distribution of the second categorical variable is scaled to 1 or 100. The length of each bar is determined by its share in the category. Use this when you want to concurrently observe each of several variables as they fluctuate and as their percentage ratio's change.

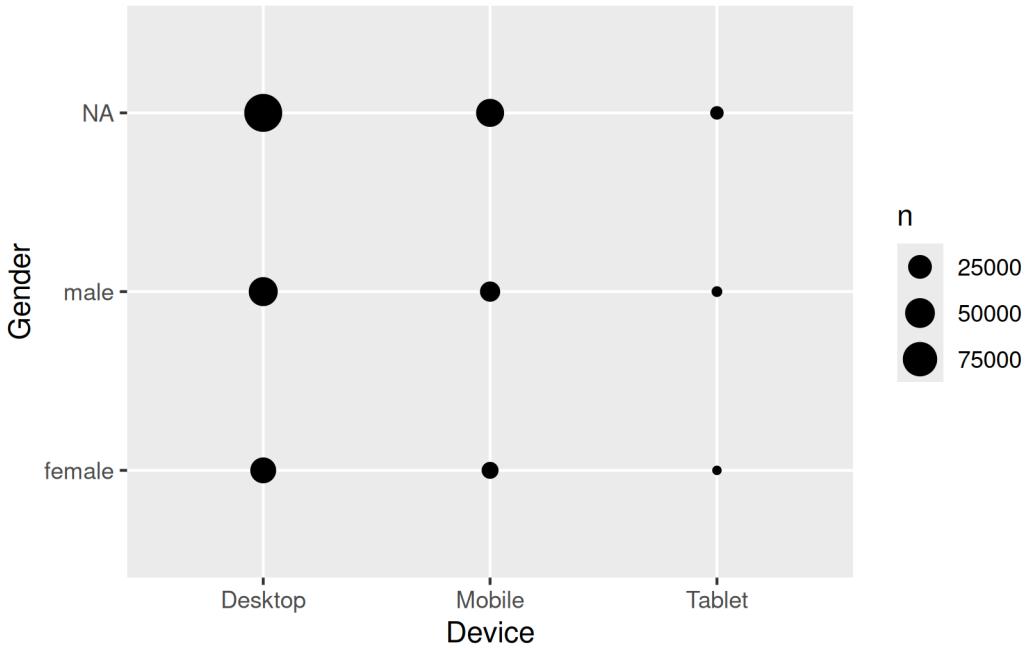
```
data |>
  select(device, gender) |>
  table() |>
  tibble::as_tibble() |>
  ggplot(aes(x = device, y = n, fill = gender)) +
  geom_bar(stat = "identity", position = "fill") +
  xlab("Device") + ylab("Gender")
```



13.2.6 Count Plot

A count plot maps the frequency of observations at each combination of factor levels to circle size using `geom_count()`. It provides a clean, dependency-free alternative for inspecting two-way categorical distributions in ggplot2.

```
ggplot(data, aes(x = device, y = gender)) +
  geom_count() +
  xlab("Device") + ylab("Gender")
```

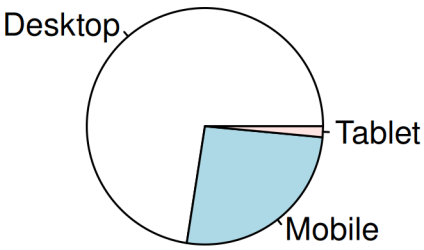


13.2.7 Pie Chart

Pie chart is a circular chart, divided into slices to show relevant sizes of data. It shows the distribution of the different levels of a categorical variable as a circle is divided into radial slices. Each level corresponds with a single slice of the circle and size indicates the proportion of the level. Use it when comparing each group's contribution to the whole as opposed to comparing groups to each other.

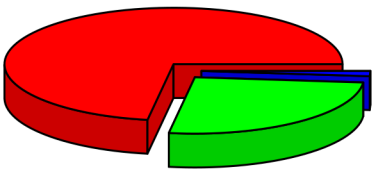
Base R

```
data |>
  pull(device) |>
  table() |>
  pie()
```



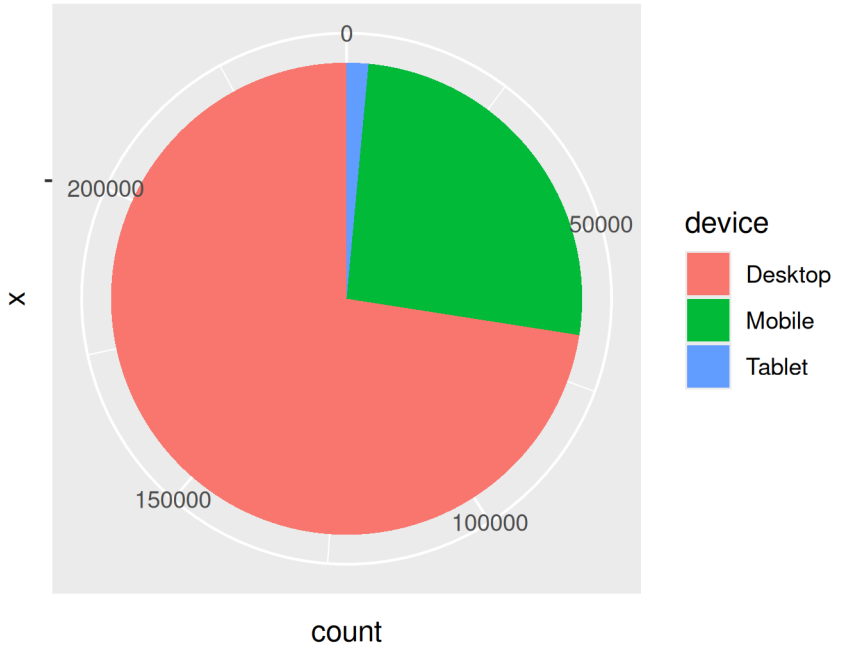
3D Pie Chart

```
data |>
  pull(device) |>
  table() |>
  pie3D(explode = 0.1)
```



ggplot2

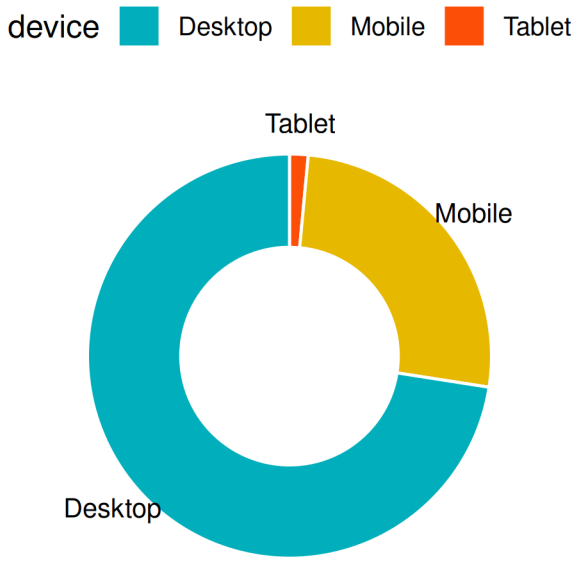
```
data |>
  pull(device) |>
  fct_count() |>
  rename(device = f, count = n) |>
  ggplot() +
  geom_bar(aes(x = "", y = count, fill = device), width = 1, stat = "identity") +
  coord_polar("y", start = 0)
```



13.2.8 Donut Chart

Donut chart is a variation of the pie chart. It has a round hole in the middle which makes it look like a donut. The focus is on the length of the arcs and not the proportions of the slices. Blank spaces inside donut chart can be used to display information inside it.

```
data |>
  pull(device) |>
  fct_count() |>
  rename(device = f, count = n) |>
  ggdonutchart("count", label = "device", fill = "device", color = "white",
               palette = c("#00AFBB", "#E7B800", "#FC4E07"))
```



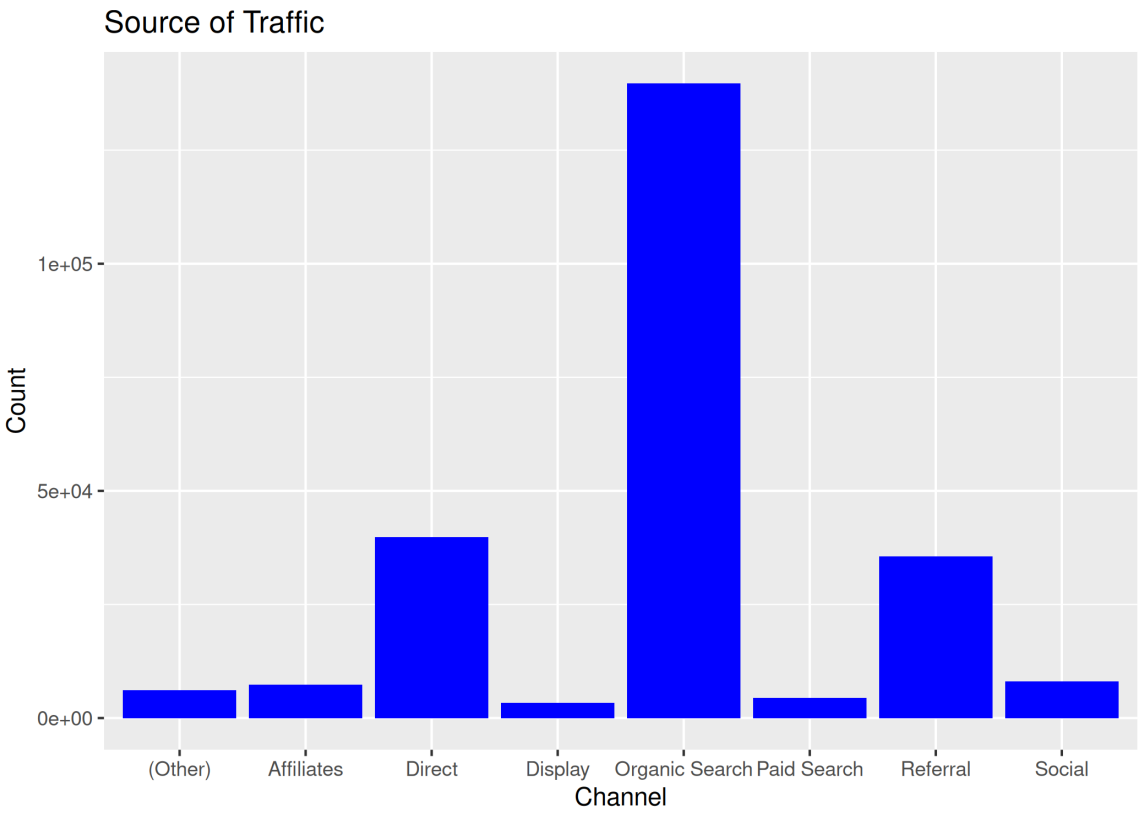
13.2.9 Summary

- Bar charts provide a visual representation of categorical data.
- Use grouped bar chart to make comparison against different categories of data.
- Use stacked bar chart while looking at cumulative data.
- Use proportional bar chart when you want to concurrently observe each of the several variables as they fluctuate.
- Use mosaic plot to discover associations between two variables.
- Use pie chart and donut chart when comparing each group's contribution to the whole.

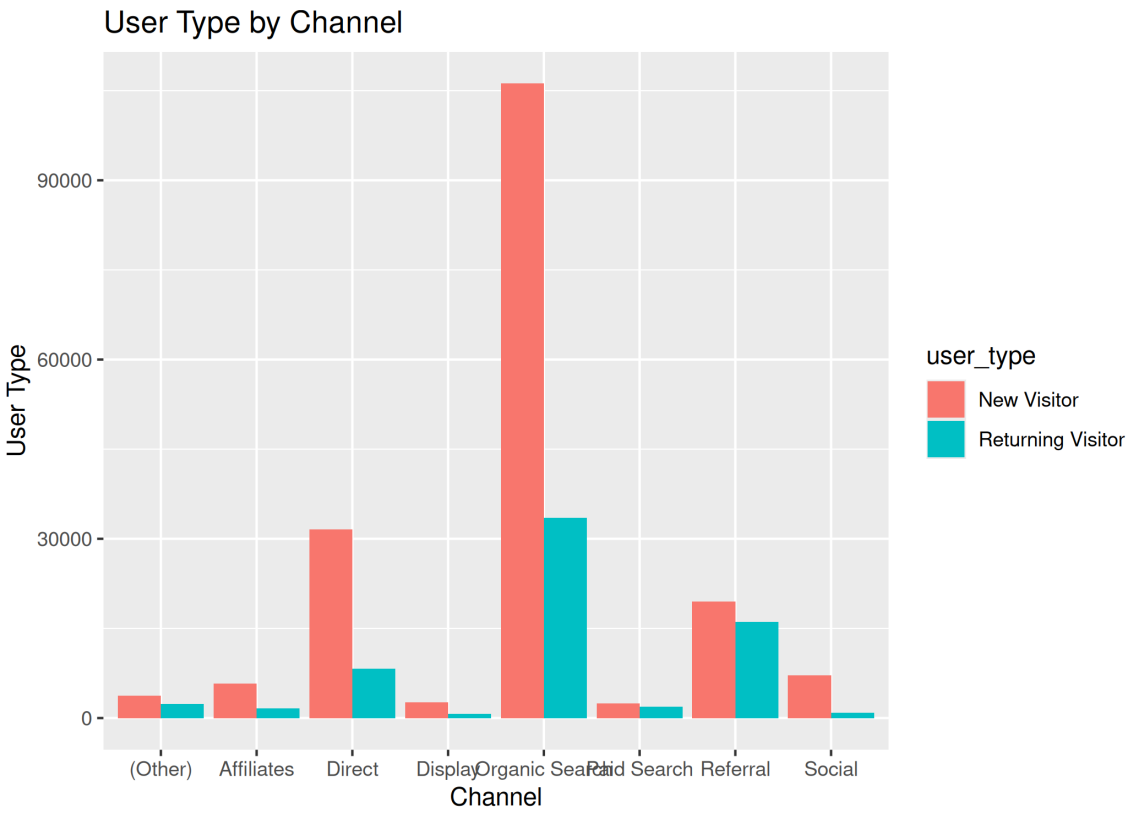
13.2.10 Your Turn

Generate all the below plots:

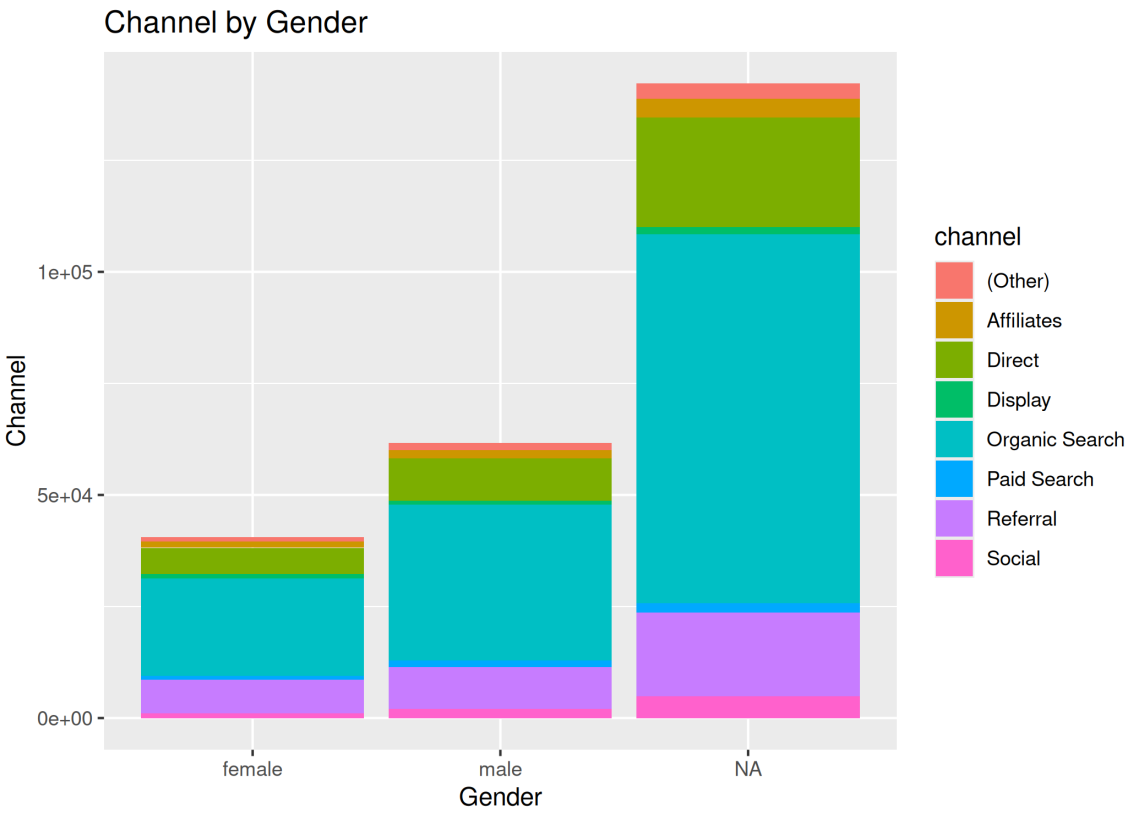
1. Bar plot of `channel`



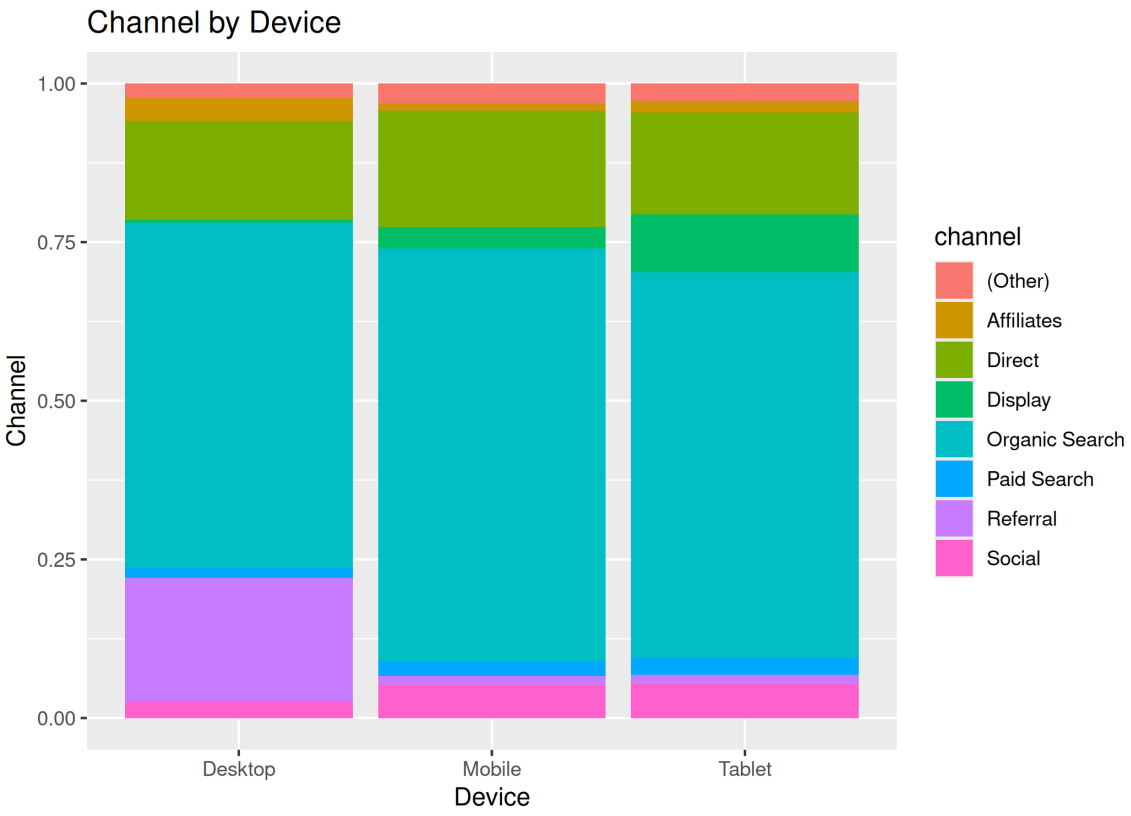
2. Display grouped bar plot of `user_type` by `channel`



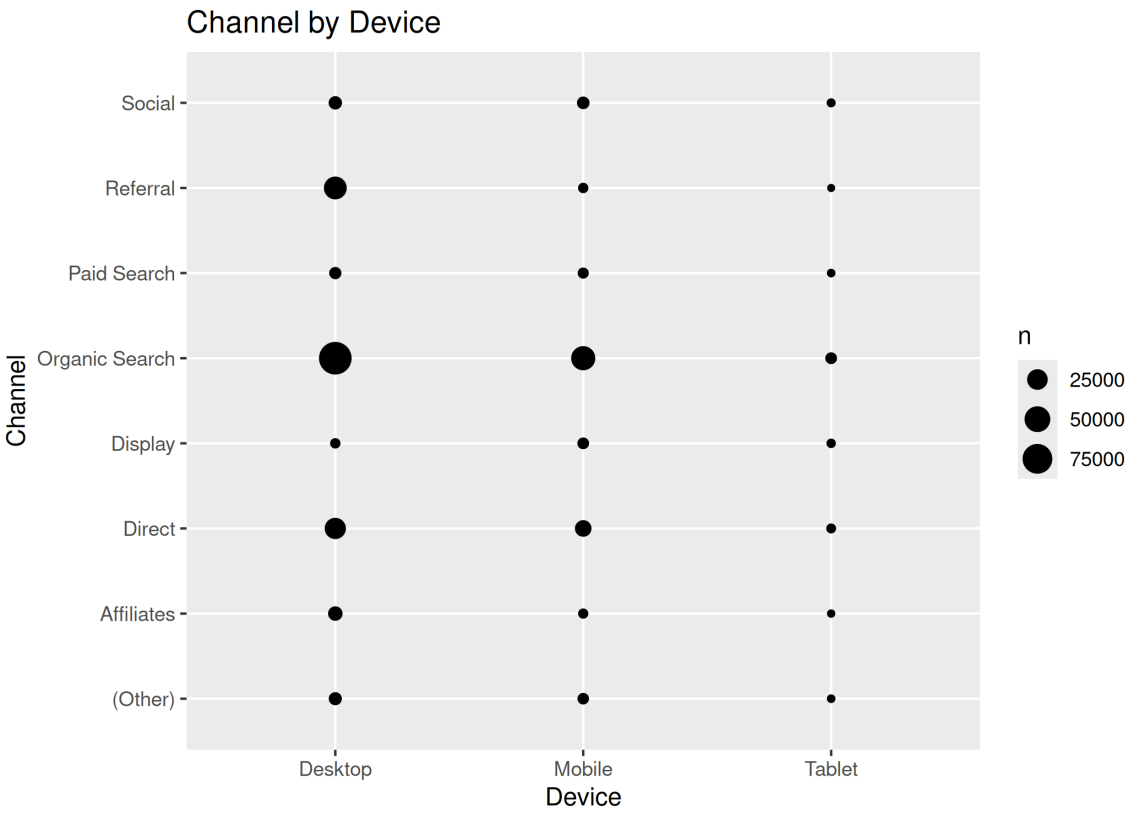
3. Display stacked bar plot of `channel` by `gender`



4. Display proportional bar plot of `channel` by `device`

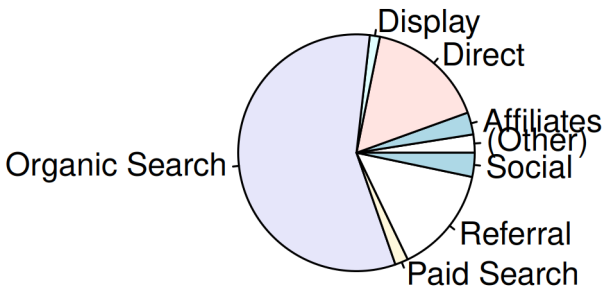


5. Display count plot of `device` by `channel`

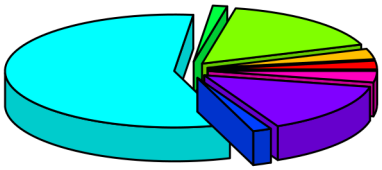


6. Display pie or donut chart of `channel`

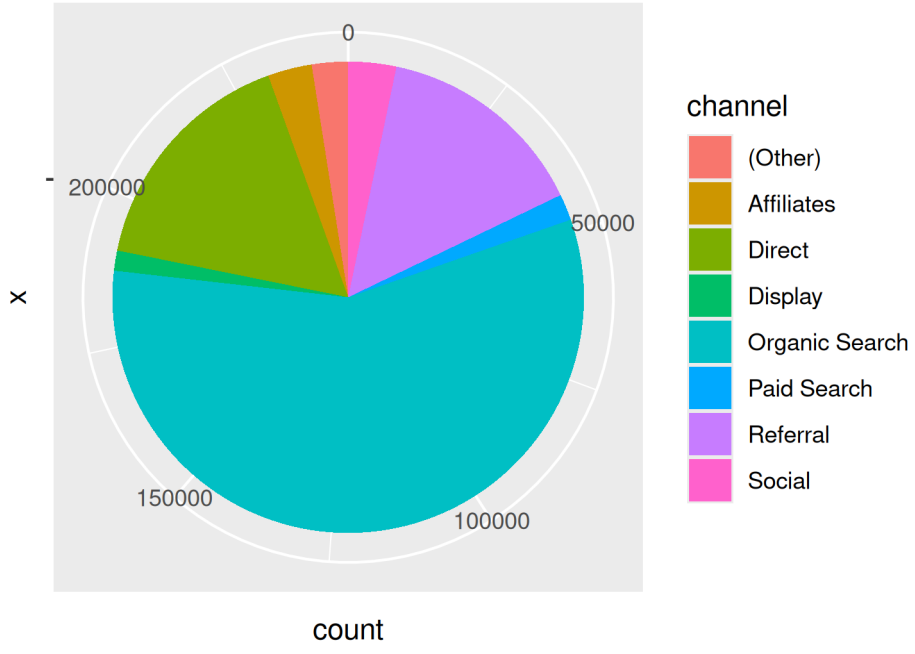
6.1 Pie Chart



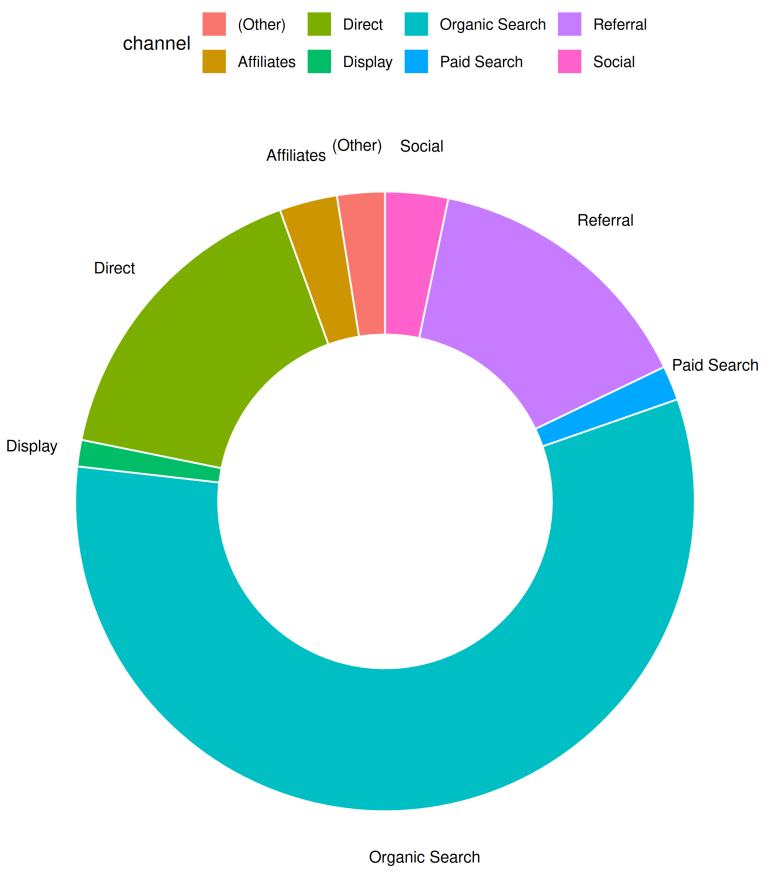
6.2 3D Pie Chart



6.3 Pie Chart (ggplot2)



6.4 Donut Chart



13.3 Useful R Packages

Below are a list of functions from different R pacakges for summarizing categorical data.

13.3.1 Summarize Variables

```
Hmisc::describe(data$device)
```

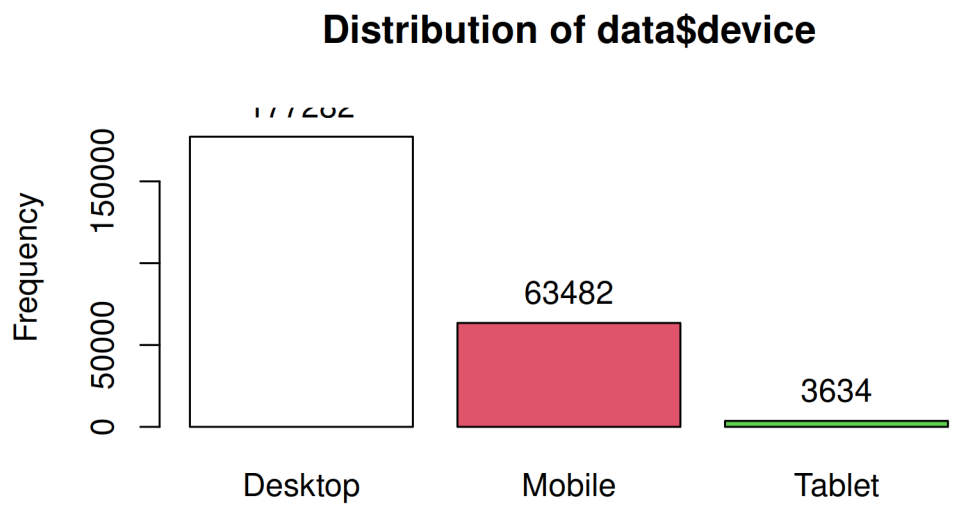
```
data$device
       n  missing distinct
  244398        0        3

Value      Desktop  Mobile  Tablet
Frequency   177282   63482    3634
Proportion   0.725   0.260   0.015
```

```
janitor::tabyl(data$device)
```

```
 data$device      n    percent
     Desktop 177282 0.72538237
      Mobile  63482 0.25974844
      Tablet   3634 0.01486919
```

```
epiDisplay::tab1(data$device)
```




```
data$device :
        Frequency Percent Cum. percent
Desktop    177282    72.5         72.5
Mobile      63482    26.0         98.5
Tablet       3634     1.5        100.0
  Total    244398   100.0        100.0
```

```
summarytools::freq(data$device)
```

```
Frequencies
data$device
Type: Factor

                     Freq   % Valid   % Valid Cum.   % Total   % Total Cum.
```

```
------------ -------- --------- -------------- --------- --------------
      Desktop   177282     72.54          72.54     72.54          72.54
       Mobile    63482     25.97          98.51     25.97          98.51
       Tablet     3634      1.49         100.00      1.49         100.00
         <NA>        0                                0.00         100.00
        Total   244398    100.00         100.00    100.00         100.00
```

```
questionr::freq(data$device)
```

```
            n    % val%
Desktop 177282 72.5 72.5
Mobile   63482 26.0 26.0
Tablet    3634  1.5  1.5
```

```
descriptr::ds_freq_table(data, device)
```

```
                        Variable: device
-----------------------------------------------------------------------
Levels     Frequency    Cum Frequency       Percent        Cum Percent
-----------------------------------------------------------------------
Desktop     177282         177282            72.54            72.54
-----------------------------------------------------------------------
Mobile       63482         240764            25.97            98.51
-----------------------------------------------------------------------
Tablet       3634          244398            1.49              100
-----------------------------------------------------------------------
 Total      244398            -             100.00             -
-----------------------------------------------------------------------
```

13.3.2 Summarize Data Set

```
minilytics <- select(data, device, browser, os)
psych::describe(minilytics)
```

```
         vars      n mean   sd median trimmed mad min max range  skew kurtosis
device*     1 244398 1.29 0.49      1    1.22 0.0   1   3     2  1.31     0.58
browser*    2 244398 8.22 4.84      6    7.14 0.0   1  26    25  1.80     1.43
os*         3 244398 8.80 4.47      8    8.99 8.9   1  16    15 -0.08    -
1.36
           se
device*  0.00
browser* 0.01
os*      0.01
```

```
skimr::skim(minilytics)
```

Table 13.4: Data summary

Name	minilytics
Number of rows	244398
Number of columns	3
_____	
Column type frequency:	
factor	3
_____	
Group variables	None

Variable type: factor

skim_variable	n_missing	complete_rate	ordered	n_unique	top_counts
device	0	1	FALSE	3	Des: 177282, Mob: 63482, Tab: 3634
browser	0	1	FALSE	26	Chr: 192176, Saf: 35323, Fir: 6420, Edg: 3787
os	0	1	FALSE	16	Win: 91223, Mac: 66171, And: 39055, iOS: 27866

```
summarytools::dfSummary(minilytics)
```

```
Data Frame Summary
minilytics
Dimensions: 244398 x 3
Duplicates: 244317

-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------
No   Variable   Stats / Values          Freqs (% of Valid)   Graph               Valid
---- ---------- ---------------------- -------------------- ------------------- ---------
1    device     1. Desktop             177282 (72.5%)       IIIIIIIIIIIII       244398
     [factor]   2. Mobile               63482 (26.0%)       IIIII               (100.0%)
                3. Tablet                3634 ( 1.5%)

2    browser    1. Amazon Silk            168 ( 0.1%)                           244398
     [factor]   2. Android Browser        101 ( 0.0%)                           (100.0%)
                3. Android Webview       1215 ( 0.5%)
                4. APKPure                  1 ( 0.0%)
                5. BlackBerry               7 ( 0.0%)
```

```
                6. Chrome               192176 (78.6%)       IIIIIIIIIIIIIII
                7. Coc Coc                  45 ( 0.0%)
                8. Edge                   3787 ( 1.5%)
                9. Firefox                6420 ( 2.6%)
                10. Internet Explorer      700 ( 0.3%)
                [ 16 others ]            39778 (16.3%)       III

3    os         1. (not set)               179 ( 0.1%)                          244398
     [factor]   2. Android                39055 (16.0%)       III              (100.0%)
                3. BlackBerry              16 ( 0.0%)
                4. Chrome OS             14038 ( 5.7%)       I
                5. Firefox OS                4 ( 0.0%)
                6. iOS                   27866 (11.4%)       II
                7. Linux                  5781 ( 2.4%)
                8. Macintosh             66171 (27.1%)       IIIII
                9. OS/2                      3 ( 0.0%)
                10. Playstation 4           15 ( 0.0%)
                [ 6 others ]             91270 (37.3%)       IIIIIII
--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------
```

```r
tableone::CreateTableOne(vars = c("device", "os"), data = minilytics)
```

```
                     Overall
  n                  244398
  device (%)
     Desktop         177282 (72.5)
     Mobile           63482 (26.0)
     Tablet            3634 ( 1.5)
  os (%)
     (not set)          179 ( 0.1)
     Android          39055 (16.0)
     BlackBerry          16 ( 0.0)
     Chrome OS        14038 ( 5.7)
     Firefox OS           4 ( 0.0)
     iOS              27866 (11.4)
     Linux             5781 ( 2.4)
     Macintosh        66171 (27.1)
     OS/2                 3 ( 0.0)
     Playstation 4       15 ( 0.0)
     Playstation Vita     1 ( 0.0)
     Samsung              5 ( 0.0)
     Tizen               20 ( 0.0)
     Windows          91223 (37.3)
     Windows Phone       13 ( 0.0)
```

```
     Xbox                   8 ( 0.0)
```

```
summary(minilytics)
```

```
     device                    browser              os
 Desktop:177282   Chrome           :192176   Windows  :91223
 Mobile : 63482   Safari           : 35323   Macintosh:66171
 Tablet :  3634   Firefox          :  6420   Android  :39055
                  Edge             :  3787   iOS      :27866
                  Samsung Internet:  2065   Chrome OS:14038
                  Android Webview :  1215   Linux    : 5781
                  (Other)          :  3412   (Other)  :  264
```

Try it live

> **Try it in your browser**
>
> Edit the code below and press **Run**. It executes entirely in your browser via WebR — no R installation needed. The runtime downloads once, on this page only.

```
library(dplyr)
library(forcats)
library(readr)
if (!file.exists("ecom_sample.csv")) {
  download.file(
    "https://wrangle-r.rsquaredacademy.com/data-webr/ecom_sample.csv",
    "ecom_sample.csv"
  )
}
ecom <- read_csv("ecom_sample.csv", show_col_types = FALSE)
ecom |>
  mutate(referrer = fct_infreq(referrer)) |>
  count(referrer)
```

14 Exercise Solutions

14.1 Introduction

Try every **Your Turn** before reading its solution — the struggle is the lesson. Worked solutions below cover @dplyr-basics, @tidying-data-with-tidyr, @date-and-time-in-r, @date-arithmetic-time-zones, @categorical-data-in-r and @forcats-manipulation. Remaining chapters are open stubs — to contribute one, open an issue or pull request with the chapter, the question, and a runnable chunk in this book's style (|>-first, same data as the chapter).

We will use the following R packages:

```
library(dplyr)
library(readr)
```

14.2 dplyr Basics

```
ecom <-
  read_csv('https://raw.githubusercontent.com/rsquaredacademy/datasets/master/web.csv',
    col_types = cols_only(device = col_factor(levels = c("laptop", "tablet", "mobile")),
      referrer = col_factor(levels = c("bing", "direct", "social", "yahoo", "google")),
      purchase = col_logical(), n_pages = col_double(), n_visit = col_double(),
      duration = col_double(), order_value = col_double(), order_items = col_double()
    )
  )
```

Q1. What is the average number of pages visited by purchasers and non-purchasers?

```
ecom |>
  summarise(mean_pages = mean(n_pages), .by = purchase)
```

```
# A tibble: 2 x 2
  purchase mean_pages
  <lgl>         <dbl>
1 FALSE          4.79
2 TRUE          15.8
```

Purchasers browse far more pages (~16 vs ~5) — the signal behind the AOV case study.

Q2. What is the average time on site for purchasers vs non-purchasers?

```
ecom |>
  summarise(mean_time = mean(duration), .by = purchase)
```

```
# A tibble: 2 x 2
  purchase mean_time
  <lgl>        <dbl>
1 FALSE         355.
2 TRUE          359.
```

Time on site barely differs (~355 vs ~359 seconds): page depth, not duration, separates buyers here.

Q3. What is the average number of pages visited by purchasers and non-purchasers using mobile?

```
ecom |>
  filter(device == "mobile") |>
  summarise(mean_pages = mean(n_pages), .by = purchase)
```

```
# A tibble: 2 x 2
  purchase mean_pages
  <lgl>         <dbl>
1 FALSE          4.99
2 TRUE          16.2
```

14.3 Tidying Data with tidyr

```
library(tidyr)
mockstring <-
  read_csv('https://raw.githubusercontent.com/rsquaredacademy/datasets/master/mock_strings
    show_col_types = FALSE)
```

Q1. Reshape the mean of `n_visit` and `order_items` by `referrer` from wide to long.

```
ecom |>
  summarise(across(c(n_visit, order_items), \(x) mean(x, na.rm = TRUE)),
    .by = referrer) |>
  pivot_longer(-referrer, names_to = "metric", values_to = "mean_value")
```

```
# A tibble: 10 x 3
   referrer metric      mean_value
   <fct>    <chr>            <dbl>
 1 google   n_visit           5.05
 2 google   order_items       1.11
 3 yahoo    n_visit           5.05
 4 yahoo    order_items       1.71
 5 direct   n_visit           4.90
 6 direct   order_items       1.51
 7 bing     n_visit           4.77
 8 bing     order_items       1.22
 9 social   n_visit           5.07
10 social   order_items       1.36
```

Q2. Split the `email` column of `mockstring` at `"@"` and reunite it — does the round-trip hold?

```
split <- mockstring |>
  select(email) |>
  separate(email, into = c("user", "domain"), sep = "@", remove = FALSE)
reunited <- split |>
  unite("rejoined", user, domain, sep = "@", remove = TRUE)
identical(reunited$rejoined, mockstring$email)
```

```
[1] TRUE
```

Yes — every row round-trips (`TRUE`), since each address holds exactly one `"@"`.

Q3. Run the `complete()` example without `fill`: what does the missing count become, and why?

```
ecom |>
  filter(purchase) |>
  count(device, purchase) |>
  complete(device, purchase = c(TRUE, FALSE))
```

```
# A tibble: 6 x 3
  device purchase     n
  <fct>  <lgl>    <int>
1 laptop FALSE       NA
2 laptop TRUE        31
3 tablet FALSE       NA
4 tablet TRUE        36
5 mobile FALSE       NA
6 mobile TRUE        36
```

The missing cells become `NA`, not 0: with no `fill`, `complete()` adds the absent combinations but has no value to put in `n`, so the count is unknown (`NA`). Pass `fill = list(n = 0L)` when a missing combination genuinely means "zero events".

14.4 Date & Time: Parsing and Components

```
library(lubridate)
transact <-
  read_csv('https://raw.githubusercontent.com/rsquaredacademy/datasets/master/transact.csv
    show_col_types = FALSE)
```

Q1. Current date, current time, AM or PM, and leap years.

```
today()
```

```
[1] "2026-11-01"
```

```
now()
```

```
[1] "2026-11-01 11:35:44 UTC"
```

```
pm(now())
```

```
[1] FALSE
```

```
leap_year(c(2018, 2016))
```

```
[1] FALSE  TRUE
```

2018 was not a leap year (`FALSE`); 2016 was (`TRUE`).

Q2. R 1.0.0 was released on `2000-02-29 08:55:23 UTC`. Save it as a `Date` from character, a `Date` from origin + number, `POSIXct`, `POSIXlt` (extracting month day, day of year, month, zone) and `ISODate`.

```
as.Date("2000-02-29")
```

```
[1] "2000-02-29"
```

```r
as.Date(11016, origin = "1970-01-01")
```

```
[1] "2000-02-29"
```

```r
as.POSIXct("2000-02-29 08:55:23", tz = "UTC")
```

```
[1] "2000-02-29 08:55:23 UTC"
```

```r
lt <- as.POSIXlt("2000-02-29 08:55:23", tz = "UTC")
c(month_day = lt$mday, day_of_year = lt$yday, month = lt$mon + 1L, zone = lt$zone)
```

```
  month_day day_of_year       month        zone
       "29"        "59"         "2"       "UTC"
```

```r
ISOdate(2000, 2, 29, 8, 55, 23, tz = "UTC")
```

```
[1] "2000-02-29 08:55:23 UTC"
```

`$mon` is zero-indexed, hence `+ 1L`; `$yday` is 59 (zero-indexed — the 60th day of the leap year).

Q3. Create `July 5th, 2019` from each spelling with `as.Date()` and the correct format.

```r
as.Date("July-05-19", format = "%B-%d-%y")
```

```
[1] "2019-07-05"
```

```r
as.Date("JUL-05-19", format = "%b-%d-%y")
```

```
[1] "2019-07-05"
```

```r
as.Date("05.07.19", format = "%d.%m.%y")
```

```
[1] "2019-07-05"
```

```r
as.Date("5-July 2019", format = "%d-%B %Y")
```

```
[1] "2019-07-05"
```

```r
as.Date("July 5th, 2019", format = "July %dth, %Y")
```

```
[1] "2019-11-05"
```

```r
as.Date("July 05, 2019", format = "%B %d, %Y")
```

```
[1] "2019-07-05"
```

```r
as.Date("2019-July- 05", format = "%Y-%B- %d")
```

```
[1] "2019-07-05"
```

```r
as.Date("05/07/2019", format = "%d/%m/%Y")
```

```
[1] "2019-07-05"
```

```r
as.Date("07/05/2019", format = "%m/%d/%Y")
```

```
[1] "2019-07-05"
```

```r
as.Date("7/5/2019", format = "%m/%d/%Y")
```

```
[1] "2019-07-05"
```

```r
as.Date("07/5/19", format = "%m/%d/%y")
```

```
[1] "2019-07-05"
```

```r
as.Date("2019-07-05")
```

```
[1] "2019-07-05"
```

Note the ambiguous pairs: `05/07/2019` vs `07/05/2019` is day-first vs month-first — the format string, not the data, decides. `as.Date()` matches literals (`"July "`, `"th"`, `", "`) character-for-character.

Q4. Parse the same spellings with `strptime()` / `parse_date_time()` / helpers.

```
dates <- c("July-05-19", "JUL-05-19", "05.07.19", "5-July 2019",
  "July 5th, 2019", "July 05, 2019", "2019-July- 05", "05/07/2019",
  "07/05/2019", "7/5/2019", "07/5/19", "2019-07-05")
parse_date_time(dates, orders = c("Bdy", "bdy", "dmy", "dBY", "BYd",
  "dmy", "mdy", "mdy", "mdy", "mdy", "ymd"))
```

```
 [1] "2019-07-05 UTC" "2019-07-05 UTC" "2019-07-05 UTC" "2019-07-05 UTC"
 [5] "2019-07-05 UTC" "2019-07-05 UTC" "2019-07-05 UTC" "2019-07-05 UTC"
 [9] "2019-05-07 UTC" "2019-05-07 UTC" "2019-05-07 UTC" "2019-07-05 UTC"
```

```
mdy("July 05, 2019")
```

```
[1] "2019-07-05"
```

```
dmy("05.07.19")
```

```
[1] "2019-07-05"
```

```
ymd("2019-07-05")
```

```
[1] "2019-07-05"
```

One `parse_date_time()` call with several `orders` handles the whole mixed vector — prefer helpers (`mdy()`/`dmy()`/`ymd()`) when a column uses a single convention.

Q5. From the `Due` column of `transact`, tabulate year, labelled month, labelled weekday, hour and quarter.

```
transact |>
  mutate(due_year = year(Due),
    due_month = month(Due, label = TRUE),
    due_wday = wday(Due, label = TRUE),
    due_hour = hour(Due),
    due_quarter = quarter(Due)) |>
  count(due_year, due_month, due_wday, due_hour, due_quarter)
```

```
# A tibble: 162 x 6
   due_year due_month due_wday due_hour due_quarter     n
      <dbl> <ord>     <ord>       <int>       <int> <int>
 1     2012 Feb       Sun             0           1    17
 2     2012 Feb       Mon             0           1    12
```

```
 3     2012 Feb       Tue             0           1    12
 4     2012 Feb       Wed             0           1    16
 5     2012 Feb       Thu             0           1    13
 6     2012 Feb       Fri             0           1    11
 7     2012 Feb       Sat             0           1     6
 8     2012 Mar       Sun             0           1    12
 9     2012 Mar       Mon             0           1    17
10     2012 Mar       Tue             0           1     6
# i 152 more rows
```

`due_hour` is 0 everywhere: `Due` is a `Date` (midnight, no time component) — `hour()` on dates is always 0.

Q6. R 2.0.0 (`2004-10-04 14:24:38`) with `make_date()` and `make_datetime()`; R 3.0.0 (`2013-04-03 07:12:36`) via `update()`.

```
r200 <- make_datetime(2004, 10, 4, 14, 24, 38)
r200_date <- make_date(2004, 10, 4)
update(r200, year = 2013, month = 4, mday = 3, hour = 7, min = 12, sec = 36)
```

```
[1] "2013-04-03 07:12:36 UTC"
```

14.5 Date & Time: Arithmetic and Time Zones

Q1. Vacation length, shifted vacation, invoice settlement and employment length.

```
vac_start <- ymd("2020-04-19")
vac_end <- ymd("2020-04-25")
vac_start %--% vac_end
```

```
[1] 2020-04-19 UTC--2020-04-25 UTC
```

```
as.period(vac_start %--% vac_end)
```

```
[1] "6d 0H 0M 0S"
```

```
# shift the start by 10 days and the end by 2 weeks, then recompute
vac_start2 <- vac_start + days(10)
vac_end2 <- vac_end + weeks(2)
as.period(vac_start2 %--% vac_end2)
```

```
[1] "10d 0H 0M 0S"
```

```
receivables <-
  read_csv('https://raw.githubusercontent.com/rsquaredacademy/datasets/master/receivables.
    show_col_types = FALSE)
receivables |>
  mutate(invoice_date = mdy(invoice_date), due_date = mdy(due_date),
    settled_date = mdy(settled_date),
    days_to_settle = settled_date - invoice_date,
    days_overdue = settled_date - due_date) |>
  select(invoice_number, days_to_settle, days_overdue) |>
  head()
```

```
# A tibble: 6 x 3
  invoice_number days_to_settle days_overdue
           <dbl> <drtn>         <drtn>
1         611365 13 days        -17 days
2        7900770 36 days          6 days
3        9231909  5 days        -25 days
4        9888306 35 days          5 days
5       15752855 34 days          4 days
6       18104516 26 days         -4 days
```

```
hr <-
  read_csv('https://raw.githubusercontent.com/rsquaredacademy/datasets/master/hr-data.csv'
    show_col_types = FALSE)
hr |>
  filter(Termd == 1, !is.na(DateofTermination)) |>
  mutate(hire = mdy(DateofHire), term = mdy(DateofTermination),
    employed = term - hire) |>
  select(Employee_Name, hire, term, employed) |>
  head()
```

```
# A tibble: 6 x 4
  Employee_Name    hire       term       employed
  <chr>            <date>     <date>     <drtn>
1 Howard, Estelle  2015-02-16 2015-04-15   58 days
2 Smith, Leigh Ann 2011-09-26 2013-09-25  730 days
3 Bunbury, Jessica 2011-08-15 2014-08-02 1083 days
4 Gill, Whitney    2014-07-07 2015-09-05  425 days
5 Guilianno, Mike  2011-03-07 2014-10-31 1334 days
6 Becker, Renee    2014-07-07 2015-09-12  432 days
```

The base vacation is 6 days; after shifting it spans 10 days. Positive `days_overdue` means the customer paid late; filter `Termd == 1` (plus a non-missing termination date) so only terminated employees count.

Q2. Your timezone, daylight savings and the current UTC time.

```
Sys.timezone()
```

```
[1] "UTC"
```

```
dst(now())
```

```
[1] FALSE
```

```
now("UTC")
```

```
[1] "2026-11-01 11:35:44 UTC"
```

Q3. Round `transact` due dates: up to weeks, down to days, back to the start of the month.

```
transact |>
  mutate(due_week_up = ceiling_date(Due, "week"),
    due_day_down = floor_date(Due, "day"),
    due_month_start = rollback(Due, roll_to_first = TRUE)) |>
  select(Due, due_week_up, due_day_down, due_month_start) |>
  head()
```

```
# A tibble: 6 x 4
  Due         due_week_up due_day_down due_month_start
  <date>      <date>      <date>       <date>
1 2013-02-01 2013-02-03  2013-02-01   2013-02-01
2 2013-02-25 2013-03-03  2013-02-25   2013-02-01
3 2013-08-02 2013-08-04  2013-08-02   2013-08-01
4 2013-03-12 2013-03-17  2013-03-12   2013-03-01
5 2012-11-24 2012-11-25  2012-11-24   2012-11-01
6 2012-02-26 2012-03-04  2012-02-26   2012-02-01
```

`Due` values are whole dates, so rounding down to days is a no-op (midnight already); `ceiling_date()` moves each due date forward to its week boundary.

14.6 Categorical Data Fundamentals

```r
analytics_raw <- readRDS("analytics_raw.rds")
```

Q1. Quantitative or qualitative? Quantitative: Age, Annual Sales, Weight, Height, Job/Work Experience. Qualitative: Gender, Education Level, Vehicle Type, Ice Cream Flavor, Blood Group, Color, Mode of Payment. (Education Level is qualitative but *ordered* — see ordered factors below.)

Q2. Dichotomous or polychotomous? Dichotomous (exactly two outcomes): Heads / Tails, Rich / Poor, Democrat / Republican. Polychotomous (three or more): Blood Group, Transportation Mode, Education Level.

Q3–Q9. Factor checks, coercion and level control on `analytics_raw`.

```r
# Q3: which of these are already factors? (raw file: none - all character)
sapply(analytics_raw[c("device", "page_depth", "landing_page")], is.factor)
```

```
      device   page_depth landing_page
       FALSE        FALSE        FALSE
```

```r
# Q4: coerce the categorical columns (page_depth stays numeric;
# `city` is not in this file, so it is skipped)
cat_vars <- c("device", "os", "browser", "user_type", "channel",
  "gender", "landing_page", "exit_page", "country")
analytics_raw[cat_vars] <- lapply(analytics_raw[cat_vars], factor)

# Q5: keep only male/female levels in gender
gender <- factor(analytics_raw$gender, levels = c("male", "female"))
levels(gender)
```

```
[1] "male"   "female"
```

```r
# Q6: admit NA as a level (no-op here - this file has no missing gender,
# but the call is what makes unseen NAs explicit downstream)
library(forcats)
gender <- fct_na_value_to_level(gender, level = NA)
levels(gender)
```

```
[1] "male"   "female" NA
```

```r
# Q7: label that NA level "missing"
gender <- fct_na_value_to_level(gender, level = "(Missing)")
levels(gender)
```

```
[1] "male"      "female"    "(Missing)"
```

```
# Q8: relabel user_type levels
user_type <- fct_recode(factor(analytics_raw$user_type),
  "New" = "New Visitor", "Returning" = "Returning Visitor")
levels(user_type)
```

```
[1] "New"       "Returning"
```

```
# Q9: is user_rating ordered? coerce if not
is.ordered(analytics_raw$user_rating)
```

```
[1] FALSE
```

```
user_rating <- ordered(analytics_raw$user_rating)
is.ordered(user_rating)
```

```
[1] TRUE
```

Q10–Q13. Level counts, categories, frequencies and a two-way summary.

```
# Q10: number of levels
sapply(analytics_raw[c("browser", "channel", "landing_page", "exit_page")],
  \(x) nlevels(factor(x)))
```

```
     browser      channel landing_page    exit_page
          26            8           33           33
```

```
# Q11: the categories themselves
lapply(analytics_raw[c("os", "channel", "browser", "gender", "user_type")],
  \(x) levels(factor(x)))
```

```
$os
 [1] "(not set)"        "Android"          "BlackBerry"       "Chrome OS"
 [5] "Firefox OS"       "iOS"              "Linux"            "Macintosh"
 [9] "OS/2"             "Playstation 4"    "Playstation Vita" "Samsung"
[13] "Tizen"            "Windows"          "Windows Phone"    "Xbox"

$channel
[1] "(Other)"        "Affiliates"     "Direct"         "Display"
[5] "Organic Search" "Paid Search"    "Referral"       "Social"
```

```
$browser
 [1] "Amazon Silk"              "Android Browser"
 [3] "Android Webview"          "APKPure"
 [5] "BlackBerry"               "Chrome"
 [7] "Coc Coc"                  "Edge"
 [9] "Firefox"                  "Internet Explorer"
[11] "Maxthon"                  "Mozilla Compatible Agent"
[13] "MRCHROME"                 "Opera"
[15] "Opera Mini"               "Playstation 4"
[17] "Playstation Vita Browser" "Puffin"
[19] "Safari"                   "Safari (in-app)"
[21] "Samsung Internet"         "SeaMonkey"
[23] "Seznam"                   "UC Browser"
[25] "User-Agent:Mozilla"       "YaBrowser"

$gender
[1] "female" "male"

$user_type
[1] "New Visitor"       "Returning Visitor"
```

```
# Q12: frequencies
fct_count(factor(analytics_raw$channel))
```

```
# A tibble: 8 x 2
  f                  n
  <fct>          <int>
1 (Other)         6073
2 Affiliates      7388
3 Direct         39853
4 Display         3375
5 Organic Search 139668
6 Paid Search     4395
7 Referral       35615
8 Social          8031
```

```
fct_count(factor(analytics_raw$user_type))
```

```
# A tibble: 2 x 2
  f                     n
  <fct>             <int>
1 New Visitor      179045
2 Returning Visitor  65353
```

```r
# Q13: channel by user_type - counts and column shares
table(factor(analytics_raw$channel), factor(analytics_raw$user_type))
```

```
                New Visitor Returning Visitor
  (Other)              3718              2355
  Affiliates           5785              1603
  Direct              31576              8277
  Display              2631               744
  Organic Search     106197             33471
  Paid Search          2477              1918
  Referral            19511             16104
  Social               7150               881
```

```r
proportions(table(factor(analytics_raw$channel),
  factor(analytics_raw$user_type)), margin = 2)
```

```
                New Visitor Returning Visitor
  (Other)        0.02076573        0.03603507
  Affiliates     0.03231031        0.02452833
  Direct         0.17635790        0.12665065
  Display        0.01469463        0.01138433
  Organic Search 0.59313022        0.51215705
  Paid Search    0.01383451        0.02934831
  Referral       0.10897260        0.24641562
  Social         0.03993409        0.01348064
```

14.7 Factor Manipulation with forcats

```r
library(forcats)
data <- readRDS("analytics.rds")
```

Q1–Q2. Frequencies in descending order; is `laptop` a `device` level?

```r
data |> pull(device) |> fct_count()
```

```
# A tibble: 3 x 2
  f            n
  <fct>    <int>
```

```
1 Desktop 177282
2 Mobile   63482
3 Tablet    3634
```

```
data |> pull(landing_page) |> fct_count()
```

```
# A tibble: 33 x 2
   f               n
   <fct>       <int>
 1 Accessories  4529
 2 Apparel     32234
 3 Bags         3462
 4 Basket       3920
 5 Brands        128
 6 Drinkware    2806
 7 Eco            75
 8 Electronics   486
 9 FAQ          2626
10 Fun             8
# i 23 more rows
```

```
data |> pull(exit_page) |> fct_count()
```

```
# A tibble: 34 x 2
   f               n
   <fct>       <int>
 1 Accessories  4856
 2 Apparel     38318
 3 Bags         4584
 4 Basket      12072
 5 Brands        129
 6 Drinkware    3227
 7 Eco            79
 8 Electronics   470
 9 FAQ          3455
10 Fun            11
# i 24 more rows
```

```
"laptop" %in% levels(data$device)
```

```
[1] FALSE
```

`fct_count()` sorts most-frequent-first. (`device` here holds Desktop/Mobile/Tablet, so `"laptop"` is not a level — it belongs to the `ecom` schema, not `analytics`.)

Q3–Q8. Collapsing, lumping, keeping and anonymizing levels.

```
# Q3: collapse account-related pages
data |> pull(landing_page) |>
  fct_collapse(Account = c("My Account", "Register", "Sign In", "Your Info")) |>
  fct_count() |> head(6)
```

```
# A tibble: 6 x 2
  f               n
  <fct>       <int>
1 Accessories  4529
2 Apparel     32234
3 Bags         3462
4 Basket       3920
5 Brands        128
6 Drinkware    2806
```

```
# Q4: lump landing pages behind fewer than 1000 visits into "Other"
data |> pull(landing_page) |> fct_lump_min(min = 1000) |> fct_count()
```

```
# A tibble: 16 x 2
   f                  n
   <fct>          <int>
 1 Accessories     4529
 2 Apparel        32234
 3 Bags            3462
 4 Basket          3920
 5 Drinkware       2806
 6 FAQ             2626
 7 Home          135485
 8 Lifestyle       5695
 9 My Account      1121
10 New             6340
11 Office          2454
12 Search          2066
13 Shop by Brand  26826
14 Sign In         3184
15 Store           8979
16 Other           2671
```

```
# Q5: top 10 landing and exit pages
data |> pull(landing_page) |> fct_lump_n(n = 10) |> fct_count()
```

```
# A tibble: 11 x 2
   f                 n
   <fct>         <int>
 1 Accessories    4529
 2 Apparel       32234
 3 Bags           3462
 4 Basket         3920
 5 Home         135485
 6 Lifestyle      5695
 7 New            6340
 8 Shop by Brand 26826
 9 Sign In        3184
10 Store          8979
11 Other         13744
```

```
data |> pull(exit_page) |> fct_lump_n(n = 10) |> fct_count()
```

```
# A tibble: 12 x 2
   f                n
   <fct>        <int>
 1 Accessories   4856
 2 Apparel      38318
 3 Bags          4584
 4 Basket       12072
 5 Home         88051
 6 Lifestyle    13996
 7 New          10426
 8 Search        7185
 9 Shop by Brand 25231
10 Store         17016
11 Other         22095
12 <NA>            568
```

```
# Q6: landing pages with at least 5% of traffic
data |> pull(landing_page) |> fct_lump_prop(prop = 0.05) |> fct_count()
```

```
# A tibble: 4 x 2
  f                n
  <fct>        <int>
1 Apparel      32234
```

```
2 Home          135485
3 Shop by Brand  26826
4 Other          49853
```

```
# Q7: keep only the big-four browsers
data |> pull(browser) |>
  fct_other(keep = c("Chrome", "Firefox", "Safari", "Edge")) |>
  fct_count()
```

```
# A tibble: 5 x 2
  f            n
  <fct>    <int>
1 Chrome  192176
2 Edge      3787
3 Firefox   6420
4 Safari   35323
5 Other     6692
```

```
# Q8: anonymize page levels (stable within a session via seed)
set.seed(42)
data |> pull(landing_page) |> fct_anon() |> head()
```

```
[1] 30 01 31 25 02 25
33 Levels: 01 02 03 04 05 06 07 08 09 10 11 12 13 14 15 16 17 18 19 20 ... 33
```

Q9–Q15. Reordering, shuffling and reversing levels.

```
set.seed(42)
landing_page <- data$landing_page
browser <- data$browser

# Q9/Q10/Q11: Home first, Apparel second, Specials last
landing_page |> fct_relevel("Home") |> levels() |> head(4)
```

```
[1] "Home"        "Accessories" "Apparel"     "Bags"
```

```
landing_page |> fct_relevel("Apparel", after = 1L) |> levels() |> head(4)
```

```
[1] "Accessories" "Apparel"     "Bags"        "Basket"
```

```
landing_page |> fct_relevel("Specials", after = Inf) |> levels() |> tail(3)
```

```
[1] "Wishlist"  "Your Info" "Specials"
```

```
# Q12: browsers by frequency
browser |> fct_infreq() |> levels()
```

```
 [1] "Chrome"                   "Safari"
 [3] "Firefox"                  "Edge"
 [5] "Samsung Internet"         "Android Webview"
 [7] "Opera"                    "Internet Explorer"
 [9] "Safari (in-app)"          "YaBrowser"
[11] "UC Browser"               "Amazon Silk"
[13] "Android Browser"          "Opera Mini"
[15] "Coc Coc"                  "User-Agent:Mozilla"
[17] "Puffin"                   "Playstation 4"
[19] "Mozilla Compatible Agent" "BlackBerry"
[21] "Maxthon"                  "SeaMonkey"
[23] "APKPure"                  "MRCHROME"
[25] "Playstation Vita Browser" "Seznam"
```

```
# Q13: landing pages in order of appearance
landing_page |> fct_inorder() |> levels() |> head(6)
```

```
[1] "Home"          "Accessories"   "Sign In"       "Apparel"
[5] "Shop by Brand" "Lifestyle"
```

```
# Q14: shuffled os levels
data |> pull(os) |> fct_shuffle() |> levels()
```

```
 [1] "(not set)"        "Firefox OS"       "Xbox"             "OS/2"
 [5] "Playstation 4"    "Chrome OS"        "Android"          "Windows"
 [9] "Macintosh"        "Linux"            "Playstation Vita" "Tizen"
[13] "Windows Phone"    "Samsung"          "BlackBerry"       "iOS"
```

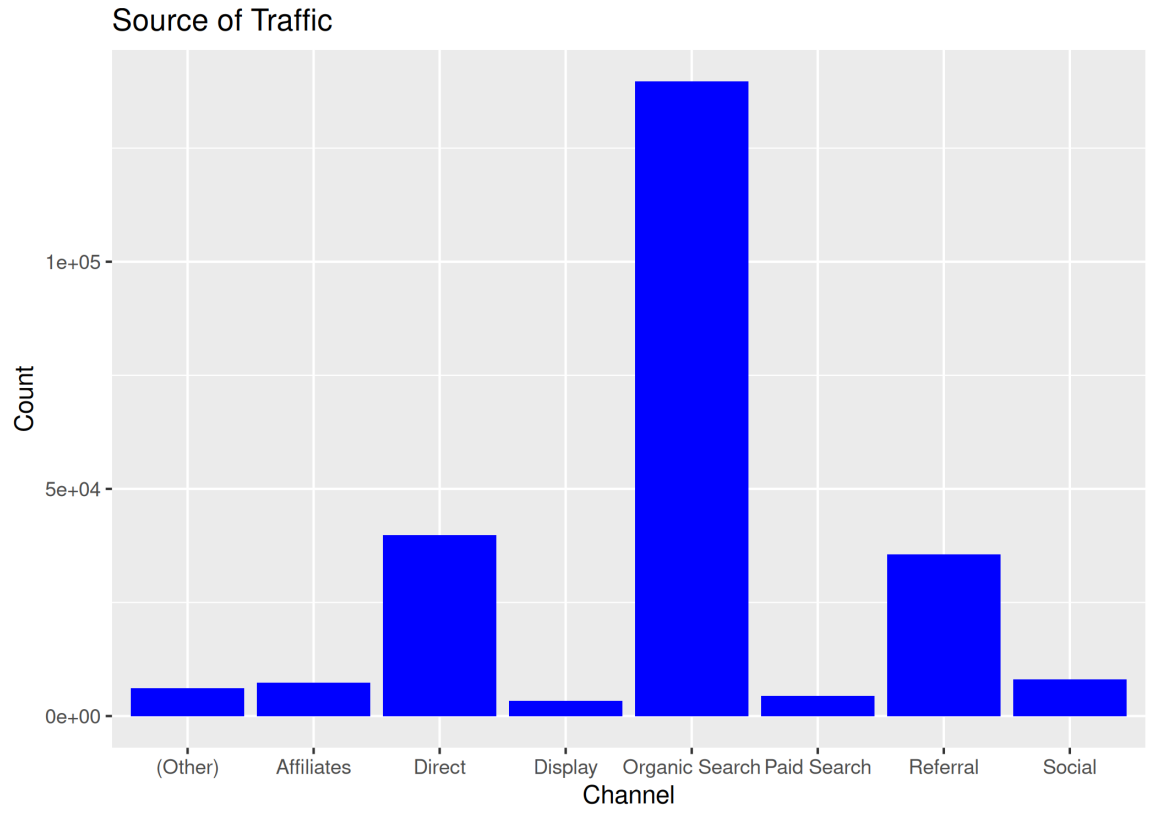
```
# Q15: reversed browser levels
browser |> fct_rev() |> levels()
```

```
 [1] "YaBrowser"                "User-Agent:Mozilla"
 [3] "UC Browser"               "Seznam"
 [5] "SeaMonkey"                "Samsung Internet"
```

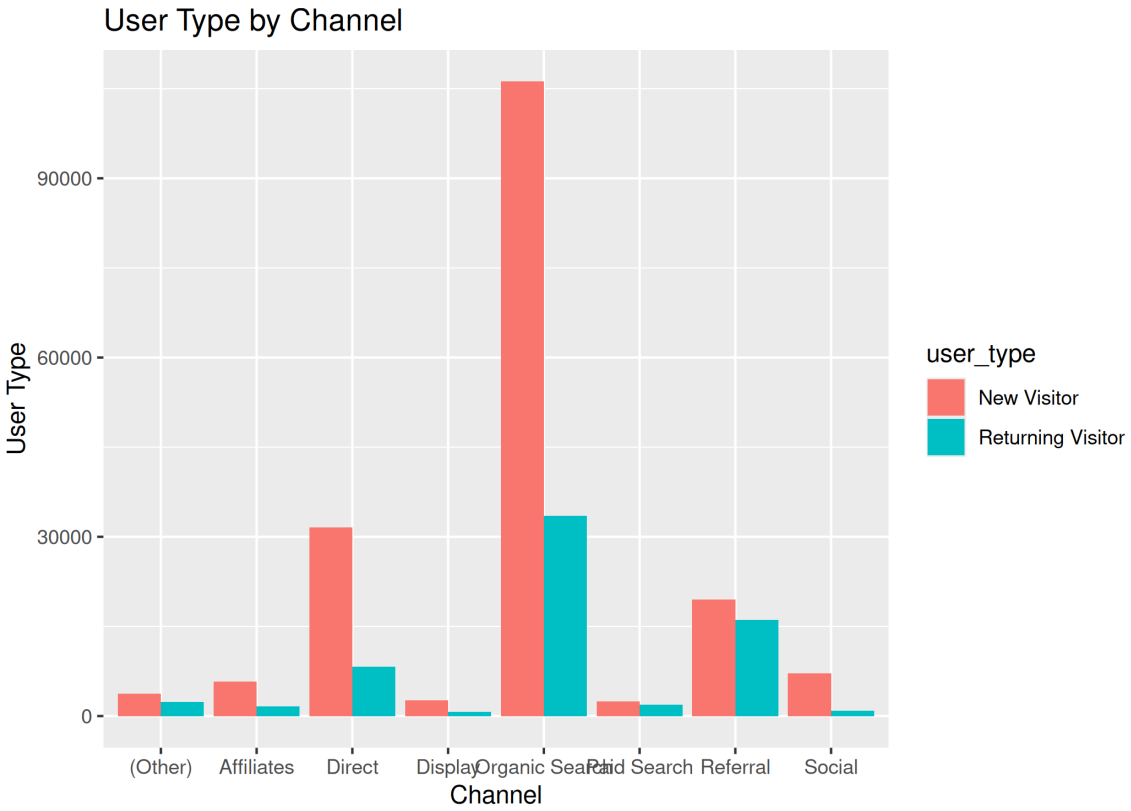
```
 [7] "Safari (in-app)"           "Safari"
 [9] "Puffin"                    "Playstation Vita Browser"
[11] "Playstation 4"             "Opera Mini"
[13] "Opera"                     "MRCHROME"
[15] "Mozilla Compatible Agent" "Maxthon"
[17] "Internet Explorer"         "Firefox"
[19] "Edge"                      "Coc Coc"
[21] "Chrome"                    "BlackBerry"
[23] "APKPure"                   "Android Webview"
[25] "Android Browser"           "Amazon Silk"
```

Q16. The plots.

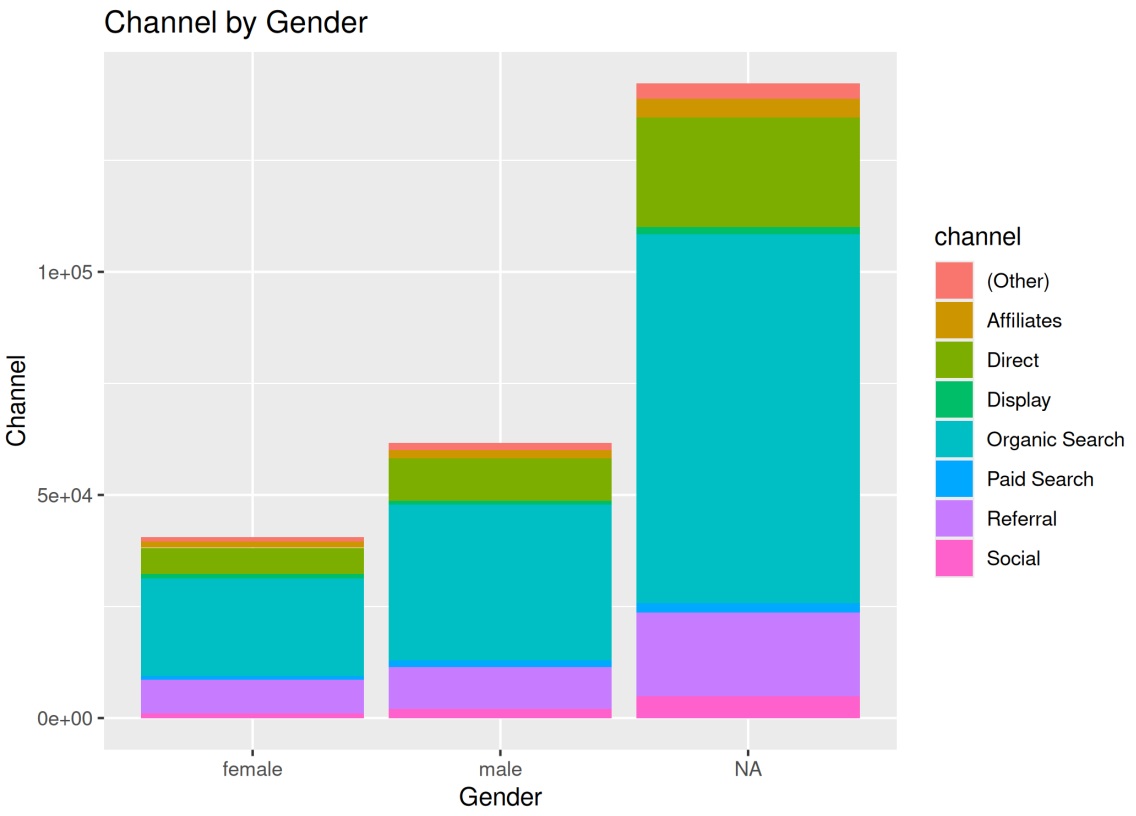
```
library(ggplot2)
# 1: bar plot of channel
ggplot(data) +
  geom_bar(aes(x = channel), fill = "blue") +
  ggtitle("Source of Traffic") + xlab("Channel") + ylab("Count")
```



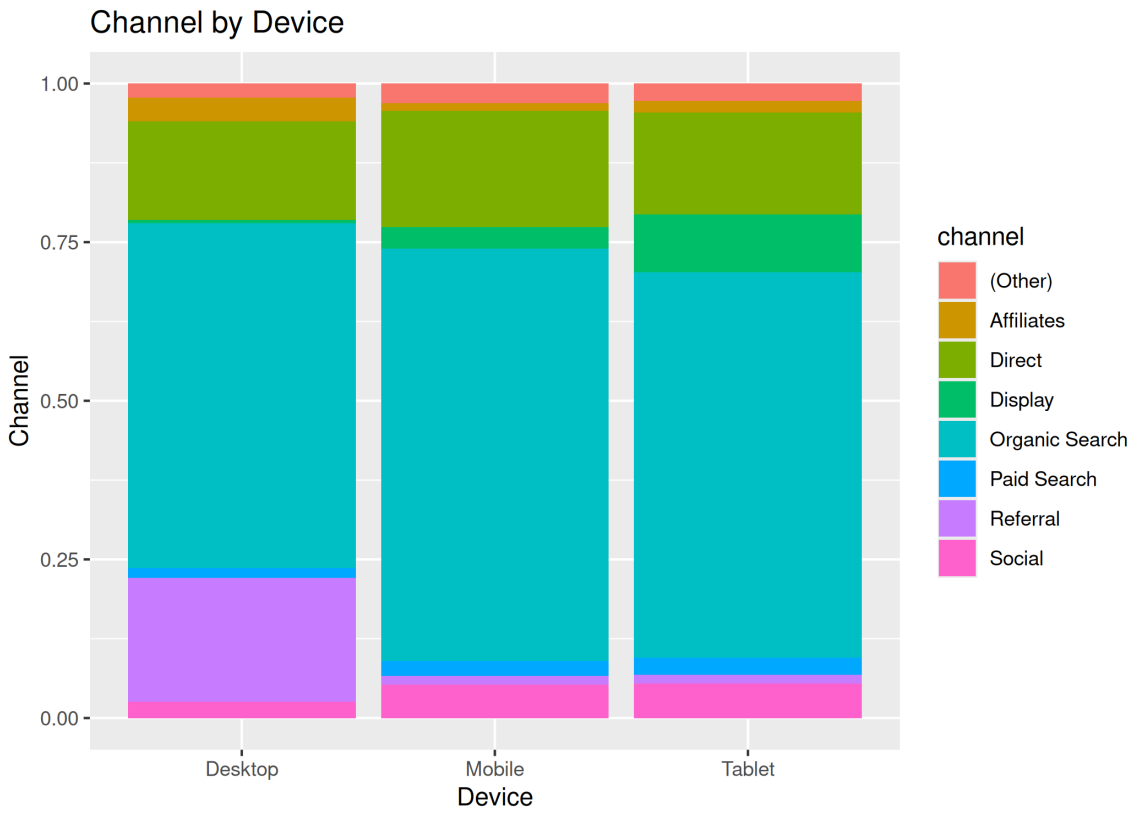
```
# 2: grouped bars, user_type by channel
ggplot(data) +
  geom_bar(aes(x = channel, fill = user_type), position = "dodge") +
  ggtitle("User Type by Channel") + xlab("Channel") + ylab("User Type")
```



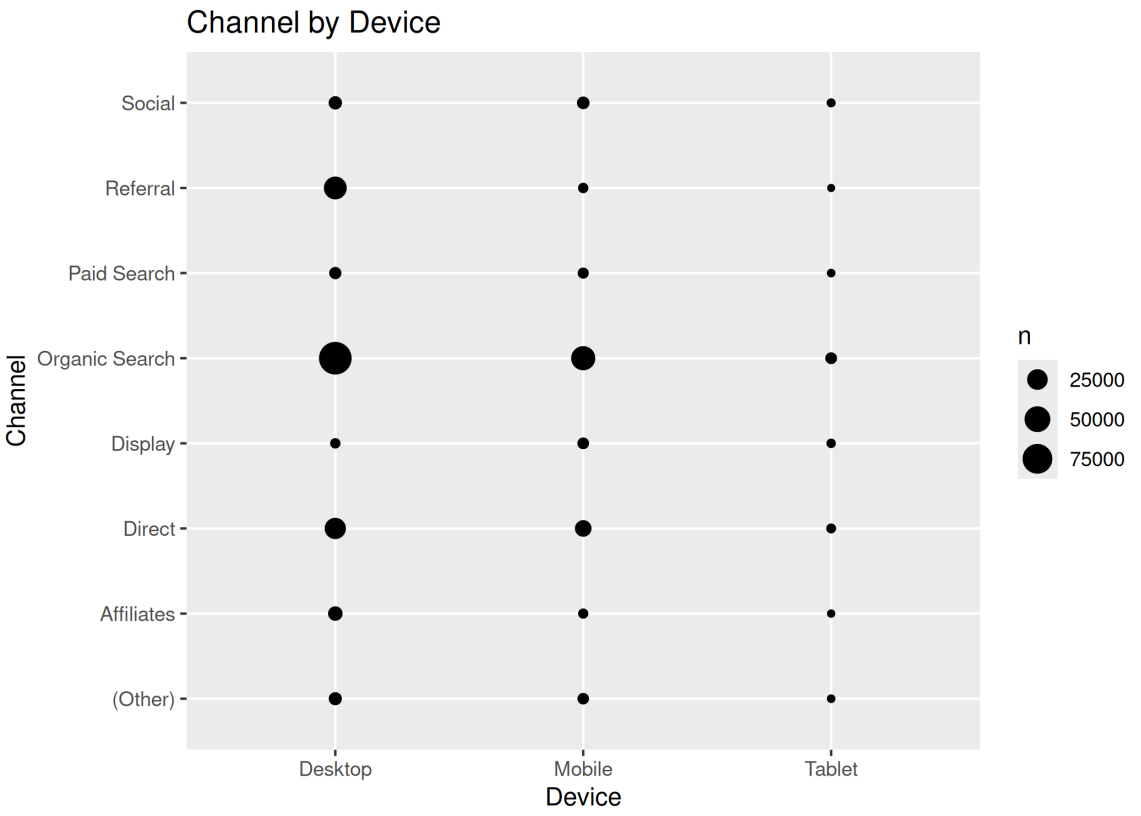

```
# 3: stacked bars, channel by gender
ggplot(data) +
  geom_bar(aes(x = gender, fill = channel)) +
  ggtitle("Channel by Gender") + xlab("Gender") + ylab("Channel")
```



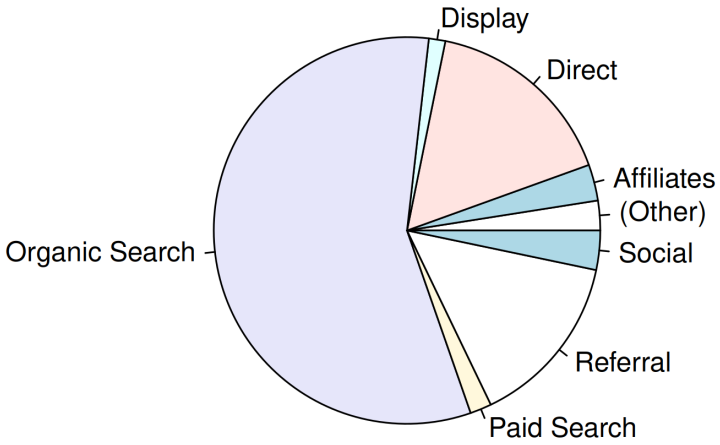

```
# 4: proportional bars, channel by device
data |>
  select(device, channel) |>
  table() |>
  tibble::as_tibble() |>
  ggplot(aes(x = device, y = n, fill = channel)) +
  geom_bar(stat = "identity", position = "fill") +
  ggtitle("Channel by Device") + xlab("Device") + ylab("Channel")
```



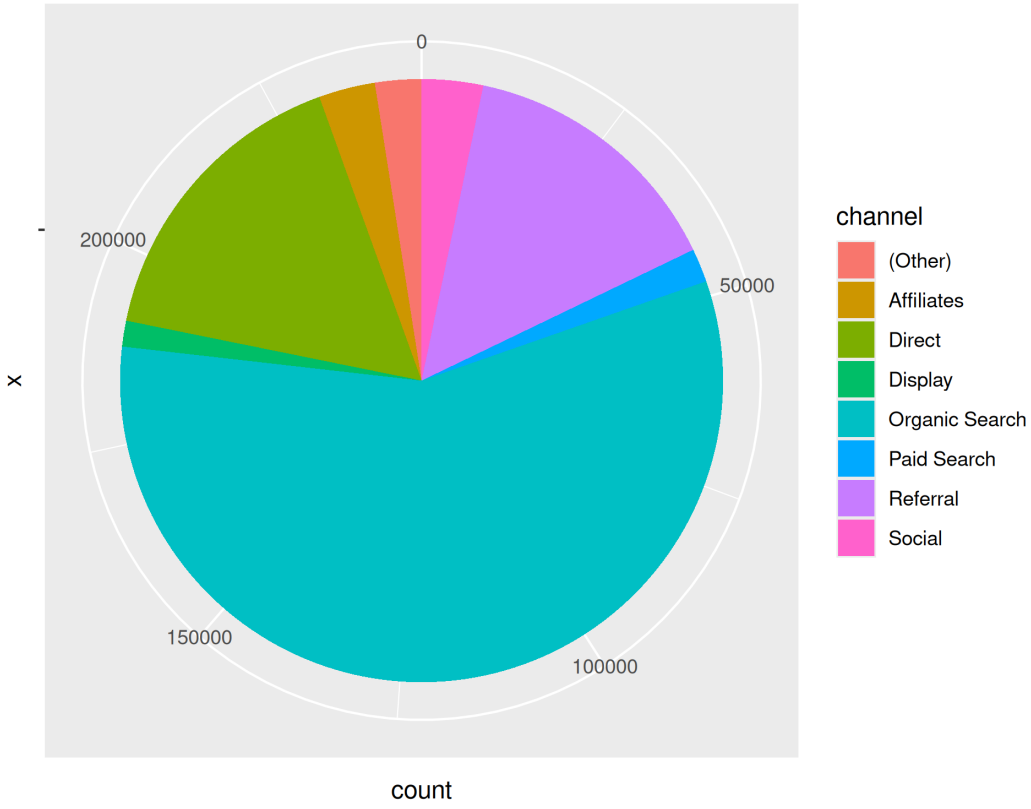

```
# 5: count plot, device by channel
ggplot(data, aes(x = device, y = channel)) +
  geom_count() +
  ggtitle("Channel by Device") +
  xlab("Device") + ylab("Channel")
```




```
# 6: pie and donut of channel
data |> pull(channel) |> table() |> pie()
```




```
data |>
  pull(channel) |>
  fct_count() |>
  rename(channel = f, count = n) |>
  ggplot() +
  geom_bar(aes(x = "", y = count, fill = channel), width = 1,
    stat = "identity") +
  coord_polar("y", start = 0)
```



14.8 Open stubs

Chapters without **Your Turn** blocks still need proposed drills + solutions — contributions welcome (see above):

- @joining-tables-in-r-dplyr: join puzzles on `customer`/`order`
- @dplyr-helper-functions: sampling/slicing drills on `ecom`
- @r-pipe-magrittr: rewrite-a-chain exercises (`%>%` → `|>`, `_`, `\(x)`)
- @tibbles-in-r: tibble vs data.frame edge cases
- @strings-in-r: URL/email parsing variants on `mockstring`
- @import-data-in-r-basics and @import-data-in-r-advanced: import-parameter drills

A Arrow, Parquet and DuckDB

A.1 Introduction

Everything so far fit in memory as CSV. Two tools cover the next scale, and both speak the dplyr you already know:

- **Parquet** (via **arrow**) — a compressed columnar file format. The same data takes far less disk and reads much faster than CSV.
- **DuckDB** (via **duckplyr**) — an in-process analytical database. dplyr verbs run inside it, so data larger than memory stays on disk until `collect()`.

Both are optional: install them with `install.packages(c("arrow", "duckdb", "duckplyr"))`. The chunks below run only when the packages are present (`eval = requireNamespace(...)`), so the book still builds without them. Browser execution of parquet is intentionally deferred until WebR binary sizes are checked (see the P2 plan).

A.2 Parquet with arrow

Write `ecom` to parquet and read it back. The round-trip lands in a temporary directory, so nothing litters the project:

```
library(dplyr)
library(readr)
library(arrow)

ecom <-
  read_csv('https://raw.githubusercontent.com/rsquaredacademy/datasets/master/web.csv',
    col_types = cols_only(device = col_factor(levels = c("laptop", "tablet", "mobile")),
      referrer = col_factor(levels = c("bing", "direct", "social", "yahoo", "google")),
      purchase = col_logical(), n_pages = col_double(), n_visit = col_double(),
      duration = col_double(), order_value = col_double(), order_items = col_double()
    )
  )

pq <- file.path(tempdir(), "ecom.parquet")
cs <- file.path(tempdir(), "ecom.csv")
write_parquet(ecom, pq)
```

```
write_csv(ecom, cs)

# same rows, roughly half the bytes
c(csv_bytes = file.size(cs), parquet_bytes = file.size(pq))
```

```
    csv_bytes parquet_bytes
        32287         14878
```

`read_parquet()` returns a tibble, so every verb from @dplyr-basics works unchanged:

```
ecom_pq <- read_parquet(pq)
class(ecom_pq)
```

```
[1] "spec_tbl_df" "tbl_df"      "tbl"         "data.frame"
```

```
ecom_pq |>
  filter(purchase) |>
  summarise(revenue = sum(order_value), orders = n(), .by = device)
```

```
# A tibble: 3 x 3
  device revenue orders
  <fct>    <dbl>  <int>
1 tablet   51321     36
2 mobile   51504     36
3 laptop   56531     31
```

A.3 DuckDB with duckplyr

`duckdb_tibble()` (duckplyr >= 1.0) moves a data frame into DuckDB and hands back a lazy table: dplyr verbs build the query, nothing runs until `collect()`:

```
library(duckplyr)

ecom_duck <- duckdb_tibble(ecom)
class(ecom_duck)
```

```
[1] "duckplyr_df" "tbl_df"      "tbl"         "data.frame"
```

```
ecom_duck |>
  filter(purchase) |>
  summarise(revenue = sum(order_value), orders = n(), .by = device) |>
  mutate(aov = revenue / orders) |>
  collect()
```

```
# A tibble: 3 x 4
  device revenue orders   aov
* <fct>    <dbl>  <int> <dbl>
1 laptop   56531     31 1824.
2 tablet   51321     36 1426.
3 mobile   51504     36 1431.
```

The numbers match the Chapter @dplyr-basics AOV exactly — the engine changed, the answers did not. Reach for this pattern when a single CSV no longer fits comfortably in memory: keep the data in DuckDB (or parquet on disk), push the verbs down, and `collect()` only the summary.

B Legacy magrittr Operators

This book teaches the base R pipe `|>` exclusively (see @r-pipe-magrittr for the one comparison table). This appendix is a graveyard: a read-only map for the magrittr operators you will meet in inherited code. Do not use them in new code.

Inherited operator	Meaning	Modern equivalent (this book)
`x %>% f()`	Forward `x` into first argument of `f`	`x |> f()`
`x %$% f(col)`	Expose columns of `x` to `f`	`x |> pull(col) |> f()`
`x %<>% f()`	Forward and assign back to `x`	`x <- x |> f()`
`x %>% extract(i)` / `extract2(i)`	Subset by position or name	`x[i]` / `x[[i]]`, or `pull(x, col)` / `pluck(x, i)`
`x %>% use_series(col)`	Extract `col` as vector	`pull(x, col)` or `x$col`

The pipe chapter's data-extraction section covers `pull()`/`pluck()` with runnable examples; the legacy note there explains why `%$%`, `%<>%`, `extract()`/`extract2()` and `use_series()` stay out of the main text.

C From pandas to dplyr

C.1 Introduction

Switching from Python? The ideas transfer one-to-one; only the verbs change. `pandas` snippets below are static reference (never executed by this book); the dplyr side runs on the ecommerce data from @dplyr-basics.

```
library(dplyr)
library(readr)

ecom <-
  read_csv('https://raw.githubusercontent.com/rsquaredacademy/datasets/master/web.csv',
    col_types = cols_only(device = col_factor(levels = c("laptop", "tablet", "mobile")),
      referrer = col_factor(levels = c("bing", "direct", "social", "yahoo", "google")),
      purchase = col_logical(), n_pages = col_double(), n_visit = col_double(),
      duration = col_double(), order_value = col_double(), order_items = col_double()
    )
  )
```

C.2 Verb map

Task	pandas	dplyr (this book)
Read CSV	`pd.read_csv("web.csv")`	`read_csv("web.csv")`
First rows	`df.head(10)`	`head(ecom, 10)` / `slice_head(ecom, n = 10)`
Filter rows	`df[df.purchase]` or `df.query("purchase")`	`filter(ecom, purchase)`
Pick columns	`df[["device", "order_value"]]`	`select(ecom, device, order_value)`
Sort	`df.sort_values("n_pages")`	`arrange(ecom, n_pages)`
New column	`df.assign(aov=df.revenue/df.orders)`	`mutate(ecom4, aov = revenue / orders)`
Group + aggregate	`df.groupby("device").agg(revenue=("order_value", "sum"))`	`summarise(ecom, revenue = sum(order_value), .by = device)`

Task	pandas	dplyr (this book)
Join	`pd.merge(customer, order, on="id", how="left")`	`left_join(customer, order, by = join_by(id))`
Drop missing	`df.dropna()`	`drop_na(df)`
Reshape long/wide	`df.melt(...)` / `df.pivot(...)`	`pivot_longer()` / `pivot_wider()`
Strings	`s.str.contains(pat)`, `s.str.extract(pat)`	`str_detect()`, `str_extract()`
Datetimes	`pd.to_datetime(s)`, `s.dt.year`	`ymd()`, `year()`, `month()`, `day()`
Categories	`astype("category")`, `cat.reorder_categories`	`factor()`, `fct_relevel()`, `fct_lump_*()`

C.3 Worked pair: grouped means

pandas:

```
ecom.groupby("purchase")["n_pages"].mean()
```

dplyr (runs here):

```
ecom |>
  summarise(mean_pages = mean(n_pages), .by = purchase)
```

```
# A tibble: 2 x 2
  purchase mean_pages
  <lgl>         <dbl>
1 FALSE          4.79
2 TRUE          15.8
```

Same split-apply-combine, same answer. The rest of the grammar maps the same way: chain with `|>` where pandas chains with `.`, and reach for Chapters @dplyr-basics–@categorical-data-in-r for the full drill.

Try it live

Try it in your browser

Edit the code below and press **Run**. It executes entirely in your browser via WebR — no R installation needed. The runtime downloads once, on this page only.

```
library(dplyr)
library(readr)
if (!file.exists("ecom_sample.csv")) {
  download.file(
    "https://wrangle-r.rsquaredacademy.com/data-webr/ecom_sample.csv",
    "ecom_sample.csv"
  )
}
ecom <- read_csv("ecom_sample.csv", show_col_types = FALSE)
ecom |>
  summarise(mean_pages = mean(n_pages), .by = purchase)
```